

Lancelot of the Laik: A Scottish Metrical Romance (About 1490-1500 A. D.)

Walter W. Skeat

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK LANCELOT OF
THE LAIK: A SCOTTISH METRICAL ROMANCE (ABOUT 1490-1500
A. D.) ***

This text includes characters that require UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding:

ƿ	long “s”
ȝ ȝ	yogh
ṁ	m with over-line (the equivalent “n” form is shown as ñ with tilde for better font support)
æ	æ with accent, only in the Glossary

There are also a few letters with macron (“long” mark). If any of these characters do not display properly—in particular, if the diacritic does not appear directly above the letter—or if the apostrophes and quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that the browser’s “character set” or “file encoding” is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser’s default font.

Unlike most EETS productions, this book was printed with long “s” (ƿ). The editor’s Introduction says:

We find, in the MS., both the long and the twisted s (ƿ and s). These have been noted down as they occur, though I do not observe any law for their use. The letter “ȝ” has been adopted as closely resembling a symbol in the MS., which apparently has the force of double s, and is not unlike the “sz” used in modern German hand-writing.

Typographical errors are shown in the text with mouse-hover popups. For details, see the [end of the e-text](#).

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Links: Throughout the book, links to numbered lines generally lead to the nearest multiple of 4 (printed number). In the two primary texts, marginal page numbers link to the Notes for that page. In the Preface, all line numbers are active links. To reduce visual chaos, conventional highlighting has been turned off; instead the links are shown in **boldface**. This may be overridden by your personal browser settings.

In the Glossary, ȝ (yogh) is alphabetized as z.

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of
Lancelot of the Laik.

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Lancelot of the Laik :

A SCOTTISH METRICAL ROMANCE,

(ABOUT 1490-1500 A.D.)

RE-EDITED

FROM A MANUSCRIPT IN THE CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY
LIBRARY,

WITH AN

INTRODUCTION, NOTES, AND GLOSSARIAL INDEX,

BY

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PREFACE.

I.—DESCRIPTION OF THE MS., ETC.

A FORMER edition of the present poem was printed for the Maitland Club, in 1839, and edited by Joseph Stevenson, Esq. It has saved me all trouble of transcription, but by no means, I am sorry to say, that of correction. Those who possess the older edition will readily perceive that it differs from the present one very frequently indeed, and that the variations are often such as considerably to affect the sense. Many of the errors in it (such as *casualtyee* for *casualty*, *grone*, for *gone*, *reprent* for *repent*) are clearly typographical, but there are others which would incline me to believe that the transcription was too hastily executed; several passages being quite meaningless. Near the conclusion of Mr Stevenson's preface we read: "The pieces which have been selected for the present volume [1](#) are printed with such errors of transcription as have crept into them by the carelessness of the scribe;" a statement which certainly implies that there was no intention on his part of departing from the original. Yet that he sometimes unconsciously did so to such an extent as considerably to alter (or destroy) the sense, the reader may readily judge from a few examples:—

LINE.	EDITION OF 1839.	TRUE READING OF THE MS.
<u>26.</u>	fatil (<i>fatal</i>),	fatit (<i>fated</i>).
<u>285.</u>	unarmyt (<i>unarmed</i>),	enarmyt (<i>fully armed</i>).
<u>682.</u>	can here,	cam nere.
<u>700.</u>	rendit (<i>rent</i>),	vondit (<i>wounded</i>).

<u>764.</u>	refuse (<i>refusal?</i>),	reprefe (<i>defeat</i>).
<u>861.</u>	felith (<i>feeleth</i>),	fetith (<i>setteth</i>).
<u>1054.</u>	vyt,	rycht.
<u>1084.</u>	speiris,	spuris.
<u>1455.</u>	cumyng (<i>coming</i>),	cunyng (<i>skill</i>).
<u>1621.</u>	he war,	be war (<i>beware</i>).
<u>1641.</u>	promyß,	punyß (<i>punish</i>).
<u>2010.</u>	ane desyne,	medysyne.
<u>2092.</u>	born,	lorn (<i>lost</i>).
<u>2114.</u>	havin,	harm.
<u>2142.</u>	Hymene (!),	hyme (<i>him</i>).
<u>2219.</u>	such,	furth (<i>forth</i>).
<u>2245.</u>	al so y-vroght,	al foly vroght.
<u>2279.</u>	chichingis (!),	thithingis (<i>tidings</i>).
<u>2446.</u>	love,	lore (<i>teaching</i>). Etc.

Several omissions also occur, as, *e.g.*, of the word “off” in 1. 7, of the word “tressore” in 1. 1715, and of four whole lines at a time in two instances; viz., lines 1191-4, and 2877-80. It will be found, in fact, that the former text can seldom be safely quoted for the purposes of philology; and I cannot but think Mr Stevenson’s claim of being accurate to be especially unfortunate; and the more so, because the genuine text is much simpler and more intelligible than the one which he has given.

The original MS. is to be found in the Cambridge University Library, marked Kk. 1. 5. It formerly formed part of a thick volume, labelled “Tracts;” but these are now being separated, for greater convenience, into several volumes. The MS. of “Lancelot” has little to do with any of the rest as regards its subject, but several other pieces are in the same hand-writing; and, at the end of one of them, an abstract of Solomon’s proverbs, occur the words, “Expliciunt Dicta Salamonis, per manum V. de F.” ² This hand-writing, though close, is very regular, and my own impression certainly is

that the scribe has almost always succeeded in preserving the sense of the poem, though there is much confusion in the dialectal forms, as will be shewn presently.

The present text is as close a fac-simile of the MS. as can be represented by printed letters, every peculiarity being preserved as far as practicable, even including the use of *y* for *þ* (or *th*); so that the reader must remember that *yow* in **l. 94** stands for *thow*, and *yis* in **l. 160** for *this*, and so on; but this ought not to cause much difficulty. The sole points of difference are the following:

1. In the MS. the headings “Prologue,” “Book I.” etc., do not occur.
2. The lines do not always begin (in the MS.) with a capital letter.
3. The letters *italicized* are (in the MS.) represented by signs of contraction. One source of difficulty is the flourish over a word, used *sometimes* as a contraction for *m* or *n*. I have expanded this flourish as an *m* or *n* wherever such letter is manifestly required; but it also occurs where it is best to attach to it no value. In such instances, the flourish occurs most frequently over the last word in a line, and (except very rarely) only over words which have an *m* or *n* in them. It would thus seem that their presence is due to the fact of the scribe wanting employment for his pen after the line had been written, and that the flourish therefore appears over certain words, not so much because the *n* is *wanting* in them, as because it is *there already*. Such words have a special attraction for the wandering pen. Still, in order that the reader may know wherever such flourishes occur, they have all been noted down; thus, in **l. 46**, the stroke over the *n* in “greñ” means that a long flourish occurs drawn over the whole word, and the reader who wishes to expand this word into “grene” or “grenn” may easily do it for himself, though he should observe that the most usual form of the word is simply “gren,” as in lines **1000**, **1305**.

In a few nouns ending in *-l*, the plural is indicated by a stroke drawn through the doubled letter; as in *perillis*, *sadillis*, etc.; and even the word *ellis* (else) is thus abbreviated.

4. I am responsible for all hyphens, and letters and words between square brackets; thus, “with-outen” is in the MS. “with outen;” and “knych[t]ly” is

written “knychly.” Whenever a line begins with a capital letter included between two brackets, the original has a blank space left, evidently intended for an illuminated letter. Wherever illuminated letters actually occur in the MS., they are denoted in this edition by large capitals.

5. We find, in the MS., both the long and the twisted s (f and s). These have been noted down as they occur, though I do not observe any law for their use. The letter “ß” has been adopted as closely resembling a symbol in the MS., which apparently has the force of double s, and is not unlike the “sz” used in modern German hand-writing. It may be conveniently denoted by ss when the type “ß” is not to be had, and is sometimes so represented in the “Notes.”

6. The MS. is, of course, not punctuated. The punctuation in the present edition is mostly new; and many passages, which in the former edition were meaningless, have thus been rendered easily intelligible. I am also responsible for the headings of the pages, the abstract at the sides of them, the numbering of the folios in the margin, the notes, and the glossary; which I hope may be found useful. The greatest care has been taken to make the text accurate, the proof-sheets having been compared with the MS. *three times* throughout. [3](#)

II.—DESCRIPTION OF THE POEM.

The poem itself is a loose paraphrase of not quite fourteen folios of the first of the three volumes of the French Romance of Lancelot du Lac, if we refer to it as reprinted at Paris in 1513, in three volumes, thin folio, double-columned. [4](#) The English poet has set aside the French Prologue, and written a new one of his own, and has afterwards translated and amplified that portion of the Romance which narrates the invasion of Arthur’s territory by “le roy de oultre les marches, nomme galehault” (in the English *Galiot*), and the defeat of the said king by Arthur and his allies.

The Prologue (lines **1-334**) tells how the author undertook to write a romance to please his lady-love; and how, after deciding to take as his subject the story of Lancelot as told in the French Romance, yet finding

himself unequal to a close translation of the whole of it, he determined to give a paraphrase of a portion of it only. After giving us a brief summary of the earlier part by the simple process of telling us what he will *not* relate, he proposes to begin the story at the point where Lancelot has been made prisoner by the lady of Melyhalt, and to take as his subject the wars between Arthur and Galiot, and the distinction which Lancelot won in them; and afterwards to tell how Lancelot made peace between these two kings, and was consequently rewarded by Venus, who

“makith hyme his ladice grace to have” (1. 311).

The latter part of the poem, it may be observed, has not come down to us. The author then concludes his Prologue by beseeching to have the support of a very celebrated poet, whose name he will not mention, but will only say that

“Ye fresch enditing of his laiting tounge
Out through yis world so wid is younge,” etc. 5 (1. 328.)

The first Book introduces us to King Arthur at Carlisle. 6 The king is visited by dreams, which he imagines to forebode misfortune; he therefore convokes all his clerks, and inquires of them the meaning of the dreams, proposing to hang them in the event of their refusal. Thus strongly urged, they tell him that those on whom he most relies will fail him at his need; and when he further inquires if this evil fate can be averted, they answer him very obscurely that it can only be remedied by help of the water-lion, the leech, and the flower; a reply which the king evidently regards as unsatisfactory. Soon after an aged knight, fully armed, enters the palace, with a message from King Galiot, requiring him to give “tribute and rent.” Arthur at once refuses, somewhat to the astonishment of the knight, who is amazed at his hardihood. Next arrives a message from the lady of Melyhalt, informing Arthur of the actual presence of Galiot’s army. We are then momentarily introduced to Lancelot, who is pining miserably in the lady’s custody. Next follows a description of Galiot’s army, at sight of the approach of which King Arthur and his “niece,” Sir Gawain, confer as to the best means of resistance. In the ensuing battle Sir Gawain greatly distinguishes himself, but is at last severely wounded. Sir Lancelot, coming to hear of Sir Gawain’s deeds, craves leave of the lady to be allowed to take part in the next conflict, who grants him his boon on condition that he

promise to return to his prison. She then provides for him a red courser, and a complete suit of red armour, in which guise he appears at the second battle, and is the “head and comfort of the field;” the queen and Sir Gawain beholding his exploits from a tower. The result of the battle convinces Galiot that Arthur is not strong enough at present to resist him sufficiently, and that he thus runs the risk of a too easy, and therefore dishonourable, conquest; for which excellent reason he grants Arthur a twelvemonth’s truce, with a promise to return again in increased force at the expiration of that period. Sir Lancelot returns to Melyhalt according to promise, and the lady is well pleased at hearing the reports of his famous deeds, and visits him when asleep, out of curiosity to observe his appearance after the fight.

In the Second Book the story makes but little progress, nearly the whole of it being occupied by a long lecture or sermon delivered to Arthur by a “master,” named Amytans, on the duties of a king; the chief one being that a king should give presents to everybody—a duty which is insisted on with laborious tediousness. Lines **1320-2130** are almost entirely occupied with this subject, and will be found to be the driest part of the whole narrative. In the course of his lecture, Amytans explains at great length the obscure prophecy mentioned above, shewing that by the water-lion is meant God the Father, by the leech God the Son, and by the flower the Virgin Mary. Though the outline of a similar lecture exists in the old French text, there would seem to be a special reason for the length to which it is here expanded. Some lines certainly seem to hint at events passing in Scotland at the time when the poem was composed. Thus, “kings may be excused when of tender age” (**I. 1658**); but when they come to years of discretion should punish those that have wrested the law. Again we find (**I. 1920**) strong warnings against flatterers, concluding (**I. 1940**) with the expression,

“Wo to the realme that havith sich o chans!”

Such hints may remind us of the long minorities of James II. and James III.; and, whilst speaking on this subject, I may note a somewhat remarkable coincidence. When King Arthur, as related in Book I., asks the meaning of his dream, he is told that it signifies that “they in whom he most trusts will fail him” (**I. 499**); and he afterwards laments (**I. 1151**) how his “men fail him at need.” Now when we read that a story is current of a prophetess having told James III. that he was destined to “fall by the hands of his own

kindred,” [7](#) and that that monarch was in the habit of consulting *astrologers* [8](#) (compare [l. 432](#)) as to the dangers that threatened him, it seems quite possible that the poem was really composed about the year 1478; and this supposition is consistent with the fact that the hand-writing of the present MS. copy belongs to the very end of the fifteenth century.

Towards the end of the Second Book, we learn that the twelvemonth’s truce draws near its end, and that Sir Lancelot again obtains permission from the lady to be present in the approaching combat, choosing this time to be arrayed in “armys al of blak” ([l. 2426](#)).

In the Third Book Galiot returns to the fight with a host thrice as large as his former one. As before, Gawain distinguishes himself in the first encounter, but is at length so “evil wounded” that he was “the worse thereof evermore” ([l. 2706](#)). In the second combat, the black knight utterly eclipses the red knight, and the last thousand (extant) lines of the poem are almost wholly occupied with a description of his wonderful prowess. At the point where the extant portion of the poem ceases, the author would appear to be just warming with his subject, and to be preparing for greater efforts.

In continuance of the outline of the story, I may add that the French text [9](#) informs us how, after being several times remounted by Galiot, and finding himself with every fresh horse quite as fresh as he was at the beginning of the battle, the black knight attempted, as evening fell, to make his way back to Melyhalt secretly. Galiot, however, having determined not to lose sight of him, follows and confronts him, and earnestly requests his company to supper, and that he will lodge in his tent that night. After a little hesitation, Lancelot accepts the invitation, and Galiot entertains him with the utmost respect and flattery, providing for him a most excellent supper and a bed larger than any of the rest. Lancelot, though naturally somewhat wearied, passes a rather restless night, and talks a good deal in his sleep. Next day Galiot prays him to stay longer, and he consents on condition that a boon may be granted him, which is immediately acceded to without further question. He then requests Galiot to submit himself to Arthur, and to confess himself vanquished, a demand which so amazes that chieftain that he at first refuses, yet succeeds in persuading Lancelot to remain with him a little longer. The day after, preparations are made for another battle, on

which occasion Lancelot wears Galiot's armour, and is at first mistaken for him, till Sir Gawain's acute vision detects that the armour really encases the black knight. As Lancelot now fights on Galiot's side, it may easily be imagined how utter and complete is the defeat of Arthur's army, which was before victorious owing to his aid only; and we are told that Arthur is ready to kill himself out of pure grief and chagrin, whilst Sir Gawain swoons so repeatedly, for the same reason, as to cause the most serious fears to be entertained for his life. At this sorrowful juncture Lancelot again claims his boon of Galiot, who, in the very moment of victory, determines at last to grant it, and most humbly sues for mercy at the hands of Arthur, to that king's most intense astonishment. By this very unexpected turn of affairs, the scene of dolour is changed to one of unalloyed joy, and peace is immediately agreed upon, to the satisfaction of all but some true-bred warriors, who preferred a battle to a peace under all circumstances. Not long after, Galiot discovers Lancelot with eyes red and swollen with much weeping, and endeavours to ascertain the reason of his grief, but with small success. After endeavouring to comfort Lancelot as much as possible, Galiot goes to visit King Arthur, and a rather long conference takes place between them as they stand at Sir Gawain's bedside, the queen being also present. In the course of it, Galiot asks Arthur what price he would pay to have the black knight's perpetual friendship; to which Arthur replies, he would gladly share with him half of everything that he possessed, saving only Queen Guinevere. The question is then put to Gawain, who replies that, if only his health might be restored, he would wish to be the most beautiful woman in the world, so as to be always beloved by the knight. Next it is put to Guinevere, who remarks that Sir Gawain has anticipated all that a lady could possibly wish, an answer which is received with much laughter. Lastly, Arthur puts the question to Galiot himself, who declares that he would willingly, for the black knight's sake, suffer that all his honour should be turned into shame, whereat Sir Gawain allows himself to be outbidden. The queen then obtains a brief private conference with Galiot, and prays him to obtain for her an interview with the black knight, who promises to do what he can to that end. He accordingly sounds the black knight upon the subject, and, finding him entirely of the same mind, does all he can to promote their acquaintance, and is at last only too successful; and at this point we may suppose the Scottish Romance to have stopped, if

indeed it was ever completed. For some account of the Romance of Lancelot, I may refer the reader to Professor Morley's English Writers, vol. i., pp. 568-570, and 573; to "Les Romans de la Table Ronde," par M. Paulin Paris; and to the Prefaces to the "Seynt Graal," edited by Mr Furnivall for the Roxburghe Club, 1861, and "La Queste del Saint Graal," also edited by the same for the same club in 1864. In the last-named volume short specimens are given from thirteen MSS. at Paris, ten of which contain the Romance of Lancelot. There are also manuscript copies of it in the British Museum, viz., MSS. Harl. 6341 and 6342, Lansdowne 757, and MS. Addit. 10293.

III.—THE DIALECT OF THE POEM.

In coming to discuss the dialect, we find everywhere traces of considerable confusion; but it is not at all easy to assign a satisfactory reason for this. ¹⁰ Certain errors of transcription soon shew that the scribe had before his eyes an older copy, which he mis-read. Thus, in l. 433, we find "set," where the older copy must have had "fet," and which he must have mis-read as "fet;" and again, in lines 2865, 2883, he has, by a similar confusion between "f" and "l," written "firft" instead of "fift." It is most probable that the older copy was written in the Lowland Scottish dialect (the whole tone of the poem going to prove this), as shewn by the use of *ch* for *gh*, as in *bricht* for *bright*, (unless this be wholly due to the scribe); by the occurrence of plurals in *-is*, of verbal preterites and passive participles in *-it*, and of words peculiarly Scottish, such as *syne* (afterwards), *anerly* (only), *laif* (remainder), *oft-syss* (oft-times), etc. Moreover, the Northern *r* is clearly indicated by the occurrence of such dissyllables as *gar-t*, 2777, *lar-g*, 2845, *fir-st*, 2958, 3075; with which compare the significant spellings *harrmful*, 1945, and *furrde*, 2583. But, on the other hand, it would appear as if either the author or the copyist had no great regard for pure dialect, and continually introduces Southern and Midland forms, mixing them together in an indiscriminate and very unusual manner. We find, for example, in line 1765,

"Beith larg and iffis frely of thi thing,"

the Scottish form *iffis* (give) and the Southern *beith* in close conjunction; and we find no less than six or seven forms of the plural of the past tense of the verb “to be;” as, for example, *war* (**3136**), *veir* (**818**), *ware* (**825**), *waren* (**3301**), *veryng* (**2971**), *waryng* (**443**), etc. If we could suppose that the scribe was not himself a Scotchman, we might in some measure account for such a result; but the supposition is altogether untenable, as the peculiar character of the handwriting (resembling that found, not in English, but in *French MSS.*) decides it to be certainly Scottish; as is also evident from the occurrence, in the same hand-writing, of a Scotticised version of Chaucer’s “Flee from the press.”

The best that can be done is to collect a few instances of peculiarities.

1. The broad Northumbrian forms *a*, *ane*, *baith*, *fra*, *ga*, *haill*, *hame*, *knew*, *law*, *sa*, *wat*, although occasionally retained, are also at times changed into *o*, *one*, *boith*, *fro*, *go*, *holl*, *hom*, *know*, *low*, *so*, and *wot*. Thus, at the end of **l. 3246**, we find *haill*, which could not have been altered without destroying the rime; but in **l. 3078**, we find it changed, in the middle of the line, into *holl*. In **l. 3406**, we find *sa*, but only three lines further on we find *so* twice.

So, too, we not only find *tane* (taken), *gais* (goes), but also the forms *tone* and *goß*. See lines **1071**, **1073**.

2. The true plural form of the verb is shewn by lines **203**, **204**,

“Of quhois fame and worschipful dedis
Clerkis into diuerß bukis *redis*,”

where alteration would have ruined the rime utterly; and the same termination (*-is*) is correctly used in the imperative mood, as,

——“fo *giffis* ws delay” (**l. 463**);

“And of thi wordis *beis* trew and stable” (**l. 1671**);

but the termination *-ith* is continually finding its way into the poem, even as early as in the fourth line,

“*Uprisith* arly in his fyre chare;”

and in the imperative mood also, as,

“*Remembrith* now it stondith one the poynt” (**l. 797**).

The most singular point of all, however, is this—that, not content with changing *-is* into *-ith* in the 3rd person singular, the scribe has done the same even in the 2nd person, thus producing words which belong to no pure example of any distinct dialect. Observe the following lines:—

“O woful wrech, that *levis* in to were!
To schew the thus the god of loue me sent,
That of thi seruice no thing is content,
For in his court yhoue [= thou] *lewith* in disspar,
And vilfully *sustenis* al thi care,
And *schapith* no thinge of thine awn remede,
Bot *clepith* ay and *cryith* apone dede,” etc. (**ll. 84-90**).

Here *levis* is altered into *lewith*, not only unnecessarily, but quite wrongly. For similar mistakes, see **ll. 1019, 1369, 1384, 2203**. For examples of correct usage, see **ll. 1024, 1337, 1796, 2200, 2201**.

3. But the terminations which are used in the most confused manner of all are *-en*, *-yne*, and *-ing* or *-yng*. Thus we find the non-Scottish infinitives, *telen* (**494**), *makine* (**191**); the constant substitution of *-ing* for *-and* in the present participle; ¹¹ a confusion between the past participial ending *-ine* (more correctly *-yn*), and the present ending *-and*, thus producing such forms as *thinkine* (**34**), and *besichyne* (**418**); and also a confusion between *-ing* and the past participial ending *-en*, as *fundyng* for *funden* (**465**), *fallyng* for *fallen* (**1217, 1322, 3267**), *swellyng* for *swollen* (**1222**), and *halding* for *halden* (**2259**). We even find *-ing* in the infinitive mood, as in *awysing* (**424**), *viting* (to know, **410**), *smyting* (**1326**), *warnnyng* (**1035**), *passing* (**2148**), *schewing* (**2736**), etc.; and, lastly, it occurs in the plural of the indicative present, instead of the Midland *-en*; as in *passing* (**1166**), *biding* (**2670**), and *levyng* (**3304**). ¹²

It may safely be concluded, however, that the frequent occurrence of non-Scottish infinitives must not be attributed to the copyist, since they are probably due rather to the author; for in such a line as

“Of his desir to viting the sentens” (**l. 410**),

the termination *-ing* is required to complete the rhythm of the line.

In the same way we must account for the presence of the prefix *i-*, as in the line

“Quharwith that al the gardinge was I-clede” (**l. 50**).

This prefix never occurs in vernacular Scottish; but we may readily suppose that this and other numerous Southern forms of words are due (as in Gawain Douglas and Lyndesay) to the author's familiarity with Chaucer's poems, as evinced by the similarity of the rhythm to Chaucer's, and by the close resemblance of several passages. Compare, for instance, the first seventy lines of the Prologue with the opening passages of "The Flower and the Leaf," and "The Complaint of the Black Knight;" and see notes to ll. 432, 1608. Indeed, this seems to be the only satisfactory way of accounting for the various peculiarities with which the poem abounds.

Mr J. A. H. Murray, in his remarks printed in the preface to Mr Lumby's edition of "Early Scottish Verse," comes to a similar conclusion, and I here quote his words for the reader's convenience and information. "There is no reason, however, to suspect the scribe of *wilfully* altering his original; indeed, the reverse appears manifest, from the fact that the 'Craft of Deyng' has not been assimilated in orthography to 'Ratis Raving,' but distinctly retains its more archaic character; while in 'Sir Lancelot,' edited by Mr Skeat for the Early English Text Society, from the handwriting of the same scribe, we have a language in its continual Anglicisms quite distinct from that of the pieces contained in this volume, of which the Scotch is as pure and unmixed as that of the contemporary Acts of Parliament. With regard to the remarkable transformation which the dialect has undergone in Sir Lancelot, there seems reason, therefore, to suppose that it was not due to the copyist of the present MS., but to a previous writer, if not to the author himself, who perhaps affected *southernism*, as was done a century later by Lyndesay and Knox, and other adherents of the English party in the Reformation movement. The Southern forms are certainly often shown by the rhyme to be original, and such a form as *tone* for *tane* = taken, is more likely to have been that of a Northerner trying to write Southern, than of a Southern scribe, who knew that no such word existed in his dialect. The same may be said of the *th* in the second person singular. A Scotch writer, who observed that Chaucer said *he liveth*, where he himself said *he lyves*, might be excused for supposing that he would also have said *thou liveth* for the Northern *thow lyves*; but we can hardly fancy a Southern copyist making the blunder."

4. We find not only the Northumbrian forms *sall* and *suld*, but also *shall*, *shalt*, and *shuld*.

5. As regards pronouns, we find the Scottish *scho* (she) in **l. 1169**; but the usual form is *sche*. We find, too, not only the broad forms *thai*, *thair*, *thaim*, but also *thei* (sometimes *the*), *ther*, and *them*. As examples of forms of the relative pronoun, we may quote *who*, *quho*, *whois*, *quhois* (whose), *quhom*, *qwhome* (whom), *quhat*, *qwhat* (what), and *whilk*, *quhilk*, *quhich*, *quich*, *wich* (which). *Wich* is used instead of *who* (**l. 387**), and we also find *the wich*, or *the wich that*, similarly employed. The nominative *who* does not perhaps occur as a *simple* relative, but has the force of *whoso*, or *he who*, as *e.g.*, in **l. 1102**; or else it is used interrogatively, as in **l. 1172**.

6. Many other peculiarities occur, which it were tedious to discuss fully. It may suffice, perhaps, to note briefly these following. We find both the soft sound *ch*, as in *wich*, *sich*, and the hard sound *k*, as in *whilk*, *reke* (reach), *streke* (stretch), etc.; which are the true Northern forms.

Mo is used as well as *more*.

Tho occurs for *then* in **l. 3184**; and for *the* in **l. 247**.

At occurs as well as *that*; *atte* as well as *at the*, **627**, **1055**.

The short forms *ma* (make), *ta* (take), *sent* (sendeth), *stant* (standeth), are sometimes found; the two former being Northumbrian.

Has is used twice as a *plural* verb (**ll. 481, 496**). ¹³

3ha (yes) occurs in **l. 2843**; but we also meet with *3his*, or *yis*; with reference to which Mr Morris writes:— “The latter term was not much in favour with the people of the North. Even now *yes* sounds offensive to a Lancashire man. ‘Hoo cou’d naw opp’n hur meawth t’ sey *eigh* (yea) or *now* (no); boh simpurt on sed *iss*; th’ dickons *iss* hur on him too. —*Tim Bobbin*.’” In fact, the distinction between *3ha* and *3his*, which I have pointed out in *William of Palerne* (Glossary, s.v. *3is*), viz., that *3ha* merely assents, whilst *3his* shews that the speaker has an opinion of his own, is in this poem observed. Thus, in **l. 2843**, *3ha* = “yes, I admit that I do;” but in **l. 514**, *yis* = “yes, but you had better do so;” in **l. 1397**, *3his* = “yes, indeed I will;” and in **l. 3406**, *3is* = “yes, but I cannot accept your answer.” ¹⁴ The true

distinction between *thou* and *ye* (*William of Palerne*, Pref. p. xli) is also generally observed. Thus the Green Bird, in the Prologue, considers the poet to be a fool, and calls him *thou*; but the clerks, in addressing Arthur (**l. 498**) politely say *ye*. And again, Amytans, when rebuking Arthur, frequently calls him *thou*, without any ceremony. Cf. **ll. 659, 908, 921, 2839**, &c.

As regards the vocabulary, we find that some Northumbrian terms have been employed, but others thrown aside. Thus, while we find the Northumbrian words *thir* (these), *traist* (trust), *newis* (neives, fists), *radour* (fear), etc., we do not, on the other hand, meet with the usual Scottish word *mirk*, but observe it to be supplanted by *dirk* (**l. 2471**). So, again, *eke* is used in the sense of *also*, instead of being a verb, as more usual in Northern works. We may note, too, the occurrence of *frome* as well as *fra*, and the Scottish form *thyne-furth* (thenceforth) in **l. 2196**.

The spelling is very various. We find even four forms of one word, as *cusynace*, *cusynece*, *cusynes*, *cwsynes*; and, as examples of eccentric spelling, may be quoted *qsquyaris* (squires, **l. 3204**), whilst in **l. 3221** we find *sqwar*.

Both in the marginal abstract and in the notes I have chiefly aimed at removing minor difficulties by explaining sentences of which the construction is peculiar, and words which are disguised by the spelling. For the explanation of more uncommon words, recourse should be had to the Glossarial Index.

¹ The volume contains other poems besides “Sir Lancelot.”

² See Mr Lumby’s editions of “Early Scottish Verse” and “Ratis Raving,” both edited for the E.E.T.S. from this MS. Only the latter of these is in the hand-writing of V. de F.

³ This refers to the edition printed in 1865. In executing the present reprint, the proof-sheets have been once more compared with the MS., and a very few insignificant errors have been thus detected and rectified.

⁴ “As to the Romance of Sir Lancelot, our author [Gower], among others on the subject, refers to a volume of which he was the hero; perhaps that of Robert de Borron, altered soon afterwards by Godefroy de Leigny, under the title of *Le Roman de la Charrette*, and printed, with additions, at Paris by Antony Verard, in the year 1494.

For if thou wilt the bokes rede
Of Launcelot and other mo,

Then might thou seen how it was tho
Of armes,” etc.

(GOWER: *Confessio Amantis*, Book iv.)

Quoted from Warton’s English Poetry, vol. ii., p. 234, *ed.* 1840. I quote this as bearing somewhat on the subject, though it should be observed that *Le Roman de la Charrette* is not the same with *Lancelot du Lac*, but only a romance of the same class. Chaucer also refers to Lancelot in his Nonnes Prestes Tale, l. 392; and it is mentioned in the famous lines of Dante (*Inf.* v. 127)—

“Noi leggevamo un giorno per diletto
Di Lancilotto, come amor lo strinse,” &c.

⁵ He does not necessarily imply that the poet invoked was still alive; and we might almost suppose Petrarch to be meant, who was more proud of his Latin poem called “Africa” than of his odes and sonnets. See Hallam’s Literary History (4 vols.), vol. i., p. 85. But this is pure conjecture.

⁶ But the French has “Cardueil.” See [l. 2153](#).

⁷ Tytler’s History of Scotland (Edinburgh, 1841), vol. iv., p. 216.

⁸ The French text does not say anything about “astronomy.” We may especially note the following lines, as *not* being in the French, viz., lines [1473-1496](#), [1523-1542](#), [1599-1644](#), [1658-1680](#), and the long passage [1752-1998](#).

⁹ See Appendix.

¹⁰ For many valuable remarks upon the dialect of the poem I am indebted to Mr R. Morris.

¹¹ We find the true forms occasionally, as *obeisand* ([641](#)), *plesand* ([1731](#)), *thinkand* ([2173](#)), *prekand* ([3089](#)), and *fechtand* ([3127](#)). Compare the form *seruand* ([122](#)).

¹² “The Scottish pronunciation of *-ing* was already, as it still is, *-een*; and the writer, knowing that the correct spelling of *dwelin*, for example, was *dwelling*, fancied also that *fallen*, *halden* (Sc. *fallyn*, *haldyn*) were *fallyng*, *haldyng*. Lyndesay and Gawain Douglas often do the same. Compare *garding* ([l. 50](#)), *laiting* ([l. 327](#)).” —J. A. H. Murray.

¹³ “The plural in Scottish always ends in *-s* after a noun or when the verb is separated from its pronoun; we still say *the men hes*, *the bairns sings*, *them ’at cums*, not *have*, *sing*, *come*. Notice the frequent use of *th* for *t*, as in [l. 497](#), *Presumyth* = *presumit*, presumed, it being presumed.” —J. A. H. Murray. [Or, *presumyth* may be the pl. imperative, as in *Remembrith* ([l. 797](#)), already noticed. —ED.]

¹⁴ “This *3is* is the common form in the Scottish writers, though *ay* is largely the modern vernacular.” —J. A. H. Murray.

APPENDIX.

EXTRACTS FROM THE FRENCH ROMANCE OF “LANCELOT DU LAC.”

As it seems impossible to do justice to the story of Lancelot without giving due attention to the famous French Romance, and since a portion of the French text is really necessary to complete even that fragment of it which the Scottish author proposed to write, the following extracts have been made with the view of shewing (1) the general outline of the earlier part of the story, (2) the method in which the Scottish author has expanded or altered his original, and (3) the completion of the story of the wars between Arthur and Galiot. [1](#)

I. Headings of the chapters of the French Romance, from its commencement to the end of the wars with Galiot.

[The commas are inserted by the present editor, and the expansions marked by italics.]

¶ Cy commence la table du premier volume de la table ronde lancelet du lac.

¶ Comment apres la mort de vterpandragon roy du royaulme de logres, & apres la mort aramon, roy de la petite bretagne, le roy claudas de la terre Descosse

Claudás, king of Scotland, deprives king Ban and king Boort of their lands.

mena guerre contre le roy ban de benoic et le roy boort
de gauues tant quil les desherita [2](#) de leurs terres.

Fueillet. i.

¶ Comment le roy claudas assiegea le chasteau de
trible auquel estoit le roy ban de benoic, et comment ilz
parlementerent ensemble. f. i.

Claudas besieges Ban in
the Castle of Tribble.

¶ Comment le roy ban de benoic, accompaigne de sa
femme et de son filzancelot, avecques vng seul
escuyer, se partirent du chasteau de trible pour aller
querir secours deuers le roy Artus a la grant bretagne.

King Ban, his wife, and
his son Lancelot repair
to the court of Arthur.

Fueillet ii.

¶ Comment apres ce que le roy ban fut party de son
chasteau de trible, le seneschal a qui il auoit baille la
garde trahit ledit chasteau, et le liura es mains du roy
claudas.

The Castle of Tribble is
treacherously given up
to Claudas.

Fueillet. ii.

¶ Comment le roy ban mourut de dueil quant il veit
son chasteau ardoir et brouyr. Et comment la dame du
lac emporta son filzancelot. [3](#)

Fueillet. iii.

King Ban dies of grief,
and Lancelot is taken
away by the lady of the
lake.

¶ Comment la royne helaine, apres que le roy fut
mort et elle eut perdu son filz, se rendit nonnain en
labbaye du monstier royal.

Fueillet. v.

¶ Comment le roy de gauues mourut | & comment la
Royne sa femme, pour paour de claudas, sen partit de
son chasteau pour aller au monstier royal, ou sa seur
estait rendue, et comment ses enfans Lyonnel et Boort
luy furent ostez.

Fueillet vi.

The two sisters, widows
of kings Ban and Boort,
retreat to a monastery.

¶ Comment la royne de Gauues, apres que son
seigneur fut mort et que elle eut perdu ses deux enfans,
se vint rendre au monastere ou estoit sa seur la royne de
benoic.

Fueillet vi.

¶ Comment merlin fut engendre du dyable: Et
comment il fut amoureux de la dame du lac.

Merlin's love for the
lady of the lake.

Fueillet vii.

¶ Comment le cheualier farien, qui auoit tollu a la royne de Gauues ses deux enfans, les emporta en sa maison | et les feist nourrir vne espace de temps. Et comment le roy claudas fut amoureux de la femme du dict Farien | et pource le fist son seneschal.

Sir Farien secretly nourishes the two sons of king Boort, and is made seneschal to king Claudas.

Fueillet viii.

¶ Comment le roy claudas fist appeller son cheualier farien de trahison par ladmonnestement de sa femme, disant quil gardoit les deux enfans du roy boort de gauues.

Claudas accuses Sir Farien of treason.

Fueillet. viii.

¶ comment le roy claudas en maniere de cheualier estrange, se partit du royaume de gauues pour aller en la grant bretagne a la court du roy artus pour veoir sa puissance & son gouuernement.

Claudaz, in disguise, visits Arthur's court.

Fueillet x.

¶ Comment la dame du lac bailla a lancelet vng maistre pour linstruyre comme il appartenoit a filz de roy.

Fueillet xii.

The lady of the lake informs Lancelot that he is a king's son.

¶ Comment la royne helaine alloit faire chascun iour son dueil au lieu ou son seigneur mourut | et de la alloit au lac ou elle perdit son filz.

Fueillet xv.

¶ Comment le bon Religieux qui auoit dit nouuelles a la royne helaine de son filz lancelet, print conge de elle, et sen vint au roy artus en la grant bretagne.

Fueillet xvi.

¶ Comment la dame du lac enuoya sa damoiselle a la court du roy claudas, pour delyurer les deux enfans au roy boort que claudas tenoit en prison.

The lady of the lake seeks to deliver the sons of king Boort.

Fueillet xvii.

¶ Comment farien, seneschal du roy claudas par le commandement de son seigneur, alla querir en prison les deux filz au roy de Gauues.

Fueillet xviii.

¶ Comment les deux enfans au roy de gauues blecerent le roy claudas, & occirent dorin son filz | et

Lyonel and Boort wound king Claudas, and slay his son Dorin.

comment la damoyselle du lac les emmena en semblance
de deux leuriers. fueil. xix.

¶ De la grant ioye et du grant honneur que la dame
du lac fist aux deux enfans quant elle les veit en sa
maison. Fueillet xx.

¶ Comment le roy claudas mena tres grant dueil
pour la mort de dorin son filz que boort auoit occis. Claudas bewails his
son's death.
Fueillet xx.

¶ Comment farien et le peuple de la cyte de gauues
sesmeurent contre le roy claudas a cause que il vouloit
faire mourir les deux filz au roy boort de gauues.
Fueillet. xxi.

¶ Comment le roy claudas se partit de gauues | et
comment ceulx dudit lieu le vouloient occire, se neust Farien saves Claudas'
life.
este farien le bon cheualier. f. xxiii.

¶ Comment le roy claudas se deffendit vaillamment
contre ceulx de Gauues qui le vouloyent occire.
Fueillet. xxv.

¶ Comment lyonnel et boort
perdirent le boire et le manger pource quilz ne scauoyent
nouuelles de leur maistres | lesquelz estoyent demourez
auec le roy claudas | & comment la dame du lac enuoya
vne sienne damoyselle a gauues pour les amener.
Fueillet. xxvii.

¶ Comment, par le conseil des barons de gauues:
leonce & lambegues sen allerent auecques la Leonce and Lambegues
go to seek Lyonnel and
Boort.
damoyselle pour veoir leurs seigneurs lyonnel et boort.
Fueillet xxviii.

¶ Comment la dame du lac sen retourna apres ce
quelle eut monstre a leonce et a lambegues les enfans du
roy de gauues leurs seigneurs, et comment lesditz
cheualiers sen retournerent a gauues.
Fueillet xxx.

¶ Comment le roy claudas retourna a gauues, pour
soy venger de la honte quon luy auoit faicte, et pour la Claudas meditates
revenge.
mort de son filz. Fueil. xxxi.

¶ Comment l'appointement fut fait entre le roy
claudas et les barons, par le moyen de farien et
lambegues son nepueu. fueillet. xxxiii.

¶ Comment farien | sa femme, et son nepueu Death of Farien.
lambegues sen partirent pour aller veoir lyonnel et
boort, qui estoyent au lac | & comment farien mourut.
 Fueillet xxxv.

¶ Comment les deux roynes menerent sainte vie au The widow of king
monstier royal | et comment celle de gauues veit ces
deux enfans &ancelot en aduision | et comment elle
trespassa de ce siecle. Fueillet. xxxv.

¶ Comment le roy artus assembla le iour de pasques
tous ses barons, & tint grant court a karahes, et
comment banin le filleul au Roy ban emporta le pris du
behourdys celluy iour. Fueillet. xxxvi.

¶ Comment la dame du lac se pourpensa de mener
ancelot au roy artus pour le faire cheualier, [4](#) et elle luy
bailla armes blanches, et partit du lac a tout quarante
cheualliers pour le conuoyer. Fueillet xxxvii.

¶ Comment vng cheualier naure, lequel auoit vne
espee fichee en la teste et deux troncons de lance parmy
le corps, [5](#) vint a la court du roy artus | et comment la
dame du lac le mena deuant le roy artus, et luy prya quil
le fist cheualier. Fueillet xxxix.

¶ Comment messire yuain, a qui le roy Artus auoit
recommandeancelot, alla faire sa requeste audit roy
artus, que le lendemain il fist leditancelot cheualier, et
comment leditancelot defferra le cheualier naure. [6](#)
 Fueillet. xli.

¶ Comment la dame de noehault [7](#) enuoya deuers le
roy artus, luy supplier quil luy enuoyast secours contre
le Roy de norhombellande qui luy menoit guerre. Et
comment Lancelot requist au roy artus quil luy donnast
congie dy aller | & il luy octroya. Fueillet xlii.

¶ Comment le nouveau cheualier aux armes
blanches vainquit la bataille pour la dame de noehault.

and won the battle for
her.

Fueillet xliii.

¶ Comment lancelot apres ce quil se fut party de la
dame de noehault, se combatit avec vng cheualier qui
lauoit mouille.

Fueillet xlv.

¶ Comment lancelot conquist vaillamment par sa
force et proesse le chasteau de la douloureuse garde *que*
nul aultre ne pouoit conquerre. [8](#)

Fueillet xlv.

How Lancelot
conquered the
“Sorrowful Castle.”

¶ Comment les nouvelles vindrent au roy artus *que*
la douloureuse garde estoit conquise par la cheualier
aux armes blanches | Et le roy y enuoya messire gauuain
pour en scauoir la verite.

Fueillet xlviii.

How Arthur hears of it,
and sends Gawain to see
if it is true.

¶ Comment messire Gauuain fut mys en prison | et
comment le roy et la royne entrerent en la premiere
porte de la | et la veirent des tumbes ou il y auoit escript
que monseigneur gauuain estoit mort, et plusieurs
aultres cheualiers.

Fueillet. xlix.

Gawain is imprisoned,
and supposed to be dead.

¶ Comment vne damoyelle de lhostel de la dame du
lac feist assauoir au cheuallier blanc *que* monseigneur
gauuain & ses compaignons estoyent emprisonnez par
celluy qui auoit este seigneur de la douloureuse garde.

Fueillet l.

Lancelot hears of
Gawain’s imprisonment,

¶ Comment le blanc cheualier se combatit encontre
celluy qui auoit este seigneur de la douloureuse garde,
qui tenoit en prison messire gauuain et ses
compaignons. [9](#)

Fueillet. l.

and delivers him and his
companions.

¶ Comment le cheuallier blanc emmena le cheualier
conquis en vng hermitage. et comment ledit cheualier
conquis luy rendit audit hermitage gauuain & ses
compaignons.

f. lii.

¶ Comment messire gauuain et ses compaignons sen
vindrent par deuers le roy artus qui estoit a la

Gawain returns to Arthur
and his Queen at
Douloureuse Garde.

douloureuse garde. Et comment le roy et la royne furent
ioyeulx quant ilz les virent. Fueillet. liii.

¶ Comment le cheuallier blanc retourna a labbaye ou
il auoit laisse ses escuyers | et comment il sceut
lassemblee qui deuoit estre entre le roy artus et le roy
doultre les marches, & comment il conquist le cheualier
qui disoit mieulx aymer le cheualier qui auoit naure que
celluy qui lauoit este. [10](#) Fueillet. liiii.

Lancelot hears of the
war to come between
Arthur and Galiot.

¶ Comment messire gauvain se mist en queste pour
trouuer le blanc cheuallier. [11](#) Et comment la meslee
dentre les gens au roy des cent cheualiers et les gens de
la dame de noehault fut appaisee. Fueillet lv.

Gawain goes to seek the
white knight,

¶ Comment le blanc cheualier vainquit lassemble
dentre les deux roys | et comment il fut naure du roy des
cent cheualiers. Fueillet. lvi.

who is wounded in the
battle against Galiot by
the king-of-a-hundred-
knights.

¶ Comment apres que le cheualier qui auoit gangne
le tournoyement dentre le roy doultre les marches sen
fut alle, le roy artus & la royne genieure se partirent pour
aller en leurs pays. Fueillet lvii.

Arthur and Queen
Genure return home.

¶ Comment messire gauvain se combatit a brehain-
sans-pitie, et le rua par terre. et comment apres ilz sen
allerent a la douloureuse garde: & comment les deux
pucelles que messire Gauvain menoit luy furent tollues.
Fueillet. lviii.

¶ Comment lancelot print congie de son mire | et
comment il mist a fin les aduentures de la douloureuse
garde. Fueillet lx.

Lancelot ends the
adventures of the
“Sorrowful Castle.”

¶ Comment messire gauvain recouura les deux
pucelles qui luy auoyent este tollues, Et comment
lancelot vainquit la seconde assemblee dentre le roy
artus & le roy doultre les marches.

Lancelot is again
victorious in the combat
between Arthur and
Galiot.

Fueillet lxi.

¶ Comment messire gauvain retourna a la court du
roy artus apres la seconde assemblee dentre le roy artus

Gawain returns to
Arthur’s court.

& le roy doultre les marches, et commentancelot
vainquit le cheualier qui gardoit le gue.

Fueillet lxiii.

[*Here begins the Scotch Translation.*]

¶ Comment le roy Artus songea plusieurs songes | et
apres manda tous les saiges clerks de son royaume pour
en scauoir la signifiance. [12](#) Arthur's evil dreams.

Fueillet lxiii.

¶ Comment le roy doultre les marches, nomme
gallehault, enuoya deffier le roy artus [13](#) | et comment
Lancelot occist deux geans empres kamalot. [14](#) Galiot defies Arthur.

Fueillet lxv.

¶ Commentancelot occist vng cheualier qui disoit
moins aymer le cheualier naure que celluy qui lauait
naure. [15](#) | et comment il fut assailly de .xl. cheualliers,
et mys en prison de la dame de mallehault. [16](#) Lancelot is assailed by
forty knights, and
imprisoned by the lady
of Melyhalt.

Fueillet lxviii.

¶ Comment gallehault assembla au roy artus vng
iour durant queancelot estoit en prison [17](#) | et comment
le lendemainancelot fut deliure de prison [18](#) | et
vainquit lassemblee dentre les deux roys. [19](#) Lancelot, released from
prison, is again
victorious against Galiot.

Fueillet lxvii.

¶ Comment le roy artus fut reprins de ses vices, et
moult bien conseille par vng cheualier qui suruint en
son ost [20](#) | Et comment gallehault donna tresues au roy
Artus iusques a vng an. [21](#) Arthur is reproved by
Amytans, and Galiot
proposes a truce for a
year.

Fueillet lxix.

¶ Commentancelot, apres ce quil eut vaincu
lassemblee, retourna en la prison de la dame de
mallehault [22](#) | et comment elle le congneut, a son cheual
et par les playes quil auoit, que cestoit celluy qui auoit
vaincu lassemblee. [23](#) Lancelot returns to the
lady of Melyhalt.

Fueillet lxxii.

¶ Comment messire gauvain, soy quarantiesme de
compaignons, se mist en queste pour trouuer le
cheualier qui auoit porte lescu vermeil a lassemblee
dentre le roy artus et Gallehault. [24](#) Gawain, with 39
comrades, departs to
seek the red knight.

Fueillet lxxii.

¶ Comment la dame de mallehault mist a rancon le cheuallier quelle tenoit en prison, et le laissa aller quant elle veit quelle ne peult scauoir son nom. [25](#)

The lady of Melyhalt accepts Lancelot's ransom.

fu. lxxiii.

¶ Comment messire gauvain et ses compaignons retournerent de leur queste [26](#) | et comment apres les treues faillies galehault vint assembler contre le roy artus, & tous ses gens en furent moult troublez. [27](#)

The truce ended, Galiot again attacks Arthur.

fu. lxxiiii.

¶ Comment gallehault suyuit le cheuallier aux noires armes, [28](#) & fist tant par belles parolles quil lemmena en son ost, dont le roy artus et tous ses gens en furent moult troublez.

Galiot gains over the black knight.

Fueillet lxxviii.

¶ Comment lancelot par sa prouesse conquist tout, et fist tant que gallehault crya mercy au roy artus.

Lancelot induces Galiot to submit to Arthur.

fu. lxxix.

¶ Comment gallehault fist tant que la royne vit lancelot | & comment ilz se arraisonnerent ensemble.

The Queen and Lancelot meet.

fu. lxxx.

¶ Comment la royne congneut lancelot apres ce quil eut longuement parle a elle, & quil luy eut compte de ses aduentures. & comment la premiere acointance fut faicte entre la royne & lancelot par le moyen de galehault.

The Queen knows Lancelot from his adventures that he tells her.

fu. lxxxii.

¶ Comment la premiere acointance fut faicte de galehault & de la dame de malehault par le moyen de la royne de logres, & comme[nt] lancelot & galehault sen alloyent esbatre & deuiser avecques leurs dames.

Galiot becomes acquainted with the lady of Melyhalt.

fu. lxxxiii.

II. The Chapter of the French romance from which the translator has taken the beginning of his First Book is here given, in order to shew in what manner he has treated his original. It begins at Fol. lxiii. a, col. 1.

Comment le roy artus songea plusieurs songes, et
apres manda tous les sages clerchez de son
royaulme pour en scauoir la signifiance.

Arthur's evil dreams.

OR dit le compte que le roy artus auoit
longuement sejourne a cardueil. Et pource ny
auenoit mie *grandement* de aduentures, il
ennuya moult aux compaignons du Roy de ce quilz
auoient si longuement sejourne, & ne veoient riens de
ce quilz souloyent veoir. Principalement keu le
seneschal en fut trop ennuye Et en parloit moult souuent,
et disoyt deuant le roy que trop estoit ce *sejour*
ennuyeulx, & trop auoit dure. Le roy luy demande “Keu |
que voudriez vous que nous feissions?” “Certes,” fait
keu, “ie conseilleroye que nous allissions a kamalot | car
la cite est plus aduantureuse *que* vous ayez | et la nous
verrions souuent et orrions choses de merueilles que
nous ne voyons pas icy. Nous auons sejourne ia icy plus
de deux moys, et oncques ne y veismes gueres de choses
aduenir.” “Or alons donc,” fait le roy, “a Kamalot, puis
que vous le *conseillez*.” Lendemain deust partir le roy |
mais la nuyct luy aduint vne merueilleuse aduenture. Il
songa *que* tous les cheueulx de sa teste cheoient, et tous
les poilz de sa barbe, dont il fut moult espouente. Et *par*
ce demoura encores en la ville. La tierce nuyt apres il
songa *que* il luy estoit aduis *que* tous les doigts luy
cheoient fors les poulces, & lors fut plus esbahy que
deuant.

King Arthur being at
Cardueil,

his knights are annoyed
at meeting with no
adventures.

Sir Kay counsels that
they should go to
Camelot.

The king consents to go;
but the same night
dreams that all his hair
falls off, which delays
him.

The third night after he
dreams that all his
fingers fall off except his
thumbs.

ALautre nuyct songea il *que* tous les ortelz des
piedz luy cheoient fors les poulces. de ce fut si
trouble que plus ne peult. “Sire,” fait son
chappelain a qui il lauait dit, “ne vous chaille | car
songes ne sont pas a croire;” le roy le dit a la royne, et
elle respond tout ainsi *que* luy auoit fait son chappelain.
“En verite,” dist il, “ie ne laisseray pas la chose ainsi” |
il fait mander ses euesques et archeuesques quilz soient

Again, that all his toes
fall off except his great
toes.

The Queen and his
chaplain disregard the
dreams;

but Arthur sends for his
bishops, archbishops,
and their wisest clerks;

a luy au .ix iour ensuyuant a kamalot, & quilz amainent
auec eulx tous les plus sages clerchez quilz pourroient
auoir et trouuer. A tant se part de cardueil & sen va par
les chasteaulx et par les citez | tant *que* au neufnisme
iour est venu a kamalot, et aussi sont venus les clerchez du
pays. Il leur demande conseil de son songe, *et* ilz elisent
dix des plus sages: le roy les fist bien enserrer, et dist que
iamais nen sortiroient de prison deuant quilz luy auroient
dit la signifiance de son songe. Ilz esprouuerent la force
de leur science par neuf iours, et puis vindrent au roy, &
dirent quilz nauoient riens trouue. “Ainsi maist dieu,” dit
le roy, “ia ainsi neschapperez.” Et ils demandent respit
iusques au troisieme iour ensuyuant, et il leur donne.
Les .iii iours passez, ilz reuiennent deuant le roy, et dient
que ilz ne peuvent riens trouuer | et demandent encores
autre delay | et ilz ont. Et de rechief vindrent pour
demander aultres troys iours de dilacion, ainsi que le roy
auoit songe de tierce nuyt en tierce nuyt. “Or sachez,”
fait le roy, “*que* iamais plus nen aurez.” Quant vint au
tiers iour ilz dirent quilz nauoient rien trouue; “ce ne
vault rien,” fait le roy, “ie vous feray tous destruire se
vous ne me dictes la verite;” et ils dirent. “Sire nous ne
vous en scairions que dire.” Lors se pense le roy quil
leur fera paour de mort. Il fait fair vng grant feu, &
commanda en leurs presences que les .v. y fussent mis,
et que les autres cinq soyent penduz | mais priueement
deffent a ses baillifz quilz ne les menassent que iusques a
la paour de mourir. Quant les cinq qui furent menez aux
fourches euerent les cordes entour leurs colz, ils eurent
paour de mourir, et dirent, que se les aultres cinq le
vouloyent dire, ilz le diroyent. La nouuelle vint au .v.
que len menoit ardre | et ilz dirent que, se les autres le
vouloyent dire, ils le diroyent | ils furent amenez
ensemble deuant le roy, et les plus sages dirent | “sire,
nous vous dirons ce *que* nous auons trouue | mais nous
ne voudrions mie que vous nous tenissiez a menteurs se

whom he imprisons till
they shall tell him what
the dreams mean.

After trying for nine
days, they fail.

They twice obtain a
delay of three days.

The king threatens to
slay them.

Five are to be burnt, and
five hung.

The five who are to be
hung, having the cords
round their necks, offer
to speak out.

They stipulate not to be
held as liars if their
interpretations fail.

il ne aduenoit | car nous voudrions bien quil nen fust rien, et voulons, comment quil en aduiengne, que vous nous asseurez *que* ia mal ne nous en aduiendra;” et il leur promet. Lors dist lung de eulx qui pour tous parla. “Sire, sachez que ceste terre et tout honneur *vous* conuiendra perdre et ceulx en qui plus vous fiez vous fauldront; telle est la substance et signifiance de voz songes.” De ceste chose fut le roy moult effraye, “Or me dictes,” fait il, “sil est chose qui *men* peult garantir.” “Certes,” fait le maistre, “nous auons veu une chose | Mais cest si grande merueille que on ne le pourroyt penser, et ne la *vous* osons dire.” “Dictes,” fait il, “seurement | car pis ne me pouez vous dire que vous mauez dit.” “Sire, riens ne vous peult garder de perdre tout honneur terrien fors le lyon sauluaige, et le mire sans medecine, par le conseil de la fleur, & se *nous* semble estre si grande folie que nous ne losions dire | Car lyon sauluaige ne y peult estre, ne mire sans medecine | ne fleur qui parlast |” le roy est moult entrepris de ceste chose: mais plus en fait belle chiere que le cueur ne luy apporte. Ung iour alla le roy chasser au boys bien matin | et mena avec luy messire gauvain, keu le seneschal, et ceulx qui lui pleust. Si laisse icy le compte a parler de luy, et retourne a *parler* du cheualier dont messire Gauvain aporta le nom en court.

The dreams mean that he will lose his land and his honour.

Arthur asks if anything can avert such fate.

He is told, “nothing, except the savage lion and the leech without medicine, by help of the counsel of the flower.”

Arthur goes to the chase.

Q Vant ²⁹ le cheuallier qui lassemblee auoyt vaincu se partast de la ou il se combatist a son hoste, il erra toute iour sans autre aduanture trouuer. Il se logea la nuyt chiez une veufue dame a lyssue dune forest a cinq lieues angleches pres de kamelot. Le cheualier se leua matin, et erra, luy et ses escuyers et sa damoysele, tant quil encontra vng escuyer. “Varlet,” fait il, “scez tu nulles nouuelles?” “Ouy,” fait il, “ma dame la royne est icy pres a kamalot.” “quelle royne” fait il “Le femme au roy

Lancelot on his wanderings.

He meets an esquire, and asks him, “what news?”

“The queen,” he says, “is at Camelot.”

artus,” fait lescuyer. Le cheuallier sen part, et cheuauche tant quil treuve vne maison forte, et voit vne dame en son surcot, qui regardoit les prez et la forest | & auoit auec elle vne damoiselle. Le cheuallier se arreste, et regarde la dame moult longuement tant quil oublie tout autre chose. Et maintenant passa vng cheuallier arme de toutes armes, qui luy dist. “Sire cheualier, que attendez vous?” et celluy ne respond mot | car il ne la pas ouy. Et le cheualier le boutte, et luy demande quil regarde. “Je regarde,” fait il, “ce *que* me plaist: Et vous nestes mie courtois, qui de mon penser me auez iecte.” “Par la foy que vous deuez o dieu,” fait le cheuallier estrange, “scauez vous bien qui la dame est que vous regardez?” “Je le cuyde bien scauoir,” fait le bon cheualier. “Et qui este elle,” fait lautre. “Cest ma dame la royne.” “Si maist dieu, estrangement la congnoissez, deables vous font bien regarder dames.” “Pourquoy,” faict il. “Pource que vous ne me oseriez suyuir par deuant la Royne la ou ie yroye.” “Certes,” faict le bon cheuallier, “se vous osiez aller la ou ie vous oseray suyuir, vous aurez passez de couraige tous les plus grans oseurs qui oncques furent.” A tant sen part le cheualier. Et le bon cheualier va apres. Et quant ilz ont vne piece alle, lautre luy dist, “vous he[r]bergerez ennuyt auec moy, et le matin ie vous meneray la ou ie vous diz,” et le bon cheuallier luy demande sil conuient ainsi faire. “Oy” | fait il. Et il dist que donc lottroyera il. Il geut la nuyt chez le cheualier sur la riuiere de kamalot, et fut moult bien herberge, et sa pucelle | et ses escuyers.

Lancelot goes on till he sees a large house, a lady, and her damsel.

He regards her fixedly.

An armed knight, passing, asks him what he is regarding so closely.

He replies, that he looks at what pleases him.

The knight asks if he knows who the lady is,

and he replies that he knows it is the queen.

The stranger takes Lancelot home to lodge with him,

and he is well entertained.

III. Our last extract will shew exactly where the Scottish poem suddenly ceases, and how the story was probably continued. For the latter purpose, four chapters of the French Romance are added beyond the point where the Scotch ends; and it is possible (judging from lines 306-312 of the Prologue) that the author did not intend to go very much further. The passage begins,

in the French copy, at Fol. lxxvii. *b*, col. 1; and, in the Scotch poem, at [l. 3427](#).

Lors descent de son cheual, et la baille au cheualier.
Et celluy si y monte sans arrest. Et gallehault monta sur
vng autre, et vient a son conroy | Si prent avec soy les
dix mille, et dit quilz voient assembler deuant; “et
vous,” fait il au roy vend, “viendres apres, si ne
assembleriez mie si tost comme ceulx cy seront
assemblez | mais quant les derrains de ceulx de dela
seront venus, vous assemblerez, & moy mesmes vous
iray querir.” A tant amaine les dix mille pour
assembler, [30](#) Et quant il fut entre en la bataille il fist
sonner ses busines tant *que* tout en retentissoit. [31](#) Quant
le noir cheualier les ouyt venir, si luy sembla que grant
effort de gens eut la, si se retrait vng pou vers les siens,
et les appella entour luy, & leur dist. “Seigneurs, vous
estes tous amys du roy. Or y perra comment vous le
ferez.” [32](#) Et messire yuain, qui les vit venir, dist a ses
gens, “Or soyes tous asseurs *que* nous ne perdrons au
iourdhuy *par* force de gens.” [33](#) Et ce disoit il pource quil
cuidoit *que* les gens gallehault fussent tous venus. [34](#)

Galiot gives Lancelot his
own horse,

and gives orders to his
own men.

He commands the
trumpets to be sounded.

Lancelot harangues his
men.

Sir Yvain comforts
Arthur’s soldiers.

Quant les .x.m. de gallehault sassemblerent, si fut
grande la noise, et moult en abbatent a leur venir
| mais quant messire yuain vint, si reconforta
moult les gens du roy artus | et tous les fuyans retournent
avec luy. Et gallehault sen va arriere a son conroy, et
commande quilz cheuauchent fermement | et quilz se
frappent es gens du roy artus [35](#) de telle maniere [36](#) que
nul dentreulz ne demeure a cheual “Vous estes tous
frays. Or y perra comment vous le ferez.” A tant
cheuauchent les conroys deuers leurs gens, Car ilz
auoyent ia du pire. Et quant le conroy de Gallehault fut
venu, si changa moult laffaire | Car moult y auoyt grant
effort de gens. Et fut a leur venue le cheualier noir mis a

Galiot orders charge.

Galiot’s reserve arriving,
his men awhile prevail.

terre. [37](#) Et aussi les six compaignons qui toute iour auoyent este pres de luy. [38](#) Lors vint gallehault, qui le remonta sur le cheual mesmes ou son corps seoit. [39](#) Et si tost comme il fut monte, il sen reuint a la meslee aussi frays comme il auoit le iour este. Et quant il vint aux coups donner, tous ceulx qui le veoyent sen esmerueilloient, Ainsi dura la bataille iusques a la nuyt. Et quant il vint au soir ilz se departirent | et toutesfoys les gens du roy Artus en eurent du meilleur. Le bon cheualier se departit de lost le plus coyement quil peut, [40](#) et sen alla par vng chemin entre les prestz et vng tertre, et cuyda que nul ne le veist | mais Gallehault sen print tres bien garde, et picqua tant son cheual qui luy fut au deuant par vne adresse, et le vint rencontrer au pied du tertre. Si le salue, et dit ‘que dieu le conduit.’ Et celuy le regarde en trauers, et luy a a moult grant peine rendu son salut. “Bel amy,” fait galehault, “qui estes vous?” “Sire,” fait il, “ie suis vng cheualier, ce pouez vous veoir.” “Certes,” fait galehault, “cheualier estes vous meilleur qui soit | & vous estes lhomme du monde que plus ie vouldroye honnourer, [41](#) et si vous suis venu prier que vous herbergez ceste nuyt avec moy.” Et il luy dist ainsi comme sil ne lauoit huy veu, “Qui estes vous, sire, qui me auez prie de me he[r]berger?” “Je suis gallehault, le sire de ces gens icy, vers qui vous auez au iourdhuy garanty le royaulme de logres, lequel ie eusse ia conquis se ne fust vostre corps.” “Comment” (fait il) “vous estes ennemy de monseigneur le roy artus, et me priez de herberger? | Avec vous ne herbergeray ie mie en ce point.” “Haa sire,” faict gallehault, “plus feray ie pour vous, et si nay mye a commencer. Et ie vous prie que vous y herbergiez par tel conuenant que ie feray tout ce que me scaurez requerre.” A tant se arresta le cheuallier, et dist a gallehault; “Sire, vous promettez assez | mais ie ne scay comment il est du rendre” | et gallehault luy dist. “Sire, se vous he[r]bergez ennuyt

Galiot again remounts Lancelot.

Night arriving, the hosts retreat.

Lancelot tries to depart unobserved,

but is followed by Galiot,

who prays him to lodge with him for that night.

Lancelot at first refuses, till Galiot agrees to do whatever Lancelot may require of him,

avec moy, ie vous donneray tout ce que vous oserez diuiser de bouche, et bien vous en feray seur,” Et lors luy fiance, & apres luy promet bailler bons plaiges; Adonc sen vont tous deux en lost.

and promises to entertain him sumptuously;

whereupon they return together to Galiot's camp.

¶ Comment gallehault suyuit le cheuallier aux noires armes, et fist tant par belles parolles quil lemmena en son ost, donc le roy artus & tous ses gens en furent moult troublez.

Messire gauuain auoyt veu aller le cheuallier au noir escu, & le eust volentiers suiuy sil eust peu monter a cheual. Lors regarde contre val la riuiere, et voit gallehault et le cheuallier noir qui retournoyent pour venir a lost, et dist a la royne, “Haa dame, or pouons nous bien dire que nous sommes gens perdus | regardez que gallehault a conquis par scauoir,” Et elle regarde, & voyt *que* cest le cheuallier noir *que* gallehault emmaine; si en est tant iree quelle ne peut dire mot. Et messire gauuain se pasme en pou dheure plus de trois fois. Le roi artus vint leans | et ouyt le cry *que* chascun disoit, “il est mort, il est mort.” Si vint a luy, et leembrassa, et commença a plorer moult tendrement. Et reuient monseigneur Gauuain de pasmoison; Et quant il veit le roy artus, il commence a le blasmer, et dit. “Ores est venu le terme que les clerchez vous disent. Regardez le tresor que vous auez huy perdu. celluy vous toldra terre qui toute iour la vous a garantie par son corps, et se vous fussiez preudhomme vous leussiez retenu, ainsi comme a fait le plus preudhomme qui viue, qui par cy deuant lemmaine.” Lors voit le roy gallehault, qui emmenoit le cheuallier, dont il a tel dueil que a pou quil ne est cheut | mais de plorer ne se peut tenir, et toutesfois faict il la plus belle chere quil peut pour son nepueu reconforter. Et si tost *que* il vit en la salle, il fist grant dueil | aussi fist chascun preudhomme.

Gawain, seeing Lancelot with Galiot,

tells the Queen that now they are all lost;

and swoons away more than three times.

He tells Arthur that his time of misfortune is come;

for their protector is lost.

Arthur also sees Galiot, and is deeply grieved, but tries to comfort his nephew.

TAnt sont allez gallehault et le cheualier quilz
sont venus empres lost, Adonc luy dist le
cheualier, “Sire, ains que ie entre dedans vostre
ost, faictes moi *parler* aux deux *plus* preudhommes que
vous ayez et esquelz vous fiez le plus.” Et gallehault
lottroye. Lors sen va en son tref, et prent deux des
hommes du monde ou plus il se fie, et leur dist, “Venez
auec moy et vous verrez le plus riche homme du
monde.” “Comment,” font ilz, “nestes vous mie le plus
riche qui soit au monde?” “Nenny,” dist il | “mais ie le
seray ains que ie dorme.” Ces deux estoyent le roy
premier conquis | et le roi des cent cheualliers. Quant ilz
virent le cheuallier, si lui firent moult grant ioye | Car ilz
le congneurent bien par ses armes. Et le cheuallier leur
demanda qui ilz estoient | et ilz se nommerent sicomme
vous auez ouy | et il leur dist. “Seigneurs, vostre sire
vous faict moult grant honneur | Car il dit que vous estes
les deux hommes du monde que plus il ayme, et entre
luy et moy a vne conuenance que ie vueil que vous oyez
| Car il ma fiance que pour en nuyt herberger auec luy
me donnera ce que ie luy voudray demander.” Et
gallehault dist | “vous dictes verite.” “Sire,” faict le
cheuallier, “ie vueil encores auoir la seurte de ses
hommes.” Et gallehault dist, “Dictes moy *comment*.”
“Ilz me fianceront,” fait le cheuallier, “*que* se vous me
failliez de *conuenant*, ilz vous guerpiront et sen
viendront auec moy la ou ie diray,” Et gallehault dit que
ainsi le veult | et il le fait fiancer. Lors appella gallehault
le roy premier conquis a vne part, et luy dist. “Allez
auant & dictes a mes barons quilz assemblent maintenant
a monstre si honnorablement comme ilz pourront, et
gardez que en mon tref soient *tous* les deduys que *len*
pourra trouuer en tout lost.” Lors sen va celluy au ferir
des esperons, & fist le commandement de son seigneur.
Et gallehault tient le cheualier aux parolles, luy & son
seneschal, tant que le commandement fust fait. Si ne

Galiot and Lancelot
arrive at Galiot’s camp,

and Lancelot asks to
speak with the two men
whom Galiot most
trusts.

Galiot takes him to the
“first-conquest” king
and the king of a
hundred knights, and

Lancelot repeats to them
his compact with Galiot,

and takes their pledge
that they will forsake
Galiot if he breaks his
agreement, and will go
with himself (Lancelot).

Galiot orders all kinds of
entertainments to be
brought to his tent.

demoura gueres que encontre eulx vindrent deux cens barons qui tous estoient hommes de gallehault, .xxviii. roys, et les autres estoient ducz et contes; la fut le cheuallier tellement honnoure que oncques si grant feste ne fut pour vng homme mescongneu comme len fit pour luy a celle fois | et disoient grans & petis, “Bien viengnez, la fleur de la cheualerie du monde” | et il en auoit grant honte. Ainsi vindrent iusques au tref de gallehault, si ne pourroient estre comtez les deduys et les instrumens qui leans estoient. A telle ioye fut receu, et quant il fut desarme, gallehault luy fit apporter vne robe moult riche, et il la vestit. quant le manger fut prest, ilz se assirent a table, et furent noblement seruis, et le cheualier fut moult honnoure.

Twenty-eight kings,
beside dukes and counts,
come to the feast, and
honour Lancelot as the
flower of the knighthood
of the world.

Lancelot is richly attired,
and nobly served.

A Pres manger commanda gallehault a faire quatre litz desquelz lung estoit plus grant que les aultres. Quant les litz furent si richement atournez, gallehault maine le cheuallier coucher. Et dist. “Sire, vous gerrez icy;” “Et qui gerra de la?” fait le cheualier. “Quatre sergens,” faict gallehault, “qui vous serviront | Et ie iray en vne chambre par dela, affin que vous soyez icy plus en paix.” “Haa, Sire, pour dieu,” faict il, “ne me faictes gesir plus ayse que ces aultres cheualiers | car tant ne me deuez a vilennir.” “Nayez garde,” faict gallehault, “Car ia pour chose que vous faciez pour moi vous ne serez tenu a villain.” A tant sen part gallehault. Et le cheuallier commence a penser au grant honneur que gallehault luy faisoit. Si lenprise moult | puis se coucha, et tantost il sendormit | car moult estoit las; Et quant gallehault sceut quil fut endormy, le plus coyement quil peut se coucha en vng autre lit empres luy | et es deux aultres litz se coucherent deux cheualiers, et nestoyent en la chambre que eulx quatre, sans plus. La nuyt se plaint moult le cheualier en son dormant, et gallehault loit bien, car il ne dormoit gueres.

After supper four beds
are prepared, one larger
than the rest, for
Lancelot.

Galiot awhile departs,
and Lancelot falls
asleep.

Galiot then returns, and
lies near Lancelot,

and hears how his guest
murmurs in his sleep.

Ains pensa toute la nuyt a le retenir. Lendemain le cheualier se leua et alla ouyr messe; et ia estoit gallehault leue | car il ne voulut mie que le cheualier laperceust. Quant ilz vindrent du monstier, le cheualier demanda ses armes, & gallehault demande pourquoy. Et il dist quil sen vouloit aller. Et gallehault luy dist. “Beau doulx amy, demourez | et ne cuydez mye que ie vous vueille deceuoir. Car vous noserez ia riens demander que vous navez. Et sachez *que* vous pourriez bien auoir compagnie de plus riche homme que ie suis | mais vous ne laurez iamais a homme qui plus vous ayme.” “Sire,” faict le cheuallier, “ie demoureray donc puis quil vous plaist. Car meilleure compagnie que la vostre ne pourroye ie mye auoir | Mais ie vous diray presentement le don pourquoy ie demoureray avec vous | et se ie ne lay, ie ny demoureray ia.” “Sire,” fait gallehault, “dictes seurement et vous laurez, se cest chose que ie puisse acomplir;” Et le cheuallier appella ses deux plaiges et dist deuant eulx, “Je vous demande,” fait il, “*que* si tost que vous serez au dessus du roy artus, que vous luy alliez crier mercy si tost comme ie vous en semondray.” Quant gallehault lentent, si en est tout esbahy, et commence a penser. Et les deux roys luy dirent. “A quoy pensez vous icy endroit, de penser nauez mestier | car vous auez tant couru que vous ne pouez retourner.” “Comment,” faict Gallehault, “cuydez vous que ie me vueille repentir | se tout le monde estoit mien si luy oseroye ie bien donner. mais ie pensoye a vng seul mot quil a dit | mais ia dieu ne maist,” dist il, “se vous nauez le don | car ie ne pourroye riens faire *pour* vous ou ie peusse auoir honte. Mais ie vous pryé que ne me tollez vostre compagnie pour la donner a aultruy;” et le cheualier luy creanca. Ainsi demoura | et ilz se asseirent au manger qui estoit appreste. Si font moult grant ioye par tout lost du cheualier qui est demoure. Ainsi passerent celle nuyt. Lendemain gallehault et son

Next day they go to hear mass,

and Lancelot then demands his arms, wishing to depart.

Galiot induces him to stay,

but again promises to do for him whatever he asks.

Lancelot then demands that Galiot shall submit himself to Arthur.

Galiot is confounded, and ponders, but then grants Lancelot's request.

Lancelot remains with him another night.

compaignon allerent ouyr messe, et gallehault luy deist |
 “Sire, il est huy iour dassembler; vouldes vous armes
 porter?” “Ouy,” dist il. “donc porterez vous les
 miennes,” fait gallehault, “pour le commencement.” Et il
 dist quil les porteroit volentiers | “mais vous ne porterez
 armes,” feist il a gallehault, “si non comme mon
 sergent?” “Non,” dist il. Lors firent apporter les armes,
 & armerent le cheuallier du fort haulbert, & des chausses
 qui trop estoyent longues & lees; Lors se armerent les
 gens de gallehault. et pareillement les gens du roy Artus,
 & passerent les lices de telz y eut. Tuteffoys le roy
 auoyt deffendu que nul ne les passast. Si y eut de bonnes
 ioustes en pou dheure | si se assemblerent tous les ostz
 deuant la lice, & commencerent a faire armes. Le roy
 artus estoit a son estandard, et auoit commande que ilz
 menassent la royne a sauliete se la descomfiture tournoit
 sur eulx | quant tous les ostz furent assemblez et le bon
 cheualier fust arme, si cuida chascun que ce fust
 gallehault, & disoyent tous. “Voicy gallehault, voicy
 gallehault” | messire gauvain le congneust bien & dist.
 “Ce nest mye gallehault | ains est le cheualier aux armes
 noires, le meilleur cheualier du monde” | & si tost
 comme ilz furent assemblez, oncques ne se tint le roy
 Artus ne ses gens depuis que le cheualier y fut arriue | et
 trop se desconfortoyent du bon cheualier qui contre eulx
 estoit, si furent menez iusques a la lice. car trop estoient
 grans gens avec gallehault. au partir des lices ce tindrent
 vne piece et souffrirent longuement | mais le souffrit ny
 peut riens valoir. Grant fut le meschief des gens au roy
 artus. et dit le compte *que* le cheualier neust mie moins
 de peine de tenir les gens de gallehault que ilz ne
 passassent oultre la lice quil auoit de chasser les gens au
 roy Artus. Et nompourtant moult les auoit supportez | &
 il les eut mis oultre a force sil eust voulu | mais il
 demoura emmy le pas pour les aultres detenir. Lors
 regarda tout entour de luy, et commenca a hucher |

Next day, the hosts are
 again armed for battle.

Lancelot is at first
 mistaken for Galiot; but
 is recognized by
 Gawain.

Arthur’s men cannot
 stand against Lancelot.

Lancelot calls upon
 Galiot to keep his

“gallehault, gallehault.” et gallehault vient grant alleure, et dist. “bel amy, que voulez vous?” “quoy,” faict il, “ie vueil que mon conuenant me tenez;” “Par ma foy,” fait gallehault, “ie suis tout prest de lacomplir puis quil vous plaist.” Lors picque le cheual des esperons & vient iusques a lestandart ou le roy artus estoit, qui faisoit si tresgrant dueil que a peu quil ne se occioit pource quil estoit desconfit. Si estoit ia la royne montee, et lemmenoyent quarante cheualliers. Et monseigneur gauvain, que on vouloit emporter en lictiere | mais il dit quil aymeroit mieulx mourir en ce point que veoir toute cheualerie morte et honnye: si se pasma tellement que len cuydoit bien que il mourust incontinent.

¶ Comment lancelot par la prouesse conquis tout, et fist tant que galehault cria mercy au roy artus.

Q Vant le cheualier veit gallehault prest dacomplir son conuenant, il iura bien que oncques si loyal compaignon ne fut trouue. Il en a telle pytie quil en souspire moult fort, & dit entre ses dens. “Haa dieu, qui pourra ce desseruir?” & gallehault cheuauche iusques a lestandart et demande le roy artus. Il vient auant moult dolent & esmaye comme celluy qui tout honneur et toute ioye terrienne cuyde auoir perdue; Et quant gallehault le voit, si luy dit. “sire, roy artus, venez auant, & navez paour | car ie vueil a vous parler.” et quant le roy louyt, il sesmerueille moult que ce peult estre; Et de si loing comme galehault le voit venir, il descend de son cheual et se agenouille, et dit. “Sire, ie vous viens faire droit de ce que ie vous ay meffait; si men repens, et me metz en vostre mercy.”

Q Vant le roy lentend, il a merueilleusement grant ioye, et lieue les mains vers le ciel, louant Dieu de ceste aduanture | et se le roy fait bonne chere,

compact.

Galiot rides forward, and finds Arthur ready to kill himself for grief, the Queen being escorted away by a guard of forty knights, and Gawain wishing to die.

How Lancelot makes Galiot cry mercy to Arthur.

Galiot demands to see King Arthur,

and, at sight of him, dismounts, kneels to him,

and submits himself to him humbly.

Arthur, overjoyed, praises God.

encores la faict meilleure Gallehault. et il se lieue de genoulx, & sentrebaisent, en font moult grande chere lung a lautre. lors dist Gallehault | “sire, faictes vostre plaisir de moy | car ie metz en vostre saisine mon corps pour en faire ce que il vous plaira. Et sil vous plaist, ie yray retraire mes gens arriere, & puis reuiendray a vous incontinent.” “Allez doncques,” fait le roy | “car ie vueil parler a vous.” A tant sen part gallehault & reuient a ses gens | & les en faict aller. Et le roy enuoya apres la royne, qui sen alloit faisant grand dueil. et les messages cheuauchent tant que ilz lattaingnent | et sont venus a elle, & luy comptent la ioye que aduenue leur est. Et elle ne le peult croire tant *quelle* voy les enseignes que le roy luy enuoye. tant coururent les nouuelles que monseigneur gauvain le sceut, lequel en eut grant ioye sur tous les aultres, et dist au roy. “Sire, comment a ce este?” “Certes, ie ne scay,” fait il: “mais ie croy que telle a este le plaisir de nostre seigneur.” moult est grande la ioye, & moult se esmerueille chascun *comment* ce peult estre aduenue. Gallehault dist a son compaignon. “que voulez vous que ie face? iay fait vostre commandement; & le roy ma dit que ie retourne | mais ie vous conuoyeray auant iusques a voz tentes.” “Haa sire,” fait le cheualier, “aincoys vous irez au roy & luy porterez le plus grant honneur que vous pourrez. Et tant auez fait pour moy que ie ne le pourroye desseruir | mais tant vous pry, pour dieu | et pour lamour que vous auez a moy, que nul ne sache ou ie suis” | ainsi sen vont parlant iusques a leurs tentes. chascun scait que la paix est faicte | mais *plusieurs* en sont dolens | car mieulx aymassent la guerre que la paix. lors sont descenduz les deux compaignons, et si tost quilz furent desarmez, Gallehault print vne de ses meilleures robbes pour aller a la court. et feist cryer par tout son ost *que* chascun sen allast, fors tant seulement ceulx de son hostel. Apres appella les deux roys, et leur baille son compaignon, & leur

Galiot, first asking Arthur’s leave, dismisses his troops to their tents.

The Queen and Sir Gawain rejoice greatly.

Lancelot prays Galiot not to reveal where he is, and they return to their tents.

Galiot commits his guest to the care of the two

commande quilz facent autant de luy comme de son corps mesmes. A tant monte Gallehault, et sen va a la court du roy artus. Et le roy luy vint alencontre, et la royne qui ia estoit retournee, & la dame de malehault avec plusieurs dames & damoyselles. A tant vont en la bretesche ou monseigneur gauvain gisoit malade. et quant il sceut que gallehault venoit, il sefforce de belle chere faire, comme celluy qui oncques mes ne lauoit veu de si pres. lors luy dist | “bien soyez vous venu comme de celluy dont ie desiroye moult lacoïntance | car vous estes lhomme du monde qui plus doibt estre prise & ayme a droit de toutes gens. Et ie cuyde que nul ne scait si bien congnoistre preudhomme comme vous & bien y a paru.” Ainsi parle messire gauvain a gallehault, & il luy demande comment il luy est | et Gauvain dist. “Jay este pres de mort. mais la grant amour qui est entre vous & le roy ma guery.” Moult font grant ioye le roy artus & la royne & monseigneur gauvain de la venue de gallehault | et tout le iour ont parle de amour et dacoïntance. Mais du noir cheualier ne tiennent ilz nulles parolles | ains passent le iour a resiouyr lung lautre tant quil vint au vespre. Lors demande gallehault congïe de ses gens aller veoir. Et le roy le luy donne | “mais vous reuiendrez,” fait il, “incontinent;” et gallehault le luy octroye | si senreuient a son compaignon & luy demande comment il a depuis fait | et il luy respondit que bien; “Sire,” fait gallehault, “comment feray ie |: le roy ma moult prie que ie retourne a luy, & il me feroit mal de vous laisser en ce point.” “Haa, sire cheualier, pour dieu mercy, vous ferez ce que monseigneur le roy voudra. car iamais a plus preudhomme que il est ne eustes accoïntance. Mais ie vueil que vous me donnez vng don.” Et gallehault luy dist. “Demandez ce quil vous plaira | car ie ne vous escondiroye iamais;” “Sire,” fait il, “ie vous remercy. Vous me auez donne que vous ne me demanderez mon nom deuant que ie le vous diray.” “Et ie men tiendray a

kings, and departs to speak with Arthur.

Arthur and Galiot go together to the tower where Gawain lies ill.

Gawain welcomes Galiot.

The Queen, the King, and Gawain rejoice at Galiot’s coming,

but he, soon after, departs to see Lancelot for a short time, promising to return.

Lancelot tells Galiot to do whatever Arthur wishes.

He charges Galiot again not to ask his name, but to tell him about Arthur.

tant puis *que* vous le voulez,” dit gallehault. “Et ne doubtez pas que ce eust este la premiere chose que ie vous eusse demande, si men tairay a tant.” Lors luy demanda de laccointance du roy artus | mais il ne nomme mie la royne | et gallehault dit que “le roy est moult preudhomme, & moult me poyse que ie ne lay congneu pieca | Car moult en feusse amende | mais ma dame la royne est sy vaillante que oncques plus honneste dame ne vey.” et quant le cheualier ouyt parler de la royne, si se embronche et commence a souspirer durement. et gallehault le regarde et se esmerueille moult pource *que* les larmes luy cheoyent des yeulx, si commence a parler daultre chose.

Galiot praises the Queen,

and Lancelot sheds tears.

Q Vant ilz ont longuement parle ensemble, le cheualier noir luy dist. “Allez, si ferez a monseigneur le roy compaignie, et si escoutez sy vous orrez de moy nulles parolles, & vous me compterez demain ce que vous aurez ouy.” “Voulentiers, sire,” faict gallehault | lors le accolle, et dit aux roys. “Je vous baille en garde cest homme comme le cueur de mon ventre.” Ainsi sen va gallehault & le cheuallier demeure en la garde de deux preu[d]hommes du pays de Gallehault | mais il ne fault mye demander sil fust honnore | car len faisoit assez plus pour luy quil neust voulu. celle nuyt geurent les deux roys au tref gallehault pour lamour du cheualier & luy firent entendant quilz ny coucheroyent mye | & ilz le firent coucher ainsi que Gallehault auoit fait lautre nuyt. Au commencement dormit le cheualier moult fort, et quant vint a mynuit si commenca a soy tourner, et commenca a faire vng dueil si grant que tous ceulz qui entour luy estoyent sen esueillerent. Et en son refrain disoit souuent. “Haa chetif, que pourray ie faire?” Et toute nuyt demena tel deuil. Au matin se leuerent les deux roys le plus coyement quilz peurent | & moult se merueillent quil pouoit auoir.

Lancelot asks Galiot to return to Arthur, and to report to him all the conversation.

Lancelot sleeps with the two kings in Galiot’s tent;

but awakes at midnight, and makes a great moaning.

Galiot comes to see after Lancelot,

daultre part fut gallehault leue, & vint a son tref veoir son compaignon. Il demande aux deux roys que son compaignon fait. Et ilz luy dient quil auoit toute nuyt mene grant dueil. Lors entre en la chambre ou il estoit, et si tost comme il le ouyt venir il essuye ses yeulx; Adonc gallehault, cuidant que il dormist, saillist dehors de la chambre incontinent; apres le cheualier se leua. Et gallehault vit que il auoit les yeulx rouges et enflez. Adonc le prent par la main, et le tyre a part, et luy dist. “Beau doulx compaignon, *pourquoy* vous occiez vous ainsi? dont vous vient ce dueil que vous auez toute nuyt demene, & le desplaisir que vous auez? Je vous pry pour dieu que vous me diez la cause, et ie vous ayderay se nul homme mortel y peult conseil mettre;” & commence a plourer si durement comme sil veist mort la chose du monde que mieulx aymast. Lors est gallehault moult a malayse et luy dit, “Beau doulx compaignon, dictes moy vostre mescheance | car il nest nul homme au monde, sil vous auoit riens forfait, que ie nen pourchassasse vostre droit.” Et il dist que nul ne luy a riens meffait. “beau doulx amy, *pourquoy* menez vous doncques si grant dueil? Vous poise il que ie vous ay fait mon maistre & mon compaignon?” “Haa,” fait il, “vous auez assez plus fait pour moy que ie ne pourroye desservir, ne riens du monde ne me met a malaise que mon cueur, qui a toute paour que cueur mortel pourrait auoir. Si doubte moult que vostre grant debonnairete ne me occie.” De ceste chose est gallehault moult a malayse, si reconforte son compaignon. Apres allerent ouyr masse. Quant vint *que* le prestre eut fait trois parties du corps de nostre seigneur, gallehault se trait auant, et tient son compaignon par la main, & luy monstre le corps de nostre seigneur que le prestre tenoit entre ses mains; Puis luy dist. “doncques ne croyez vous pas bien que cest le corps de nostre saulueur?” “Voirement le croy ie bien,” fait le cheualier. Et

finds him with his eyes red and swoln,

and conjures him to tell him what the matter is.

Lancelot cries bitterly,

and says that it is his heart, which has all the dread that it is possible for mortal heart to have.

They go to Mass, and Lancelot declares his belief that the Bread is the Body of Christ.

gallehault luy dist. “beau doulx amy, or ne me mescreez mye que ces trois parties de chair que ie vois en semblance de pain, ia ne feray en ma vie chose *que* ie cuyde qui vous ennuye: mais toutes les choses que ie scauray qui vous plairont, pourchasseray a mon pouoir.” “sire,” fait il, “grant mercys.” A tant se taisent iusques apres la messe | et lors demanda gallehault a son compaignon quil fera; “Sire,” fait il, “vous ne laisserez mie le roy en ce point | ains yrez luy faire compaignie.” “Sire,” faict il, “grant mercys;” A tant sen part de luy, si le rebaille aux preudhommes de la court du roy artus. si font de luy grant signeurie sicomme ilz peuent.

After Mass, Lancelot bids Galiot go again to Arthur.

ET quant vint apres disner, sy furent le roy & la royne & gallehault appuyez au lict de messire gauuain, tant *que* messire gauuain dist a gallehault. “Sire, or ne vous poise dune chose que ie vous demanderay.” “Certes,” fait galehault, “non fera il.” “sire, celle paix qui fut entre vous & mon oncle, par qui fut elle, par la chose au monde qui plus vous ayez?” “Sire,” fait il, “vous me auez tant coniuire que ie le vous diray. Vng cheualier la fist.” “Et qui est le cheualier?” fait messire gauuain. “Si maist dieu,” fait gallehault, “ie ne scay.” “Qui fut celluy aux noires armes?” deist messire gauuain. “Ce fut,” fait il, “vng cheualier;” “Tant,” fait il, “en pouez vous bien dire | mais acquitter vous conuient.” “Je me suis acquite de ce que me coniuirastes. Ne plus ne vous en diray ores | ne rien ne vous en eusse ores dit, se vous ne me eussiez coniuire.” “Par dieu,” faict la royne, “ce fut le cheuallier noir | mais faictes le nous monstrar.” “Qui | moy, dame?” faict gallehault, “ie le vous puy bien monstrar sicomme celluy qui riens nen scait!” “Taisez vous,” fait la royne, “il est demoure avec vous, & hier porta voz armes.” “Dame,” fait il | “il est vray | mais ie ne le vys oncques puis que ie party du roy a la premiere fois.” “comment,”

After dinner the King and Queen visit Gawain, and he asks Galiot who made peace between him and Arthur.

“A knight,” says Galiot. “But what knight?” asks Gawain.

“The Black Knight,” answers the Queen; “show him to us.”

“I cannot,” says Galiot; “he is not from my country;”

fait le roy, “ne le cognoissiez vous mye | ie cuydoie que il fust de vostre terre.” “Si maist dieu, non est,” fait gallehault. “certes,” fait le roy, “ne de la myenne non est il mye.” | Moult tindrent longuement gallehault a parolle le roy et la royne pour auoir le nom du cheualier | mais plus nen peurent traire. et messire gauvain craint quil ne ennuye a gallehault, si dist au roy. “Or en laissez a tant le parler. certes le cheualier est preudhomme, & pleust a dieu que ie luy ressemblasse.” Moult loe messire gauvain le cheualier. Si en ont la parolle laissee | et gallehault la recommence et dit. “Sire, veistes vous oncques meilleur cheualier que celluy au noir escu?” “certes,” fait le roy, “ie ne vy oncques cheualier de qui ie ayasse mieulx laccointance pour cheualerie;” “Non,” | fait gallehault. “Or me dictes,” faict gallehault, “par la foy que vous deuez a ma dame qui cy est, combien vous voudriez auoir donne pour auoir son accointance a tousioursmais?” “Si maist dieu,” faict il, “ie luy partiroie la moytie de tout ce que ie pourroye auoir, fors seulement de ceste dame.” “Certes,” fait gallehault, “assez y mettriez. Et vous, messire gauvain, se dieu vous doint sante que tant desirez, quel meschief en feriez vous pour auoir compaignie a si preudhomme?” Et quant messire gauvain lot, si pense vng petit comme celluy qui ne cuyde iamais auoir sante. “Se dieu me donnoit la sante que ie desire | ie voudroye orendroit estre vne des plus belles dames du monde, par conuenant quil me aymast tous les iours de sa vie.” “par ma foy,” fait gallehault, “assez y auez mis.” “Et vous, madame, quel meschef feriez vous par conuenant que vng tel cheualier fust tousiours en vostre seruice?” “par dieu,” fait elle, “messire gauvain y a mis toutes les offres que dame y peult mettre.” Et monseigneur gauvain & tous aultres se commencerent a rire. “Gallehault,” fait messire gauvain, “qui tous nous auez adiurez par le serment que ie vous coniu-ray, ores qui

and Galiot will not disclose the knight's name,

but asks Arthur if he ever saw a better knight, and what he would give to know him henceforth.

“Half of all I have, except my wife,” Says Arthur.

“And what would you give, Gawain?”

“I should like to turn woman if he would love me all his life.”

“I can offer no more than Gawain,” says the Queen.

vouldriez vous y auoir mys?” “Si maist dieu,” faict gallehault, “ie y vouldroye auoir tourne mon honneur a honte, par tel si *que* ieusse a tousioursmais vng si bon cheualier en ma compaignie.” “Sy maist dieu,” faict messire gauvain, “plus y auez mys que nous.” et lors se pensa messire gauvain que cestoit le noir cheualier qui le paix auoit faicte | car pour luy auoit tourne son honneur a honte, quant il veit quil estoyt au dessus. Et le dist gauvain a la royne, & se fut la cause dont gallehault fut plus prise; Moul tindrent longuement parolles du cheualier. et la royne sadressa, et dist quelle sen vouloit aller vers la bretesche pour veoir les prez, et gallehault la conuoye: si le print la royne par la main & luy dist. “Gallehault, ie vous ayme moul, & il est vray que vous auez le cheualier en vostre baillie, & par aduenture il est tel que ie le congnois bien; si vous prie si cher que vous auez mamour, que vous faciez tant que ie le voye.” “Dame,” fait gallehault, “ie nen ay encores nulle saisine | & ne le vy puis que la paix fut faicte de moy & du roy. Et se il estoit or en mon tref, si y conuiendroit il aultre voulente *que* le vostre & que la mienne. Et bien saichez que tant me auez coniuire *que* ie mettray tout le pouoir que ie pourray. comment vous pourrez parler a luy?” “se vous en faictes vostre pouoir,” fait elle, “ie le verray bien, & ie men attens a vous, et faictes tant que ie soye vostre a tousiours: car cest vng des hommes du monde que ie verroye plus volentiers.” “Dame,” fait il, “ie en feray mon pouoir.” “Grant mercys,” fait elle. “Or gardez que ie le voye au plus tost que vous pourrez | car il est en vostre baillie, ie le scay bien | et se il est en vostre terre, enuoyez le querre.” Atant sen part gallehault & sen vient au roy. Et monseigneur gauvain & le roy lui dient. “gallehault, ie suis deliure de mes gens, ores faictes approcher voz gens des nostres, ou ie feray approcher les nostres des vostres | Car nous sommes a priuee mesgnie.” “Sire,” faict gallehault, “ie feray approcher les

“Well,” says Galiot, “I would turn all my honour into shame, for his sake.”

So Gawain concludes that it was the Black Knight who brought about the peace.

The Queen walks away with Galiot, tells him she loves him much, and prays him to let her see the Black Knight.

He promises to do all he can for her;

and the Queen says, “I shall be sure to see him if you try,

for he is in your custody. Send and get him.”

Arthur wishes Galiot’s people and his own to be brought nearer to one another.

miens daultre part de cest riuiere si que mon tref sera endroit le vostre, et sera vne nef appareillee en quoy nous passerons dicy la et de la icy.” “Certes,” fait le roy, “moult auez bien dit.”

L Ors sen va Gaillehault en sa tente, et trouue son compaignon moult pensif. Il luy demande comment il a puis fait; Et il dist, “bien, se paour ne me mestriast.” et gallehault dist, “de quoy auez vous telle paour?” “que ie ne soye congneu,” dist il. “or nen ayez mie paour, car vous ny serez ia congneu, se vostre volente ne y est;” Lors luy compte les offres que le roy et messire gauvain ont faict pour luy, et ce que la royne dit | et comment la royne la tenu a grant parlement de le veoir | et comme il luy respondit. “et saichez que elle na de nully si tres grant desir de veoir comme de vous. Et monseigneur la Roy ma pryé que ie face mes gens approcher | car nous sommes trop loing lung de lautre. Or me dictes que vous voulez que je face | car il est en vostre plaisir.” “Je loue que vous facez ce que monseigneur le roy vous pryé;” “Et a ma dame que respondray ie, beau doulx amy?” “Certes,” fait il, “ie ne scay.” Lors commence a souspirer. Et gallehault luy deist. “Beau doulx amy, ne vous esmavez point | mais dictes moy comment vous voulez quil soit | car bien saichez quil sera ainsi comme vous voudrez | et ie aymeroye mieulx estre courrouce a la moytie du monde que a vous tout seul. ores me dictes quil vous en plaist.” “Sire,” faict ledit cheualier, “ce que vous me louerez | car ie suis en vostre garde desormais.” “Certes,” fait gallehault, “il me semble que pour veoir ma dame la royne il ne vous peult empyrer.” Lors apperceut gallehault assez de son penser, & le tient si court quil luy octroye ce quil demande | “mais il conuiendra,” faict il, “que il soyt faict celeement, que nul ne le saiche | fors moy et vous.” Et gallehault dit que il ne se soulcye

Galiot returns to Lancelot,

tells him what the King, Gawain, and the Queen have said of him,

and asks him what answer he shall give the Queen.

Lancelot sighs,

and says, “Whatever you advise.”

“There will be no harm in seeing her,” answers Galiot.

Lancelot says the matter must be managed secretly; and they agree that Galiot shall tell the Queen he has sent to seek for Lancelot.

point. “Or dictes,” (fait le cheualier a gallehault,) “a ma dame que vous me auez enuoye querre.” “Sur moy en laissez le surplus,” dit Gallehault. Lors sen part a tant, et commanda ses trefz a tendre la ou il auoit en conuenant au roy | et son seneschal fist son commandement.

¶ Comment gallehault fist tant que la royne veit Lancelot, Et comment ilz se araisonnerent ensemble, et parlerent de plusieurs choses.

How Guinevere and Lancelot meet and talk.

A Tant sen partit gallehault & sen vient au tref du roy, & si tost comme la royne le voit, si luy courut a lencontre, & luy demande comment il auoit employcte la besongne. “dame,” faict il, “ie en ay fait tant que ie craing que lamour de vostre pryere ne me tolle la chose du monde que ie ayme plus.” “Sy maist dieu,” faict elle, “vous ne perderez riens par moy que ie ne vous rende ou double | mais que y pouez vous,” fait elle, “perdre?” “Celluy mesmes que vous demandez,” fait gallehault | “Car ie doubte quil ne se courrouce, et que ie ne le perde a tousiours.” “Certes,” faict elle, “ce ne pourray ie pas rendre | mais ia par moy ne le perderez, se dieu plaist. Et touteffoys dictes moy quant il viendra” | “dame,” fait il, “quant il pourra | car ie lay enuoye querre, et croy que il ne demourra mye longuement.” De leur conseil entendit ung peu la dame de mallehault qui sen prenoit garde et nen faisoit mye semblant. Lors sen partit gallehault et vient a ses gens qui estoyent logez la ou il auoit commande.

The Queen asks Galiot what he has done for her.

“Sent to seek for your knight,” says he.

Galiot returns to his men,

Q Vant il fut descendu, il parla a son Seneschal et luy deist | “quant ie vous enuoyeray querir, venez a moy, vous & mon compaignon en ce lieu la.” Et le roy des cent cheualiers, qui son seneschal estoit, dist que moult volentiers feroit son commandement & son plaisir. Lors salua Gallehault son compaignon, et sen retourna a la court. Et quant la

and tells his Seneschal to bring Lancelot when he sends for him.

Galiot then goes back to the Queen, says he thinks she will see her

royne veit gallehault qui estoit venu, elle luy dist que il
 gardast bien et loyaulment ce quil luy auoit promis. Et il
 luy dist | “dame, ie cuyde que vous verrez ennuyt ce que
 vous auez tant desire.” Quant elle ouyt ce, si en fut moult
 ioyeuse, et moult luy ennuya ce iour pour sa volente
 acomplir du desir *que* elle auoit de parler a celuy ou
 toutes ses pensees estoyent. Lors luy deist Gallehault,
 “nous yrons apres soupper en ce vergier la aual” | et elle
 luy octroye. Quant ce vint apres souper, si appelle la
 royne | la dame de mallehault | et dame Lore de
 cardueil, une sienne pucelle, et sen vont tout droit la ou
 gallehault auoyt dit | et gallehault prent ung escuyer et
 luy dist. “Va et dy a mon seneschal que il viengne la ou
 ie luy commanday.” Et celuy y va. Apres ne demoura
 guaires que le seneschal y vint, luy et le cheualier. Ilz
 estoyent tous deux de grant beaulte; Quant ilz
 approcherent, si congneut la dame de mallehault le
 cheualier comme celluy que elle auoyt eu maint iour en
 sa baillie. Et pource quelle ne vouloit mye que il la
 congneut, se embroncha, et ilz passent oultre. le
 seneschal les salue. Et gallehault dit a la royne. “Dame,
 lequel vous semble il que se soit?” | et elle dit. “Certes,
 ilz sont tous deux beaulx cheualliers | mais ie ne voy
 corps ou il puisse auoir tant de prouesse que le noir
 cheualier auoit.” “or saichez, dame, que cest lung de ces
 deux” | a tant sont venuz auant, et le cheuallier tremble si
 que a peine peult saluer la royne, & la royne sen
 esmerueille. lors se agenouillent eulx deux, et le
 cheualier la salue | mais cest moult pourement | car
 moult estoit honteux. Lors se pense la royne que cest il.
 Et gallehault dit au seneschal. “allez, si faictes a ces
 dames compaignie.” Et celluy fait ce que son sire luy
 commande. A doncques la royne prent le cheualier par
 la main & le assiet iouxte elle. Sy luy fait moult beau
 semblant & dit en riant. “Sire, moult *vous* auons desire,
 tant que, dieu mercy et gallehault, vous voyons. et

knight that evening, and
 appoints to meet her in
 an Orchard below.

After supper the Queen
 goes to the Orchard,

and Galiot sends for his
 Seneschal and the
 Knight,
 who come.

The Queen at first
 cannot think that either
 is the black knight,

but one is so bashful that
 she fixes on him,

seats him by her, smiles
 on him, says she has so
 longed to see him,

nonpourtant encores ne croy ie mye que ce soit celluy que ie demande | & gallehault ma dit que cestes vous | & encores vouldroye scauoir qui vous estes par vostre bouche mesmes, se vostre plaisir y estoit.” Et celuy dit que il ne scait | et oncques ne la regarda au visaige. Et la royne ce esmerueille que il peult auoir, tant quelle souspeconne une partie de ce quil a. Et gallehault, qui le voigt si honteux, pense quil veult dire a la royne son penser seul a seul. lors sen vient messire gauvain celle part, et fait rasseoir les damoyelles pour ce que leuees sestoient encontre luy. Puis commencent a parler de maintes choses. Et la Royne dit au cheuallier, “Beau sire, pourquoy vous celez vous de moy? Certes il ne y a cause pourquoy; nestes vous mie celluy qui porta les noires armes, et qui vainquist lassemblee?” “Dame, nenny” | “et nestes vous pas celluy qui porta lendemain les armes a gallehault?” “Dame, ouy;” “Donc estes vous celluy qui vainquistes lassemblee qui fut faicte le premier iour par deuers nous et par [42](#) deuers Gallehault?” “Dame, non suis.” Quant la royne ot ainsi parler le cheualier, a donc appercoit elle bien quil ne veult mie congnoistre quil eust vaincue lassemblee, si len prise mieulx la royne | car quant vng homme se loe luy mesmes, il tourne son honneur a honte | et quant aultruy le loe, adonc il est mieulx prise. “Or me dictes,” fait la royne a lancelet | “qui vous fist cheuallier?” “Dame,” fait il, “vous;” “Moy?” fait elle, “Et quant?” “Dame,” fait il, “vous remembrez vous point quant vng cheuallier vint a Kamalot, lequel estoyt naure de deux troncons de lance au corps, et dune espee parmy la teste, et que vng varlet vint a court en vng vendredy, et fut cheualier le dymenche, et deffera le cheuallier?” “De ce,” fait elle, “me souient il bien | et se dieu vous aist, feustes vous ce que la dame du lac amena en court vestu dune robe blanche?” “Dame, ouy.” “Et pourquoy dictes vous donc que ie vous fis cheuallier?” “Dame,” fait il,

and now he must tell her who he is. “I don’t know,” he answers.

Galiot leaves the two to themselves,

and the Queen asks the knight, “Are not you he who wore the black armour, and overcame everyone?”

“No, I am not,” saith he, refusing to praise himself.

“Then who made you a knight, and when?”

“You, at Kamalot, when the pieces of a spear were drawn out of the wounded knight,

“ie dys vray | Car la coustume est telle que nul ne peut estre cheuallier sans ceindre espee. Et celluy de qui il tient lespee, le faict cheuallier; de vous la tiens ie. Car le roy ne la me donna onques. Pour ce dis ie que vous me feistes cheualier.” De ce est la royne moult ioyeuse | “ou vous en allastes vous au partir de court?” “Dame, ie men allay pour secourir la dame de noehault;” “Et durant ce temps me mandastes vous riens?” “Dame, ouy | ie vous enuoyay peux pucelles.” “Il est vray,” dist la royne. “Et quant vous partistes de noehault, trouuastes vous nul cheuallier qui se reclamast de moy?” “Dame, ouy; vng qui gardoit vng gue, et me dist que descendisse de dessus mon cheual et le vouloit auoir, et ie luy demanday a qui il estoit | et il dist a vous. Puis luy demanday apres, qui le commandoyt. Et il me dist quil nauoyt nul commandement que le sien. Et adoncques remys le pied en lestrief et remontay | Car ie estoye ia descendu | et luy dis que il ne lauoyt point, et me combatis a luy. Et ie scay bien que ie vous fis oultraige, si vous en crie mercy” | “Certes a moy ne en feistes vous point | Car il nestoyt mye a moy | et luy sceuz mauuais gre de ce quil ce reclama de moy. Mais or me dictes on vous en allastes la?” “Dame, ie men allay a la douloureuse garde” | “& qui la conquist?” “Dame, ie y entray” | “et ne vous y viz ie oncques.” “Ouy, plus de troys foyes.” “Et en quel temps?” fist elle. “Dame,” fist il, “vng iour que ie vous demanday se vous vouliez leans entrer; Et vous deistes ouy | et estiez moult esbahye par semblant.” “Et quel escu portiez vous?” “Dame, ie portay a la premiere foyes vng escu blanc a vne bande de belif vermeille. Et lautre foyes vng ou il y auoyt deux bendes” | “Et vous vys ie plus?” “Ouy, la nuyt que vous cuidiez auoir perdu messire Gauvain et ses compaignons, et que les gens cryoyent que len me prenist; Je vins hors a tout mon escu a troys bendes.” “Certes,” faict elle, “ce poise moy | car se on vous eust

and you girded on my sword, thus knighting me,

and I went away to help the Lady of Noehault, and sent you two damsels.

Then I met a man, who said he was your knight,

and I fought him (for which I crave your pardon).

After that I took the Sorrowful Castle, and there I saw you thrice,

last when you thought you had lost Gawain and his companions,

detenu, tous les enchantements feussent demourez | Mais or me dictes, fustes vous ce qui iettastes messire Gauvain de prison?” “Dame, ie y ayday a mon pouoir.” “Certes,” faict elle, “en toutes les choses *que* vous me dictes ie nay trouue si non verite. Mais or me dictes qui estoit en vne tournelle dessus la chambre monseigneur.” “Dame, cestoyt vne pucelle que ie ne villennay oncques | Car ma dame du lac la me auoyt enuoyee | si me trouua en ceste tournelle | il fut assez qui la honnora pour moy. Quant ie ouy nouuelles de monseigneur Gauvain, si en fut moult angoisseux, et men party de la Damoysele qui auecques moy debuoit venir, et luy priay que elle ne se remuast tant que elle eust mon messaige ou moy. Si fus si surprins de tresgrant affaire que ie loubliay | et elle fut plus loyalle uers moy que ie ne fus courtois vers elle | car oncques ne se remua iusques a ce *quelle* eut mes enseignes, et ce fut grant piece apres.”

Comment la royne congneut Lancelot apres quil eut longuement parle a elle, et quil luy eut compte de ses aduentures. Et comment la premiere acointance fut faicte entre lancelot et la royne genieure par le moyen de gallehault.

Quant la royne eut parle de la damoiselle, si scait bien *que* cest Lancelot. Si luy enquist de toutes les choses *quelle* auoit ouy de luy, et de toutes le trouua vray disant; “Or me dictes,” fait elle, “vous vy ie puis?” “Ouy, dame, telle heure que *vous* me eustes bien mestier | car ieusse este noye a kamalot se ne eussiez vous este.” “Comment! feustes vous celluy que daguenet le fol print?” “Dame, prins fus ie sans faulte.” “Et ou alliez vous?” “Dame, ie alloye apres vng cheuallier.” “Et vous combatistes vous a luy” | “dame, ouy.” “Et dillec ou allastes vous?” “Dame, ie trouuay deux grans villains que me occirent *mon* cheual | mais messire yuain, qui bonne aduenture ayt, men donna

and I helped to deliver him from prison.”

The Queen asks the knight who was in the turret above his room there.

“A damsel whom I never dishonoured,

but I asked her not to leave till she saw my messenger or me, which I then forgot, and kept her there a very long time.”

How the Queen knew Lancelot.

When she heard of this damsel the Queen knew it must be Lancelot,

and asks him if he was the knight whom Daguenet took. He answers “Yes;” and that two rascals killed his horse, and Ywain gave him another.

vng.” “Ha, ha,” fait elle, “ie scay bien qui vous estes; Vous avez nomancelot du lac.” Il se taist. “Par dieu,” faict elle, “pournant le celez | long temps a que messire Gauvain apporta nouvelles de vostre nom a court;” Lors luy compta comment messire yvain auoit compte que la damoyselle auoit dit | cest la tierce. “Et anten quelles armes portastes vous?” “Vnes vermeilles.” “Par mon chef cest verite. Et auant hier pourquoy feistes vous tant darmes comme vous feistes?” Et il commenca a souspirer. “Dictes moy seurement | Car ie scay bien que pour aulcune dame ou damoyselle le feistes vous, et me dictes qui elle est, par la foy que vous me deuez.” “Haa, dame, ie voy bien quil le me conuient dire, cestes vous.” “Moy?” faict elle. “Voire, dame.” “Pour moy ne rompistes vous pas les troys lances que ma pucelle vous porta?” “Car ie me mis bien hors du mandement, dame; ie fis pour elle ce que ie deuz, et pour vous ce que ie peux.” “Et combien a il que vous me ayez tant?” “Des le iour que ie fus tenu pour cheuallier, et ie ne lestoie mye” | “Par la foy que vous me deuez, dont vindrent ces amours que vous avez en moy mises?” “dame,” fait il, “vous le me feistes faire qui de moy feistes vostre amy, se vostre bouche ne me a menty.” “Mon amy!” faict elle, “comment?” “Dame,” fait il, “ie vins deuant vous quant ie eu prins congie monseigneur le roy | si vous commanday a dieu, et dis que ie estoie vostre cheuallier en tous lieux. Et vous me dictes que vostre amy et vostre cheuallier voulliez vous que ie fusse. Et ie dys, “a dieu! dame.” Et vous distes “a dieu! mon beau doulx amy!” Ce fut le mot qui preudhomme me fera, se ie le suis, ne oncques puis ne fus a si grant meschef que il ne men remembrast. Ce mot ma conforte en tous mes ennuy. Cest mot ma de tous maulx guarir. Cest mot ma fait riche en mes pouretez;” “Par ma foy,” fait la royne, “ce mot fut en bonne heure dict | et dieu en soyt aoure | ne ie ne le prenroye pas acertes comme vous feistes, et a maint

“Ah, then your name is Lancelot,” says she,

“and for what lady or damsel did you do such feats of arms the day before yesterday?”

“For you, Lady; and for you I broke the three lances that your maiden brought me

for you had made me your *friend*, and said I was your knight in all lands, and bid me adieu as your own sweet friend.

Printed as shown: inner and outer quotes both use double quotation marks.

That word has never left me, but always been my strength and wealth.”

preudhomme ay ie ce dict ou ie ne pensay oncques riens que le dire. Mais la coustume est telle des cheualliers que font a mainte dame semblant de telles choses dont a gueres ne leur est au cueur.” Et ce disoit elle pour veoir de combien elle le pourroit mettre en malaise; Car elle veoit bien quil ne pretendoit a autre amour que a la sienne | mais elle se delectoyt a sa malaisete veoir, et il eut si grant angoisse que par vng pou quil ne se pasma | & la royne eut paour quil ne cheist, si appella gallehault, et il y vint acourant. Quant il voyt que son compaignon est si courrouce, si en a si grant angoisse que plus ne peut. “Haa, dame,” fait gallehault, “vous le nous pourrez bien tollir, et ce seroit trop grand dommaige.” “Certes, sire, se seroit mon;” “Et ne scauez vous pour qui il a tant fait darmes?” faict gallehault. “Certes, nenny,” faict elle | “mais, se il est veoir ce qui ma este dict, cest pour moy;” “Dame, se maist dieu, bien len pouez croire | car aussi comme il est le plus preudhomme de tous les hommes | aussi est son cueur plus vray que tous aultres.” “Voirement,” fait elle, “diriez vous quil seroit preudhomme se vous scauiez quil a fait darmes puis quil fut cheuallier.” Lors luy compte tout ainsi comment vous auez ouy | “et saichez quil a ce faict seulement pour moy,” fait elle. Lors luy prie gallehault, & dist. “Pour dieu, dame, ayez de luy mercy, et faictes pour moy ainsi comme ie fis pour vous quant vous men priastes.” “Quelle mercy voulez vous que ien aye?” “Dame, vous scauez que ie vous ayme sur toutes, et il a fait pour vous plus que oncques cheualier ne fist pour dame, et sachez que la paix de moy et de monseigneur neust ia este faicte se neust il este.” “Certes,” faict elle, “il a plus faict pour moy que ne pourroye desservir, ne il ne me pourroyt chose requerre dont ie le puisse esconduyre | mais il ne me requiert de riens | ains est tant melencolieux que merueilles.” “Dame,” fait gallehault, “aez en mercy; il est celluy qui vous ayme plus que soy mesmes. Si maist

“Oh, but that was only an ordinary compliment,” says Guinevere, to tease him. This grieves Lancelot so that he nearly faints, at which Galiot is greatly grieved,

tells the Queen that Lancelot is the gallantest and truest of men,

and prays her to have mercy on him.

“What mercy?” says she;

“there is nothing he can ask of me that I will not do; but he will not ask.”

dieu, ie ne scauoye riens de sa volente quant il vint, fors
 quil doubtoit de estre congneu, ne oncques plus ne men
 descouurit.” “Je en auray,” fait elle, “telle mercy comme
 vous voudrez.” “Dame, vous auez fait ce que ie vous ay
 requis; aussi doy ie bien faire ce *que* vous me requerez.”
 Se dit la royne, “il ne me requiert de riens.” “Certes,
 dame,” fait gallehault, “il ne ose | car len ne aymera ia
 riens par amours que len ne craigne | mais ie vous en
 prie pour luy, & se ie ne vous en priasse, si le deussiez
 vous pourchasser. Car plus riche tresor ne pourriez vous
 conquerer.” “Certes,” fait elle, “ie le scay bien et ie en
 feray tout ce que vous commanderez.” “Dame,” fait
 Gallehault, “grant mercy. Je vous prie que vous luy
 donnez vostre amour, et le retenez pour vostre cheuallier
 a tousiours, et deuenez sa loyalle dame toute vostre vie |
 et vous le aurez fait plus riche que se vous luy auiez
 donne tout le monde.” “Certes,” faict elle, “ie luy
 ottroye que il soyt mien | et moy toute sienne, et que par
 vous soyent amendez tous les meffaitz.” “Dame,” faict
 Gallehault, “grant mercy. Or conuient il commencement
 de seruice;” “Vous ne deuiserez riens,” fait la royne,
 “que ie ne face.” “Dame,” faict il, “grant mercy | donc
 baisez le deuant moy pour commencement de vrayes
 amours.” “Du baiser,” faict elle, “ie ne voy ne lieu ne
 temps | et ne doutez pas,” faict elle, “que ie ne le
 voulsisse faire aussi voullentiers quil feroit | mais ces
 dames sont cy qui moult se merueillent *que* nous auons
 tant fait, si ne *pourroyt* estre que ilz ne le vissent.
 Nompourtant, se il veult, ie le baisera voullentiers.” Et
 il en est si ioyeux que il ne peult respondre si non tant
 quil dict. “Dame,” faict il, “grant mercy” | “dame,” faict
 Gallehault, “de son vouloir nen doutez ia | Car il est
 tout vostre, bien le saichez, ne ia nul ne sen
 apperceuera; Nous troys serons ensemble ainsi comme
 se nous conseillions” | “Dequoy me feroye ie pryer” |
 faict elle | “plus le vueil ie que vous.” Lors se trayent a

“He does not dare,”
 answers Galiot, “but I
 will ask for him.”

“Then I will grant it,”
 says Queen Guinevere.
 Galiot prays her to give
 Lancelot her love, and
 become his loyal lady all
 her life.

She promises to be
 Lancelot’s,
 and that she will do
 everything she is told.

“Then kiss Lancelot
 before me,” says Galiot.

This Guinevere agrees to
 do, if Lancelot wishes it.

Galiot says there is no
 doubt about Lancelot’s
 wish;

part, et font semblant de conseiller. La Royne voyt que le cheuallier nen ose plus faire, si le prent par le menton, et baise deuant Gallehault assez longuement. Et la dame de Mallehault (*sic*) sceut de vray que elle le baisoyt. Lors parla la Royne qui moult estoyt sage & vaillant dame. “Beau doulx amy,” faict elle, “tant auez faict que ie suys vostre; Et moult en ay grant ioye. Or gardez que la chose soyt celee. Car mestier en est. Je suys une des Dames du monde dont len a greigneur bien dict, Et se ma renommee empiroyt par vous, il y auroyt layde amour et villaine | et vous, Gallehault, ie vous pryé que mon honneur gardez | Car vous estes le plus saige | Et se mal men venoyt, ce ne seroyt si non par vous; Et se ien ay bien et ioye, vous me lauez donnee.” “Dame,” faict Gallehault, “il ne pourroyt vers vous mesprendre, et ien ay bien faict ce que vous me commandastes. Or vous pryé que faciez ma volente ainsi comme iay fait la vostre;” “Dictes,” fait elle, “tout ce quil vous plaira hardyment | car vous ne me scauriez chose commander que ie ne face.” “Dame,” faict il, “donc mauez vous ottroye que ie seray son compaignon a tousiours.” “Certes,” fait elle, “se de ce vous failloit, vous auriez mal employe la peine que vous auez prinse pour luy et pour moy.” Lors prent le cheuallier par la main, et dict. “Gallehault, ie vous donne ce cheualier a tousiours sans ce que iay auant eu, et vous le me creancez ainsi” | et aussi le cheualier luy creance | “scauez vous,” fait elle, “Gallehault, que ie vous ay donne lancelot du lac, le filz au roy ban de benoic;” Ainsi luy a fait le cheualier congnoistre, qui moult en a grant honte. Lors a gallehault greigneure ioye quil neust oncques | car il auoit maintesfois ouy dire, comme parolles vont, que cestoyt le meilleur cheualier et le plus preux du monde, et bien scauoit que le roy ban auoit este moult gentil homme, et moult puissant de amys et de terre.

and as he is bashful, the Queen takes him by the chin, and kisses him before Galiot. (The Lady of Mallehault sees her.)

Guinevere tells Lancelot that she is his, but charges him to keep the matter secret,

and Galiot too.

Galiot promises this,

and asks Guinevere to make Lancelot his companion for ever.

She takes Lancelot's hand, gives him to Galiot,

and says she has given him Lancelot of the Lake, son of King Ban.

This gives Galiot more joy than ever he had before, as he had often heard how Lancelot was the gallantest knight in the world.

A Insi fut faicte la premiere acointance de la royne et deancelot par gallehault | et Gallehault ne lauoit oncques congneu que de veue, et pource luy fait creancer quil ne luy demanderoit son nom tant quil luy dist, ou autre pour luy. Lors se leuerent tous troys, et il anuytoit durement. Mais la lune estoyt leuee, si faisoit cler | Si que elle luysoyt par toute la prairie | Lors sen retournerent a vne part contrement les prez droit vers le tref le cheualier, & le seneschal et gallehault vint apres luy & les dames tant quilz vindrent endroit les tentes de gallehault. Lors enuoya Gallehault son compaignon a son tref, et prent conge de la royne, et gallehault la conuoye iusques au tref du Roy. Et quant le roy les veyt, si demanda dont ilz venoyent. “Sire,” fait Gallehault, “nous uenons de veoir ces pres a si peu de compaignie comment vous veez.” Lors se assient, et parlent de plusieurs choses; si sont la Royne et Gallehault moult ayses.

By the bright moonlight
they recross the meads
towards Lancelot’s tent,

and Galiot sends
Lancelot there, while he
conducts the Queen to
Arthur’s tent,
and tells him they have
only been looking at the
fields by themselves.

A V chef de piece se leua la royne, et sen alla en la bretesche; gallehault la conuoya iusques la. Puis la commande a dieu, et dist quil sen yroit gesir avec son compaignon. “Bien auez fait,” dit la royne, “il en sera plus ayse” | A tant sen part gallehault, et vient au roy prendre congie, et dist quil ne luy desplaise, et que il yra gesir avec les gens pource quil ny auoyt geu de grant piece, et dist. “Sire, ie me doibz pener de faire leur voulente | car ilz me ayment moult.” “Sire,” fait messire gauvain, “vous dictes bien, et len doit bien honnorer telz preudhommes qui les a.” Lors sen part gallehault et vient a son compaignon; Ilz se coucherent tous deux en vng lict, et deviserent la une piece. Si nous laisserons ores a parler de gallehault & de son compaignon, et dirons de la royne qui est venu en la bretesche.

Galiot sees the Queen to
her tower,

and then takes leave of
Arthur and of Gawain,

and goes to Lancelot’s
bed.

Vant gallehault fut party, la royne sen alla en vne fenestre, et commence a penser a ce que plus luy

Qu'plaisoyt. La dame de mallehault saprocha delle quant elle la vit seulle, et luy dist le plus priueement que elle peut. "Haa, dame! pourquoy ne est bonne la compaignie de quatre?" La royne le ouyst bien, si ne dit mot, et fait semblant *que* riens nen ouyt. Et ne demoura gueres *que* la dame dist celle parolle mesmes; la royne lapella et dist. "Dame, pourquoy auez ce dit?" "Dame," fait elle, "pardonnez moi, ie nen diray ores plus | car par aduenture en ay plus dit que a moy n'apartient | & len ne se doit mi faire plus priuee de sa dame que len est | car tost en acquiert on hayne." "Si maist dieu," fait la royne, "vous ne me pourriez riens dire dont vous eussiez ma haine | ie vous tiens tant a saige et a courtoyse, que vous ne diriez riens qui fust encontre ma volente | Mais dictes hardyment | Car ie le vueil, et si vous en prie." "Dame," fait elle, "donc le vous diray ie | Je dy que moult est bonne la compaignie de quatre; Jay huy veu nouveau accointement *que* vous auez faict au cheuallier qui parla a vous la bas en ce vergier. Et scay bien que cest la personne du monde qui plus vous ayme, et vous ne auez pas tort se vous laymez | car vous ne pourriez vostre amour mieulx employer;" "Comment," fait la royne, "le congnoissez vous?" "Dame," fait elle, "telle heure a este ouen que ie vous en eusse bien peu faire refus comme vous en pouez ores faire a moy | car ie lay tenu vng an et demy en prison. Cest celluy qui vaincquit lassemblee aux armes vermeilles | & celle de deuant hier aux armes noires, les vnes & les autres luy baillay ie; Et quant il fut auant hier sur la riuere pensif, et ie luy voulu mander *que* il fist vaillamment armes, ie ne le faisoye sinon pour ce que ie esperoye quil vous aymast; si cuydoye telle heure fust que il me aymast | Mais il me mist tost hors de cuyder, tant me descouurit de son penser." Lors luy compta comment elle lauoyt tenu en prison an et demy | et pourquoy elle lauoit prins. "Or me dictes," fait la

Queen Guinevere goes to the window to think,

and the Lady of Mallehault asks her why four are bad company. At first Guinevere will not hear this, but the Lady repeats it; the Queen asks why she says it, and the Lady asks pardon, as perhaps she has said too much.

"No," says Guinevere,

"speak boldly out; I wish it."

"Then I must say that I think four very good company. I saw the new acquaintance you made to-day, and know he is the man who loves you most in the world.

I kept him a year and a half in prison, and gave him both the red and the black arms in which he won the tourneys;

and I thought then that he loved me, but he soon undeceived me."

royne, “quelle compaignie vault mieulx de quatre que de troys | car mieulx est vne chose celee par trois que par quatre.” “Certes non est cy endroit, et si vous diray. Vray est que le cheualier vous ayme, et aussi fait il gallehault, et desormais se conforteront lung lautre en quelque terre quilz soient. Car icy ne seront ilz pas longuement: et vous demourerez cy toute seule, et ne le scaura nul fors vous | ne si ne aurez a qui descourir vostre pensee, si porterez ainsi vostre faix toute seulle | mais sil vous pleust que ie fusse la quarte en la compaignie entre nous deux dames, nous solacierons ainsi comme entre eulx deux cheualiers feront, si en seriez plus aise.” “Scauez vous,” fait la royne, “qui est le cheuallier?” “Se maist dieu,” fait la dame, “nenny.” “Vous avez bien ouy comment il se couurit vers moy.” “Certes,” faict la royne, “moult estes apparceunte, et moult conuiendroit estre sage qui vous vouldroit rien embler, & puis que ainsi est que vous lauez aperceu, et que vous me requerez la compaignie, vous laurez | mais ie vueil que vous portez vostre faix ainsi comme ie feray le mien.” “Dame,” faict elle, “ie feray ce que il vous plaira, pour ci haulte compaignie auoir.” “En verite,” faict la royne, “vous laurez | car meilleure compaignie que vous ne pourroye ie mye auoir,” “Dame,” fait elle, “nous serons ensemble toutes les heures quil vous plaira.” “Jen suys ioyeuse,” faict la Royne. “Et nous affermerons demain la compaignie de nous quatre.” Lors luy compte de Lancelot, comment il auoyt ploure quant il regarda deuers elle, “et ie scay que il vous congneut, et saichez que cest lancelot du lac, le meilleur cheuallier qui viue.” Ainsi parlerent longuement entre elles deux | et font moult grant ioye de leur accointement nouveau. Icelle nuyct ne souffrit oncques la Royne de logres que la dame de mallehault geust sinon auec elle | mais elle y geut a force. Car elle doubtoyt moult de gesir auec si riche dame; Quant elles furent couchees si

The Queen answers,
 “But tell me why four
 are better company than
 three.”

“Because, though your
 knight loves you, he
 loves Galiot too, and
 they will not stay here

long, but you will; and if
 you have no one else to
 tell your thought to, you
 will be forced to keep
 your faith to yourself;
 but if you will let me be
 a fourth, we can comfort
 one another.”

Queen Guinevere agrees
 to this with great joy,

and tells the Lady that
 the knight is Lancelot of
 the Lake.

At night the ladies sleep
 together,

commencerent a parler de leurs nouuelles amours; La royne demanda a la dame de mallehault selle a[y]me nulluy par amours, et elle luy dict que nenny. “Saichez, dame, que ie naymay oncques que vne foy, ne de celle amour ne fis ie que penser;” et ce dit elle de lancelot, quelle auoit tant aymer comme femme pourroit aymer homme mortel | Mais elle nen auoit oncques aultre ioye eue, non pourtant ne dit pas que ce eust il este. La royne pensa quelle feroit ses amours de elle et de gallehault, mais elle nen veult parler iusques a tant quelle scaura de gallehault sil la veult aymer ou non | car autrement ne len requerroit elle pas. Lendemain se leuerent matin elles deux, & allerent au tref du roy, qui gisoit la pour faire a monseigneur gauvain et aux aultres cheualiers compaignie. La royne sesueilla, & dist, “que moult estoyt mauuais qui a ceste heure dormoyt.” Lors se tournerent contreal les prez, et dames et damoyselles avec elles. Et ils allerent la ou laccointement damours auoyt este faict, et dict la Royne a la dame de mallehault toute laccointance de lancelot | et comme il estoit esbahy deuant elle, et riens ne luy laissa a dire. Puis commenca a louer gallehault, et dit que cestoit le plus saige homme et le plus vertueux du monde; “Certes,” fait elle, “ie luy compteray laccointance de nous deux quant il viendra, et sachez que il en aura grant ioye. Or allons | car il ne demourra gueres quil ne viengne.”

and talk of their new loves,

the Lady of Mallehault saying that she never loved but one, and then only in thought (and that was Lancelot).

The Queen thinks she will make the Lady and Galiot fall in love with one another.

Next morning they go to Arthur’s tent and wake him, and then return over the meadows

where the meeting with Lancelot took place, and the Queen tells the Lady of Mallehault all about it, and then praises Galiot as the wisest and best man in the world.

The rubric of the next chapter is as follows:

¶ *Comment la premiere acointance fut faicte de gallehault et de la dame de malehault par le moyen de la royne de logres. Et comment lancelot & gallehault sen alloient esbatre et deuiser avec leurs dames.*

How Galiot became acquainted with the Lady of Melyhalt.

It relates how Queen Guinevere requires Galiot to let her dispose of his love as he had disposed of hers. To this he consents, and she commends him to

the Lady of Mallehault. Next, they arrange for the promised *parlement de eulx quatre*; and the queen points out to Lancelot the lady who had so many a day kept him in prison, i.e., the Lady of Mallehault. At recognizing his old acquaintance, Lancelot feels somewhat distressed, but is reassured by observing the new love-making between her and Galiot. Seated in a wood, the four “demourerent grant piece, ne oncques ne tindrent parolles, fors tant seullement de accoller & de baiser comme ceulx qui volentiers le faisoient.”

We next hear of Gawain’s recovery, and of the separation of the party of four above spoken of. Galiot takes Lancelot home with him to his own country, whilst the Lady of Mallehault remains for a time with the queen and Arthur. When Lancelot is next spoken of, he is in Galiot’s country, where we will now leave him.

NOTES TO THE APPENDIX.

[P. xxiii.](#) *Descosse* = *d’Écosse*, of Scotland. In Old French, words are frequently run together; thus we have *labbaye* for *l’abbaye*, *sesmeurent* for *s’émeurent*, etc. Also the letter *s* is often replaced in modern French by an acute or circumflex accent; so that *Escosse* = *Êcosse*; *chasteau* = *château*, etc.

The word *si* often occurs below with a great variety of meanings, viz. I, he; and, also; so, thus; etc.

[P. xxiv.](#) *baille*, given, entrusted.

brouyr (*brûler*), being burnt.

monstier, monastery.

gauues, so in the original throughout; *gaunes* is used in other romances.

[P. xxv.](#) *avecques* = *avec*, with.

[P. xxvi.](#) *aduisioun*, vision.

behourdys, tournament.

naure, wounded.

deffera = *desferra*, un-ironed; it means that Lancelot drew the weapons out of the knight's wounds.

deuers, "Préposition relative au temps et au lieu dont on parle; près, vers, contre, proche; de *versus*." Roquefort.

octroya, permitted (authorized).

mouille, *lit.* wetted; insulted.

[P. xxvii.](#) *veirent*, saw.

escript (*écrit*), written.

lassemblee, the gathering; *i.e.* the war, strife.

rua, overthrew.

[P. xxviii.](#) *mire*, physician.

gue, ford, pass.

tresues, a truce; spelt *treues* on p. xxix.

[P. xxix.](#) *esbatre*, to divert oneself. In modern French, *s'ébattre*.

[P. xxx.](#) *orrions*, shall hear.

deust = *dût*.

cheoient, from *cheoir*, to fall. Compare *chûte*.

poilz, hairs.

esbahy, amazed.

ortelz, toes.

chaille; from *chaloir*, to be anxious about.

dilacion, delay.

[P. xxxi.](#) *paour*, fear.

mire, physician.

veufue, old.

[P. xxxii.](#) *cheuauche*, rides.

boutte, buts, pushes.

iecte (*jeté*), cast.

cuyde, I believe.

Si maist dieu, so God aid me. Here *maist* is put for *m'aist*.

oncques, ever.
ennuyt, this night, to-night.
lottroyera, will grant him his request.
conroy, troops.

[P. xxxiii.](#) *derrains* (*derniers*), last.

busines, trumpets.
Or y perra, now it will appear.
cuidoit, believed; from the old verb *quider*.
cheuauchent, ride.
ia, already.
tertre, a small hill.

[P. xxxiv.](#) *adresse*, a cross-path.

huy, just before; *lit.* this day. Lat. *hodiè*.
se pasme, swoons.
leans, thither.

[P. xxxv.](#) *ores*, now.

huy, to-day.
preudhomme, a wise and prudent man.
lottroye, permits him.
tref, tent.
neny, no!
ains, before.
guerpiront, will leave.
deduys, amusements, diversions.

[P. xxxvi.](#) *leans*, there.

gerrez, will lie.
las, tired.
Ains, but.

[P. xxxvii.](#) *semondray*, shall ask.

esbahy, amazed.
tollez, take away.

creanca, promised.

lees, wide, full.

lices, lists.

[P. xxxviii.](#) *emmy le pas*, in the midst of the passage.

hucher, to cry aloud.

[P. xxxix.](#) *lieue*, lifts.

saisine, disposal.

enseignes, tokens.

aincoys, first of all.

[P. xl.](#) *oncques mes*, never.

a resiouyr (réjouir), in amusing.

escondiroye, will refuse.

me poyse, it troubles me.

pieca, long ago.

se embronche, covers his face.

[P. xli.](#) *sen esueillerent*, awoke thereat.

Adonc, then.

riens forfait, anyway injured.

[P. xlii.](#) *ne me mescreez mye que*, do not doubt me more than.

[P. xliii.](#) *doint*, gives, were to give.

[P. xliv.](#) *mesgnie*, properly the *suite* or household of a prince; see Roquefort s.v. *magnie* and *maignee*.

nef, a boat.

loue, advise.

[P. xlv.](#) *vous esmayez*, afflict yourself.

courrouce, wrath, displeased.

[P. xlvi.](#) *vergier*, orchard.

aua, below.

se embroncha, she veiled herself, or, hid herself.

iouxte, beside.

[P. xlvii.](#) *maintes*, many.

ot, heard.

len prise mieulx, esteemed it better.

loe, praises.

deffera, dis-ironed, drew the weapons out of.

lestrief, the stirrup.

[P. xlviii.](#) *leans* (*la dédans*), there.

belif. We find in Cotgrave's French Dictionary, "*Belic*, a kind of red or geueles, in Blazon."

enseignes, tokens, message.

[P. xlix.](#) *mestier*, serviceable.

dillec, thence.

pourneant, for nothing, in vain.

voire, truly.

commanday a dieu, commended to God, bade farewell.

[P. li.](#) *mestier en est*, there is need of it.

greigneur bien, exceedingly well, very highly.

[P. lii.](#) *greigneure*, greater.

anuytoit, became night.

ie me doibz pener, I ought to take pains.

[P. liii.](#) *ouen*, this year.

¹ The extracts are from the Paris edition of 1513, 3 vols. folio, a copy of which is in the King's Library in the British Museum. There are also two other editions in the Museum, one in the Grenville Library, 3 vols. Paris, 1494, folio; the other in one folio volume, Paris, 1520.

² See [ll. 1447-1449](#).

³ Lines [215](#), [220](#).

⁴ Line [223](#).

⁵ Lines [237-245](#).

⁶ Lines [249-252](#).

- [7](#) Line [255](#).
- [8](#) Lines [257-259](#).
- [9](#) Lines [263](#), [-4](#).
- [10](#) See [ll. 244](#), [-5](#).
- [11](#) Line [267](#).
- [12](#) Lines [363-527](#).
- [13](#) Lines [540-592](#).
- [14](#) Line [280](#).
- [15](#) Lines [233-252](#).
- [16](#) Lines [281-292](#).
- [17](#) Lines [634-894](#).
- [18](#) Lines [895-974](#).
- [19](#) Lines [975-1138](#).
- [20](#) Lines [1275-2130](#).
- [21](#) Lines [1543-1584](#).
- [22](#) Lines [1139-1152](#).
- [23](#) Lines [1181-1274](#).
- [24](#) Lines [2161-2256](#).
- [25](#) Lines [2347-2442](#).
- [26](#) Lines [2504-2530](#).
- [27](#) Lines [2531-3268](#).
- [28](#) Lines [3343-3487](#).
- [29](#) There is no trace of the rest of this chapter in the Scottish poem.
- [30](#) Line [3432](#).
- [31](#) Lines [3435-3440](#).
- [32](#) Lines [3441-3476](#).
- [33](#) Lines [3477-3480](#).
- [34](#) Lines [3481-3484](#).
- [35](#) Lines [3485](#), [6](#).

[36](#) Line [3487](#) and last.

[37](#) Compare lines [3365-3368](#).

[38](#) Lines [3369](#), [70](#).

[39](#) Compare lines [3391-3426](#).

[40](#) Compare line [1140](#).

[41](#) Compare lines [2845-8](#).

[42](#) The original has *pat*.

The Romans
of
Lancelot of the Laik.

[PROLOGUE.]

The soft morow ande The lustee Aperill,
The wynter set, the stormys in exill,
Quhen that the brycht *and* fresch illumynare
4 Uprifith arly in his fyre chare
His hot courß in to the orient,
And frome his spere his goldine stremis sent
Wpone the grond, in maner off melag,
8 One euery thing to valkyne thar curage,
That natur haith set wnder hire mycht,
Boith gyrß, and flour, *and* euery lusty vicht:
And namly thame that felith the assay
12 Of lufe, to schew the kalendis of may,
Throw birdis songe *with* opine wox one hy,
That fessit not one lufaris for to cry,
Left thai forȝhet, throw flewth of Ignorans,
16 The old wlage of lowis obseruans.
And frome I can the bricht face asspy,
It deuait me no langare fore to ly,
Nore that loue schuld fleuth In to me finde,

[Fol. 1.]

In April, when the fresh
luminary upriseth,

and sendeth from his sphere
his golden streams,

and when I espy his bright
face,

OET BEWAILS HIS LOT.

20 Bot walkine furth, bewalinge in my mynde
the dredful lyve endurit al to longe,
Sufferans in loue of forouful harmys stronge,
The scharpe dais and the hewy 3erys,
24 Quhill phebus thris haith passith al his speris,
Vithoutine hope ore traiftinge of comfort;
So be such meine fatit was my sort.
Thus in my faull Rolinge al my wo,
28 My carful hart carwing cañ In two
The derdful fuerd of lowis hot diffire;
So be the morow set I was a-fyre
In felinge of the acceß hot *and* colde,
32 That haith my hart in sich a fevir holde,
Only to me thare was noñe vthir eß
Bot thinkine qhow I schulde my lady pleß.
The scharp assay and ek the Inwart peine
36 Of dowblit wo me neulyngis cañ constrein,
Quhen that I have remembrit one my thocht
How sche, quhois bewte al my harm haith wrocht,
Ne knouith not how I ame wo begoñe,
40 Nor how that I ame of hire seruandis oñe;
And in my self I cañ nocht fynde the meyne
In to quhat wyß I fal my wo compleine.

I walk forth, bewailing my
sad life.

The sword of love carves my
heart.

My lady knoweth not how I
am wobegone.

[Fol. 1 b.]

ES A VISION OF A GREEN BIRD.

Thus in the feild I walkith to *and* froo,
44 As thochtful wicht that felt of nocht bot woo,
Syne to o gardinge, that weß weil beseñ,
Of quiche the feild was al depaynt *with* greñ.
The tendyre and the lufty flouris new
48 Up thrōue the greñ vpone thar stalkis grew
Azhane the fone, and thare levis spread,

I walked thus in the field, and
came to a well-beseen garden.

Quharwith that al the gardinge was I-clede;
 That pryapus, in to his tyme before,
 52 In o lustear walkith nevir more;
 And al about enweronyt and Iclofit
 One lich o wyß, that none *within* supposit
 Fore to be señ *with* ony vicht thare owt;
 56 So dide the levis clof it ¹ all about.
 Thar was the flour, thar was the queñ alpheft, ²
 Rycht wering being of the *nychtis* rest,
 Wnclofing gañe the crownel for the day;
 60 The brycht sone illumynit haith the spray,
 The *nychtis* lobir ande the most schowris,
 As cristoll terys *withhong* vpone the flouris,
 Haith vpwarpith In the lufty aire,
 64 The morow makith soft, ameyne, and faire;
 And the byrdis thar *mychty* voce out-throng,
 Quhill al the wood refonite of thar songe,
 That gret confort till ony vicht It wer
 68 That pleßfith thame of lustenes to here.
 Bot gladneß til the thochtful, euer mo
 The more he seith, the more he haith of wo.
 Thar was the garding *with* the flouris ourfret,
 72 Quich is in poly fore my lady set,
 That hire Represent to me oft befor,
 And thane also; thus al day gan be for ³
 Of thocht my goft *with* torment occupy,
 76 That I becamē In to one exafy,
 Ore flep, or how I wot; bot so befell
 My wo haith done my livis goft expell,
 And in lich wiß weil long I can endwr,
 80 So me betid o wondir aventur.
 As I thus lay, Rycht to my spreit vas señ
 A birde, yat was as ony lawrare greñ,

It was closely environed with leaves.

¹ MS. "clofit."

² May we read "alcest"?

The sun illumined the sprays;

the birds sang till the woods resounded;

the garden was adorned with flowers.

³ MS. "befor."

[Fol. 2.]

I fell there into an ecstasy or sleep,

A-licht, and fayth in to hir birdis chere;

BIRD'S MESSAGE.

84 "O woful wrech, that levis in to were!
To schew the thus the god of loue me sent,
That of thi seruice no thing is content,
For in his court yhoue lewith *in* diffpar,
88 And vilfully sustenis al thi care,
And schapith no thinge of thine awn remede,
Bot clepith ay and cryith apone dede.
Yhow callith the birdis be morow fro thar bouris,
92 Yhoue devith both the erbis and the flouris,
And clepit hyme vnfaithful king of lowe,
Yow dewith hyme in to *his* rigne abufe,
Yhow tempith hyme, yhoue doith thi self no gud,
96 Yhoue are o moñ of wit al destitute.
Wot yhoue *nocht* that al liwis creatwre
Haith of thi wo *in* to *his* hand the cwre?
And set yhoue clep one erbis and one treis,
100 Sche heris not thi wo, nore 3hit sche feis;
For none may know the dirkneß of thi thocht,
Ne blamyth her thi wo sche knowith *nocht*.
And It is weil accordinge It be so
104 He suffir harme, that to redreß *his* wo
Previdith not; for long ore he be fonde,
Holl of his leich, that schewith not *his* vound.
And of owid ye autor schall yhow know
108 Of lufe that feith, for to confel or schow,
The laft he clepith althir-best of two;
And that is futh, and fal be euer mo.
And loue also haith chargit me to fay,
112 Set yhoue prefume, ore beleif, ye affay
Of his seruice, as It wil ryne ore go,

and saw in my dream a green
bird, who said:

"The God of Love is
discontent with thee.

You are destitute of wit.

Though you call on trees,
your lady hears not.

Ovid says it is better to shew,
than to conceal love.

[Fol. 2 b.]

Prefwme It not, fore It wil not be so;
Al magre thine a *seruand* schal yow bee.

116 And as tueching thine *aduerfyttee*,
Complen and sek of the ramed, the cwre,
Ore, gif yhow likith, furth thi wo endure.”

And, as me *thocht*, I anfuerde *azaiñe*

120 Thus to the byrde, in wordis *schort* and plane:

“It ganyth not, as I have harde *Recorde*,
The *seruand* for to *disput* *with* ye lord;

Bot well he knowith of al my vo the quhy,

124 And in quhat wyß he hath me set, quhar I

Nore may I not, nore can I not attane,

Nore to hir hienes dare I not complane.”

As touching thine adversity,
seek the remedy.”

Then answered I:

“Love knows the reason of
my wo.”

BIDS HIM WRITE A POEM.

“Ful!” *quod* the bird, “lat be thi nyß *dispare*,

128 For in this erith no lady is so fare,

So hie estat, nore of so gret *empriß*,

That in hire self haith *visdome* ore gentrice,

Yf that o wicht, that worthy is to be

132 Of lovis court, *schew* til hir that he

Seruith hire in lovis hartly wyß,

That *schall* thar for hyme *hating* or *dispiß*.

The god of love thus *chargit* the, at *schort*,

136 That to thi lady yhoue thi wo *Report*;

Yf yhoue may not, thi plant *schall* yhov *vrit*.

Se, as yhoue cane, be *maner* oft *endit*

In *metir*, quhich that no man haith *suffpek*,

140 Set oft tyme thai *contenyng* gret *effecc*;

Thus one fume wyß yhow *schal* thi wo *dwclar*.

And, for thir *sedulis* and thir *billis* are

So generall, and ek so *schort* at lyte,

144 And *fwme* of *thaim* is loft the *appetit*,

“Fool,” said the bird, “despair
not;

the God of Love charges thee
to speak out your love, or else
to write thy plaint;

Sum treti schall yhoue for yi lady lak,
 That wnkouth is, als tak one hand and mak,
 Of love, ore armys, or of sum othir thing,
 148 That may hir one to thi Remembryng brynge;
 Qwich foundith Not one to no hewynes,
 Bot one to gladneß and to lufteneß,
 That yhoue belevis may thi lady pleß,
 152 To have hir thonk and be one to hir eß;
 That sche may wit in seruice yhow art one.
 Faire weil,” quod sche, “thus schal yhow the
 dispone,
 And mak thi self als mery as yhoue may,
 156 It helpith not thus fore to wex al way.”
 With that, the bird sche haith hir leif tak,
 For fere of quich I can onone to wak;
 Sche was ago, and to my self thocht I
 160 Quhat may yis meyne? quhat may this signify?
 Is It of troucht, or of Illufioun?

write, then, some treatise for
her to read;

[Fol. 3.]

one that may please her and
get her thanks.

Farewell, and be merry.”

Thereon I awoke, and
wondered what it might mean.

3SOLVES TO DO SO.

Bot finaly, as in concludioun,
 Be as be may, I schal me not discharge,
 164 Sen It apperith be of lovis charg;
 And ek myne hart noñe othir biffynes
 Haith bot my ladice seruice, as I geß;
 Among al vtheris I schal one honde tak
 168 This litil occupatioun for hire lak.
 Bot hyme I pray, the mychty gode of loue,
 That fitith hie in to his spir abuf,
 (At command of o wyß quhois vifioun
 172 My goft haith takin this opvnioun,)

That my lawboure may to my lady pleß
 And do wnto hir ladeschip sum eß,

I determined to take in hand
this occupation.

So that my *trauell* be *nocht* tynt, and I
 176 Quhat vtheris say fetith nothing by.
 For wel I know that, be this worldis *famē*.
 It schal not be bot hurting to my *namē*,
 Quhen that thai here my febil negligens,
 180 That empit is, and bare of eloquens,
 Of discreffioune, and ek of Retoryk;
 The metire and the cuning both elyk
 So fere discording frome *perfeccioune*;
 184 *Quhilk* I submyt to the correccioune
 Of yaim the quhich that is discret *and* wyß,
 And enterit is of loue in the *seruice*;
 Quhich knouyth that no lovare dare *withstonde*,
 188 Quhat loue hyme chargit he mot tak one honde,
 Deith, or defamē, or ony maner wo;
 And at this tyme *with me* It stant rycht so,
 As I that dar makine no demande
 192 To quhat I wot It lykith loue *commande*.
 Tueching his chargis, as *with al* destitut,
 Within my mynd schortly I conclud
 For to fulfyll, for ned I mot do so.

I know it will but hurt my name, when men hear my feeble negligence.

I submit my poem to the correction of the wise;

[Fol. 3 b.]

for I dare not oppose Love's command.

LINKS OF THE STORY OF LANCELOT.

196 Thane in my *thocht* rolling to and fro
 Quhare that I *myhct* *fum* wnkouth mater fynde,
 Quhill at ye laft it fell in to my mynd
 Of o story, that I befor had sene,
 200 That boith of loue and armys can conteñ,
 Was of o knyght clepit lancelot of ye laik,
 The sone of bane was, king of albanak;
 Of quhois fame *and* worshipful dedis
 204 Clerkis in to diuerß bukis redis,
 Of quhome I thynk her *fum* thing for to writ

At last I thought of the story of "Lancelot of the Lake,"

At lous charge, and as I cane, endit;
Set men tharin fal by experiens
208 Know my confait, and al my negligens.
Bot for that fstory is fo pafing larg,
One to my wit It war fo gret o charg
For to tranflait the romans of that knyght;
212 It paffith fare my cunyng and my mycht,
Myne Ignorans may It not comprehende;

RIEFLY ENUMERATES

Quharfor thare one I wil me not depend
How he was borne, nor how his fader deid
216 And ek his moder, nore how he was denyed
Efter thare deth, prefumyng he was ded,
Of al ye lond, nore how he fra that ftede
In sacret wyß wnwyft away was tak,
220 And nwrift *with* ye lady of ye lak.
Nor, in his 3outh, think I not to tell
The auentouris, quhich to hyme befell;
Nor how the lady of the laik hyme had
224 One to the court, quhare that he knyght was mad;
None wift his nome, nore how that he was tak
By loue, and was Iwondit to the ftak,
And throuch *and* throuch perfit to ye hart,
228 That al his tyme he couth It not aftar;
For thare of loue he enterit in *feruice*,
Of wanore throuch the beute and franchis,
Throuch quhois *feruice* in armys he has vrocht
232 Mony wonderis, and perellis he has socht.
Nor how he thor, in to his 3oung curage,
Hath maid awoue, and in to lous rage,
In the rewenging of o wondit knyght
236 That cumyne was in to the court that nyght;

of whom I here think to write something.

But because my ignorance cannot comprehend the French romance,

I shall not tell how he was born;

nor how he was nourished by the Lady of the Lake;

nor how he was brought to Arthur's court,

[Fol. 4.]

and pierced to the heart by the beauty of Wanore (Guinevere),

for whose service he wrought many wonders;

nor how he made a vow to revenge a wounded knight,

In to his hed a brokin ⁴ fuerd had he,
 And in his body also mycht men see
 The tronfione of o brokine sper that was,
 240 Quhich no man out dedenyt to aras;
 Nor how he haith the wapnis out tak,
 And his awow apone this wis can mak,
 That he schuld hyme Reweng at his poware
 244 One euery knycht that louith the hurtare
 Better thane hyme, the quhich that vas Iwond.
 Throw quich awoue in armys hath ben founde
 The deth of mony wereoure ful wicht; ⁵
 248 For, fro tho wow was knowing of the knycht,
 Thare was ful mony o palage in the londe
 By men of armys kepit to withstond
 This knycht, of quhome thai ben al set afyre
 252 Thaim to reweng in armys of defir.
 Nor how that thane incontynent was fend
 He and *fir* kay togidder to defend
 The lady of nohalt, nor how that hee
 256 Gouvernit hyme thare, nore in quhat degre.
 Nor how the gret pafing vaffolag
 He efcheuit, thrōue the outragouß curag,
 In conquirng of the sorowful castell.
 260 Nor how he passith doune in the cauis fell,
 And furth ye keys of Inchantment brocht,
 That al diftroyt quhich that thare vas vrocht.
 Nore howe that he reskewit *fir* gawane,
 264 *With* his ix falouß in to presone tane;
 Nore mony vthere diuerß aduenture,
 Quhich to report I tak not in my cwre,

⁴ MS. "abrokin."

who had a broken sword in his head, and a truncheon of a broken spear in his body;

⁵ The MS. wrongly transposes ll. 247 and 248.

a vow which caused the death of many a wight warrior;

or how he and Sir Kay were sent to defend the lady of Nohalt;

or how he conquered the Sorrowful Castle;

[Fol. 4 b.]

or how he rescued Sir Gawane and his nine fellows;

ELOT'S EARLY DEEDS.

Nor mony affemblay that gawane gart be maid

268 To wit his name; nor how that he hyme hade
 Wnswift, and hath the worfchip *and* empriß;
 Nor of the knyghtis in to mony ⁶ diuerß wyß
 Throuh his awoue that hath thare dethis found;
 272 Nor of the sufferans that by louis wounde
 He in his trawel sufferith auer more;
 Nor in the quenis *presens* how tharfor
 By camelot, in to that gret Revare,
 276 He was ner dround. I wil It not declare
 How that he was in louis hewy thocht
 By dagenet in to the court I-brocht;
 Nor how the knyght that tyme he cane *perfew*,
 280 Nor of the gyantis by camelot he flew;
 Nor wil I not her tell the maner how
 He flew o knyght, by *natur* of his wow,
 Off melyholt; nore how in to that toune
 284 Thar came one hyme o gret confufione
 Of pupil *and* [of] knyghtis, al enarmyt,
 Nor how he thar haith kepit hyme wnharmyt;
 Nor of his worfchip, nor of his gret prowes,
 288 Nor his defens of armys in the pres.
 Nor how the lady of melyhalt yat *ſche*
 Came to the feild, and pray[i]th hyme that he
 As to o lady to hir ⁷ his fuerd hath zold,
 292 Nor how he was in to hir keping hold;
 And mony vthir nobil deid also
 I wil report quharfor I lat ourgo.
 For quho thaim lykith for to ſpecyfy,
 296 Of one of thaim mycht mak o gret ſtory;
 Nor thing I not of his hye renōwn
 My febil wit to makin menfioune;
 Bot of the weris that was ſcharp *and* ſtrong,
 300 Richt perellouß, and hath enduryt long,

nor of the many “assemblies”
 Gawane held to find out his
 name;

⁶ We should perhaps omit
 “mony.”

nor of his suffering caused by
 love’s wound;

nor how he was nearly
 drowned at Camelot;

nor how he was brought to
 court by Dagenet;

nor of the giants he slew at
 Camelot;

nor how he slew a knight of
 Melyholt;

and there defended himself
 against a crowd;

whereupon the lady of
 Melyhalt prayed him to yield
 his sword to her; and kept him
 in her power.

⁷ MS. “his.”

Whoever likes, might make of
 these things a long story.

But I think to tell of the wars
 between Arthur and Galiot;

Of Arthur In defending of his lond
Frome galiot, fone of the fair gyonde,
That brocht of knyghtis o pasing confluens;
304 And how lancelot of arthuris hol defens
And of the veris berith the renown;
And how he be the wais of fortoun
Tuex the two princis makith the accorde,
308 Of al there mortall weris to concorde;
And how that venus, fiting hie abuf,
Reuardith hyme of trauell in to loue,
And makith hyme his ladice grace to have,
312 And thankfully his seruice cane refave;
This is the mater quhich I think to tell.
Bot ftill he mot rycht with the lady duell,
Quhill tyme cum eft that we schal of hym fpek.
316 This proceß [now] mot clofine beñ and ftek;
And furth I wil one to my mater go.

DEDICATION.

Bot first I pray, and I befek also,
One to the moft conpilour to fupport,
320 Flour of poyetis, quhois nome I wil report
To me nor to noñ vthir It accordit,
In to our rymyng his nañ to be recordit;
For fum fuld deme It of prefumpfioune,
324 And ek our rymyng is al bot deryfioune,
Quhen that remembrith is his excellens,
So hie abuf that ftant in reuerans.
Ye fresch enditing of his laiting tounge
328 Out throuch yis world fo wid is yroung,
Of eloquens, and ek of retoryk;
Nor is, nor was, nore neuer beith hyme lyk,
This world gladith of his fuet poetry.

[Fol. 5.]

wherein Lancelot won renown
by his defence of Arthur;

and at last made peace
between the two princes.

I shall also tell how Venus
rewarded him.

My summary must end for the
present.

But I pray for the support of a
very great poet,

whose name I may not
mention;

for our riming is but derision,
when his excellence is
remembered.

The world knows his
eloquence in inditing Latin;

332 His faul I blyß conferuyt be for-thy;
And yf that ony lusty terme I wryt
He haith the thonk yerof, *and* this endit.

and none can ever gladden the
world like him:

to him be the thanks for my
success.

EXPLICIT PROLOGUS, ET INCIPIT PRIMUS
LIBER.

UR AT CARLISLE.

[BOOK I.]

Q uhen [that] tytan, withe his lusty heit,

[Fol. 5 b.]

336 Twenty dais In to the aryeit
Haith maid his courß, and all with diuerß hewis
Aparalit haith the feldis and the bewis;
The birdis amyð the erbis *and* the flouris,
340 And one the branchis, makyne gone thar bouris,
And be the morow finging in ther chere
Welcum to the lusty leffone of the 3ere.
In to this tyme the worthi conqueroure
344 Arthure, wich had of al this worlde the floure
Of cheuelry auerding to his crown,
So pafing war his knyghtis in renoune,
Was at carlill; and hapynnit so that hee
348 Soiornyt well long in that faire cuntree.
In to whilk tyme In to the court thai heire
None awenture, for wich the knyghtis weire
Anoit all at the abiding thare.
352 For-why, beholding one the fobir ayre
And of the tyme the pafing lustynes,

When Titan, being in Aries,
had apparelled the fields,

and birds began to make their
bowers;

king Arthur was at Carlisle.

His knights, hearing of no
adventure, were annoyed.

Can so thir knyghtly hartis to encreß,
That thei þhir kay one to the king haith sende,
356 Befeiching hyme he wold wichfaif to wende
To camelot the Cetee, whare that thei
Ware wont to heryng of armys day be day.
The king forfuth, heryng thare entent,
360 To thare defir, be schort awyflment,
Ygrantid haith; and so the king proponit
And for to pas hyme one [8](#) the morne disponit.

UR'S TWO DREAMS.

Bot so befell hyme [on] that nycht to meit
364 An aperans, the wich one to his spreit
It femyth that of al his hed ye hore
Of fallith and maid defolat; wharfore
The king therof was pensyve in his mynd,
368 That al the day he couth no resting fynde,
Wich makith hyme his Iorneye to delaye.
And so befell apone the thrid day,
The bricht sone, pasing in the west,
372 Haith maid his courß, and al thing goith to Rest;
The king, so as the story can dewyß,
He thocht azeine, apone the samyne wyß,
His vombe out fallith vith his hoil syde
376 Apone the ground, *and* liging hyme befid;
Throw wich anon out of his slep he stert,
Abafit and adred in to his hart.
The wich be morow one to the qwen he told,
380 And she azeine to hyme haith ansuer 3olde;
“To dremys, *sir*, shuld no man have Respek,
For thei ben thingis weyn, of non affek.”
“Well,” quod the king, “god grant It so befall!”
384 Arly he roß, and gert one to hyme call

They therefore sent Sir Kay to
pray the king to go to
Camelot.

The king proposed to do so on
the morrow.

[8](#) MS. “to pas one hyme
one,” with first “one”
lightly crossed out.

That night he dreamt that his
hair all fell off;

which made him delay his
journey.

Again he dreamt, that his
bowels fell out, and lay beside
him.

[Fol. 6.]

He told the queen, who
answered, “No man should
respect vain dreams.”

O clerk, to whome that al his hewynes
Tweching his drem fhewith he expreß,
Wich anfuer yaf and feith one to the kinge;
388 “Shir, no Record lyith to fuch thing;
Wharfor now, fhir, I praye yow tak no kep,
Nore traift in to the vanyteis of slep;
For thei are thingis that askith no credens,
392 But caufith of fum maner influens,
Empriß of thoght, ore superfleuytee,
Or than fum othir cafualytee.”
“3it,” quod the king, “I fal nocht leif It so;”

INDS FOR HIS CLERKS.

396 And furth he chargit mefingeris to go
Throgh al his Realm, *withouten* more demande,
And bad them ftratlly at thei fhulde comande
All the bißhopes, and makyng no delay
400 The fhuld appere be the twenty day
At camelot, with al thar hol clergy
That moft expert war, for to certefye
A mater tueching to his goft be nyght;
404 The meßag goith furth with the *lettres* Right.

The king eft lone, *within* a litill fpace,
His Iornay makith haith frome place to place,
Whill that he cam to camelot; and there
408 The clerkis all, as that the chargit were,
Affemblit war, and came to his prefens,
Of his defir to viting the fentens.
To them that war to hyme moft fpeciall
412 Furth his entent fhauyth he al hall;
By whois confeil, of the worthieft

The king next shewed his
dream to a clerk,

who said, “Sir, such things
testify nothing.”

“Yet,” replied he, “I shall not
leave it so.”

He bade all the bishops and
clergy come to Camelot
within twenty days.

He goes to Camelot, and finds
the clerks assembled.

He chelith ten, yclepit for the best,
 And moft expert and wifelt was fuppoft,
 416 To qwhome his drem all hail he haith difcloffit;
 The houre, the nyght, and al the *cercumftans*;
 Befichyne them that the *signifycans*
 Thei wald hyme fhaw, that he *mycht* refting fynde
 420 Of It, the wich that occupeid his mynde.
 And one of them with 9 al ther holl affent
 Saith, “fhire, fore to declare our entent
 Vpone this matere, ye wil ws delay
 424 Fore to awyfling one to the ix day.”
 The king ther-to grantith haith, bot hee
 In to o place, that ftrong was and hye,
 He clofith them, whare thei may no whare get,
 428 Vn to the day, the wich he to them set.
 Than goith the clerkis fadly to awyß
 Of this mater, to feing in what wyß
 The kingis drem thei fhall beft fpecefy.
 432 And than the maiftris of aftronomy
 The bookis longyne to ther artis set; 10
 Not was the bukis of arachell forget,
 Of nembrot, of danzhelome, thei two,
 436 Of moyfes, *and* of herynes all soo;
 And feking be ther calcolacioune
 To fynd the planetis difpoficioune,
 The wich thei fond ware wonder ewill yfet
 440 The famyne nyght the king his fweuen met.

REFUSE TO EXPLAIN THEM.

So ner the point focht thei have the thing,
 Thei fond It wonder hewy to the king,
 Of wich thing thei waryng in to were
 444 To fhew the king, for dreid of his danger.

He discloses all to the ten that are most expert,

[Fol. 6 b.]

and beseeches them to explain the dreams.

9 MS. “saith with” (with a very slight scratch through “saith”).

One of them asks for nine days to advise upon the matter.

The king complies, but shuts them up in a strong place.

The masters of astronomy fetch their books,

10 So in MS. Read “fet.”

and calculate the disposition of the planets.

They found the matter heavy for the king, and doubted if they should tell him so.

Of ane accorde thei planly haue proponit
No worde to show, and so thei them disponit.
The day is cumyng, and he haith fore them lent,
448 Befichyne them to shewing ther entent.
Than spak they all, and that of an accorde;
“Shir, of this thing we can no thing Recorde,
For we can noght fynd in til our sciens
452 Tweching this mater ony ewydens.”
“Now,” quod the king, “and be the glorius lorde,
Or we depart ye shall sum thing recorde;
So pas yhe not, nor so It fall not bee.”
456 “Than,” quod the clerkis, “grant ws dais three.”
The wich he grantid them, and but delay,
The term passith, no thing wold the say,
Wharof the king stondith heuy cherith,
460 And to the clerkis his visag so apperith,
That all thei dred them of the kingis myght.
Than faith o clerk, “sir, as the thrid nyght
Ye dremyt, so [now] giffis ws delay
464 The thrid tyme, and to the thrid day.”
By whilk tyme thei fundyng haith the ende
Of this mater, als far as shal depend
To ther sciens; yit can thei not awyß
468 To schewing to the king be ony wyß.
The day is cum, the king haith them besocht,
But one no wyß thei wald declar ther thocht;
Than was he wroth in to his self and noyt,
472 And maid his wow that thei shal [11](#) ben distroyt.
His baronis he commandit to gar tak
Fyve of them one to the fir-ftak,
And vther fyue be to the gibbot tone;
476 And the furth *with* the kingis charg ar gone.
He bad them in to secret wyß that thei

Being sent for,

they all spake, “Sir, we can
find no evidence.”

“Ere we part,” quoth the king,
“ye shall witness something.”

[Fol. 7.]

He grants them three days
more.

They pray for a further delay
of three days.

They still refuse to declare
their thought.

The king vows to destroy
them;

[11](#) MS. “that.”

Shud do no harm, but only them aße.
The clarkis, dredful of the kingis Ire,
480 And faw the perell of deth and of the fyre,
Fyve, as thei can, has grantit to record;
That vther herde and ben of ther accorde;

but secretly charges his
knights not to harm them.

INTERPRETATION OF THE DREAMS.

And al thei ben yled one to the king,
484 And shew hyme thus as tueching of this thing.
“Shir, fen that we conftrenyt ar by myght
To shaw that wich [12](#) we knaw no thing aricht;
For thing to cum preferuith It allan
488 To hyme the wich is euery thing certañ,
Excep the thing that til our knowleg hee
Hath ordynat of certan for to bee;
Therfor, fhir king, we your magnificens
492 Befeich It turne till ws to non offens,
Nor hald was noch as learis, thocht It fall
Not in this mater, as that we telen shall.”
And that the king haith grantit them, *and* thei
496 Has chargit one, that one this wiß fall seye.
“Prefumyth, fhir, that we have fundyne so;
All erdly honore ye nedis [13](#) moft for-go,
And them the wich ye moft affy in-tyll
500 Shal failye 3ow, magre of ther will;
And thus we haue in to this matere founde.”
The king, quhois hart was al wyth dred ybownd,
And askit at the clerkis, if thei fynde
504 By there clergy, that ftant in ony kynde
Of possibilibitee, fore to reforme
His defteny, that ftud in such a forme;
If in the hewyne Is preordynat
508 On such o wiß his honor to tranflat.

They yield at last, and say,

[12](#) MS. “wich that.”

“Hold us not as liars, though
it happen not as we say.

[13](#) MS. “nedift;” but see
[1. 518](#).

You must forego all earthly
honour;

[Fol. 7 *b*.]

and those on whom you most
rely, will fail you.”

The king asks if his destiny
can be altered.

The clerkis faith, “forfuth, and we haue fene
O thing whar-of, if we the trouth shal meñ,
Is so obscure and dyrk til our clergie,
512 That we wat not what It shal signefye,
Wich caufith ws we can It not furth say.”
“Yis,” quod the king, “as lykith yow ye may,
For wers than this can nat be laid for me.”

CLERKS GIVE MYSTERIOUS ADVICE.

516 Thane faith o maiftir, “than futhly thus finde
we;

Thar is no thing fal fucour nor refkew,
Your worldly honore nedis moft adew,
But throuch the watrye lyone *and* ek fyne,
520 On throuch the liche *and* ek the wattir fyne,
And throuch the confeill of the flour; god wot
What this shude meñ, for mor ther-of we not.”
No word the king anfuerid ayane,
524 For al this refone thinkith bot in weyne.

He shawith outward his contenans
As he therof takith no greuans;
But al the nyght it passid nat his thocht.
528 The dais courß *with* ful defir he focht,
And furth he goith to bring his mynd *in* rest
With mony O knyght vn to the gret forest;
The rachis gon wn-copelit for the deire,
532 That in the wodis makith nois *and* cheir:
The knyghtis, *with* the grewhundis in aweit,
Secith boith the planis and the streit.
Doune goith the hart, doune goith the hynd also;
536 [In to the feld can rusching to and fro] [14](#)
The swift grewhund, hardy of assay;
Befor ther hedis no thing goith away.

They reply, that the matter is dark.

A master says, there is no help
but in the true watery lion,
and in the leech, and in the
flower.

God knows what this should
mean.

The king shews no outward
grief,

but is not rid of anxiety all
night.

Next day he goes to the forest.

The chase.

[14](#) A line must here be lost,
but there is nothing to shew
this in the MS. The inserted

The king of hunting takith haith his sport,
540 And to his palace home he can Refort,
Ayan the noon; and as that he was set
With all his noble knyghtis at the met,
So cam ther in an agit knyght, *and* hee
544 Of gret efftat femyt for to bee;
Anarmyt all, as tho It was the gyß,
And thus the king he saluft, one this wiß,

OT'S MESSAGE.

“**S**hir king, one to yow am y fende
548 Frome the worthieft that in world is kend,
That leuyth now of his tyme and age,
Of manhed, wisdome, *and* of hie curag,
Galiot, fone of the fare gyande;
552 And thus, at fhort, he bidis yow your londe
Ye yald hyme our, *without* Impedymment;
Or of hyme holde, and if tribut and rent.
This is my charge at fhort, whilk if youe left
556 For to fulfill, of al he haith conquest
He fais that he moft tendir fhal youe hald.”
By fhort awys the king his anfuer yald;
“Shir knyght, your lorde wondir hie pretendis,
560 When he to me fic falutatioune sendis;
For I as yit, in tymys that ar gone,
Held neuer lond excep of god alone,
Nore neuer thinkith til erthly lord to yef
564 Trybut nor rent, als long as I may lef.”
“Well,” *quod* the knyght, “ful for repentith me;
Non may recift the thing the wich mone bee.
To yow, *fir* king, than frome my lord am I
568 With diffyans fent, and be this refone why;

line is imitated from
[l. 3293](#).

The king returns.

[Fol. 8.]

As they sit at meat, an aged
knight enters, fully armed.

The knight's message is that
king Galiot bids Arthur to
yield to him his kingdom.

The king refuses.

The knight replies, that his
lord bids him defiance, and
will invade his land in a
month;

His purpos Is, or this day moneth day,
With all his oft, planly to affay
Your lond, *with* mony manly man of were,
572 And helmyt knyghtis, boith with sheld *and*
 fpere;
And neuer thinkith to retwrn home whill
That he this lond haith conquest at his will;
And ek vanour the quen, of whome that hee
576 Herith report of al this world that shee
In fairhed and in wertew doith excede,
He bad me say he thinkis to possede.”

not to return till he has
conquered;

and he intends to possess
queen Vanour.

UR DEFIES GALIOT.

“Schir,” *quod* the king, “your mefag me behufis
580 Of refone and of curtafy excuß;
But tueching to your lord *and* to his oft,
His powar [and] his mefag and his boft,
That pretendith my lond for to distroy,
584 Thar-of as 3it tak I non anoye;
And say your lord one my behalf, when hee
Haith tone my lond, that al the world shal see
That It shal be magre myne entent.”
588 With that the knyght, *withouten* leif, is went,
And richt as he was pafing to the dure,
He faith, “a gode! 15 what wykyt aduenture
Apperith!” *with* that his hors he nome,
592 Two knichtis kepit, waiting *his* outcome.
The knicht is gon, the king he gan Inquere
At gawan, and at other knyghtis sere,
If that thei knew or euer hard recorde
596 Of galiot, and wharof he wes lorde;
And ther was non among his knyghtis all
Which anfuerd o word in to the hall.

Arthur returns his defiance.

[Fol. 8 b.]

The knight departs, lamenting
Arthur’s adventurous spirit.

15 MS. “agod^e.”

Arthur asks Gawane who
Galiot is.

Than galygantynis of walys rafe,
600 That trauelit in diuerß londis has,
In mony knyghtly auentur haith ben;
And to the king he faith, “*fir*, I haue sen
Galiot, which is the fareft knyght,
604 And hieft be half a fut one hycht,
That euer I saw, and ek his men accordith;
Hyme lakid noch that to a lord recordith.
For vifare of his ag is non than hee,
608 And ful of larges and humylytee;
An hart he haith of pafing hie curag,
And is not xxiiij 3er of age,
And of his tyme mekil haith conquerit;
612 Ten kingis at his *command* ar fterit.
He *vith* his men fo louit is, y geß,
That hym to pleß is al ther befynes.
Not fay I this, *fir*, in to ye entent
616 That he, nor none wnder the firmament,
Shal pouere haue ayane your maieftee;
And or thei fhuld, this y fey for mee,
Rather I fhall knyghtly in to feild
620 Refaue my deith anarmyt wnder fheld.
This spek y left;”—the king, ayan the morn,
Haith varnit huntaris baith with hund *and* horne,
And arly gan one to the forest ryd,
624 With mony manly knyghtis by his fid,
Hyme for to fport and comfort *with* the dere,
Set contrare was the fefone of y^e yere.
His moft huntynge was atte wyld bore;
628 God wot a lufty cuntree was It thoore,
In the ilk tyme! weil long this noble king
In to this lond haith maid his fuiornyng;

Galygantynis of Wales
replies,

that Galiot is the tallest knight
by half a foot of all he ever
saw; that he is wise, liberal,
humble,

courageous, and under xxiv
years of age.

Ten kings obey him.

The king goes again to the
chase.

He likes boar-hunting best.

[Fol. 9.]

ADY OF MELYHALT'S MESSAGE.

Frome the lady was send o mefinger
632 Of melyhalt, wich faith one this maner,
As that the story fhewith by recorde:

A messenger comes from the
lady of Melyhalt,

“T O yow, *sir* king, as to hir foueran lorde,

My lady hath me chargit for to fay
636 How that your lond stondith *in* affray;
For galiot, lone of the fare gyande,
Enterit Is by armys in your land,
And so the lond and cuntre he anoyth,
640 That quhar he goith planly he distroyth,
And makith al obeifand to his honde,
That nocht is left wnconquest *in* that lond,
Excep two castellis longing to hir cwre,
644 Wich to defend she may nocht long endure.

to say that Galiot has entered
Arthur's land,

and has conquered all but two
castles belonging to his
mistress.

Wharfor, *sir*, in wordis plan *and* short,
Ye mon dispone your folk for to support.”

“Wel,” *quod* the king, “one to thi lady fay
648 The neid is myne, I fall It not delay;
But what folk ar thei nemmyt for to bee,
That in my lond is cumyne in fich degree?”

The king promises not to
delay, and inquires the
number of the foe.

“An hundreth thouland boith with sheld *and* spere
652 On hors ar armyt, al redy for the were.”

“A hundred thousand,” is the
reply.

UR'S READINESS FOR WAR.

“Wel,” *quod* the king, “and but delay this nycht,
Or than to morn as that the day is lycht,
I shal remuf; ther shal no thing me mak
656 Impedymnt, my Iorney for to tak.”
Than feith his knychtis al *with* one assent,
“Shir, that is al contrare our entent;

The king says he will set off
that very night.

For to your folk this mater is wnwift,
 660 And ye ar here our few for to recift
 3one power, and youre cuntre to defende;
 Tharfor abid, and for your folk ye send,
 That lyk a king and lyk a weriour
 664 Ye may fulten in armys your honoure.”
 “Now,” *quod* the king, “no langer that I 3eme
 My crowne, my lepture, nor my dyademe,
 Frome that I here, ore frome I wnderstand,
 668 That ther by fors be entrit in my land
 Men of armys, by strenth of vyolens,
 If that I mak abid or refydens
 In to o place langar than o nycht,
 672 For to defend my cuntre *and* my rycht.”
 The king that day his melage haith furth sent
 Throuch al his realme, and fyne to rest is went.

His knights advise him to wait
till he has raised an army.

He refuses to wait longer than
till the morrow.

[Fol. 9 b.]

Up goith the morow, wp goith the brycht day,
 676 Wp goith the sone in to his fresh aray;
 Richt as he spred his bemys frome northeft,
 The king wpraß *withouten* more areft,
 And by his awn conseil and entent
 680 His Iornaye tuk at shorth awyfmment.
 And but dulay he goith frome place to place
 Whill that he cam nere whare [16](#) the lady was,
 And in one plane, apone o reuer fyde,
 684 He lichtit doune, and ther he can abide;
 And yit *with* hyme to batell fore to go
 Vij thousand fechteris war thei, *and* no mo.

The king arises next morning
without delay,

[16](#) MS. “whare that,” with
slight scratch through
“that.”

and reaches a plain by the
river side,

having only seven thousand
with him.

This was the lady, of qwhome befor I tolde,
688 That lancilot haith in to hir kepinge holde;
But for to tell his pasing hewynesse,
His peyne, his forow, and his gret distresse
Of prefone and of loues gret suppris,
692 It war to long to me for to dewys.
When he remembrith one his hewy charge
Of loue, wharof he can hyme not discharge,
He wepith and he sorowith in his chere,
696 And euery nyght femyth hyme o yere.
Gret peite was the sorow that he maad,
And to hyme-felf apone this wiß he saade:

Lancelot, having been
imprisoned by the lady of
Melyhalt,

laments his fate.

“Q what haue y gilt, allace! or qwhat deferuit?
700 That thus myne hart shal vondit ben *and* carwit
One by the fuord of double peine and wo?
My comfort and my plefans is ago,
To me is nat that shuld me glaid referuit.

Lancelot's lament;

his pleasure is gone;

704 I curß the tyme of myne Natiuitee,
Whar in the heuen It ordinyd was for me,
In all my lyue neuer til haue eeß;
But for to be example of difeß,
708 And that apperith that euery vicht may see.

he curses his natal day;

Sen thelke tyme that I had sufficians
Of age, and chargit thoghtis sufferans,
Nor neuer I *continewite* haith o day
712 With-out the payne of thoghtis hard assay;
Thus goith my youth in tempest *and* penans.

he has never spent a single
day free from anxiety,

And now my body is In prefone broght;

and is now in prison;

But of my wo, that in Regard is noght,
716 The wich myne hart felith euer more.
O deth, allace! whi hath yow me forbore
That of remed haith the so long befoght!”

[Fol. 10.]

and invokes Death.

Thus neueremore he fefith to compleine,
720 This woful knyght that felith not bot peine;
So prekith hyme the smert of loues fore,
And euery day encreffith more and more.
And with this lady takine is also,
724 And kepit whar he may no whare go
To haunt knyghted, the wich he most defirit;
And, thus his hart *with* dowbil wo yfirate,
We lat hyme duel here with the lady still,
728 Whar he haith laifere for to compleine his fyll.

Thus the smart of love’s
sorrow pricketh him.

He is kept by her from the
exercise of knighthood;

and there we let him dwell.

OT BESIEGES A CASTLE.

And galiot in this meyne tyme he laie
By strong myght o castell to assay,
With many engyne and diuerß wais fere,
732 For of fute folk he had a gret powere
That bowis bur, and vther Instrumentis,
And with them lede ther palzonis *and* ther tentis,
With mony o strong chariot and cher
736 With yrne qwhelis and barris long *and* sqwar;
Well stuffit with al maner apparell
That longith to o lege or to batell;
Whar-with his oft was clofit al about,
740 That of no strenth nedith hyme to dout.
And when he hard the cumyne of the king,
And of his oft, and of his gaderyng,
The wich he reput but of febil myght

Meanwhile, Galiot besieged a
castle.

His army had pavilions, tents,
and iron-wheeled chariots.

When he heard of Arthur’s
coming,

744 Ayanis hyme for to fulten the ficht,
His confell holl affemblit he, but were,
Ten knightis with other lordis fere,
And told theme of the cuming of the king,
748 And askit them there confell of that thing.
Hyme thocht that it his worfchip wold degrade,
If he hyme felf in *propir perfone* raide
Enarmyt ayane fo few menye
752 As It was told arthur[is] fore to bee;

ORATION FOR THE BATTLE.

And thane the kyng-An-hundereth-knychtis cold,
(And fo he hot, for neuermore he wolde
Ryd of his lond, but In his cumpany
756 O hundyre knyghtis ful of chiuellry).
He faith, “shir, ande I one hond [may] tak,
If It you pleß, this Iorney þhal I mak.”
Quod galiot, “I grant It yow, but ye
760 Shal firft go ryd, yone knychtis oft *and* see.”
With-uten more he ridith our the plan,
And faw the oft and is returnyd ayañ;
And callit them mo than he hade fen, for why
764 He dred the reprefe of his cumpany.
And to his lord apone this wys faith hee,
“Shir, ten thoufand y ges them for to bee.”
And galiot haith chargit hyme to tak
768 Als fell folk, and for the feld hyme mak.
And fo he doith and haith them wel Arayt;
Apone the morne his banaris war difplayt.

Up goth the trumpetis with the clariounis,
772 Ayaine the feld blawen furth ther fownis,

he assembled his council,

who thought it would degrade
him, to fight in proper person
against so few.

[Fol. 10 b.]

The king of a hundred knights
(Maleginis) undertakes the
exploit;

who reconnoitres Arthur's
host, and says it is 10,000
strong: whereon Galiot
charges him to take the same
number.

Furth goth this king *with* al his oft anon.
Be this the word wes to king arthur gone,
That knew no thing, nor wift of ther entent,
776 But fone his folk ar one to armys went;
But arthur by Report hard saye
How galiot non armys bur that day,
Wharfor he thoght of armys nor of sheld
780 None wald he tak, nor mak hyme for the feld.
But gawane haith he clepit, was hyme by,
In qwhome Rignith the flour of cheuelry;
And told one what maner, and one what wyß
784 He shuld his batelles ordand and dewys;
Befeching hyme, [hyme] willy to for-see
Azaine thei folk, wich was far mo than hee.
He knew the charg and passith one his way
788 Furth to his horß, and makith no dulay;
The clariounis blew and furth goth al onõñ,
And our ye watter and the furd ar goñe.
Within o playne vpone that other fyð
792 Ther gawan gon his batellis to dewide,
As he wel couth, and set them *in* aray,
Syne with o manly contynans can lay,

ANE HARANGUES HIS MEN.

“Ye falowis wich of the round table beñ,
796 Through al this erth whois fam is hard *and* fen,
Remembrith now It stondith one the poynt,
For why It lyith one your speris poynt, [17](#)
The well-fare of the king and of our londe;
800 And fen the fucour lyith in your honde,
And hardement is thing shall moft awaill
Frome deth ther men of armys in bataill,
Lat now your manhed and your hie curage

Galiot's host set out.

Arthur's host don their
armour.

Arthur, hearing that Galiot is
unarmed, will not arm
himself;

but calls Gawane, and tells
him how to order his
battalions.

Gawane and his men cross
over the water at the ford.

He harangues his men.

[17](#) At the bottom of this
page appears for the first
time a catchword, which is
— “The wel fare.”

[Fol. 11.]

804 The pryd of al thir multitude affuage;
 Deth or defence, non other thing we wot.”
 This fresch king, that maleginis was hot,
 With al his oft he cummyne our the plañ,
 808 And gawan fend o batell hyme agañ;
 In myde the borde, [18](#) and festinit in the stell
 The sperithis poynt, that bitith scharp *and* well;
 Bot al to few thei war, and mycht nocht left
 812 This gret Rout that cummyth one so fast.
 Than haith *sir* gawan fend, them to support,
 One othir batell with one knyghtly sorte;
 And fyne the thrid, and fyne the ferde also;
 816 And fyne hyme-felf one to the feld can go,
 When that he fauch thar latter batell steir,
 And the ten thoufand cummyne al thei veir;
 Qwhar that of armes prewit he so well,
 820 His ennemys gane his mortall [strokis] fell.
 He goith ymong them in his hie curage,
 As he that had of knyghthed the wlage,
 And couth hyme weill *conten in* to on hour;
 824 Azaine his strok refistit non armour;
 And mony knyght, that worth ware and bolde,
 War thore with hyme of arthuris houshold,
 And knyghtly gan one to the feld them bere,
 828 And mekil wrought of armys In to were;

\ANE DEFEATS MALEGINIS.

Sir gawan than vpone such wyß hyme bure,
 This othere goith al to discumfitoure;
 Sewyne thoufand fled, *and* of the feld thei go,
 832 Whar-of this king in to his hart was wo,
 For of hyme felf he was of hie curage.
 To galiot than fend he in mefag,

Maleginis and all his host
 come over the plain, and
 Gawane sends a company
 against them.

[18](#) Or “berde.”

But they were all too few;
 wherefore Gawane sends a
 second company;

then a third; then a fourth; and
 then sets out himself, to resist
 the 10,000.

He goes among them in his
 courage,

and many other of Arthur’s
 knights perform wonders.

Maleginis goeth to
 discomfiture, and 7,000 of his
 men flee.

That he shuld help his folk for to defende;
 836 And he to hyme hath xxx^{te} thousand sende;
 Whar-of this king gladith in his hart,
 And thinkith to Reweng all the smart
 That he to-for haith suffirit and the payne.
 840 And al his folk returnyt Is ayayne
 Atour the feld, and cummyne thilk as haill; [19](#)
 The fwyft horß goith first to the affall.
 This noble knyght that feith the grete forß
 844 Of armyt men, that cummyne vpone horß,
 To-giddir semblit al his falowship,
 And thought them at the sharp poynt to kep,
 So that thar harm shal be ful deir ybought.
 848 This vthere folk with straucht courß hath focht
 Out of aray atour the larg felld;
 Thar was the strokis festnit in the shelde,
 Thei war Refaut at the speris end.
 852 So arthuris folk can manfully defend;
 The formeft can thar lyues end conclude,
 Whar lone assemblit al the multitude.
 Thar was defens, ther was gret affaill,
 856 Richt wonderfull and strong was y^e bataill,
 Whar arthuris folk sustenit mekil payn,
 And knyghtly them defendit haith azaine.
 Bot endur thei myght, apone no wyß,
 860 The multitude and ek the gret suppriß;

Galiot sends him 30,000 more.

[Fol. 11 b.]

His folk return across the field as thick as hail.

[19](#) MS. "thilk as (Rayne) haill," as if it were at first intended to find a rime to "ayayne."

Arthur's folk receive them manfully.

but sustain much pain,

and cannot endure against so many.

ANE'S VALIANT DEEDS.

But gawan, wich that setith al his payn
 Vpone knyghthed, defendid so azaine,
 That only in the manhede of this knyght
 864 His folk reIofit them of his gret myght,
 And ek abafit hath his ennemys;

For throw the feld he goith in fuch wyß,
 And in the preß so manfully them feruith,
 868 His fuerd atwo the helmys al to-kerwith,
 The hedis of he be the fhouderis fmat;
 The horß goith, of the maifter defolat.
 But what awaaleth al his befynes,
 872 So ftrong and fo infufferable vas the preß?
 His folk are paffit atour the furdis ilkon,
 Towart ther bretis and to ther luges gon;
 Whar he and many worthy knyght alfo
 876 Of arthuris houß endurit mekill wo,
 That neuer men mar in to armys vroght
 Of manhed, 3it was It al for noght.
 Thar was the ftrength, ther was the pafing myght
 880 Of gawan, wich that whill the dirk nyght
 Befor the luges faucht al hyme aloñ,
 When that his falowis entrit ware ilkoñ,
 On arthuris half war mony tan and flan;
 884 And galotis folk Is hame returnyd azaine,
 For it was lait; away the oftis ridith,
 And gawan 3it apone his horß abidith,
 With fuerd in hond, when thei away var gon,
 888 And so for-wrocht hys lymmys ver ilkon,
 And wondit ek his body vp and doune,
 Vpone his horß Right thore he fel in fwoune;
 And thei hyme tuk *and* to his luyne bare,
 892 Boith king and qwen of hyme vare *in* difpare;
 For thei fuppoftit, throw marwellis that he vroght,
 He had hyme-felf to his confufioun broght.

[T]his [20](#) was nere by of melyhalt, the hyll,
 896 Whar lanfcelot 3it was *with* the lady ftill.
 The knyghtis of the court [can] pafing homē;
 This ladiis knyghtis to hir palice com,

Gawane carves helmets in two, and smites heads off shoulders;

but his men recross the ford to go to their lodges.

[Fol. 12.]

Gawane fights alone till night,

when Galiot's folk return home.

Gawane swoons upon his horse.

The king and queen fear he has brought himself to confusion.

[20](#) See note to this line.

And told to hir, how that the feld was vent,
 900 And of gawan, and of his hardymment,
 That merwell was his manhed to behold;
 And fone thir tithingis to the knyght was told,
 That was with wo and hewyness opprest;
 904 So noyith hyme his fuiorne and his reft,
 And but dulay one for o knyght he send,
 That was moft speciall with the lady kend.
 He comyne, and the knyght vn to hyme faid,
 908 “Displeß yow not, *fir*, be 3he not ill paid,
 So homly thus I yow exort to go,
 To gare my lady spek o word or two
 With me, that am a carful *presonere*.” ²¹
 912 “*Sir*, your commande y shall, withouten were,
 Fulfill;” and to his lady passit hee
 In lawly wyß befiching hir, that she
 Wald grant hyme to pas at his request,
 916 Vnto hir knyght, stood wnder hir areft;
 And she, that knew al gentilleß aright,
 Furth to his chamber passit wight ²² the licht.

ELOT PRAYS TO BE RELEASED.

And he aroß and saluft Curtasly
 920 The lady, and faid, “madem, her I,
 Your presoner, besekith yow that 3he
 Wold merfy and compaffione have of me,
 And mak the ranfome wiche that I may yeif;
 924 I waitt my tyme in presoun thus to leife.
 For why I her on be report be told,
 That arthur, with the flour of his housholde,
 Is cummyne here, and in this cuntre lyis,
 928 And ftant In danger of his ennemyis,

The lady of Melyhalt hears of
Gawane’s deeds;

and Lancelot also,

who sends for a knight to take
a message to the lady;

²¹ MS. “presonerere.”

²² Read “with” (?).

who comes to his chamber.

[Fol. 12 b.]

Lancelot beseeches her to
appoint his ransom,

And haith affemblit; and eft this fhalt bee
Within fhort tyme one new affemlee.
Thar-for, my lady, y youe *grace* befech,
932 That I mycht pas, my Ranlon for to fech;
Fore I prefume thar longith to that fort
That loud me, and fhall my nede fupport.”

presuming that some of
Arthur’s knights will pay it.

LADY AT FIRST REFUSES;

“**S** hire knyght, It ftant nocht in fuch dugree;
936 It is no ranfome wiche that caufith me
To holden yow, or don yow fuch offens;
It is your gilt, It is your wiolens,
Whar-of that I defir no thing but law,
940 Without report your awn trefpas to knaw.”
“Madem, your plesance may ye wel fulfill
Of me, that am in prefone at your will.
Bot of that gilt, I was for til excuß,
944 For that I did of werrey nede behwß,
It tuechit to my honore and my fame;
I mycht nocht lefe It but hurting of my nam,
And ek the knyght was mor to blam than I.
948 But ye, my lady, of your curteßfy,
Wold 3e deden my Ransoune to refaue,
Of prefone fo I my libertee myght haue,
Y ware 3olde euermore [to be] your knyght,
952 Whill that I leif, *with* al my holl myght.
And if fo be ye lykith not to ma
My ranfome, [madem,] if me leif to ga
To the affemlee, wiche fal be of new;
956 And as that I am feithful knyght *and* trew,
At nyght to yow I enter fhall azaine,
But if that deth or other lat certañ,

She replies that she does not
want a ransom, but has
imprisoned him for his guilt.

He prays for pardon,

and begs for liberty:

or at least to be allowed to go
to the next battle,

under a promise to return at
night.

Throw wich I [may] have fuch Impediment,
960 That I be hold, [23](#) magre myne entent.”

[23](#) MS. “behold.”

[Fol. 13.]

AT LAST GRANTS HIS BOON.

“*Sir knyght*,” *quod* she, “I grant yow leif, *withthy*
Your name to me that 3e wil fpecify.”

She consents, if he will
specify to her his name.

“Madem, as 3it, futly I ne may

964 Duclar my name, one be no maner way;

But I promyt, als fast as I haue tyme

He refuses for the present.

Conuenient, or may vith-outen cryme,

I fhall;” and than the lady faith hyme tyll,

968 “And I, fchir knyght, one this condiscione will

Grant yow leve, fo that ye oblift bee

For to Return, as ye haue faid to me.”

She grants him leave, under
the proposed condition.

Thus thei accord, the lady goith to reft,

972 The fone difcending clofit in the veft;

The ferd day was dewyfit for to bee

Betuex the oftis of the affemblee.

And galiot Richt arly by the day,

976 Ayane the feld he can his folk aray;

And fourty thoufand armyt men haith he,

That war not at the othir affemle,

Commandit to the batell for to gon;

980 “And I my-felf,” *quod* he, “fhall me difpone

On to the feild azaine the thrid day;

Whar of this were we fhall the end affay.”

Galiot assembles 40,000 fresh
men.

ANd arthuris folk that come one euery fyd,

984 He for the feld can them for to prouide,

Wich ware to few azaine the gret affere

Of galiot 3it to fulten the were.

Arthur also provides his men
for the field.

The knyghtis al out of the cete roß
 988 Of melyholt, and to the semble gois.
 And the lady haith, in to sacret wyß,
 Gart for hir knyght and prefoner dewyß
 In red al thing, that ganith for the were;
 992 His curfeir red, so was boith scheld *and* spere.
And he, to qwham the prefone hath ben smart,
 With glaid defir apone his curfoure start;
 Towart the feld anon he gan to ryd,
 996 And in o plan houit one reuer syde.

ELOT ENCOURAGES HIMSELF.

This knyght, the wiche that long haith ben in cag,
 He grew in to o fresch *and* new curage,
 Seing the morow blythfull and amen,
 1000 The med, the Reuer, and the vodus gren,
 The knyghtis in [ther] armys them arayinge,
 The baneris ayaine the feld displayng,
 His youth in strenth and in prosperytee,
 1004 And fyne of lust the gret aduerfyttee. [24](#)
 Thus in his thocht remembryng at the last,
 Efterward one fynd he gan his Ey to cast,
 Whar our a bertes [25](#) lying haith he sen
 1008 Out to the feld loking was the qwen;
 Sudandly with that his goft astart
 Of loue anone haith caught hym by the hart;
 Than faith he, "How long shall It be so,
 1012 Loue, at yow shall wike me al this wo?
 Apone this wyß to be Infortunat,
 Hir for to serue the wiche thei no thing wate
 What sufferance I in hir wo endure,
 1016 Nor of my wo, nor of myne aduenture?
 And I unworthy am for to attane

The knights of Melyhalt join him.

The lady secretly provides Lancelot with a red courser, and a shield and spear, both red also.

He rides towards the field, and halts in a plain by the river-side.

Lancelot is encouraged, seeing the blithe morn, the mead, the river, the green woods, and the knights and banners.

[Fol. 13 b.]

[24](#) May we read "diuerfyttee"?

Casting his eyes aside, he sees the queen looking over a parapet.

[25](#) MS. "abertes."

Love catches him by the heart.

To hir presens, nor dare I noght complane.
Bot, hart, fen at yow knawith fhe is here,
1020 That of thi lyue and of thi deith is ftere,
Now is thi tyme, now help thi-felf at neid,
And the dewod of euery point of dred,
That cowardy be none In to the señ,
1024 Fore and yow do, yow knowis thi peyne, I weyn;
Yow art wnable euer to attane
To hir mercy, or cum be ony mayne.
Tharfor y red hir thonk at yow differue,
1028 Or in hir presens lyk o knyght to fterf.”

He counsels his heart to help
itself at need,

to forego cowardice,

and to deserve her thanks or
die.

RED KNIGHT'S TRANCE.

With that confulit *with* an hewy thoct,
Wich ner his deith ful oft tyme haith hyme focht,
Deuoydit was his spritis and his goft,
1032 He wift not of hyme-felf nor of his oft;
Bot one his horß, als ftil as ony fton.
When that the knyghtis armyt war ilkon,
To warnnyng them vp goith the bludy fown,
1036 And euery knyght vpon his horß is bown;
Twenty thoufand armyt men of were.
The king that day he wold non armys bere;
His batellis ware devyfit euerilkon,
1040 And them forbad out our the furdys to gon.
Bot frome that thei ther ennemys haith sen,
In to fuch wys thei couth them noght fufteñ;
Bot ovr thei went vithouten more delay,
1044 And can them one that oyer sid affay.
The red knyght ftil in to his hewy thoght
Was hufyng 3it apone the furd, *and* noght
Wift of hime felf; with that a harrold com,
1048 And fone the knyght he be the brydill nom,

Confused with a heavy
thought,

he [sits] on his horse as still as
stone.

The bugles are blown, and the
knights are ready on
horseback, 20,000 in number.

They are forbidden to cross
the fords, but cannot be
restrained.

[Fol. 14.]

The red knight still halting by
the ford, a herald seizes his
bridle, and bids him awake.

Saying, “awalk! It is no tyme to flep;
Your worfchip more expedient vare to kep.”
No word he fpak, fo prikith hyme the fmart
1052 Of hevynes, that ftood vnto his hart.
Two fcrewis cam with that, of quhich [that] oñ
The knyghtis fheld ryght frome his hals haith toñ;
That vthir watter takith atte laft,
1056 And in the knyghtis wentail haith It caft;
When that he felt the vatter that vas cold,
He wonk, and gan about hyme to behold,
And thinkith how he fum-quhat haith myfgoñ.
1060 With that his fpere In to his hand haith ton,

RED KNIGHT FIGHTS LIKE A LION.

Goith to the feild *withouten* vordis more;
So was he vare whare that there cam before,
O manly man he was in to al thing,
1064 And clepit was the ferft-conquest king.
The Red knyght *with* [the] fpuris fmat the fted,
The tother cam, that of hyme hath no drede;
With ferß curag ben the knyghtis met,
1068 The king his fpere apone the knyght hath set,
That al in peciß flaw in to the felde;
His hawbrek helpit, fuppos he had no fcheld.
And he the king in to the fcheld haith ton,
1072 That horß and man boith to the erd ar gon.
Than to the knyght he cummyth, that haith tan
His fheld, to hyme deliuerith It ayane,
Befiching hyme that of his Ignorance,
1076 That knew hyme nat, as takith no grewance.
The knyght his fche[l]d but mor delay haith tak,
And let hyme go, and no thing to hyme fpak.
Than thei the [26](#) wich that fo at erth haith fen

Two shrews next approach;
one takes his shield off his
neck,

the other casts water at his
ventayle, which causes him to
wink, and arouse himself.

He goes to the field, and sees
the first-conquest king.

They meet.

The red knight, though
shieldless, overthrows his foe.

The shrew restores his shield.

1080 Ther lord, the ferst-conquest king, y meñ,
In haift thei cam, as that thei var agrevit,
And manfully thei haith ther king Releuit.

[A]nd Arthuris folk, that lykith not to byde,
1084 In goith the spuris in the ftedis syde;
To-giddir thar assemblit al the oft:
At whois meting many o knyght was loft.
The batell was richt crewell to behold,
1088 Of knyghtis wich that haith there lyvis zolde.
One to the hart the spere goith throw the scheld,
The knyghtis gaping lyith in the feld.
The red knyght, byrnyng in loues fyre,
1092 Goith to o knyght, als swift as ony vyre,
The wich he perfit throuch *and* throuch the hart;
The spere is went; *with* that anon he start,
And out o fuerd in to his hond he tais;
1096 Lyk to o lyone in to the feld he gais,
In to his Rag smyting to and fro
Fro sum the arm, fro sum the nek in two,
Sum in the feild lying is in fwoun,
1100 And sum his fuerd goith to the belt al douñe.
For qwhen that he beholdith to the qwen,
Who had ben thore his manhed to haue sen,
His doing in to armys and his myght,
1104 Shwld lay in world war not fuch o wight.
His faloufchip sicke comfort of his dede
Haith ton, that thei ther ennemys ne dreid;
But can them-self ay manfoly conten
1108 In to the ftour, that hard was to fulten;
For galyot was O pasing multitude
Of prewit men in armys that war gude,
The wich can *with* o fresch curag affaill
1112 Ther ennemys that day In to batell;

[26](#) MS. "thei," altered to
"thee," which is still wrong.

The men of the first-conquest
king come to the rescue.

[Fol. 14 b.]

The battle was right cruel to
behold.

The red knight loses his spear,
but draws his sword, and
roams the field like a lion.

Some he cleaves to the belt.

His fellows take comfort from
his deeds,

though Galiot's host was a
surpassing multitude.

That ne ware not the vorſchip *and* manhede
Of the red knyght, in perell and in dreid
Arthuris folk had ben, vith-outen vere;
1116 Set thei var good, thei var of ſmal powere.

ANE BEHOLDS THE RED KNIGHT.

And gawan, wich gart bryng hyme-ſelf befor
To the bertes, ſet he was vondit ſore,
Whar the qwen vas, and whar that he mycht ſee
1120 The manere of the oft and aſſemble;
And when that he the gret manhed haith ſen
Of the red knyght, he faith one to the qwen,
“Madem, 3one knyght in to the armys Rede,
1124 Nor neuer I hard nore ſaw in to no ſted
O knyght, the wich that in to ſchortar ſpace
In armys haith mor forton nore mor grace;
Nore bettir doith boith with ſper and ſcheild,
1128 He is the hed and comfort of our feild.”
“Now, ſir, I traift that neuer more vas ſen
No man in feild more knyghtly hyme *conten*;
I pray to hyme that euery thing hath cure,
1132 Saif hyme fro deth or wykit aduenture.”
The feild It was ryght perellus and ſtrong
On boith the fydis, and continewit long,
Ay from the ſone the varldis face gan licht
1136 Whill he was gone *and* cumyne vas the nyght;
And than o forß thei mycht It not aſſtart,
On euery fyd behouit them depart.
The feild is don and ham goith euery knyght,
1140 And prevaly, unwiſt of any wicht,
The way the red knyght to the cete taiis,
As he had hecht, *and* in his chambre gais.
When arthure hard how the knyght Is gon,

Had it not been for the
manhood of the red knight,
Arthur’s folk had been in
peril.

Gawane is led to the parapet,

and ſaith to the queen, that
none ever did better than yon
red knight.

[Fol. 15.]

The queen prays for Lancelot.

The field was perilous on both
sides,

from early morn till the sun
had gone down.

Every knight then returns
home, and the red knight
privily goes back to the city.

1144 He blamyt fore his lordis euerilk-one;
And oft he haith remembrit in his thoght,
What multitud that galiot had broght;
Seing his folk that ware so ewil arayt,
1148 In to his mynd he stondith al affrayt,
And faith, "I traift ful futh It fal be founde
My drem Richt as the clerkis gan expounde;
For why my men fail3eis now at neid,
1152 My-felf, my londe, in perell and in dreide."

Arthur, seeing the multitude
of Galiot's men, recalls his
dream, saying,

"My men now fail me at
need."

OT PROPOSES A TRUCE.

And galiot vpone hie worfchip set,
And his confell anon he gart be fet,
To them he faith, "with arthur weil 3e see
1156 How that It ftant, and to qwhat degre,
A3anis ws that he is no poware;
Wharfor, me think, no worfchip to ws ware
In conqueryng of hyme, nor of his londe,
1160 He haith no strenth, he may ws not vithftonde.
Wharfor, me think It beft is to delay,
And relput hyme for a tuelmoñeth day,
Whill that he may affemble al his myght;
1164 Than is mor worfchip a3anis hyme to ficht;"
And thus concludit thoght hyme for the beft.
The very knyghtis paffing to there Reft;
Of melyholt the ladeis knyghtis ilkone
1168 Went home, and to hir presens ar thei gon;
At qwhome ful fone than gan fcho to Inquere,
And al the maner of the oftis till spere;
How that It went, and in what maner wyß,
1172 Who haith moft worfchip, *and* who is moft to pryß?
"Madem," *quod* thei, "O knyght was In the feild,
Of Red was al his armour and his fheld,

Galiot tells his council

that there is no honour in
conquering Arthur,

and proposes a twelvemonth's
truce.

The lady of Melyholt asks her
knights who hath won most
honour.

[Fol. 15 b.]

Whois manhed can al otheris to exced,
1176 May nan report in armys half his deid;
Ne wor his worfchip, fhortly to conclud,
Our folk of help had ben al deftitud.
He haith the thonk, the vorfchip in hyme lyis,
1180 That we the feld defendit in fich wyß.”
The lady thane one to hir-felf haith thocht,
“Whether Is 3one my prefonar, ore noght?
The futhfaftneß that fhäl y wit onon.”

They reply, that a red knight
had exceeded all others.

The lady wonders if her
prisoner is meant.

LADY VISITS LANCELOT.

1184 When euery wight vn to ther Reft war gon,
She clepith one hir cwfynes ful nere
Wich was to hir moft fpeciall and dere,
And faith to hir, “qwheyar if yone bee
1188 Our prefonar, my consell Is we see.”
With that the maden In hir hand hath ton
O torche, and to the ftabille ar thei gon;
And fond his fted lying at the ground,
1192 Wich wery was, ywet *with* mony wounde.
The maden faith, “vpone this horß is fen,
He in the place quhar strokis was hath beñ;
And 3hit the horß It is *nocht* wich that hee
1196 Furth *with* hyme hade;”—the lady laid, “*per* dee,
He vfyt haith mo horß than one or two;
I red one to his armys at we go.”
Tharwith one to his armys ar thei went;
1200 Thei fond his helm, thei fond his hawbrek rent,
Thei fond his fcheld was frufchit al to *nocht*;
At fchort, his armour In fich wyß vas vrocht
In euery place, that no thing was left haill,
1204 Nore neuer eft accordith to bataill.
Than faith the lady to hir cufyneß,

She calls her cousin,

who takes a torch, and they go
to the stable,

and find his steed wounded.

Next they view his armour,

and find his hauberk rent, and
his shield frushed all to
naught.

“What fal we fay, what of this mater geß?”
 “Madem, I fay, thei have *nocht* ben abwsyt;
 1208 He that them bur *schortly* he has them *vfyt*.”
 “That may 3e fay, suppos the best that lewis,
 Or most of worfchip in til armys prewis,
 Or 3hit haith ben in ony tyme beforñ,
 1212 Had them in feld in his maft curag bornñ.”
 “Now,” *quod* the lady, “will we paß, and see
 The *knycht* hyme-self, and ther the *futh* may we
 Knaw of this thing.” Incontynent them [27](#) both
 1216 Thir ladeis vn to his chambre goith.
 The *knycht* al wery fallyng was on flep;
 This maden paffith In, *and* takith kep.
 Sche fauch his breft *with* al his *schowderis* bare,
 1220 That bludy war and woundit her and thare;
 His face was al to-hurt and al to-*schent*,
 His newis fwellyng war and al to-Rent.
 Sche *fmylyt* a lyt, and to hir lady *saïd*,
 1224 “It *femyth* weill this *knycht* hath ben affaid.”

LADY IS LOVE-SMITTEN.

The lady fauch, and rewit in hir thoght
 The *knychtis* worfchip wiche that he haith vroght.
 In hire Remembrance loues fyre dart
 1228 *With* hot defyre hir *smat* one to the hart;
 And then a quhill, *with-outen* wordis mo,
 In to hir mynd thinking to and fro,
 She studeit so, and at the laft abraid
 1232 Out of hir *thocht*, and sudandly thus *saïd*,
 “*With-draw*,” *quod* she, “one fynd a lyt [28](#) the lyght,
 Or that I paß that I may kyß the knyght.”

COUSIN REPROVES HER.

They think he has well used his armour.

They next visit the knight himself,

[27](#) “then” (?).

[Fol. 16.]

who was now asleep.

The lady’s cousin observes his breast and shoulders bloody, his face hurt, and his fists swollen.

The lady next observes him,

and is smitten to the heart by the dart of love,

and prays her cousin to draw aside, while she kisses the knight.

[28](#) MS. “alyt.”

“Madem,” *quod* fche, “what is It at 3e meñ?
1236 Of hie worfchip our mekill have 3e señ
So sone to be fupprifit *with* o thoght.

What is It at 3he think? *prefwm* 3e noght
That if yon knyght wil walkin, and *perfaif*,
1240 He fhall yarof no thing bot ewill confaif;
In his entent Ruput yow therby
The ablare to al lychtneß and foly?

And blam the more al vtheris in his mynd,
1244 If your gret wit in flich defire he fynde?”

“Nay,” *quod* the lady, “no thing may I do
For flich o knyght may be defam me to.”

“Madem, I wot that for to loue yone knyght,
1248 Confidir his fame, his worfchip, and his mycht;

And to begyne as worfchip wil dewyß,
Syne he ayaine mycht lowe yow one fuch wyß,
And hold yow for his lady and his loue,
1252 It war to yow no maner of Reprwe.

But quhat if he appetit be and thret
His hart to lowe, and ellis whar y-fet?
And wel y wot, madem, if It be so,

1256 His hart hyme fal not fuffir to loue two,
For noble hart wil have no dowbilneß;

If It be fo, 3he tyne yowr low, I geß;
Than is your-felf, than is your loue Refufit,
1260 Your fam is hurt, your gladneß is conclufit.

My confell is, therefore, you to abften
Whill that to yow the werray Rycht be feñ
Of his entent, the wich ful fon 3he may
1264 Have knowlag, If yow lykith to affay.”

So mokil to hir lady haith fhe vroght
That at that tyme fhe haith Returnyt *hir thocht*,
And to hir chambre went, *withouten* more,

Her cousin reproves her,

lest the knight should awake.

The lady replies.

Her cousin next argues the
point;

“What if he loves another?”

[Fol. 16 b.]

She persuades the lady to
return to her chamber, without
further delay.

1268 Whar loue of new affaith hir ful sore.
So well long thei speking of the knyght,
Hir cufynace hath don al at the mycht
For to expel that thing out of hir thocht;
1272 It wil not be, hir labour Is for nocht.
Now leif we hir In to hir neweft pan,
And to arthur we wil retwrn agañ.

Her cousin labours to expel
her love for Lancelot from her
thoughts, but her labour is in
vain.

EXPLICIT PRIMUS LIBER, INCIPIT SECUNDUS.

UR'S GREAT ANXIETY.

[BOOK II.]

The cloudy nyght, wndir whois obfcure
1276 The reft and quiet of euery criatur
Lyith lauf, quhare the goft *with* befyned
Is occupiit, *with* thoughtfull hewynes;
And, for that thocht furth fchewing vil his mycht,
1280 Go fare-wel reft and quiet of the nycht.
Artur, I meyne, to whome that reft is nocht,
But al the nycht fupprifit is with thocht;
In to his bed he turnyth to and fro,
1284 Remembryng the apperans of his wo,
That is to fay, his deith, his confufioun,
And of his realme the opin diftruccioun.
That in his wit he can no thing provide,
1288 Bot tak his forton thar for to abyd.
Vp goith the fon, vp goith the hot morow;
The thoughtful king al the nycht to forow,
That fauch the day, vpon his feit he ftart,

Night.

Arthur cannot rest.

The sun goeth up.

[Fol. 17.]

1292 And furth he goith, diftrublit in his hart.
 A quhill he walkith in his penlyf goft,
 So was he ware thar cummyne to the oft
 O clerk, with whome he was aqwynt befor,
 1296 In to his tyme non better was y-bore;
 Of qwhois com he gretly vas Reiofit,
 For in to hyme fum comfort he fuppoft;
 Betuex them was one hartly affeccioune.
 1300 Non orderis had he of Relegioune,
 Famus he was, and of gret excellence,
 And rycht expert in al the vij. fciences;
 Contemplatif and chaft in gouernance,
 1304 And clepit was the maifter amyfans.
 The king befor his palzoune one the gren,
 That knew hyme well, *and* haith his cummyn feñ,
 Velcummyt hyme, and maid hyme rycht gud chere,

Arthur goeth forth.

He hears that a clerk has arrived,

between whom and himself there was a hearty affection.

He was expert in the seven sciences,

and was named Amyfans.

Arthur welcomes him.

FANS REPROVES ARTHUR.

1308 And he agan, agrewit as he were,
 Saith, “nothir of thi falofing, nor the,
 Ne rak I nocht, ne charg I nocht,” *quod* hee.
 Than *quod* the king, “maifter, *and* for what why
 1312 Ar ze agrewit? or quhat treffpas have I
 Commytit, fo that I fhall yow disples?”
 Quod he, “no thing It is ayane myn eß,
 But only *contrare* of thi-felf alway;
 1316 So fare the courß yow paffith of the way.
 Thi fchip, that goth apone the stormy vall,
 Ney of thi careldis in the fwelf it fall,
 Whar fhe almoft is in the perell drent;
 1320 That is to fay, yow art fo far myfwent
 Of wykitneß vpone the vrechit dans,
 That yow art fallyng in the storng [29](#) vengans

He recks nothing of Arthur’s salutation.

The king inquires what trespass he has committed.

He replies, “It is not against me, but against thyself.

Thy ship is almost drowned in the whirlpool.

Of fadirleß, and modirleß also,
And wedwis ek fustenit mekill wo.
With gret myscchef oppreßit ar the pure;
1356 And thow art cauß of al this hol Iniure,
Whar-of that god a raknyng fal craf
At the, and a fore Raknyng fal hafe;
For thyne estat is gewyne to Redreß
1360 Thar ned, and kep them to rychtwyneß;
And thar is non that ther complantis heris;
The mychty folk, and ek the flattereris
Ar cheif with the, and doith this oppreßioun;
1364 If thai complen, It is ther confußioun.
And daniell saith that who doith to the pure,
Or faderleß, or modirleß, Enlure,
Or to the puple, that ilke to god doth hee;
1368 And al this harme fustenit Is throw the.
Yow sufferith them, oppreßith *and* anoyith;
So yow art cauß, throw the thei ar distroyth;
Than, at thi mycht, god so distroys yow.
1372 What shal he do azane? quhat shal yow,
When he distroys by vengeance of his fuerd
The synaris fra the vysagis of the Erde?
Than vtraly yow shall distroyt bee;
1376 And that Richt weill apperis now of thee,
For yow allon byleft art solitere;
And the wyß salamon can duclar,
'Wo be to hyme that is byleft alone,
1380 He haith no help;' so Is thi forton goñe;
For he is callit, *with* quhom that god is nocht,
Allone; and so thi wykitneß haith wrocht
That god hyme-self he is bycummyn thi fo,
1384 Thi pupleis hartis haith thow tynt also;
Thi wykitneß thus haith the maid alon,

The poor are oppressed.

If they complain, it is their
confusion.

What wilt thou do, when God
destroys sinners off the visage
of the earth?

Solomon saith, 'Wo to him
who is left alone! He hath no
help.'

[Fol. 18.]

Thou hast lost thy people's
hearts,

That of this erth thi fortune Is y-goñ.
Yow mone thi lyf, yow mone thi vorſchip tyne,
1388 And eft to deth that neuer ſhal haf fyne.”

and shalt come to death that
hath no end.”

UR ASKS ADVICE.

“**M**aister,” quod he, “of yowre beneuolens,
Y yow befech that tueching myn offens,
Ȝhe wald wichſaif your confell to me If
1392 How I ſal mend, and ek her-efthir leif.”
“Now,” quod the maister, “and I have merwell
qwhy

Arthur asks how he shall
amend,

Yow askith confail, and wil in non affy,
Nor wyrk thar-by; and Ȝhit yow may In tym,
1396 If yow lykith to amend the cryme.”
“Ȝhis,” ſaith the king, “and ſuthfaſtly I will
Ȝour ordynans in euery thing fulfyll.”
“And if the liſt at confail to abide,

and promises to fulfil his
bidding.

1400 The remed of thi harme to prouyde—
Firſt, the begyning is of ſapiens,

The master replies, “Thou
must first dread the Lord.

To dreid the lord and his magnificens;
And what thow haith in contrar hyme ofendit,
1404 Whill yow haith mycht, of fre defir amend it; [30](#)

[30](#) MS. “amendit.”

Repent thi gilt, repent thi gret treſpaß,
And remembir one goddis richwyſneß;

Repent thy guilt.

How for to hyme that wykitneß anoyt,
1408 And how the way of ſynaris he diſtroit;

And if ye lyk to ryng wnder his peß,
Ye wengans of his mychty hond yow ſeß,
This ſchalt yow do, if yow wil be perfit.

1412 Firſt, mone yow be penitent and contrit
Of euery thing that tuechith thi conſiens,
Done of fre will, or Ȝhit of neglygens.

Thi neid requirith ful contretioune,
1416 Princepaly with-out conclusioun;
With humble hart and goftly byfyneß,
Syne fhalt yow go deuotly the confeß
Ther-of vnto füm haly confeffour,
1420 That the wil confail tueching thin arour;
And to fulfill his will and ordynans,
In fatiffaccione and doing of penans,
And to amend al wrang and al Iniure,
1424 By the ydone til euery Creature;
If yow can In to thi hart fynde,
Contretioune well degeft In to thi mynd.
Now go thi weie, for if it leful were,
1428 Confeffioun to me, I fhuld It here.”

UR CONFESSES HIS SINS,

Than arthur, Richt obedient *and* mek,
In to his wit memoratyvecan feik
Of euery gilt wich that he can pens,
1432 Done frome he paffith the 3eris of Innocens;
And as his maifter hyme commandit hade,
He goith and his confeffioun haith he maad
Richt deuotly with lementable chere;
1436 The maner wich quho lykith for to here
He may It fynd In to the holl romans,
Of confeffioun o pafing *cercumftans*.
I can It not, I am no confeffour,
1440 My wyt haith ewill confat of that labour,
Quharof I wot I aucht repent me fore.
The king wich was confeffit, what is more,
Goith and til his maifter tellith hee,
1444 How euery fyne In to his awn degree

Thy need requireth full
contrition.

Confess to some holy
confessor.

Do penance, and amend all
wrong.”

[Fol. 18 b.]

Arthur tries to remember
every sin done since his years
of innocence,

and made his confession with
lamentable cheer.

He shew, that mycht occur yng to his mynde.

“Now,” *quod* the maistere, “left thow aght behynde

Of albenak the vorfchipful king ban,

1448 The wich that vas in to my seruice flān,

And of his wif disherift eft also?

Bot of ther sone, the wich was them fro,

Ne spek [31](#) y not;”—the king in his entent

1452 Abafyt was, and furthwith is he went

Azane, and to his confessour declarith;

Syne to his maister he ayane Reparith,

AGAIN ASKS FOR ADVICE.

To quhome he faith, “I aftir my cunyng

1456 Your ordinans fulfillit in al thing;

And now right hartly y beseich and prey,

3he wald withschaif sum thing to me say,

That may me comfort in my gret dreid,

1460 And how my men ar falzet in my Neid,

And of my dreame, the wich that is so dirk.”

This maister faith, “and thow art bound to virk

[32](#) **A**T my confail, and if yow has maad

1464 Thi confessione, as yow before hath said,

And in thi conciens thinkith perseuere,

As I presume that thow onon shalt here

That god hyme-self shal so for y^e prouide,

1468 Thow shal Remyne and In thi Ring abyde.

And why thi men ar falzet At this nede,

At short this is the caus, shalt yow nocht dred,

Fore thow to gode was frawart and perwert;

1472 Thi ryngne and the he thocht for to subwart;

And yow shal know na power may recift,

In contrar quhat god lykith to affi[li]t.

“Leftest thou aught behind,”
quoth the master, “about Ban,
king of Albanak, and his
disinherited wife?”

[31](#) MS. apparently has
“srpek;” but a comparison
with line 1543 shews that
the apparent *r* is due to the
meeting of two slight
flourishes belonging to the *s*
and *p*.

The king again confesses, and
returns,

prays for comfort,

and inquires about his dream.

The master saith, “If thou art
bound to work by my counsel,

[32](#) This line (though it
should not) begins with an
illuminated letter.

thou shalt abide in thy
kingdom.

[Fol. 19.]

S DERIVE THEIR POWER FROM GOD.

The vertw nore the strenth of victory
1476 It cummyth not of man, bot anerly
Of hyme, the wich haith euery strinth; *and* than,
If that the waiis plessit hyme of man,
He shal have forß azane his ennemys.
1480 A-ryght agan apone the samyne vyß,
If he displeß vn to the lord, he shall
Be to his fais a subiet or a thrall,
As that we may In to the bible red,
1484 Tueching the folk he tuk hyme-felf to led
In to the lond, the wich he them byhicht.
Ay when thei 3hed in to his ways Richt,
Ther fois gon befor there fuerd to nocht;
1488 And when that thei ayanis hyme hath vrocht,
Thei war so full of radur and disspare,
That of o leif fleing in the air,
The found of It haith gart o thoufand tak
1492 At onys apone them-felf the bak,
And al ther manhed vterly foryhet;
Sich dreid the lord apone ther hartis set.
So shalt yow know no powar may *with*stond,
1496 Ther god hyme-felf hath ton the cauß on hond.
And ye quhy stant in thyne awn offenses,
That al thi puple fal3het off defens.
And sum ar fal3eing magre ther entent;
1500 Thei ar to quhom thow yewyne hath thi rent,
Thi gret Reuard, thi richeß and thi gold,
And cheriffith and held in thi houshold.
Bot the most part ar fal3heit the at wyll,
1504 To quhome yow haith wnkyndneß schawin till;
Wrong and *in*lure, and ek defalt of law,
And pwnyng of qwhich that thei stand aw;

Strength of victory cometh
from God only.

Whoso displeases Him shall
be subject to his enemies, as
we read in the Bible
concerning the Jews.

When they wrought against
Him, they were so full of fear
that the sound of a falling leaf
made a thousand flee.

Thine own offence is the
reason why thy people fail
thee.

Thou hast shewn some of
them unkindness,

And makith seruice but reward or fee,
 1508 Syne haith no thonk bot fremmytneß of the.
 Such folk to the cummyth bot for dred,
 Not of fre hart the for to help at nede.
 And what awalith owthir sheld or sper,
 1512 Or horß or armoure according for ye were,
 Vith-outen man them for to ftere and led?
 And man, yow wot, that vantith hart is ded,
 That in to armys seruith he of noght;
 1516 A cownt oft ful mekil harm haith vroght.
 In multitude nore 3hit in confluens
 Of flich, is nowther manhed nore defens.
 And fo thow hath the rewlyt, that almost
 1520 Of al thi puple the hartis ben ylost;
 And tynt richt throw thyne awn myfgouernans
 Of auerice and of thyne errogans.
 What is o prince? quhat is o gouernoure
 1524 Withouten fame of worfchip and honour?
 What is his mycht, fuppos he be A lorde,
 If that his folk fal nocht to hyme accorde?
 May he his Rigne, may he his holl Empire
 1528 Suften al only of his owne defyre,
 In ferwyng of his wrechit appetit
 Of awerice and of his awn delyt,
 And hald his men, wncherift, in thraldome?

ST KINGS ARE PUNISHED.

1532 Nay! that shal fone his hie estat confome.
 For many o knyght [33](#) therby is broght ydoune,
 All vtraly to ther confufioun;
 For oft it makith vther kingis by
 1536 To wer on them In traft of victory;
 And oft als throw his peple is diftroyth,

[Fol. 19 b.]

and a man that wanteth heart
is dead.

Thou hast so conducted
thyself as to lose all thy
people's hearts.

What is a prince without
honour?

Can he by himself sustain his
kingdom, by serving his own
appetite?

His oppression of his people
consumes his high estate, and
makes other kings war on
them.

[33](#) "king" (?).

That fyndith them agrewit or anoyth;
And god also oft with his awn fwerd,
1540 Punyfith ther wyfis one this erd.
Thus falith not o king but gouernans,
Boith realme and he goith one to myfchans.”

SSAGE FROM GALIOT.

AS thai war thus speking of this thinge,
1544 Frome galiot cam two knyghtis to the king;
That one the king of hundereth knyghtis was;
That other to nome the fyrst-conquest king ³⁴ has,
At firft that galyot conquerit of one.

1548 The nereft way one to the king thei gon,
And vp he roß, as he that wel couth do
Honor, to quhome that It afferith to;
And 3hit he wift not at thei kingis were;
1552 So them ³⁵ thei boith and vyth rycht knyghtly
cher

Reuerendly thei faluft hyme, and thane
The king of hunder knyghtis he began
And laid hyme, “*fir*, to 3ow my lord ws fende,
1556 Galiot, whilk bad ws fay he wende,
That of this world the vorthieft king wor 3he,
Greteft of men and of awtoritee.

Wharof he has gret wonder that 3he ar
1560 So feble cummyne In to his contrare,
For to defend your cuntre *and* your londe,
And knowith well 3he may hyme nocht *withftonde*.
Wharfor he thinkith no worfchip to conquere,
1564 Nore in the weris more to *perfyuere*;
Confiddir yowr wakneß and yowr Indegens,
A3anis hyme as now to mak defens.

God also punishes their
vices.”

Meanwhile, the king of a
hundred knights and the first-
conquest king come from
Galiot,

³⁴ MS. “kinghe,” a
spelling due to confusion
with “knight.” See [L.1533](#).

³⁵ “then” (?).

and the former delivers his
message, to the effect that

[Fol. 20.]

Galiot wonders at the
feebleness of Arthur’s folk,

Wharfore, my lord haith grantit by vs here
 1568 Trewis to yhow and resput for o 3here,
 If that yhow lykith by the 3heris space
 For to retwrn ayane In to this place,
 Her to manteine yhour cuntre and *withstond*
 1572 Hyme *with* the holl power of yhour lond.
 And for the tyme the trewis shal endure,
 Yhour cuntre and yhour lond he will affurre;
 And wit 3he 3hit his powar is *nocht* here.
 1576 And als he bad ws fay yhow by the yhere,
 The gud knyght wich that the Red armys bure
 And in the feild maid the discumfiture,
 The whilk the flour of knyghthed may be cold,
 1580 He thinkith hym to haue of his houshold.”
 “Well,” quod the king, “I have hard quhat yhe fay,
 But if god will, and ek if that I may,
 In to sich wyß I think for to withstond,
 1584 Yhour lord shal have no powar of my londe.”
 Of this mesag the king Reiofing haß,
 And of the trewis wich that grantit was,
 Bot anoyt 3hit of the knyght was he,
 1588 Wich thei awant to have in such dogre.
 Ther leif thei tuk; and when at thei war gon,

³⁶ **T**his maister faith, “how lykith god dispone!

Now may yhow se *and* futh is my recorde;
 1592 For by hym now is makith this accord;
 And by non vthir worldly providens,
 Sauf only grant of his bynewolans,
 To se if that the lykith to amend,
 1596 And to prouid thi cuntre to defend.
 Wharfor yow shalt in to thi lond home fair,

and is willing to grant a year’s
 truce,

if Arthur will return to fight
 against him in a year’s time;

and desires to have the red
 knight in his household.

Arthur rejoices at the truce,

³⁶ The initial T is
 illuminated.

which the master attributes to
 God’s providence, and
 exhorts him, saying,

And gowerne the as that I shall declaire.
 Firft, thi god with humble hart yow ferfe,
 1600 And his comand at al thi mycht obferf;
 And fyne, lat paß the ilk bleffit wonde
 Of lowe *with* mercy Iuftly throw thi londe;
 And y befeich—to quhome yow fal direke
 1604 The rewle vpone, the wrangis to correk—
 That yow be nocht in thi electioun blynde;
 For writin It Is and yow fal trew It fynde.
 That, be thei for to thonk or ellis blame,
 1608 And towart god thi *part* fhall be the faṁ;
 Of Ignorans fhalt yow nocht be excufit,
 Bot in ther werkis forly be accufit,
 For thow fhuld euer cheß apone fich wyß

TO CHOOSE JUDGES.

1612 The minifteris ³⁷ that rewill haith of Iuftice:—
 Firft, that he be defcret til wnderftond
 And lowe and ek the mater of the londe;
 And be of mycht and ek Autoritee,
 1616 (For puple ay *contempnith* low degre,)
 And that of trouth he folow furth the way;
 That is als mych as he louyth trewth alway,
 And haitith al them the wich fal pas therfro.
 1620 Syne, that he god dreid and lowe al-so.
 Of auerice be-war with the defyre,
 And of hyme full of haftynes *and* fyre;
 Be-war thar-for of malice and defire,
 1624 And hyme alfo that lowith no medyre;
 For al this abhominable was hold,
 When Iuftice was in to the tymis olde.
 For qwho that is of an of thir by-know,
 1628 The left of them subuertith all the low,

[Fol. 20 b.]

“First, serve God with humble
 heart, and let the wand of law
 pass through the land.

Thus shalt thou choose the
 ministers of justice.

³⁷ MS. “mīfteris.”

Avoid avaricious and wrathful
 men.

And makith It w[n]lusty ³⁸ to procede;
Eschew tharfor, for this fal be thi meid
Apone the day when al thing goith aright,
1632 Whar none excuß hidyng schal ye lyght;
But he the Iug, that no man may fullspek,
Euery thing ful Iustly fal correk.
Be-war thar-with, as before have I told,
1636 And cheß them wyfly that thi low shal hold.
And als I will that it well oft be sen,
Richt to thi-self how thei thi low *conten*;

S MUST BE JUST AND TRUE.

And how the Right, and how the dom is went,
1640 For to Inquer that yow be delygent.
And punyß for, for o thing shal yow know,
The most trespas is to subuert the low,
So that yow be not in thar gilt accufit,
1644 And frome the froit of bliffit folk refufit.
And pas yow shalt to euery chef toune,
Throw-out the boundis of thi Regioun
Whar yow fall be, that Iustice be Elyk
1648 With-out diuifione baith to pur *and* ryk.
And that thi puple have [ane] awdiens
With thar complantis, and also thi *presens*;
For qwho his eris frome the puple stekith,
1652 And not his hond in ther support furth rekith,
His dom fall be ful grewous & ful hard,
When he fal cry and he fal *nocht* be hard.
Wharfor thyne eris ifith to the pwre,
1656 Bot in redreß of ned, & not of *inlure*;
Thus fall thei don of Rellone & knowlag.

³⁸ MS. “w Iustly.”

Eschew unfit men, for this
shall be thy meed in the day
of judgment.

Be diligent to inquire how
judgment is given.

[Fol. 21.]

Visit every chief town
throughout the bounds of thy
kingdom.

Give thine ears to the poor.

Kings, while minors, may be
excused;

B ut kingis when thei ben of tender ag,
Y wil not say I traft thei ben excufit,
1660 Bot fchortly thei fall be far accufit,
When fo thei cum to yheris of Refone,
If thei tak not full contrifioune,
And pwnyß them that hath ther low myßgyit.
1664 That this is trouth it may not be denyit;
For vther ways thei fal them not difcharg,
[Excep thei pwnyß them that have the charg] ³⁹
One eftatis of ther realm, that fhold
1668 *With*-in his 3outh fe that his low be hold. ⁴⁰
And thus thow the, *with* mercy, kep alway
Of Iuftice furth the ilk bleffit way.

but, when of age, they must
punish those that have
wrested justice.

³⁹ A blank space here
occurs, just sufficient to
contain one line.

⁴⁰ MS. "behold."

Temper justice with mercy.

Be true and stable in thy
words.

And of thi wordis beis trew and ftable,
 1672 Spek not to mych, nore be not vareable.
 O kingis word fhuld be o kingis bonde,
 And laid It is, a kingis word fhuld ftond;
 O kingis word, among our faderis old,
 1676 Al-out more precious & more fur was hold
 Than was the oth or feel of any wight;
 O king of trouth fuld be the werray lyght,
 So treuth and Iuftice to o king accordyth.
 1680 And als, as thir clerkis old recordith,

A king should be the very
light of truth.

S SHOULD CHERISH ALL MEN.

41 **I**n tyme is larges and humilitee
 Right well according vnto hie dugre,
 And pleffith boith to god and man al-so;
 1684 Wharfor I wil, *incontinent* thow go,
 And of thi lond in euery part abide,
 Whar yow gar fet and clep one euery fid
 Out of thi cuntreis, and ek out of thi tovnis,
 1688 Thi dukis, erlis, and thi gret baronis,
 Thi pur knychtis, and thi bach[e]leris,
 And them refauf als hartly as afferis,
 And be them-felf yow welcum them ilkon:
 1692 Syne, them to glaid and cheris, thee difpone
 With fefting and with humyll *contynans*.
 Be not penfyve, nore proud in arrogans,
 Bot *with* them hold in gladnes cumpany;
 1696 Not with the Rich nor myghty anerly,
 Bot with the pure worthi man alfo,
With them thow fit, *with* them yow ryd and go.
 I fay not to be our fameliar,

41 The initial I is
 illuminated; rather because
 there is here a change of
 subject than because it
 begins a new sentence.

[Fol. 21 b.]

Invite thy dukes, earls, great
 barons, thy poor knights, and
 thy bachelors, and welcome
 them severally.

Keep company not with the
 rich man only, but with the
 poor worthy man also.

1700 For, as the moſt philoſephur can duclar,
To mych to oyß familiaritee
Contempnyng bryngith one to hie dugre;
Bot cherice them *with* wordis fair depaynt,
1704 So with thi pupelle fal yow the aquaynt.
Than of ilk cuntre wyfly yow enquere
An agit knyght to be thi conſulere,
That haith ben hold in armys Richt famus,
1708 Wyß and diſcret, & no thing Inwyus;
For there is non that knowith ſo wel, I-wyß,
O worthy man as he that worthi Is.

S MUST BE LIBERAL.

When well long haith yow fwiornyt in a place,
1712 And well acqueynt the *vith* thi puple has,
Than fhalt thou ordand & *prowid* the
Of horß and ek of armour gret plente;
Of gold, and filuer, tressore, and cleithing,
1716 And euery Riches that *longith* to o king;
And when the lykith for to tak thi leif,
By largeß thus yow thi reward geif,
First to the pure worthy honorable,
1720 That is til armys and til manhed able;
(Set he be pur, 3hit worſchip in hyme bidith);
If hyme the horß one wich thi-felwyne Ridith,
And bid hyme that he Rid hyme for yhour fak;
1724 Syne til hyme gold and filuer yow betak;
The horß to hyme for worſchip and prowes,
The trefor for his fredome and larges.
If moſt of Riches and of Cherifiſing;
1728 Eftir this gud knyght berith vitneſing.
Syne to thi tennandis & to thi wawafouris
If eſſy haknays, palfrais, and curſfouris,

Yet remember that familiarity
breeds contempt.

Choose out of each diſtrict an
aged knight to be thy
counſellor.

When thou haſt ſojourned
long in a place, then provide
thee with plenty of horſes,
armour, gold, ſilver, and
clothing;

and, before leaving, diſtribute
gifts liberally.

Give to the poor worthy man
the horſe thou thyſelf rideſt.

[Fol. 22 a.]

Give to thy tenants and
vavasours eaſy hackneys,

And robis sich as plesand ben and fair;
 1732 Syne to thi lordis, wich at mychty aire,
 As dukis, erlis, princis, and ek kingis,
 Yow if them strang, yow if them vncouth thingis,
 As diuerß iowellis, and ek preciouß stonis,
 1736 Or halkis, hundis, ordinit for the nonis,
 Or wantone horß that can nocht stand in stāble;
 Thar giftis mot be fair and delitable.
 Thus, firft vn to the vorthi pur yow if
 1740 Giftis, that may ther pouerte Releif;
 And to the rich iftis of plesans,
 That thei be fair, let nocht of gret substans;
 For riches alkith no thing bot delyt,
 1744 And powert haith ay ane appetyt
 For to support ther ned and Indigens:
 Thus shall yow if and makith thi dispens.
 And ek the quen, my lady, shalt also
 1748 To madenis and to ladeis, quhar 3he go,
 If, and cheriß one the samyne wyß;
 For in to largeß al thi welfar lyis.
 And if thy giftis with sich continans
 1752 That thei be sen ay gifyne vith plesans;
 The wyß man lais, and suth it is approuit,
 Thar is no thonk, thar is no ift alowit,
 Bot It be ifyne In to sich manere,
 1756 (That is to say, als glaid in to his chere),
 As he the wich the ift of hyme Refauith;
 And do he not, the gifar is diffauith.
 For who that iffis, as he not if wald,
 1760 Mor profit war his ift for to with-hald;
 His thonk he tynith, and his ift also.
 Bot that thow ifith, if with boith two,
 That is to say, vith hart and hand atonis;

palfries, and coursers.

Give to thy lords things
strange and uncouth.

So, too, shall the queen give
to maidens and ladies,

for all thy welfare lies in
liberality.

Remember that the giver
should be as glad in his cheer
as the receiver.

1764 And fo the wyfman ay ye ift difponis.
Beith larg and iffis frely of thi thing;
For largeß is the trefour of o king,
And not this other Iowellis nor this gold
1768 That is in to thi trefory with-holde.
Who gladly iffith, be vertew of larges
His trefory encreßis of Richeß,
And fal a3aïne the mor al-out refawe.

REAL KINGS ARE LOVED IN LIFE,

1772 For he to quhome he 3ewith fall hawe,
Firft his body, fyne his hart with two,
His gudis al for to difpone also
In his feruice; and mor atour he fhall
1776 Have O thing, and that is beft of all;
That is to fay, the worfchip and the loß
That vpone larges in this world furth goß.
And yow fhall know the lawbour & the preß
1780 In to this erth about the gret Richeß.
Is ony, bot [42](#) apone the cauß we see
Of met, of cloth, & of prosperitee?
All the remanant ftant apone the name
1784 Of purches, furth apone this worldis fame.
And well yow wot, in thyne allegians
Ful many Is, the wich haith fufficians
Of euery thing that longith to ther ned;
1788 What haith yow more, qwich [haith] them al to lede,
For al thi Realmys and thi gret Riches,
If that yow lak of worfchip the encreß?
Well leß, al-out; for efter thar eftate
1792 Thei have vorfchip, and kepith It al-gat;
And yow degradith al thyne hie dugree,
That fo fchuld fhine In to nobelitee,

Give with both hand and heart
at once;

for liberality is the treasure of
a king.

[Fol. 22 b.]

Whoso gives liberally, his
treasury increases.

For the receiver shall place
his goods at the king's
disposal,

who shall gain, moreover,
both worship and praise.

Is there any labour except for
meat and clothing? All the
remnant is for fame.

[42](#) MS. "Is ony bout bot;"
"bout" being defaced.

Throuch wys and throw the wrechitneß of hart.

COMMENDED AFTER DEATH.

1796 And knowis yow not what fall be [43](#) thi part,
Out of this world when yow fal paß the courß?
Fair well, I-wyß! yow neuer shall Recourß
Whar no prince more shall the subiet [44](#) have,
1800 But be als dep in to the erd y-grave,
Sauf vertew only and worfchip wich abidith;
With them the world apone the laif dewidith;
And if he, wich shal eftir the succed,
1804 By larges spend, of quich that yhow had
dreid,
He of the world comendit is and prifit,
And yow ftant furth of euery thing dispifit;
The puple faith and demyth thus of thee,
1808 “Now is he gone, a werray vrech was hee,
And he the wich that is our king and lord
Boith wertew haith & larges in accorde;
Welcum be he!” and so the puple foundith.
1812 Thus through thi viß his wertew mor aboundith,
And his vertew the more thi wice furth schawith.
Wharfor 3he, wich that princes ben y-knawith,
Lat not yhour vrechit hart so yhow dant,
1816 That he that cummyth next yhow may awant
To be mor larg, nore more to be commendit;
Best kepit Is the Riches well dispendit.
O 3he, the wich that kingis ben, fore sham
1820 Remembrith yhow, this world hath bot o naam̄
Of good or ewill, efter 3he ar gone!
And wyfly tharfor cheffith yhow the toñ
Wich moft accordith to nobilitee,
1824 And knytithe larges to yhour hie degre.

Knowest thou not what shall
be thy part, when thou passest
away from this world?

[43](#) MS. has “by.”

[44](#) MS. has “subei^et.”

Virtue and honour will alone
remain.

And if thy successor be
liberal, he will be commended
of the world;

[Fol. 23 a.]

and his virtue will abound
through thy vice.

Riches well spent are the best
kept.

For qwhar that fredome In O prince Ringnis,
It bryngith In the victory of kingis,
And makith realmys and puple boith to dout,
1828 And subectis ⁴⁵ of the cuntre al about.

⁴⁵ Or “subettis.”

RAL KINGS WIN SUBJECTS,

And qwho that thinkith ben o conquerour,
Suppos his largeß sumquhat pas myfour,
Ne rak he nat, bot frely iffith ay;
1832 And as he wynyth, beis var al-way
To mych nor 3hit to gredy that he hold,
Wich fal the hartis of the puple colde.
And low and radour cummyth boith two
1836 Of larges; Reid and 3he fal fynd It fo.
Alexander this lord the warld that wan,
Firft *with* the fuerd of larges he began,
And as he wynith ifith largely,
1840 He rakith No thing bot of cheuelry;
Wharfor of hyme so passith the Renown,
That many o cetee, and many o strang towñ
Of his worfchip that herith the Recorde,
1844 Diffirith so to haveing sich o lorde;
And offerith them *with*-outen strok of spere,
Suppos that thei war manly men of were,
But only for his gentilleß that thei
1848 Have hard; and so he louit was al-way
For his larges, humilitee, and manhed,
With his awn folk, that neuermore, we Reid,
For al his weris nor his gret trawell,
1852 In al his tym that thei hyme onys fail;
Bot in his worfchip al thar befynes
Thei fet, and lewith in to no distres;
Whar-throw the fuerd of victory he berith.

Whoso will be a conqueror,
let him not reck to give
largely.

Both love and fear spring
from liberality.

Alexander gave so liberally,

that many cities desired to
have such a lord,

and offered themselves
peaceably to him, though they
were manly men of war.

[Fol. 23 b.]

1856 And many prince full oft the palm werith,
As has ben hard, by largeß, of before,
In conqueringe of Rignis & of glore.
And wrechitnes Richt fo, in the contrar,

JNJUST ONES DESPOIL THEM.

1860 Haith Realmys maid ful defolat & bare,
And kingis broght doun from ful hie estat;
And who that Red ther old bukis, wat
The vicis lef, the wertew have in mynde,
1864 And takith larges In his awn kynd;
A-myd standing of the vicis two,
Prodegalitee and awerice alfo.
Wharfor her-of It nedith not to more,
1868 So mych ther-of haith clerkis vrit to-fore.
Bot who the wertw of larges & the law
Sal cheß, mot ned confidir well & know
In to hyme-felf, and thir thre wnderftande,
1872 The subftans firft, the powar of his land,
Whome to he iffith, and the cauß wharfore,
The nedful tyme awatith euermore.
Kepith thir thre; for qwho that fal exced
1876 His rent, he fallith fodandly in nede.
And fo the king, that on to myfter drowis,
His subiettis and his puple he our-thrawis,
And them difpolzeith boith of lond and Rent;
1880 So is the king, fo is the puple fchent.
For-quhi the voice It fcrik[i]th vp ful ewyne
With-out abaid, and paffith to the hewyne,
Whar god hyme-felf refauith ther the crye
1884 Of the opprefioun and the teranny,
And vith the fuerd of wengans doun y-fmytith,
The wich that caruith al to for, and bitith,

Many princes bear the palm
of victory, through liberality;

while miserliness hath made
realms desolate.

Choose the mean between
prodigality and avarice.

Whoso chooses to be liberal,

must understand three things:
the *amount he has*, to *whom*
he giveth, and the *fit time* for
giving.

(1) The king that becomes
indigent overthrows his
subjects.

For the voice of the oppressed
shrieketh up ceaselessly to
heaven;

and God smiteth down with
the sword of vengeance.

And hyme diftroyth, as has ben hard or this
1888 Of euery king that wirkith ficht o mys.

ARE OF INJUSTICE AND FLATTERY.

For ther is few eschapith them, It fall
Boith vpone hyme & his successeione fall;
For he forfuth haith ifyne hyme the wond
1892 To Iustefy and Reull in pece his lond,
The puple all submytit to his cure;
And he aȝan one to no creatur
Save only shal vn to his gode obey.
1896 And if he passith so far out of the wey,
Them to oppreß, that he shuld reul & gid,
Ther heritag, there gwdis to dewide,
Ye, wnder whome that he most nedis stond,
1900 At correccioune shal strek his mychty hond,
Not euery day, bot shal at onys fall
On hyme, mayhap, and his succescione all.
In this, allace! the blyndis of the kingis,
1904 And Is the fall of princis and of Rygnis.
The most wertew, the gret Intellegens,
The bleffit tokyne of wysdom and prudens
Iß, in o king, for to restren his honde
1908 Frome his pupleis Riches & ther lond.
Mot euery king have this wice in mynd
In tyme, and not when that he ned fynde!
And in thi larges beith war, I pray,
1912 Of nedful tyme, for than is best alway.
Awyß the ek quhome to that thow salt if,
Of there fam, and ek how that thei leif;
And of the wertws and wicious folk also,
1916 I the befeich dewidith well thir two,
So that thei stond nocht in[to] o degree;

For God hath given the king
the wand of justice:

[Fol. 24 a.]

and if he oppresses them
whom he should rule,

God shall stretch His mighty
hand for correction.

Herein, alas! is the blindness
of kings.

The blessed token of a king's
wisdom is for him to restrain
his hand from his people's
riches.

(2) Choose a *fitting time*.

(3) Take care *to whom* you
give.

Let not the virtuous and the
vicious stand in the same
degree.

Discrecciounē fall mak the diuerfitee,
Wich clepith the moder of al vertewis.

FLATTERERS SUCCEED WHEN KINGS ARE FOOLISH.

1920 And beith war, I the befeich of this,
That is to fay of flatry, wich that longith
To court, and al the kingis larges fongith.
The vertuouß man no thing thar-of refauith,
1924 The flattereris now fo the king diffauith
And blyndith them that wot no thing, I-wyß,
When thei do well, or quhen thei do o myß;
And latith kingis oft til wnderftonde
1928 Thar vicis, and ek ye faltis of ther lond.
In to the realme about o king Is holde
O flatterere were than is the stormys cold,
Or peftelens, and mor the realme anoyith;
1932 For he the law and puple boith diftroyith.
And in to principall ben ther three thingis,
That cauffith flattereris ftonding *with* the kingis;
And on, It is the blyndit Ignorans
1936 Of kingis, wich that hath no gouernans
To wnderftond who doith flich o myß;
But who that fareft fchewith hym, I-wyß,
Moft fuffilith and beft to his plefans.
1940 Wo to the realme that havith flich o chans!
And fecundly, quhar that o king Is
Weciuß hyme-felf, he cheriffith, ywys,
Al them the wich that one to vicis foundith,
1944 Whar-throw that vicis and flattery ek aboundith.
The thrid, is the ilk fchrewit harrmful wice,
Wich makith o king *within* hyme-felf fo nyce,
That al thar flatry and ther gilt he knowith
1948 In to his wit, and 3hit he hyme *with*-drowith

Beware of flattery.

A flatterer is worse than a
storm or a pestilence.

[Fol. 24 b.]

Three things make flatterers
in favour.

First, the blind ignorance of
kings.

Secondly, where a king is
vicious himself.

Thirdly, where the king is so
foolish, that he knows their
flattery, yet withdraws from
reproving them.

Them to repref, and of ther vicis he wot;
And this It is wich that difsemblyng hot,
That in no way accordith for o king.

1952 Is he not fet abuf apone his Ringne,
As fouerane his puple for to lede?

Whi fchuld he fpare, or quhom of fchuld he dred
To fay the treuth, as he of Right is hold?

Why should a king spare to
say the truth?

1956 And if fo ware that al the kingis wold,
When that his legis comytit ony wyce,
As beith not to fchamful, nore to nyce,
That thei prefume that he is negligent,

1960 But als far as he thinkith that thei myß-went,
But difsemblyng repewith as afferis;

He should reprove without
dissembling, as it is fitting.

And pwnice them quhar pwnyfyng Requeris,
Sauf only mercy in the tyme of ned.

1964 And fo o king he fchuld his puple led,
That no trefpaß, that cummyth in his way,
Shuld paß his hond wne-pwnift away;

Nore no good deid in to the famyn degree,

1968 Nore no wertew, fuld wn-Reuardid bee.

Than flattry fhuld, that now is he, be low,
And wice from the kingis court *with*-drow;

Then flattery, that now is
high, should be low.

His minifteris that fhuld the Iuftice reull,

1972 Shuld kep well furth of quiet & reull,

That now, god wat, as It conferwit Is,

The ftere is loft, and al is gon amys;

And vertew fhuld hame to the court hyme drefß,

[Fol. 25 a.]

1976 That exillith goith in to the wildernes.

KINGS MAKE A WISE PEOPLE.

Thus if o king ftud lyk his awn degree,
Wertwis and wyß than fhuld his puple bee,
Only fet by vertew hyme to pleß,

If a king thus stood like his
own degree, his people would
be virtuous and wise.

1980 And fore adred his wisdom to displeß.
And if that he towart the vicis draw,
His folk fall go on to that ilk law;
What shal hyme pleß that wil nocht ellis fynd,
1984 Bot ther-apon fetith al ther mynde.

Thus only in the wertew of o king
The reull stant of his puple & his ringne,
If he be wyß and, but dissemblyng, schewis,
1988 As I have laid, the vicis one to schrewis.
And so thus, *fir*, It stant apone thi will

For to omend thi puple, or to spill;
Or have thi court of vertewis folk, or fullis;
1992 Sen yow art holl maister of the scoullis
Teichith them, and thei sal gladly leir,
That is to say, that thei may no thing heir [46](#)
Sauf only wertew towart thyn estat;
1996 And cheriß them that wertews ben algait.
And thinkith what that wertew is to thee;
It pleßfith god, vphaldith thi degree.”

“Maister,” *quod* he, “me think rycht profitable
2000 Yowr conseell Is, and wonder honorable
For me, and good; rycht well I have *confaut*,
And in myne hartis Inwartneß refaut.

I shal fulfill and do yowr ordynans
2004 Als far of wit as I have suffisans;
Bot y befeich yow, in til hartly wyß,
That of my drem 3he so to me dewyß,
The wich so long haith occupeid my mynd,
2008 How that I shal no maner sucour fynd
Bot only throw the wattir lyon, & fyne
The leich that is *withouten* medyfyne;
And of the confell of the flour; wich ayre
2012 Wonderis lyk that no man can duclar.”

Thus the rule of his people
and kingdom standeth only in
the king’s virtue.

Since thou art wholly master
of the schools, teach them,
and they shall gladly learn.”

[46](#) Or, “leir.” MS.
apparently has “leir,”
corrected to “heir.”

Arthur considers his counsel
profitable.

He beseeches him to expound
his dream,

how he shall only find help
through the water-lion, the
leech, and the flower.

“**N**ow, *fir*,” *quod* he, “and I of them al thre,
What thei betakyne shal I schaw to the,
Such as the clerkis at them *specifiit*;
2016 Thei vfit no thing what thei *signefiit*.
The wattir lyone Is the god werray,
God to the lyone is lyknyt many way;
But thei have hyme In to the wattir *señ*,
2020 Confutit were ther wittis al, y *weñ*;
The wattir was ther awn fragelitee,
And thar trespas, and thar Inequitee
In to this world, the wich thei *ftond y-clofit*;
2024 That was the wattir wich thei have *suppofit*,
That haith there knowlag maad fo Inperfyte;
Thar fyne & ek ther worldis gret delyt,
As cloudy wattir, was euermore betweñ,
2028 That thei the lyone *perfitly* hath *nocht* *señ*;
Bot as the wattir, wich was *yer* awn *lynne*,
That euermor thei *ftond* confutit In.
If thei haith *ftond* in to *religioñ* clen,
2032 Thei had the lyone Not in watter *fen*,
Bot clerly vp in to the hewyne abuf,
Eternaly whar he shal not remufe.
And euermore in vatter of fyne was hee,
2036 For-quhi It is Imposseble for to bee; [47](#)
And thus the world, wich that thei ar In,
Y-clofit Is in dyrknes of ther fyne;
And ek the thikneß of the air between
2040 The lyone mad in vattir to be *fen*.
For It was *nocht* bot *ftrenth* of ther clergy
Wich thei have here, and It is bot erthly,

The master’s explanation.

[Fol. 25 *b.*]

The water-lion is the very
God.

The water is men’s fragility;

whereby they see not the lion
perfectly.

Had men been always
religious, they had seen the
lion not in water, but clearly.

[47](#) “see”(?).

The world is enclosed in the
darkness of their sin.

That makith them there refouns dewyß,
 2044 And fe the lyone thus in ertgly wyß.
 This is the lyone, god, and goddis sone,
 Ihesu crift, wich ay in hewyne fal wonne.
 For as the lyone of euery belt is king,
 2048 So is he lord and maifter of al thing,
 That of the bleffit vyrgyne was y-bore.
 Ful many a natur the lyone haith, quhar-fore
 That he to god resemblyt is, bot I
 2052 Lyk not mo at this tyme fpecify.
 This is the lyone, thar-of have yow no dred,
 That fhall the help and comfort In thi ned.

The lion is God's son, Jesu Christ.

LEECH WITHOUT MEDICINE IS CHRIST.

The fentens here now woll I the defyne
 2056 Of hyme, the lech *withouten* medyfyne,
 Wich is the god that euery thing hath vroght.
 For yow may know that vther Is It noght,
 As furgynis and feficianis, wich that delith
 2060 *With* mortell thingis, and mortell thingis helyth,
 And al thar art is in to medyfyne,
 As it is ordanit be the mycht dewyne,
 As plafteris, drinkis, and anouyntmentis [48](#) feir,
 2064 And of the qualyte watyng of the yher;
 And of the planetis difpoficioune,
 And of the naturis of compleccyoun,
 And in the diuerß changing of hwmowris.
 2068 Thus wnder reull lyith al there cwriss;
 And yhit thei far as blynd man In the way,
 Oft quhen that deith thar craft lift to affay.
 Bot god, the wich that is the foueran lech,
 2072 Nedith no maner medyfyne to fech;

The leech without medicine is also God.

[Fol. 26 a.]

Not as surgeons,

whose art is in medicine,

and in plaisters, drinks, and various anointments; who know the quality of the year, and the disposition of the planets.

[48](#) MS. "anoñytmētis," or "anoūytmētis."

For ther is no Infyrmyte, nore wound,
 Bot as hyme lykith al is holl and found.
 So can he heill Infyrmytee of thocht,
 2076 Wich that one erdly medefyne can noght;
 And als the faul that to confusioun goith,
 And haith with hyme and vther parteis boith,
 His dedly wound god helyth frome the ground;
 2080 On to his cure no medfyne is found.
 This Is his mycht that neuer more shall fyne,
 This is the leich *withouten* medfyne;
 And If that yhow at confessioun hath ben
 2084 And makith the of al thi synnis clen,
 Yow art than holl, and this ilk samyn is he
 Schall be thi leich In al neceffitee.

But God can heal infirmity of
 thought,

and also the soul that goeth to
 confusion.

He shall be thy leech in all
 necessity.

LOWER IS THE VIRGIN MARY.

N ow of the flour y woll to the discern:

2088 This is the flour that haith [49](#) the froyt etern,
 This is the flour, this fadith for no schour,
 This is the flour of euery flouris floure;
 This is the flour, of quhom the froyt was born,
 2092 This ws redemyt efter that we war lorn;
 This Is the flour that euer spryngith new,
 This is the flour that changith neuer hew;
 This is the vyrgyne, this is the bleffit flour
 2096 That Ihesu bur is our salweour,
 This flour wnwemmyt of hir wirginitee;
 This is the flour of our felicitee,
 This is the flour to quhom ve shuld exort,
 2100 This is the flour not fessith to support
 In prayere, confell, and in byssynes,
 Vs catifis ay In to our wrechitnes

[49](#) The word, though
 indistinct, is almost
 certainly “haith.” Stevenson
 has “high;” but this gives no
 sense.

The flower is she of whom
 the eternal fruit was born,

the virgin that bore the
 Saviour,

that ceaseth not to support us
 caitiffs,

On to hir sone, the quick hir confell herith;

[Fol. 26 b.]

2104 This is the flour that al our gladneß sterith,

Throuch whois prayer mony one is sawit,

through whose prayer are
many saved.

That to the deth eternaly war refawit,

Ne war hir hartly fuplicatione.

2108 This is the flour of our saluatione,

Next hir sone, the froyt of euery flour;

This is the sam that shal be thi succour,

If that the lykith hartly Reuerans

2112 And seruice 3eld one to hir excellens,

Syne worfchip hir *with* al thi byßfyness;

Sche shal thi harm, sche shal thi ned redress.

Sche shal lye confell if one to the two,

She shall so counsel the lion
and the leech, that thou need
not despair.

2116 The lyone and the fouerane lech also,

Yow shal not Ned yi dreem for to dispar,

Nor 3hit no thing that is in thi contraire.

Now—*quod* the maister—yow may well wnderstand

2120 Tueching thi drem as I have born on hande;

And planly haith the mater al declarith,

That yhow may know of wich yow was disparith.

The lech, the lyone, and the flour also,

2124 Yow worfchip them, yow serue them euermo;

And ples the world as I have said before;

In gouernans thus stondith al thi glore.

Do as yow list, for al is in thi honde,

Do now as thou list, for all is
in thy hand.

2128 To tyne thi-self, thi honore, and thi londe,

Or lyk o prince, o conquerour, or king,

In honore and in worfchip for to Ringe.”

UR IS COMFORTED.

“Now,” *quod* the king, “I fell that the support

The king replies,

2132 Of yhour confell haith don me lich comfort,

Of euery raddour my hart is In to eß,

To 3hour *command*, god will, y fal obeß.
 Bot o thing is yneuch wn to me,
 2136 How galiot makith his awant that he
 Shall have the knycht, that only by his honde
 And manhed, was defendour of my londe;
 If that fhall fall y pray yhow tellith me,
 2140 And quhat he hecht, and of quhat lond is hee?”
 “What that he hecht yow fhall no foryer know,
 His dedis fall her-eftewart hyme fchaw;
 Bot *contrar* the he fhall be found no way.
 2144 No more thar-of as now y will the fay.” [50](#)
 With that the king haith at his maiftir tone
 His leve, one to to* his cuntre for to goñe;
 And al the oft makith none abyde,**
 2148 To paffing home anone thei can *prowid*;
 And to *fir* gawane thei haith o lytter maad,
 Ful fore ywound, and hyme on *with* them haade.
 [T]he king, as that the fstory can declar,
 2152 Paffith to o Cete that was Right fair,
 And clepit cardole, In to walis, was,
 For that tyme than It was the nereft place,
 And thar he foiornt xxiiijti days
 2156 In ryall fefting, as the auttore fays.
 So difcretly his puple he haith cherit,
 That he thar hartis holy haith *conquerit*.
 And *fir* gawan, helyt holl and found
 2160 Be xv dais he was of euery wounde;
 Right blyth therof in to the court war thei.

UR AGAIN BECOMES MOURNFUL.

And fo befell, the xxiiij [51](#) day,
 The king to fall in to o hewynes,
 2164 Right ate his table fiting at the meß;

that his heart is eased from
 fear;

but inquires if Galiot will win
 over the red knight, and what
 is his name.

The master evades reply.

[50](#) At the bottom of the
 page is the catch-word,
 “With that the king.”

[Fol. 27 a.]

* Text unchanged.
 Duplication does not fit
 metre, and another
 edition has ‘one to his’.
 ** Missing syllable?

The king and the host return
 home.

The king sojourns twenty-four
 days at Cardole, in Wales.

Sir Gawan is healed in fifteen
 days.

[51](#) MS. “xxviiij,” altered to
 “xxiiij.”

And *fir* gawan cummyth hyme before,
And laid hyme, “*fir*, yhour thocht is al to fore,
Confidering the diuerß knyghtis fere
2168 Ar of wncouth and strang landis here.”
The king anfuert, as in to matalent,
“*Sir*, of my thocht, or 3hit of myne entent,
Yhe have the wrang me to repref, for-quhy
2172 Thar lewith none that shuld me blam, for I
Was thinkand one the worthiest that lewynt,
That al the worfchip In to armys prewynt;
And how the thonk of my defens he had,
2176 And of the wow that galiot haith mad.
But I have fen, when that of my houfhold
Thar was, and of my falowfchip, that wold,
If that thei wift, quhat thing shuld me pleß,
2180 Thei wald noch leif for trawell nor for eß.
And fum tyme It prefwmyt was & laid,
That in my houfhold of al this world I had
The flour of knyghted and of chevalry;
2184 Bot now thar-of y fe the contrarye,
Sen that the flour of knyghted is away.”
“*Schir*,” *quod* he, “of Refone futh yhe fay;
And if god will, In al this world fo Round
2188 He fal be foght, if that he may he found.”

ANE'S EXPEDITION.

Than gawan goith *with* o knyghtly chere,
At the hal dure he faith In this maner:
“In this palag who lykith for to wend?
2192 It is o Iorne moft for to comend
That In my tyme In to the court fallith,
To knyghtis wich that chewellry lowith
Or trawell In to armys for to hant;

The king becomes mournful,
as he sits at the mess.

Gawan rebukes him.

The king answers in
“matalent,”

that he was thinking of the
worthiest knight living;

that he once had the flower of
knighthood in his household,
but now this flower is away.

[Fol. 27 b.]

Gawan departs to seek
Lancelot.

2196 And lat no knyght fra thyne-furth hyme awant
That it denyith;”—with that onon thei roß,
Al the knyghtis, and frome the burdis goß.

All the knights rise to go with him.

The king that fauch In to his hart was wo,
2200 And laid, “fir gawan, nece, why dois yow fo?
Knowis yow nocht I myne houfhold fuld encreß,
In knyghted, and in honore, and largeß?

Arthur reproves him.

And now yow thinkith mak me diffolat
2204 Of knyghtis, and my houß tranfulat,
To fek o knyght, and It was neuer more
Hard lich o femble makith o before.”

“Sir,” quod he, “als few as may yhow pless;
2208 For what I said was no thing for myne eß,
Nor for defir of falowfchip, for-why
To paß alone, but cumpany, think I;

Gawan explains.

And ilk knyght to paß o fundry way;
2212 The mo thei paß the fewar elchef thay,
Bot thus fhall pas no mo bot as yhow left.”

“Takith,” quod he, “of quhom 3he lykith beft,
Fourty in this pafag for to go;”

Arthur assigns him forty companions.

2216 At this command and gawan chelit fo
Fourty, quhich that he louit, & that was
Richt glaid in to his falowfchip to pas.

ANE AND HIS FELLOWS DEPART.

[A]nd furth thei go, and al anarmyt thei
2220 Come to the king, withouten more delay,
The relykis brocht, as was the maner tho,
When any knyghtis frome the court fuld go.
Or when the paffit, or quhen thei com, thei fwor
2224 The trouth to fchaw of euery aduentur.
Sir gawan knelyng to his falowis fais,
“Yhe lordis, wiche that in this feking gais,

These knights arm themselves,

and bring the relics, whereon to swear to shew the truth.

So many noble and worthi knyghtis ar þhe,
2228 Me think in wayne yhour trauel shuld nocht be,
For aduentur is non so gret to pref,
As I suppone, nor þhe sal It effchef,
And if þhe lyk as I that shal dewyß,
2232 Yhour oth to fwer In to the famyne wyß
Myne oith to kep;”—and that thei vndertak,
How euer so that he his oith mak
It to conferf, and that thei have all fworñ.
2236 Than gawan, wich that was the king beforñ,
On kneis fwore, “I sal the futh duclar
Of euery thing when I agan Repar,
Nor neuer more aþhane sal I returnñ,
2240 Nore in o place long for to fuiorñ
Whill that the knyght or verray evydens
I have, that shal be toknis of credens.”
His falowfchip abafit of that thing,
2244 And als therof anoyt was the king,

[Fol. 28 a.]

Gawane swears not to return
till he has found Lancelot, or
evidence of him.

ADY ASKS LANCELOT HIS NAME.

Sayng, “Nece, yow haith al foly vroght
And wilfulneß, that haith nocht in thi thoght
The day of batell of galot and me.”
2248 *Quod* gawan, “Now non other ways ma be.”
Thar-with he and his falowfchip also
Thar halmys lafit, on to ther horß thei go,
Syne tuk ther lef, and frome the court the fare,
2252 Thar names ware to long for to declar.
Now sal we leif hyme and his cumpany,
That in thar feking passith biffely;

Arthur reproves him for
forgetting the coming day of
battle.

Gawane says it must be so.

Gawane and his fellow lace
their helms, and take their
leave.

ANE AND HIS FELLOWS DEPART.

And of the lady of melyhalt we tell,

2256 *With whome the knyght mot ned alway duell.*

[52](#)[O] day she mayd hyme on to *hir prefens* fet,

And on o sege be-fid hir haith hyme fet,

“*Sir*, in keping I have yow halding long,”

2260 And thus sche laid, “for gret trespass & wrong,

Magre my Stewart, in worfchip, and for-thi

3he suld me thonk;”—“*madem*,” *quod* he, “and I

Thonk yhow so that euer, at my mycht,

2264 Whar-fo I pass that I sal be yhour knyght.”

“Grant mercy, *sir*, bot o thing I 3ow pray,

What that 3he ar 3he wold wicsauf to lay.”

“*Madem*,” *quod* he, “yhour mercy ask I, quhy

2268 That for to lay apone no wyß may I.”

“No! wil 3he not? non oyer ways as now

3he sal repent, and ek I mak awow

One to the thing the wich that I best love,

2272 Out frome my keping sal 3he not Remuf

Befor the day of the assamblee,

Wich that, o 3her, is nereft for to bee;

And if that 3ow haith plessit for to lay,

2276 3he had fore me deliuerit ben this day;

And I sal know, quheyer 3he wil or no,

For I furth-with one to the court sal go,

Whar that al thithingis goith & cumyth soñ.”

2280 “*Madem*,” *quod* he, “yhour plesance mot be doñe.”

With that the knyght one to his chalmer goith,

And the lady hir makith to be wroith

A3anis hyme, but futhly vas sche not,

2284 For he al-out was mor in to hir thoght.

Than schapith she a3ane the ferd day,

And richly sche gan hir-self aray;

Syne clepit haith apone her cufynes,

2288 And faith, “y will one to the court me dresß;

The story returns to the lady of Melyhalt.

[52](#) Room is here left in the MS. for an illuminated letter, and a small “o” inserted as a note.

She inquires Lancelot’s name.

He refuses to tell.

She vows to keep him in thrall till the day of combat;

[Fol. 28 b.]

and to go to the court to try and learn it.

The knight retires.

Before going to the court,

And malice I have schawin on to 3hon knycht,
 For-quhy he wold nocht schew me quhat he hicht,
 Bot so, I-wyß, It is nocht in my thocht,
 2292 For worthyar non In to this erth is wrocht.
 Tharfor I pray, and hartly I requer
 3he mak hyme al the cumpany and chere,
 And do hyme al the worschip and the eß,
 2296 Excep his honore, wich that may hym pleß;
 And quhen I cum deliuerith hyme als fre
 As he is now;”—“ne have no dred,” *quod* sche.
 [T]he lady *partit*, and hir lef hath ton,
 2300 And by hir Iorne to the court Is gon.

she prays her cousin to take care of him.

GOES TO SEE ARTHUR.

The king hapnit at logris for to bee,
 Wich of his realme was than the chef cete;
 And haith hir met, and In til hartly wyß
 2304 Refautit her, and welcummyt oft-fyß;
 And haith hir home one to his palice brocht,
 Whar that no dante nedith to be focht,
 And maid hir cher *with* al his ful entent.
 2308 Eft supir one to o chalmer ar thei went,
 The king and sche, and ek the quen al thre;
 Of hir tithandis at hir than alkit hee,
 And what that hir one to the court had brocht?
 2312 “Sir,” *quod* sche, “I come [53](#) not al for nocht;
 I have o frend haith o dereyne ydoo,
 And I can fynd none able knycht tharto;
 For he the wich that in the *contrar* Is
 2316 Is hardy, strong, and of gret kyne, I-wyß;
 Bot, It is laid, If I mycht have *with* me
 3our knycht, quich in the last assemble
 Was in the feld, and the red armys bur,

The lady meets Arthur at Logris;

who brings her home to his palace;

and inquires what has brought her.

[53](#) MS. “conne.”

She says she has a friend who has made a challenge,

[Fol. 29 a.]

2320 In his manhed y mycht my cauß affur;
And yhow, *sir*, richt hartly I exort
In to this ned my myfter to fupport.”

which the red knight could
best maintain.

UR CAN TELL HER NOTHING.

“Madem, by faith one to the quen I aw
2324 That I beft loue, the knyght I neuer faw
In nerneß by which that I hyme knew;
And ek gawane Is gan hyme for to few
With other fourty knyghtis In to cumpany.”

Arthur replies that Gawane is
gone to seek him.

2328 The lady fmylit at ther fanteffy;
The quen thar-with prefumyt wel that fche
Knew quhat he was, and laid, “madem, If 3he
Knowith of hyme what that he is, or quhar,
2332 We 3how befech til ws for to declar.”

The queen asks the lady if she
knows where he is.

“Madem,” *quod* fche, “now be the faith that I
Aw to the king and yhow, as for no why
To court I cam, but of hyme to Inquere;
2336 And fen of hyme I can no tithingis here,
Nedlyngis to-morn homwart mon I fair.”

She replies no, and proposes
to return.

“Na,” *quod* the king, “madem, our fon It waire;
3he fal remayne her for the qwenys fak;
2340 Syne fhall 3he of our beft knyghtis tak.”

Arthur prays her to stay.

“*Sir*,” *quod* fche, “I pray 3ow me excuß,
For-quhy to paß nedis me behuß;
Nor, fen I want the knyght which I have focht,
2344 Wtheris with me to have defir I nocht,
For I of otheris have that may fuffice.”

She remains till the third day.

Bot 3hit the king hir prayt on fich wyß,
That fche remanit whill the thrid day;
2348 Syne tuk hir leif to pafing hom hir way.
It nedis not the fefting to declar
Maid one to hir, nor company nor fare;

She is sumptuously
entertained,

Sche had no knyght, fche had no damyfeill,
2352 Nor thei richly rewardit war and well.
Now goith the lady homwart, and fche
In her entent defyrus Is to fee
The flour of knyghted and of chevelry;
2356 So was he pryfit and hold to euery wy.

and returns home.

LADY AGAIN SENDS FOR LANCELOT.

The lady, which one to hir palace come,
Bot of schort time remanith haith at home
When fche gart bryng, *withouten* Recidens,
2360 *With grete effere* this knyght to hir presens,
And laid hyme; “*fir*, so mekil have I *focht*
And knowith that be-for I knew *nocht*,
That If yhow lyk I wil yhour Ransone mak.”
2364 “Madem, gladly, wil zhe *wichslauf* to tak
Efter that as my powar may attein,
Or that I may *prowid* be ony meñ.”
“Now, *fir*,” fho laid, “forfuth It fal be so,
2368 Yhe fal have thre, and cheß yhow on of tho;
And if yhow lykith them for to refuß,
I can no mor, but zhe fal me excuß,
Yhe nedis mot fulten yhour aduentur
2372 Contynualy In ward for til endur.”
“Madem,” *quod* he, “and I yhow hartly pray,
What that thei say [54](#) zhe wald *wichslauf* to say?”
“[T]he firft,” *quod* fche, “who hath in to the cheñ
2376 Of low yhour hart, and if zhe may dereñ?
The next, yhour nam, the which ze fal not lye?
The thrid, if euer zhe think of cheualry
So mekil worfchip to atten in feild
2380 Apone o day in armys wnder fcheld,

[Fol. 29 b.]

Soon after, she sends for
Lancelot,

and proposes to ransom him,

on one of three conditions.

[54](#) So MS. We should
probably read “bee.”

Either he must tell whom he
loves,

or declare his name,

or say if he expects again to
equal his former exploits.

As yat 3he dyd the famyne day, when 3he
 In red armys was at the affemlee?”
 “Madem,” *quod* he, “is thar non vther way
 2384 Me to redem, but only thus to fay
 Of thingis, which that Rynyth me to blam,
 Me to awant my lady or hir name?
 But If that I moft schawin furth that one,
 2388 What suerte fchal I have for to gone
 At libertee out of this danger free?”
 “Schir, for to dred no myfter is,” *quod* fhee;
 “As I am trew and faithfull woman hold,
 2392 3he fal go fre quhen one of thir is told.”
 “Madem, yhour will non vther ways I may,
 I mone obey; and to the firft y fay,
 55[I]s, to declar the lady of myne hart,
 2396 My goft fal rather of my breft aftar”—
 Whar-by the lady fayndit al for nocht
 The lowe quhich long hath ben In to *his thocht*—
 “And of my nam, fchortly for to fay,
 2400 It ftondith fo that one no wyß I may.

He refuses to tell his lady’s name,

55 A space is here left for an illuminated letter.

or his own;

ELOT CLAIMS HIS LIBERTY;

Bot of the thrid, madem, I se that I
 Mon fay the thing that tuechith velany;
 For futh it is I traft, and god before,
 2404 In feld that I fal do of armys more
 Than euer I did, if I *commandit* bee.
 And now, madem, I have my libertee,
 For I have laid I neuer *thocht* to fay.”
 2408 “Now, *fir*,” *quod* fche, “when-euer 3he wil ye may;
 Bot o thing Is, I yhow hartly raquer,
 Sen I have hold yhow apone fuch maner
 Not as my fo, that 3he vald grant me till.”

[Fol. 30 a.]

but declares that he trusts to do more than ever before; and requires his liberty.

She begs of him a boon;

2412 “Madem,” *quod* he, “It *fal* be as *ʒhe* will.”

“Now, *fir*,” *quod* *ſche*, “it is no thing bot *ʒhe*

Remañ with ws wn to the affemble,

And euery thyng that In yhour myfter lyis

2416 I *fall* gar ordan at yhour awn dewyß;

And of the day I ſhall yow certefy

Of the affemble *ʒhe* *fal* not pas therby.”

“Madem,” *quod* he, “It *fal* be as yhow lift.”

2420 “Now, *fir*,” *quod* *ſche*, “and than I hald It beſt,

That *ʒhe* *remañ* lyk to the ſamyne dogre

As that *ʒhe* war, yat non *fal* wit that *ʒhe*

*Deliuere*it war; and in to ſacret wyß

2424 Thus may *ʒhe* be; and now yhe *fal* dewyß

What armys that yhow lykyth I gar mak.”

that he will remain with her
till the day of battle;

and inquires what arms he
would like to have made for
him. He chooses black
armour,

ASKS FOR BLACK ARMOUR.

“Madem,” *quod* he, “armys al of blak.”

With this, this knycht is to his chalmer goñ;

2428 The lady gan ful prewaly diſſpone

For al that longith to the knycht, in feild;

Al blak his horß, his armour, and his ſcheld,

That nedful is, al thing *ſche* well prewidith;

2432 And in hir keping thus *with* hir he bidith.

Suppos of love *ſche* takyne hath the charg,

Sche bur It clos, ther-of *ſche* vas not larg,

Bot wyfly *ſche* abſtenit hir diſſir,

2436 For ellis quhat, *ſche* knew, he was afyre;

Thar-for hir wit hir worſchip haith defendit,

For in this world thar was nan mor commendit,

Boith of diſcreccioun and of womanhed,

2440 Of *gouernans*, of nurtur, and of farhed.

This knycht *with* hir thus al this whil mon duell,

And furth of arthur ſumthing wil we tell—

which is provided.

She keeps her love close,

being commended for
discretion.

The story returns to Arthur—

[T]hat walkyng vas furth in to his Regiounis,
2444 And foiornt in his ceteis and his townis,
As he that had of vildome sufficyans.
He kepit the lore of maister amyntans
In ryghtwylnes, In felting and larges,
2448 In cherifing cumpany and hamlynes;

[Fol. 30 b.]

who obeys the counsel of
Amyntans,

UR'S LIBERALITY.

For he was biffy and was diligent,
And largely he iffith, and difpent
Rewardis, boith one to the pur & riche,
2452 And holdith fest throw al the 3her eliche.
In al the warld passing gan his name,
He chargit not bot of encreß and fañe,
And how his puples hartis to empleß;
2456 Thar gladnes ay was to his hart most eß.
He rakith not of riches nor treßfour,
Bot to difpend one worschip & honour;
He ifith riches, he ifith lond and rent,
2460 He cherißeþ them *with* wordis eloquent,
So that thei can them vtraly propone
In his seruice thar lyves to difpone:
So gladith themē his homely *contynans*,
2464 His cherifyng, his wordis of plesans,
His cumpany, and ek his mery chere,
His gret rewardis, and his iftis fere.
Thus hath the king non vthir befynes
2468 Bot cherifing of knyghtis and largeß,
To mak hyme-felf of honour be *commend*;
And thus the 3her he drywith to the ende.

and gives away largely;

and thus gains his people's
love.

EXPLICIT SECUNDA PARS, INCIPIT TERCIA
PARS.

[BOOK III.]

The long dirk pafag ⁵⁶ of the vinter, & the lycht

2472 Of phebus *comprochit* with his mycht;

The which, ascending In his altitud,

Awodith saturñ with his stormys Rude;

The soft dew one fra the hewyne doune valis ⁵⁷

2476 Apone the erth, one hillis and on valis,

And throw the fobir & the mwft hwmouris

Vp nurifit ar the erbis, and in the flouris

Natur the erth of many diuerß hew

2480 Our-fret, and cled with the tendir new.

The birdis may them hiding in the grawis

Wel frome the halk, that oft ther lyf berevis;

And scilla hie ascending in the ayre,

2484 That euery vight may heryng hir declar

Of the felfone the passing lustynes.

This was the tyme that phebus gan hym dref

In to the rame, and haith his courß bygown,

2488 Or that the trewis and the 3her vas Rown,

Which was y-fet of galiot and the king

Of thar affemble, and of thar meting.

Arthur haith a xv dais before

2492 Affemblit al his barnag and more

That weryng wnder his subieccioune,

Or louith hyme, or longith to his crown;

And haith his Iornay tone, withouten let,

2496 On to the place the wich that was y-fet,

Whar he hath found befor hyme mony o knycht

The sun ascends in his altitude.

⁵⁶ So MS. Should we read “pasith”?

The soft dew falls down from heaven.

⁵⁷ So MS. It should be “falís.”

Nature decks the earth with various hues.

[Fol. 31 a.]

The birds may hide them from the hawk in the groves, and Scilla may ascend in the air.

The time of combat between Galiot and the king drew near.

Arthur goes to the appointed place.

That cummyng war *with* al thar holl mycht,
Al enarmyt both *with* spere & scheld,
2500 And ful of lugis plantith haith the feld,
Hyme In the wer for to support and ferf
At al ther mycht, his thonk for to differf.

ANE REJOINS ARTHUR.

And gawan, which was in the feking 3hit
2504 Of the gud knyght, of hyme haith got no wit,
Remembrith hyme apone the kingis day,
And to his falowis one this wys can lay:
“To 3how is knowin the mater, in what wyß
2508 How that the king hath *with* his ennemys
A certan day, that now comprochit nere,
And one to ws war hewynes to here
That he var in to perell or in to dreid,
2512 And we away and he of ws haith neid;
For we but hyme no thing may elschef,
And he but ws in honore well may lef;
For, be he loft, we may no thing *with*stond,
2516 Our-self, our honore we tyne, & ek *our* lond.
Tharfor, I red we pas on to the king,
Suppos our oth It hurt in to sum thing,
And in the feld *with* hyme for til endur,
2520 Of lyf or deth and tak our aduentur.”
Thar-to thei ar consentit euerilkon,
And but dulay the have thar Iorney toñe.
When that the king them saw, in his entent
2524 Was of thar com Right wonder well content;
For he prefwmyt no thing that thei wold
Have cummyne, but one furth to yer feking hold.
And thus the kinghis oft affemblit has
2528 Azane the tyme, azaine the day that vas

Gawane remembers the day,

and proposes to his fellows to
go to help the king.

[Fol. 31 b.]

Arthur is well content at their
coming,

not expecting them.

Y-statut and ordanit for to bee,
And euery thing hath fet in the dogre.

[A]nd galiot, that haith no thing for3het
2532 The termys quhich that he befor had set,
Alfsemlit has, apone his best maner,
His folk, and al his other thingis fere,
That to o weryour longith to prouid,
2536 And is y-come apone the tothir fyde.
Whar he befor was one than vas he two,
And al his vthir artil3ery also
He dowblith hath, that merwell was to señ;
2540 And by the rewere lychtit one the greñ,
And fstronghar thane ony wallit toune
His oft y-bout yclofit in Randoune.
Thus war thei cummyne apone ather fyd
2544 Be-for the tyme, them-felf for to prowid.

TRUCE ENDS.

Or that the trewis was complet & rwn,
Men mycht have fen one euery fid begwn
Many a fair and knyghtly Iuperty
2548 Of lusty men, and of 3ong chevalry,
Difyrus In to armys for to pruf;
Sum for wynyng, sum caufith vas for luf,
Sum In to worfchip to be exaltate,
2552 Sum caufit was of wordis he & hate,
That lykit not ydill for to ben;
A hundereth pair at onis one the gren.
Thir lusty folk thus can thar tyme dispend,
2556 Whill that the trewis goith to the ende.
The trewis paf, the day is cummyne onone,
One euery fyd the can them to dispone;
And thai that war moft facret & moft dere

Galiot also assembles his folk,

doubling his army and
artillery;

and pitches on the green by
the river.

Before the truce is ended,

many combats are seen
between lusty men;

a hundred pair at once.

The truce past,

2560 To galiot, at hyme the can enquere,
 “Who fal affsemble one yhour fyd to-morñe?
 To-nycht the trewis to the end is worne.”
 He anfuerit, “As yhit one to this were
 2564 I ame awyflit I wil none armys bere,
 Bot If It ftond of more Necessitee;
 Nor to the feld will pas, bot for to fee
 Yhone knyght, the which that berith sich o fame.”
 2568 Than clepit he the *conquest* king be name,
 And hyme *commandit* xxx thoufand tak
 Azaine the morne, and for the feld hyme mak.
 And gawane haith, apone the toyer syde,
 2572 Confultit his Eme he fchuld for them prowid,
 And that he fchuld none armys to hyme tak
 Whill [58](#) galiot will for the feld hyme mak.
 “I grant,” *quod* [he [59](#)], “wharfor 3he mone difpone
 2576 Yhow to the feld *with* al my folk to-morne,
 And thinkith in yhour manhed and curage
 For to recift 3hone folkis gret owtrag.”

[T]he nycht is gone, vp goith the morow gray,
 2580 The brycht fone fo cherith al the day:
 The knyghtis gone to armys than, in haft;
 One goith the fcheildis and the helmys laft;
 Arthuris oft out our the furrde thai ryd.
 2584 And thai agane, apone the toyer syd,
 Affemblit ar apone o lufty greyne,
 In to o waill, whar fone thar mycht be feyne
 Of knyghtis to-gedder many o pair
 2588 In to the feld affemblyng her & thair,
 And ftedis which that haith thar mafter lorne; [60](#)
 The knyghtis war done to the erth doune borne.

Galiot's friends inquire who shall fight on his side on the morrow.

[Fol. 32 a.]

He commands the first-conquest king to take 30,000 men.

[58](#) MS. “Wihill.”

[59](#) Omitted in MS.

Gawane leads Arthur's forces.

The day comes.

Arthur's men cross the ford.

Galiot's men assemble in a vale.

[60](#) MS. has “borne.” We should read “lorne,” as in line 2092.

Sir esquyris, which was o manly knyght
2592 In to hyme-felf, and hardy vas & wycht;
And in till armys gretly for to pryß,
3hit he was pure, he prewit wel oft-fyß;
And that tyme was he of the cumpanee
2596 Of galiot, bot efterwart was hee
With arthur; and that day In to the feild
He come, al armyt boith with spere and scheld,
With ferß defir, as he that had na dout,
2600 And is affemblit ewyne apone a rowt;
His spere is gone, the knyght goith to the erd,
And out onon he pullith haith o fwerd;
That day In armys prewit he rycht well
2604 His strenth, his manhed; arthuris folk thai fell.

S OF SIR GWYANS.

Than galys gwynans, with o manly hart,
Which broyer was of ywane the bastart,
He cummyne Is onone one to the ftour
2608 For conquering In armys of honour,
And cownterit with esquyris hath so
That 61 horß and man, al four, to erth thai go;
And ftill o quhill lying at the ground.
2612 With that o part of arthuris folk thei found
Till gwyans, and haith hyme fone refkewit.
A3anis them til esquyris thei fewyt
Of galiotis well xxx^{ti} knyghtis & mo;
2616 Gwyans goith done, and vthir vij alfo,
The wich war tone & esqwyris relewit.
Than ywane the anterus, aggrewit,
With kynnifmen one to the melle focht.
2620 The hardy knyghtis, that one thar worfchip thocht,
Cownterit them In myddis of the scheld,

Sir Esquyris, a manly knight,

at that time of Galiot's
company,

attacks a band,

and proves his manhood.

Then Galys Gwynans, brother
of Ywan,

[Fol. 32 b.]

encounters him, and horse and
man go all four to earth.

61 MS. has "than."

Arthur's folk rescue Gwyans;

thirty knights of Galiot's
arrive, and rescue Esquyris.

Next Ywan comes to the
mêlée.

Whar many o knyght was born doñ in the feld;
 Bot thei wiche ware on galiotis part,
 2624 So wnder takand nor of so hardy hart
 Ne ware thei not as was in ye *contrare*.
 Sir galys gwyans was resqwyt thare
 With his falowis, and esqwyris don bore.
 2628 Thar al the batellis cam, *withouten* more,
 On ather part, and is assemblit fo
 Whar fyfty thoufand war thei, & no mo.
 In o plane befyd the gret Riwere
 2632 Xxx thoufand one galiotis half thei vare;
 Of arthuris x thoufand and no mo
 Thei ware, and 3hit thai *contenit* them fo
 And in the feld fo manly haith borñ,
 2636 That of thar fois haith the feld forfworñ.

AWANE'S INTREPIDITY.

The conquest king, wiche the perell knowith,
 Ful manly one to the feld he drowith;
 The lord *sir* gawan, couerit with his scheld,
 2640 He ruschit in myddis of the feld,
 And haith them fo in to his com assayt,
 That of his manhed ware thei al affrait;
 No langer mycht thei *contrar* hyme endur,
 2644 Bot fled, and goith one to discumfiture.
 And galiot, wiche haith the discumfit fen,
 Fulfillit ful of anger and of ten,
 Incontinent he send o new poware,
 2648 Whar-with the feldis al our-couerit ware
 Of armyt stedis both in plait and mail,
 With knyghtis wiche war reddy to assaill.
 Sir gawan, feing al the gret suppris
 2652 Of fois cummyng In to lich o wys,

Galiot's men give way.

Gwyans is again rescued.

50,000 men are assembled.

30,000 on Galiot's side
approach the river,

and 10,000 on Arthur's.

Gawane puts the conquest-
king to flight.

Galiot, full of anger and grief,
sends out a new band.

[Fol. 33 a.]

Gawane draws his men
together, and shews them

Togiddir al his cumpany he drew,
 And confortable wordis to them schew;
 So at the cummyng of thar ennemys
 2656 Thei them refauf, in fo manly wyß,
 That many one felith deithis wound,
 And wnder horß lyith sobing one the ground.
 This vther cummyth in to gret defir,
 2660 Fulfillit ful of matelent and Ire,
 So freschly, with fo gret o confluens,
 Thar strong affay hath don sich vyolens,
 And at thar come arthuris folk fo led,
 2664 That thai war ay abayfit and adred.
 Bot gawan, wich that, by this worldis fame,
 Of manhed and of knychthed bur the name,
 Haith prewit [hym] well be experiens;
 2668 For only In til armys his defens
 Haith maid his falowis tak sich hardyment,
 That manfully thei bidding one the bent.
 Of his manhed war merwell to raherß;
 2672 The knychtis throw the scheldis can he perß,
 That many one thar dethis haith refaut;
 None armour frome his mychty hond them sauit,
 3hit ay for one ther ennemys wor thre.
 2676 Long mycht thei nocht endur in such dugree;
 The preß it was so creuell & so strong,
 In gret anoy and haith continewit longe,
 That, magre them, thei nedis most abak
 2680 The way one to thar lugis for to tak.
 Sir gawan thar sufferith gret myschef,
 And wonderis in his knychthed can he pref;
 His falouschip haith merwell that hym saw,
 2684 So haith his fois that of his fuerd stund aw.

comfortable words.

They receive the foe in manly wise.

Gawane encourages his fellows,

though their foes are three to one;

yet his men are forced to retreat to their tents.

WAN RESCUES GAWANE.

King arthur, that al this whill beheld
The danger and the perell of the feld,
Sir ywan with o falowfchip he fende,
2688 Them In that ned to help & to defend,
Qwich fond them In to danger and in were,
And enterit nere In to thar tentis were.
Sir gawan fechtand was one fut At erde,
2692 And no defend, but only in his fwerde,
Azanis them both with fperre and fcheld.
Of galowa the knyght goith to the erde. [62](#)
Thar was the batell furyous and woud [63](#)
2696 Of armyt knyghtis; to the grownde thai 3hud.
Sir ywane, that was a noble knyght,
He fchew his ftrenth, he fchew thar *his gret mycht*,
In al his tyme that neuer of before
2700 Off armys, nore of knyghted, did he more:
Sir gawan thar refkewit he of fors,
Magre his fois, and haith hyme fet one horß
That frome the firft *conquest* king he wañ;
2704 Bot *fir gawan* fo ewill was wondit than,
And in the feld *fupprifit* was fo fore,
That he the werß thar-of was euermore.
Thar fchew the lord *fir ywan* his curage,
2708 His manhed, & his noble waffolage;
And gawan, in his doing, wald noch irk;

OF THE FIRST DAY'S BATTLE.

So al the day enduring to the dyrk
Sal them, magre of thar defyre, *constren*
2712 On ayar half fore [to] depart in twen.
And when that gawan of his horß vas toñ,
The blud out of his noiß & mouth is goñ,

Arthur beholds the peril of the field, and sends Sir Ywan to help them,

[Fol. 33 b.]

who finds Sir Gawane fighting on foot with only his sword.

[62](#) Read “felde”?

The battle was furious and wood.

[63](#) MS. “woid,” but the “i” is undotted, and is therefore perhaps meant for the first stroke of a “u.”

Sir Ywan rescues Sir Gawane,

who was so evilly wounded, that he was the worse thereof evermore.

Darkness parts the combatants.

And largely so passith euery wounde,
2716 In fwoyng thore he fell one to the ground:
Than of the puple petee was to here
The lemytable clamour, and the chere;
And of the king the sorow and the care,
2720 That of his *necis* lyf was in diffpare.
“Far well,” he fais, “my gladnes, & my delyt,
Apone knyghted far well myne appetit,
Fare well of manhed al the gret curage,
2724 Yow flour of armys and of vassolage,
Gif yow be loft!”—thus til his tent hymne brocht
With wofull hart, and al the furreynis focht,
Wich for to cum was reddy at his neid;
2728 Thai fond the lord was of his lyf in dreid,
For wondit was he, and ek wondit so,
And in his fynd ware brokyne Ribys two.
Bot nocht for-thi the king thai maid beleif
2732 That at that tyme he shuld the deith eschef.

[O]ff melynalt the ladyis knyghtis were
In to the feld, and can thir tithingis here,
And home to thar lady ar thai went,
2736 Til hir to schewing efter thar entent,
In euery poynt, how that the batell stod
Of galiot, and of his multitud;
And how gawan hymne in the feld hath born,
2740 Throw quhoys swerd so many o knyght vas
lorn,
And of the knyghtly wonderis that he wrocht,
Syne how that he one to his tent vas brocht.
The lady hard, that lowit gawan so,
2744 She gan to wep, in to [64](#) hir hart vas wo.
Thir tythyngis one to lancelot ar goñ,
Whar-of that he was wonder wo-bygone,

Sir Gawane swoons,

so that the king despairs of his
“niece’s” life, and laments
over him.

The surgeons are sought,

who found he had two broken
ribs, but no mortal wound.

[Fol. 34 a.]

The lady of Melynalt’s
knights tell her how the battle
went,

and how Gawane bare him in
the field, and of his wounds.

She weeps for him.

[64](#) MS. “in in”; but “in to”
is clearly meant.

And for the lady haftely he sent,
2748 And ſche til hyme, at his command, Is went:
He ſaluſt hir, and ſaid, “madem, Is trew
Thir tithingis I her report of new
Of the aſſemble, and meting of the oft,
2752 And of *fir* gawan, wich that ſhuld be loſt?

Lancelot requests to see the lady;

and inquires if Gawane is really likely to die.

ELOT’S LAMENT FOR GAWANE.

If that be fwth, adew the flour of armys,
Now neuermore recoueryt be the harmys!
In hyme was manhed, curteſſy, and trouth,
2756 Bely trawell In knyghted, ay but fleuth,
Humilyte, [and] gentrice, and cwrag;
In hyme thar was no maner of outrage.
Allace! knyght, allace! what ſhal yow ſay?
2760 Yow may complen, yow may bewail the day
As of his deith, and gladſchip aucht to ſes,
Baith menſtrafy and feſting at the des;
For of this lond he was the holl comfort,
2764 In tyme of ned al knyghted to ſupport!
Allace! madem, and I durſt ſay at þhe
Al yhour beheft not kepit haith to me,
Whar-of that I was in to full belef
2768 Aþaþne this day that I ſchuld have my lef,
And nocht as cowart thus ſchamfully to ly
Excludit in to cage frome chewalry,
Whar othir knyghtis anarmyt on thar ſtedis
2772 Hawntis ther þhouthhed in to knyghtly dedis.”
“Sir,” quod ſche, “I red yhow not diſpleß,
þhe may In tyme her-eſter cum at es;

He laments over him,

first apostrophizing himself,

and next blaming the lady for not having allowed him to be present in the battle.

[Fol. 34 b.]

ELOT PREPARES FOR BATTLE.

For the thrid day Is ordanit, & ſhal be

2776 Of the oftis a new assemble,
And I have gart ordan al the gere
That longith to 3our body for to were,
Boith horß and armour In the famyne wyß
2780 Of fable, ewyne aftir 3hour awn dewyß;
And yhe fal her remayne one to the day;
Syne may 3he paß, fore well 3he know the way.”
“I will obey, madem, to yhour entent.”
2784 With that fche goith, and to hir reft is went:
One the morn arly vp fche roß
Without delay, and to the knyght fche gois,
And twk hir lef, and laid that fcho vald fare
2788 On to the court, *with*-outen any mare.
Than knelit he, and thankit hir oft-fys,
That fche fo mych hath done hyme of gentriß,
And hir byhecht euer, at his myght,
2792 To be hir awn trew & ftedfaft knyght.
Sche thonkith hyme, and fyne fche goith *her* way
On to the king, *with*-owten more delay,
Whar that in [65](#) honour *with* king & qwen fche fall
2796 Ryght thankfully refautit be *with*-all.
Eft to fir gawan thai hir led, & fche
Ryght gladly hyme defyrit for to see,
And fche hyme fond, and fche was glad tharfore,
2800 All vthir ways than was hir told before.
The knyght, the wiche in to hir keping vas,
Sche had *commandit* to hir cuffynece,
Wich cherift hyme apone hir beft manere,
2804 And comfort hyme, and maid hym ryght gud chere.

[T]he days goith, fo paffith als the nycht,
The thrid morow, as that the fone vas lyght,
The knyght onon out of his bed aroß,
2808 The maden fone one to his chalmer goß,

She promises he shall go to
the next battle,

saying that his sable armour is
ready.

In the morn she takes her
leave, to go to the court.

He kneels, and thanks her
often.

She goes unto the king,

[65](#) MS. “*with*,” which is
crossed out, and “*in*”
inserted above, rather
minutely written.

and finds Sir Gawane quite
different from what had been
told her.

The lady’s cousin cherishes
Lancelot in her best manner.

The third day, the maiden
goes to his chamber, and
fastens on his armour.

And facretly his armour one hyme spent.
He tuk his lef, and syne his way he went
Ful prewaly, rycht to the samyne greñ
2812 One the rewere, whar he befor had ben,
Ewyne as the day [he] the first courß hath maad.
Alone rycht thar he howit, and abaade,
Behalding to the bertes, whar the qweñ
2816 Befor at the assamble he had señ
Rycht so the fone schewith furth his lycht,
And to his armour went is euery wycht;
One athir half the Iusting is bygon,
2820 And many o fair and knychn[t]ly courß is rown.
The blak knyght 3hit howyns on his fted,
Of al thar doing takith he no hed,
Bot ay, apone the befynes of thocht,
2824 In beholding his ey departit nocht.

QUEEN BEHOLDS THE BLACK KNIGHT.

To quhom the lady of melyhalt beheld,
And knew hyme by his armour & his scheld,
Qwhat that he was; and thus sche laid one hycht:
2828 “Who is he 3one? who may he be, 3hone knyght,
So ftill that hovith and fterith not his Ren,
And feith the knyghtis rynyng one the greñ?”
Than al beholdith, and in princypale
2832 Sir gawan beholdith moft of all;
Of melyha[l]t the lady to hyme maid
Incontinent, his couche and gart be had
Be-fore o wyndew thore, as he mycht se
2836 The knyght, the oft, and al the assamble.
He lukith furth, and fone the knyght hath fen,
And, but delay, he faith one to the qwen,
“Madem, if 3he remembir, so it was

He goes to the same green,
beside the river, as before.

[Fol. 35 a.]

He abides there alone, looking
towards the parapet where he
saw the queen.

The jousting begins.

The black knight still halts on
his steed.

The lady beholds him and
knows him; but yet inquires
who he is,

thus calling the attention of
Gawane,

who saith to the queen:

2840 The red knyght in to the famyne place
 That wencuft al [at] the first affemble;
 Whar that 3one knyght howis, howit hee.”
 “3ha,” *quod* the qwen, “rycht well remembir I;
 2844 Qwhat is the cauß at 3he inquere, & quhy?”
 “Madem, of [al] this larg world is he
 The knyght the wich I most defir to fee
 His strenth, his manhed, his curag, and his mycht,
 2848 Or do in armys that longith to o knyght.”

ORDER OF BATTLE.

[B]y thus, arthur, *with* confell well awyfit,
 Haith ordanit his batellis, and dewyfit:
 The firft of them led ydrus king, & he
 2852 O worthy man vas nemmyt for to bee.
 The fecund led harwy the Reweyll,
 That in this world was knyght that had moft feill
 For to *prowid* that longith to the were,
 2856 One agit knyght, and well couth armys bere.

[T]he thrid feld [he] deliuerit in the hond
 Of angus, king of ylys of scotlande,
 Wich cufing was one to king arthur nere,
 2860 One hardy knyght he was, *withouten* were.
 The ferd batell led ywons the king,
 O manly knyght he was In to al thing.
 And thus dewyfit ware his batellis fere,
 2864 In euery feld xv thoufand were.

[T]he fift [66](#) batell the lord *fir* ywan lede,
 Whois manhed was in euery cuntre dred,
 Sone he was one to wryne the kyng,
 2868 Forwart, ftout, hardy, wyß, and 3hing;
 Xx thoufand in his oft thai paft,
 Wich ordanit was for to affemble laft.

“Madam, remember that the red knight halted where yon knight halts.”

“Why do you inquire?” she replies.

“He is the knight, madam, whom I most desire to see.”

Arthur arranges his lines of battle.

King Ydrus leads the first;

Harwy the Reweyll, an aged knight, the second.

[Fol. 35 b.]

King Angus, a cousin of Arthur, leads the third.

King Ywons the fourth.

In every company are 15,000.

[66](#) MS. “firft.” See [l. 2870](#).

The lord Sir Ywan leads the rearguard.

[A]nd galiot, apone the tothir fyde,
2872 Rycht wyfly gan his batellis to dewid.
The firft of them led malenginys the king,
None hardyar In to this erth lewyng;
He neuer more out of his cuntre Raid,
2876 Nor he with hyme one hundereth knychtis hade.

Galiot's armies.

Malenginys leads the first
line;

[T]he fecund the first-conqueft king led,
That for no perell of armys vas adred;
The thrid, o king clepit walydeyne,
2880 He led, and was o manly knycht, but weyne.

the first-conquest king the
second; Walydeyne the third;

[T]he ferd, king clamedeus has,
Wich that lord of far ylys was.
The fift [67](#) batell, whar xl thouland were,
2884 King brandymagus had to led and ftere,
O manly knycht, and prewit well oft-fyß,
And in his confell wonder fcharp & wyß.
Galiot non armys bur that day,
2888 Nor as o knycht he wald hyme-felf aray,
But as o feruand in o habariowne,
O prekyne hat, and ek o gret trownfciowñ
In til his hond, and one o curfour fet,
2892 The beft that was in ony lond to get.
Endlong the rewar men mycht behold & fee,
Of knychtis weryne mony one affemble;
And the blak knycht ftill he couth abyde,
2896 Without remowyng, one the Riwer fyde,
Bot to the bartes to behold and fee
Thar as his hart defyrit moft to bee:

Clamedeus the fourth;

and King Brandymagus the
fifth.

[67](#) MS. "firft."

Galiot bore no arms;

but was arrayed as a servant
in a habergeon with a
"prekyne" hat, and a
truncheon in his hand.

The black knight still remains
looking towards the parapet.

FIRST MESSAGE TO THE BLACK KNIGHT.

And quhen the lady of melyhalt haith feñ
2900 The knycht fo ftond, fche laid one to the qweñ,
"Madem, It is my confell at 3he send

The lady says to the queen—

[Fol. 36 a.]

One to 3one knyght, 3our-felf for to *commend*,
 Befeching hyme that he wald wndertak
 2904 This day to do of armys, for 3our lak.”
 The quen anfuerit as that hir lykit nocht,
 For othir thing was more In to hir thocht,
 “For well 3he fe the perell how disio[i]nt,
 2908 The adwentur now ftondith one the point
 Boith of my lord his honore, and his lond,
 And of his men, in [68](#) danger how thai ftond:
 Bot 3he, and ek thir vthere ladice may,
 2912 If that yhow lykith, to the knyght gar fay
 The mefag; is none that wil yhow let,
 For I tharof fal nocht me entermet.”
 On to the quen fcho faith, “her I,
 2916 If fo it pleß thir vthir ladice by,
 Am for to fend one to the knyght *content*;
 And al the ladice can thar-to affent,
 Befeching hir the mefag to dewyß,
 2920 As fche that was moft prudent & moft wyß.
 Sche grantit, and o madeñ haith thai tone,
 Difcret, apone this mefag for till gone;
 And fir gawan a fqwyar bad alfo,
 2924 *With* two fperis one to the knyght to go.
 The lady than, *withouten* more dulay,
 Haith chargit hir apone this wyß to fay:
 “Schaw to the knyght, the ladice euer-ilkone
 2928 Ben In the court, excep the quen allon,
 Til hyme them haith recommandit oft-fyß,
 Befeching hyme of knyghthed and gentriß,
 (Or if It hapyne euermore that he fhall
 2932 Cum, quhar thai may, owther an or all,
 In ony thing awail hyme or fupport,
 Or do hyme ony plefans or comfort,)

“Madam, pray commend yourself to yon knight.”

The queen replies

[68](#) Stevenson reads “the”; but “the” is crossed out, and “in” written over it.

that the lady and the rest may send a message, but that she will not herself take part in it.

The lady sends a discreet maiden,

and Sir Gawane a squire, with two spears,

to say that all the ladies, the queen alone excepted, commend them to the black knight,

He wold wichfaif for loue of them this day
2936 In armys fum manhed to affay;
And say, *fir* gawan hyme the *ſperis* ſent;
Now go, this is the fek of our entent.”
The damyſell ſche hath hir palfray tone,
2940 The ſqwyar *with* the *ſperis with* hir goñ;
The *nereſt* way thai paß one to ye knyght,
Whar ſche repete hir meſag haith ful rycht:

ANCELOT IS NOT CONTENT.

And quhen he hard, and planly wnderſtude,
2944 How that the quen not in the meſag ʒude,
He ſpak no word, bot he was not *content*;
Bot, of *fir* gawan, glaid in his entent,
He alkit quhar he was, and of *his* fair?
2948 And thai to hyme the maner can duclair;
Than the ſqwyar he prayth that he wold
Paß to the feld, the *ſperis* for to hold.
He ſaw the knyghtis ſemblyng her and thare,
2952 The ſtedis Rynyng *with* the ſadillis bare;
His ſpuris goith in to the ſtedis syde,
That was ful ſwyft, and lykit not to byd;

SETS UP SIR GAWANE’S TWO SPEARS.

And he that was hardy, ferß, and ftout,
2956 Furth by o ſyd aſſemblyng on a rout
Whar that one hundereth knyghtis was, & mo;
And *with* the firſt has Recounterit ſo,
That frome the deth not helpith hym his ſcheld,
2960 Boith horß and man is lying in the feld;
The ſpere is gone, and al in pecis brak,
And he the trunſcyoune in his hand hath tak
That two or thre he haith the ſadillis reft,

and pray him to essay some
deed of arms.

The damsel and squire

[Fol. 36 b.]

repeat the message.

Sir Lancelot, finding the
queen not in the message,

was not content,

but asks the squire to hold the
two spears ready for him.

He attacks a company of a
hundred knights, slays the
nearest,

and with the stump of his
spear bereaves two or three of

2964 Whill in his hond ſchortly no thing is left.
 Syne, to the ſquyar, of the feld is goñ,
 Fro hyme o ſpere In to his hond haith ton,
 And to the feld returnyt he aʒayne:
 2968 The firſt he met, he goith one the plan,
 And ek the next, and ſyne the thrid alſo;
 Nor in his hond, nore in his ſtrak was ho.
 His ennemys that veryng In affray
 2972 Befor his ſtrok, and makith rovm alway;
 And in ſich wyß ay in the feld he vrocht,
 Whill that his ſperis gon var al to nocht;
 Whar-of ſir gawan berith vitneſing
 2976 Throw al this world that thar vas non levyng,
 In ſo ſchort tyme ſo mych of armys wrocht.
 His ſperis gone, out of the feld he ſocht,
 And paſſit is one to the Rewere syde,
 2980 Rycht thore as he was wont for to abyde;
 And ſo beholdyne In the ſamyne plañ,
 As to the feld hyme lykit nocht aʒañ.

their saddles.

He takes a new spear from the squire, and overthrows three knights.

His spears gone, he returns to his first position.

[Fol. 37 a.]

SECOND MESSAGE TO THE BLACK KNIGHT.

Sir gawan law, and faith on to the quen,
 2984 “Madem, yhone knyght diſponit [not], ⁶⁹ I
 weyñ,
 To help ws more, fore he ſo is awyfit;
 As I prefume, he thinkith hyme diſpifit
 Of the meſag that we gart to hyme mak;
 2988 Yhowre-ſelf yhe have ſo ſpecialy out-tak,
 He thinkith ewill contempnit for to bee,
 Conſidering how that the neceſſitee
 Moſt prinſpally to yhowr ſupporting lyis.
 2992 Tharfor my conſell is, yhow to dewyß,
 And ek ʒhowre-ſelf in yhowr treſpas accuß,

Sir Gawane says to the queen:

“Madam, yon knight thinks himself despised, because you so specially excepted yourself in the message;

⁶⁹ “not” seems required.

And ask hyme mercy, and yhour gilt excuß.

For well it oucht o prince or o king

2996 Til honore and til cheriß in al thing

O worthi man, that is in knyghted prewit.

For throw the body of o man eschevit

Mony o wondir, mony one aduenture,

3000 That merwell war til any creature.

And als oft-tyme is boith hard & fen,

Quhar xl thouland haith discumfit ben

Vith v thouland, and only be o knyght;

3004 For throw his strenth, his vorschip, & his
mycht,

His falowship sich comfort of hym tais

That thai ne dreid the danger of thar fays.

And thus, madem, I wot, *withouten* were,

3008 If that 3hone knyght this day will *perfywere*

With his manhed for helping of the king,

We fal have cauß to dred in to no thing.

Our folk of hyme thai fal sich comfort tak,

3012 And so adred thar ennemys fal mak,

That fur I am, onys or the *nycht*,

Of forß 3hone folk fal tak one them the *flycht*:

Wharffor, madem, that 3he have gilt to mend,

3016 My confell is one to 3hon knyght 3e fend.”

“*Sir*,” *quod* sche, “quhat plessith yhow to do

3he may dewyß, and I consent thar-to.”

Than was the lady of melyhalt *content*,

3020 And to *fir* gawan in-to-*contynent*

Sche clepit the maid, wich that passit ar;

And he hir bad the mesag thus duclar.

“Say [to] [70](#) the knyght, the quen hir recommendith,

3024 And fal correk in quhat that sche offendith

At his awn will, how so hyme lift dewyß;

ask him mercy, therefore, and
excuse your guilt.

For often, by one knight’s
prowess, have 40,000 been
worsted by 5,000.

If yon knight will continue to
help the king,

yon folk shall perforce take to
flight.”

She consents to send a
message.

[Fol. 37 b.]

A maiden is therefore sent to
say,

[70](#) “to” seems required.

And hyme exortith, in most humyll wyß,
As euer he will, whar that sche can or may,
3028 Or powar haith hir charg, be ony way,
And for his worschip and his hie manhede,
And for hir luf, to helpen *in* that ned
The kingis honore, his land fore to preferf,
3032 That he hir thonk for euer may deferf.”

that the queen humbly exhorts
him

to help in that need to
preserve the king’s honour,
and to deserve her thanks.

AWANE SENDS HIM TEN SPEARS MORE.

And four squyaris chargit he alfo
With thre horsß and speris x to go
Furth to the knyght, hyme prayng for his lak,
3036 At his raquest thame in his ned to tak.

Sir Gawane also sends four
squires with three horses and
ten spears.

[T]he maden furth *with* the squyaris is went
One to the knyght, and schawith *yar* entent.
Tho mefag hard, and ek ye present señ,
3040 He anwerit, and alkith of the qwen;
“Sir,” *quod* sche, [“sche” [71](#) in to þhone bartiis lyis,
Whar that this day yhour dedis sal dewyß,
Yhowr manhed, yhour worschip, and affere,
3044 How þhe *conten*, and how yhe armys bere;
The quen hir-felf, and many o lady to,
Sal Iugis be, and vitnes how yhe do.”

The message heard, he
inquires about the queen,

and is told that from yon
parapet she can witness his
deeds.

[71](#) A second “sche” is here
required.

Than he, whois hart stant in o new aray,
3048 Saith, “damyceyll, on to my lady say,
How euer that hir lykith that it bee,
Als far as wit or powar is in me,
I am hir knyght, I sal at hir *command*
3052 Do at I may, *with*outen more demand.
And to *sir* gawan, for his gret gentriß,
Me recommend and thonk a thousand fyß.”
With that o sper he takith in his hond,
3056 And so in to his sterapis can he stond

He returns a message that he
is the queen’s knight.

That to *fir* gawan femyth that the knyght
Encrefyng gon o larg fut one hycht;
And to the ladice faith he, and the qwen,
3060 “*Þ*hon is the knyght that euer I have fen
In al my tyme moft knyghtly of affere,
And in hyme-felf gon fareft armys bere.”

He stands in his stirrups; and
seems to increase a foot in
height.

BLACK KNIGHT'S CHARGE.

[T]he knyght that haith Remembrit in his thocht
3064 The qwenys chargis, & how *ſ*che hym beſocht,
Curag can encreſing to his hart;
His curſer lap, and gan onon to ſtart;
And he the ſqwaris haith reqwyrit ſo,
3068 That thai *with* hyme one to the feld wald go.
Than goith he one, *withouten* mor abaid,
And our the reuar to the feld he raid;
Don goith his ſpere onone In to the Reſt,
3072 And in he goith, *withouten* mor areſt,
Thar as he ſaw moſt perell and moſt dred
In al the feld, and moſt of help [72](#) had ned,
Whar ſemblyt was the firſt-*conqueſt* king
3076 *With* mony o knyght that was in his leding.
The firſt he met, doune goith boith horſ & man;
The ſper was holl, and to the next he Rañ
That helpit hyme his hawbrek nor his ſcheld,
3080 Bot throuch and throuch haith perfit *in* the feld.

[Fol. 38 a.]
Greatly encouraged,

without delay he crosses over
the river to the field;

and goes in wherever he sees
most peril.

[72](#) MS. “held.”

He overthrows two knights.

NIGHTS FOLLOW HIM.

Sir kay, the wich haith this encontyr fen,
His horſ he ſtrekith our the larg gren,
And *fir* ſygramors ek the deſyrand,
3084 *With ſir* greſown cummyth at *yar* honde,
Son of the duk, and alſua *fir* ywan

Sir Kay, Sir Sygramors, Sir
Gresown, Sir Ywan, Sir
Brandellis, and Gahers, all six
in a race spur across the field
with stretched spears,

The baltart, and *fir* brandellis onan,
 And gaherß, wich that broyir was
 3088 To gawan; thir sex in a Raß
 Deliuerly com prekand our the feldis
 With speris ltraucht, and couerit *with* thar scheldis;
 Sum for love, sum honor to purcherß,
 3092 And aftir them one hundereth knyghtis was,
 In famyne will, thar manhed to assay.
 On his v falowis clepit than *fir* kay,
 And faith them, “*firis*, thar has 3honder ben
 3096 A courß that neuer-more farar was sen
 Maid be o knyght, and we ar cummyn ilkon
 Only ws one [his] worfchip to dispone;
 And neuer we in al our dais mycht
 3100 Have bet axampil than iffith ws 3one knyght
 Of well doing; and her I hecht for me
 Ner hyme al day, if that I may, to bee,
 And folow hyme at al [my] mycht I fall,
 3104 Bot deth or vthir adwentur me fall.”
 With that thir sex, al in one assent,
 With fresch curag In to the feld Is went.
 The blak knyghtis spere in pecis goñe,
 3108 Frome o sqwyar oñe vthir haith he toñe,
 And to the feld onone he goith ful rycht;
 Thir sex *with* hyme ay holdith at *yar* mycht.
 And than bygan his wonderis in the feld;
 3112 Thar was no helme, no hawbryk, nore no scheld,
 Nor yhit no knyght so hardy, ferß, nore stout,
 No 3hit no maner armour mycht hald owt
 His strenth, nore was of powar to *withstond*;
 3116 So mych of armys dyde he *with* his honde,
 That euery wight ferleit of *his* deid,
 And al his fois stondith ful of dreid.

and 100 knights after them.

Sir Kay exhorts them

to keep near the black knight,
and follow his guidance all
day.

[Fol. 38 b.]

With a second spear, the black
knight seeks the field, closely
followed by the six.

No knight nor armour can
withstand him.

Every wight wonders at his
deeds.

So befely he can his tyme dispend,
3120 That of the speris wich *sir* gawan fend,
Holl of them all thar was not lewit oñe;
Throw wich but mercy to the deyth is gon
Ful many o knycht, and many o weriour,
3124 That couth fulten ful hardely o stour.
And of his horß supprifit ded ar two,
One of his awn, of gawanis one also,
And he one fut was fechtand one the gren,
3128 When that *sir* kay haith with his falowis feñ;
The sqwyar with his horß than to hym brocht;
Magre his fois he to his courfeir focht
Deliuerly, as of o mychty hart,
3132 Without steropis in to his fadill start,
That euery wycht beholding mervell has
Of his strenth and deliuer befynes.

AY ASKS WHO THE BLACK KNIGHT IS.

Sir kay, feing his horß, and how that thai
3136 War cled in to *sir* gawanis aray,
Alkith at the sqwyar if he knewith
What that he was, this knycht? & he hym schewith
He wist no thing quhat that he was, nore hee
3140 Befor that day hyme neuer saw with Ee.
Than alkith he, how and one quhat wyß
On gawanis horß makith hyme sich seruice?
The sqw[y]ar faith, “forfuth y wot no more;
3144 My lord ws bad, I not the cauß quharfore.”
The blak knycht, horlit, to the feld can sew
Als fresch as he was in the morow new;
The sex falowis folowit hyme ilkone,
3148 And al in front on to the feld ar goñ;
Rycht freschly one thar ennemys thai foght,

He uses up all Gawane’s
spears.

Two horses of his are killed,
and he fights on foot.

The squire brings him a fresh
horse;

he leaps into the saddle
without stirrups.

Sir Kay asks who he is,

but the squire cannot tell.

The black knight returns to
the field.

The six comrades follow him.

[Fol. 39 a.]

And many o fair poynt of armys vroght.

[T]han hapnyt to king malangins oft
3152 By ydras king discumfit was, & loft,
And fled, and to the conquest-king ar goñe,
Thar boith the batellis assemblit In to one;
King malengynis in to his hart was wo,
3156 For of hyme-self no better knyght mycht go;

Thar xl thousand war thai for xv.
Than mycht the feld ryght perellus be fen
Of armyt knyghtis gaping one the ground;
3160 Sum deith, and sum *with* mony a grewous wond;
For arthuris knyghtis, that manly war and gud,
Suppos that vthir was o multitude,
Refautit tham well at the speris end;
3164 But one such wyß thai may not lang defend.

Malangin's host is
discomfited by king Ydras;
and retreats to join the second
line, commanded by the
Conquest-king;

so that 40,000 are now
opposed to 15,000 of
Arthur's.

3LACK KNIGHT'S PROWESS.

The blak knyght saw the danger of the feld,
And al his doingis knowith quho beheld,
And ek remembrith in to his entent
3168 Of the mesag that sche haith to hyme sent:
Than curag, strenth encrefing *with* manhed,
Ful lyk o knyght one to the feld he raid,
Thinking to do his ladice love to have,
3172 Or than his deth befor hir to refave.
Thar he begynyth in his ferß curag
Of armys, as o lyoun in his rag;
Than merwell was his doing to behold;
3176 Thar was no knyght so strong, nor yhit so bold,
That in the feld befor his fuerd he met,
Nor he so hard his strok apone hyme set,
That ded or wondit to the erth he focht;
3180 For thar was not bot wonderis that he wrocht.

The black knight, knowing
who is beholding him,

thinks to have his lady's love,
or die before her.

And magre of his fois euerilkone,
 In to the feld oft tymys hyme aloñ
 Throuch and throuch he passith to & fro;
 3184 For in the ward [73](#) it was the maner tho
 That non o knyght shuld be the brydill tak
 Hyme to orest, nore cum behynd his bak,
 Nor mo than on at onys one o knyght
 3188 Shuld strik, for that tyme worfchip stud fo rycht.
 3hit was the feld rycht perellus and strong
 Till arthuris folk, fet thai *contenyt* longe;
 Bot in sich wyß this blak knyght can *conten*,
 3192 That thai, the wich that hath his manhed señ,
 Sich hardyment haith takyne In his ded,
 Them thocht thai had no maner cauß of dred,
 Als long as he mycht owthir ryd or go,
 3196 At euery ned he them recomfort fo.
Sir kay haith *with* his falowis al the day
 Folowit hyme al that he can or may,
 And wondir well thai have in armys prewit,
 3200 And *with* thar manhed oft thar folk relewit;
 Bot well thai faucht in diuerß placis sere,
With multitud *yar* folk confufit were,
 That long in sich wyß mycht thai nocht *conten*.

AY'S MESSAGE TO SIR HARWY.

3204 *Sir* kay, that hath *fir* gawans qfquyaris sen,
 He clepit hyme, and haith hyme prayt fo,
 That to *fir* harwy the rewell wil he go,
 And say to hyme, “ws think hyme ewil awyfit;
 3208 For her throuch hyme he sufferit be supprifit
 The best knyght that euer armys bur;
 And if it so befell of adwentur,
 In his defalt, that he be ded or lamyt,

He works nothing but wonders;

and often passes alone through the field.

[73](#) Another spelling of *world*, i.e. world, which occurs in the fuller form in [l. 3212](#).

[Fol. 39 b.]

He fights in such wise as to encourage all who see his deeds.

Sir Kay and his fellows follow him all day.

But at last they are nearly all overpowered by numbers.

Sir Kay sends Gawane's squire with a message to Sir Harwy that he ought not to suffer the best knight that ever bore arms to be surprised,

3212 This world fal have hyme vtraly defamyt.

And her ar of the round table alfo

A faloufchip, that fall in well and wo

Abid with hyme, and furth for to endur

3216 Of lyf or deth, this day, thar adwentur;

And if fo fal difcumfyt at thai bee,

The king may fay that wonder ewill haith he

Contentit hyme, and kepit his honore,

3220 Thus for to tyne of chevalry the flour!”

The fqw[y]ar hard, and furth his way Raid,

In termys fchort he al his mefag laid.

Sir harwy faith, “y wytneß god, that I

3224 Neuer in my days comytit tratory,

And if I now begyne In to myne eld,

In ewill tyme fyrft com I to this feld;

Bot, if god will, I fal me fon difcharg.

3228 Say to fir kay, I fal not ber the charg,

He fal no mater have me to rapref,

I fal amend this mys if that I lef.”

The fqwyar went and tellit to fir kay;

nor six knights of the Round
Table to be difcomfited.

The squire takes the message.

Sir Harwy says that Sir Kay
shall have no cause to reprove
him.

OT'S FOLK ARE WORSTED.

3232 **A**nd fir harwy, in al the haft he may,

Affemblyt hath his oftis, & onon

In gret defyre on the feld is gon

Before his folk, and haldith furth his way;

3236 Don goith his fper, and ewyne before fir kay

So hard o knycht he ftrykith in his ten

That horß and he lay boith apone the gren.

Sir gawan faw the counter that he maad,

3240 And leuch for al the farues that he had:

That day fir harwy prewyt in the feld

Sir Harwy comes to support
them;

[Fol. 40 a.]

Of armys more than longith to his eld,
For he was more than fyfty yher of ag,
3244 Set he was ferß and 3ong in his curag;
And fro that he assemblyt his bataill
Doune goith the folk of galotis al hail;
For to *withstond* thai war of no poware,
3248 And yhit of folk x thoufand mo thei vare.

K yng valydone, that fauch on fuch o wyß
His falowis dangerit *with* thar ennemys,
With al his folk, being freß and new,
3252 Goith to the feld onon, them to reßkew;
Thar was the feld *rycht* perellus a3añe,
Of arthuris folk ful many on var flan.

B ot angus, quhich that lykith not to bid,
3256 And faw the perell one the tother fid,
His fted he strok, and *with* his oft is gon
Whar was moft ned, and thar the feld has ton.

K yng clamedyus makith non abaid,
3260 Bot *with* his oft one to the fid he raid.

A nd ywons king, that haith his cummyn fen,
Encounterit hyme in myddis of the greñ.
The aucht batellis assemblyt one this wiß;
3264 On ather half the clamore and the cryiß
Was lametable and petws for til her,
Of *knychtis* wich in diuerß placis fere
Wondit war, and fallyng to and fro,

and proves himself a better
warrior than might have been
expected of one so old.

Galiot's folk are beaten.

King Valydone comes to
support them.

Angus comes to aid Arthur's
men.

Clamedyus comes to aid
Galiot's men.

Ywons encounters
Clamedyus.

Great clamour and lamentable
cries on either side.

3268 Ȝhit galyotis folk war xx thoufand mo.

ȜLACK KNIGHT'S DARING RESOLUTION.

The blak knyght than on to hyme-felf he laid:
“Remembir the, how yhow haith ben araid,
Ay fen ye hour that yow was makid knyght,
3272 *With* love, azane quhois powar & whois mycht
Yow haith no ftrenth, yow may It not endur,
Nor Ȝhit non vthir erthly creatur;
And bot two thingis ar the to amend,
3276 Thi ladice mercy, or thi lyvys end.
And well yhow wot that on to hir prefens,
Til hir estat, nor til hir excellens,
Thi febilneß neuermore is able
3280 For to attan, fche is fo honorable.
And fen no way yow may fo hie extend,
My verray confell is, that yow pretend
This day, (fen yow becummyne art hir knyght
3284 Of hir comand, and fechtit in hir fycht),
And well yow fchaw, fen yow may do no mor,
That of refone fche fal the thank tharfore;
Of euery poynt of cowardy yow fcham,
3288 And in til armys purches the fum nam.”
With that of love in to o new defir
His fpere he ftraucht, and fwift as any wyre
With al his forß the nereft feld he foght;
3292 His ful ftrenth in armys thar he vroght,
In to the feld rufching to and fro,
Doune goith the man, doune goith the horß also;
Sum throw the fcheld is perfit to the hart,
3296 Sum throw the hed, he may It not aftar.
His bludy fuerd he dreuch, that carwit fo

The black knight bids himself
remember love's power over
him;

and that only his lady's mercy
or his life's end can amend
him.

[Fol. 40 b.]

He counsels himself to strive
for her thanks,

and to be ashamed of every
point of cowardice.

Swift as a crossbow-bolt he
seeks the field.

Fro fum the hed, and fum the arm in two;
 Sum in the feld fellit is in fwoñ,
 3300 Throw fum his fuerd goith to the fadill doune.
 His fois waren abafit of his dedis,
 His mortell ftrok fo gretly for to dred Is;
 Whar thai hyme faw, *within* a lytall fpace,
 3304 For dreid of ded, thai levyng hyme the place,
 That many o ftrok ful oft he haith forlorñ;
 The fpedy horß away the knycht hath borñ.
 In to his wyrking neuermore he feft,
 3308 Nor non abaid he makith, nor areft.
 His falowis, fo in his knychthed affuryd,
 Thai ar recomfort, thar manhed is recoueryt,
 And one thar fois ful ferfly thai foght,
 3312 Thar goith the lyf of many o knycht to nocht.
 So was the batell wonderful to tell,
 Of knychtis to fe the multitud that fell,
 That pety was til ony knycht to feñ
 3316 The knychtis lying gaping on the gren.
 The blak knycht ay *continewit* fo faft,
 Whill [74](#) many one, difcumfit at the laft,
 Are fled, and planly of the feld thei pas:

His sword carves the head
from some, and cuts the arms
of others in twain.

When his foes see him, they
leave the place for dread of
death.

His knightly deeds assure his
fellows.

It was pitiful to see the
knights gaping upon the
green.

[74](#) MS. "Whilk."

[Fol. 41 *a.*]

OT WONDERS WHY HIS MEN FLEE.

3320 And galyot haith wondyr, for he was
 Of mor powar, and alkit at them qwhy
 As cowartis thai fled fa fchamfully?
 Than faith o knycht, for wondit in the brayne,
 3324 "Who lykith, he may Retwrn azayne
 Frome qwhens we come, merwalis for to fee,
 That in his tyme neuer fich fauch hee."
 "Marwell," *quod* he, "that dar I boldly fay
 3328 Thay may be callit, and quhat thai ar, I pray?"

Galiot asks his men why they
flee.

A knight replies, that whoever
likes may go and see marvels.

Galiot asks, what marvels;
and the knight tells him there

“Schir, in the feld forluth thar is o knyght,
That only throw his body and his mycht
Wencuffith all, that thar may non fuften
3332 His strokis, thai ar so fureows and ken.
He farith as o lyone or o beyre,
Wod in his rag, for sich is his affere.
Nor he the knyght in to the armys Red,
3336 Wich at the first assemble in this sted
Wencuffith all, and had the holl renown,
He may to this be no comparyfoune,

is a knight who vanquishes
all;

who fares as a lion or a bear;

to whom the red knight hears
no comparison.

Fore neuer he fefith fen the day vas goñ,
3340 Bot euermore *continewit* in to one.”
Quod galiot, “in nome of god and we
Al, be tyme, the futhfastneß fal see.”

Galiot says he will go and see.

OT RALLIES HIS MEN.

[T]han he in armys that he had is gon,
3344 And to the feld *with* hyme a3ane hath ton
Al the flearis, and foundyne [in] 75 fich aray
His folk, that ner difcumfyt al war thay;
Bot quhen thai law cummyne our the plan
3348 Thar lord, thai tuk fich *hardement* a3añ,
That thar effen3eis lowd thai gon to cry.
He chargit tham to go, that ware hyme by,
Straucht to the feld, *with* al thar holl forß;
3352 And thai, the wich that fparit not the horß,
All redy war to fillyng his *command*,
And frefchly went, *withowten* more demand:
Throw quich thar folk recoueryt haith thar place,
3356 For al the feld *prefwmyt* that thar was
O new oft, one fuch o wyß thai foght;
Whar arthuris folk had paffith al to *nocht*,
Ne war that thai the better war ilkoñe,
3360 And at thai can them vtraly *dispoñe*
Rathar to dee than flee, in thar entent,
And of the blak *knycht* haith fich *hardyment*;
For at al *perell*, al *harmys*, and *myfchef*,
3364 In tyme of ned he can tham al *ralef*.

Galiot is armed, rallies the
flyers, and encourages his
men.

75 The sense, but not the
metre, requires “in.”

They shout their war-cries.

All think a new host is
coming.

Arthur’s folk determine rather
to die than fly.

[Fol. 41 b.]

[T]har was the batell *dangerus* & strong,
Gret was the pres, bath *perellus* & throng;
The blak *knycht* is born on to the ground,
3368 His horß hyme falyth, that fellith dethis
wound.

The black knight is borne to
the ground.

The vi falowis, that falowit hyme al day,
 Sich was the preß, that to the erth go thay;
 And thar in myd among his ennemys
 3372 He was about enclofit one lich wyß
 That quhare he was non of [his] falowis knew,
 Nor mycht nocht cum to help hyme, nore refkew.
 And thus among his ennemys allon
 3376 His nakid fuerd out of his hond haith ton;
 And thar he prewit his wertew & his strenth;
 For thar was none *within* the fuerdis lenth
 That came, bot he goith to confusioune.
 3380 Thar was no helme, thar was no habirioune,
 That may resist his fuerd, he smytith so;
 One euery fyd he helpith to and fro,
 That al about the compas thai mycht ken;
 3384 The ded horß lyith virflyng *with* the men.
 Thai hyme affalzeing both *with* scheld & spere,
 And he azane; as at the stok the bere
 Snybbith the hardy houndis that ar ken,
 3388 So farith he; for neuer mycht be sen
 His fuerd to rest, that in the gret rout
 He rowmyth all the compas hyme about.

The six comrades go to the earth.

None know where he is.

He defends himself with his sword.

No helm nor habergeon may resist his sword....

He fares like a bear at the stake, that snubs the hardy hounds.

OT WONDERS AT LANCELOT'S PROWESS.

[A]nd galiot, beholding his manhed,
 3392 *Within* his-felf wonderith of his ded,
 How that the body only of o knyght
 Haith lich o strenth, haith lich affere & mycht;
 Than said he thus, "I wald not that throw me,
 3396 Or for my cauß, that such o knyght suld dee,
 To conquer all this world that is so larg."
 His horß than can he *with* his spuris charg,
 A gret trunfioune In to his hond hath ton,

Galiot wonders at his deeds;

and says that such a knight shall not die on his account.

3400 And in the thikeſt of the preß is goñ,
 And al his folk chargit he to feß.
 At his *command* thai levyng al the preß;
 And quhen he had departit all the rout,
 3404 He laid, “*fir knycht*, havith now no dout.”
 Wich anſwerit, “I have no cauß to dred.”
 “*3is*,” *quod* he, “*fa euer* god me ſped,
 Bot apone fut quhill *3e* ar fechtand here,
 3408 And yhow defendith apone ſich manere,
 So hardely, and ek ſo lyk o *knycht*,
 I fal my-felf *with* al my holl *mycht*
 Be yhour defens, and varand fra al harmys;
 3412 Bot had yhe left of worſchip In til armys,
 What I have don I wold apone no wyß;
 Bot ſen yhe ar of *knychthed* ſo to prys,
3he fal 76 no maner cauß have for to dred:
 3416 And ſet yhour horß be falit at this ned,
 Diſpleß yhow not, for-quhy *3e* fal not want
 Als many as yhow lykith for to hawnt;

He charges all his folk to cease;

[Fol. 42 a.]

and assures the black knight that he will himself warrant him from all harm.

76 MS. “falt.”

He offers him as many horses as he needs; and proposes that they shall never again part.

OT GIVES LANCELOT HIS OWN HORSE.

And I my-felf, I fal yhowr ſqwyyar bee,
 3420 And, if god will, neuer more fal wee
 Depart;” *with* that, anon he can to lycht
 Doune frome his horß, and gaf hym to y^e *knycht*.
 The lord he thonkit, and the horß hath ton,
 3424 And als ſo freſch one to the feld is gon,
 As at no ſtrokis he that day had ben.
 His falowis glad, one horß that hath hym ſen,
 To galiot one vthir horß thai broght;
 3428 And he goith one, and frome the feld he *focht*,
 And to the plan quhar that his oftis were;
 And brandymagus chargit he to ſtere

He 'lights from his horse, and gives him to Lancelot, who thanks him.

Galiot returns to his host, and chooses a band of 10,000

Efter hyme, *within* a lytill fpace,
3432 And x thoufand he takyne *with* hym haß.
Towart the feld onon he can to Rid,
And chargit them befor ye oft to byd.
Wp goith the trumpetis, and the claryownis,
3436 Hornys, bugillis blawing furth thar fownis,
That al the cuntre refownit hath about;
Than arthuris folk var in dispar & dout,
That hard the noys, and faw the multitud
3440 Of frefch folk; thai cam as thai war wod.

ELOT HARANGUES ARTHUR'S HOST.

[B]ot he that was *withowten* any dred,
In fabill cled, and faw the gret ned,
Affemblyt al his falowis, and arayd;
3444 And thus to them in manly *termes* laid:
“What that 3e ar I knaw not yhour eftat,
Bot of manhed and worfchip, well I wat,
Out throuch this warld yhe aw to be *commendit*,
3448 This day 3e have fo knyghtly yhow defendit.
And now yhe fee how that, a3anis the *nycht*,
Yhour ennemys *pretendit* *with* thar myght
Of multitud, and *with* thar new oft,
3452 And *with* thar buglis and thar wyndis boft
Frefchly *cummyng* In to lich aray,
To ifyne yhow one owtrag [77](#) or affray.
And now almoft *cummyne* Is the *nycht*,
3456 Quharfor yhour ftrenth, yhour curag, & yhovr
 mycht
Yhe occupye in to fo manly wyß,
That the worfchip of knyghted & empryß
That yhe have wonyng, and ye gret renown
3460 Be not yloft, be not ylaid doune.

men.

The trumpets, clarions, horns,
and bugles are sounded.

Arthur's folk despair.

The sable knight, still
fearless,

harangues his men, saying,

[Fol. 42 b.]

“I know not who ye are, but I
know that ye ought to be
commended.

Ye see how your enemies, as
night approaches, are striving
to give you an outrage or a
fright.

[77](#) MS. “owtray.” See
Glossary.

Employ then your courage, so
that the honour ye have won
be not again lost.

For one hour the sufferiſſe of diſtreſſe,
 Gret harm It war yhe tyne the hie encreſſe
 Of vorſchip, ſeruit al this day before.
 3464 And to yhow al my confell is, tharfore,
 With manly curag, but radour, yhe pretend
 To met tham ſcharply at the ſperis end,
 So that thei feil the cold ſperis poynt
 3468 Out-throw thar ſcheldis, in thar hartis poynt.
 So ſal thai fynd we ar no-thing affrayt;
 Whar-throuch we fall the well leſſe be affayt.
 If that we met them ſcharply in the berd,
 3472 The formeſt ſal mak al the laif afferd.”
 And with o woyſſe thai cry al, “ſir knyght,
 Apone yhour manhed, and yhour gret mycht,
 We ſal abid, for no man ſhall eſchef
 3476 Frome yhow this day, his manhed for to pref.”
 And to his oft the lord ſir yvane ſaid,
 “Yhe comfort yow, yhe be no-thing affrayd,
 Ws ned no more to dreding of ſuppriſſe;
 3480 We ſe the ſtrength of al our ennemys.”
 Thus he ſaid, for he wend thai var no mo,
 Bot ſir gawan knew well It vas not ſo;
 For al the oftis mycht he ſe al day,
 3484 And the gret hoſt he ſaw quhar yat it lay.

Resolve then to meet them sharply, without fear, so that they may feel the cold spear in their hearts.

Perhaps then the foremost will make the rest afraid.”

They promise to stand firm.

Sir Yvan also bids his men be comforted; for that they see all the strength of their enemies.

Sir Gawane, however, knew better.

POEM ABRUPTLY ENDS.

[A]nd galiot he can his folk exort,
 Befeching them to be of good comfort,

Galiot also exhorts his men.

And lich encounter

[*The rest is wanting.*]

NOTES.

[It may be observed, once for all, that the expression *in to* repeatedly occurs where we should simply use *in*; and *one to* is in like manner put for *unto*. The ending *-ith* (for *-ed*) is frequent in the past tense, and *-it* (also for *-ed*) in the past participle, though this distinction is not always observed. A still more noticeable ending is *-ing* (for *-en*) in the infinitive. Observe further that the letters *v*, *u*, and *w* are perfectly convertible, and used quite indiscriminately; so that *wpone* means *upon*; *vthir* means *uthir*, i.e., *other*: *our* is put for *over*; *vounde* signifies *wound*, etc.]

Page 1, [line 1](#). *The soft morow*. This nominative case has no verb. A similar construction occurs in the first lines of Books II. and III.

[4](#). *Uprisith*—*his hot courss*, Upriseth in his hot course; *chare*, chariot.

[6](#). *sent*, sendeth; so also *stant*, standeth, [l. 326](#).

[8](#). *valkyne*, waken.

[10](#). *gyrss*, grass.

[11](#). *assay*, assault.

[13](#). *wox*, voice.

[17](#). *frome I can*, from the time that I did.

[18](#). *It deuit me*, it availed me. Jamieson gives “*Dow*, 1. to be able; A.S. *dugan* (*valere*), to be able. 2. to avail; Teut. *doogen*.”

P. 2, [l. 23](#). *hewy 3erys*, heavy years.

[24](#). “Until that Phœbus had thrice gone through his full circuits” (lit. spheres). See the peculiar use of “*pas*” in other places.

[26](#). “So, by such a manner, was my lot fated;” see [l. 41](#).

[28](#). *carving can*, did cut.

[30](#). *be the morow*, by the morn.

[36](#). *neulyngis*, newly, anew.

[43](#). *walkith*, walked.

[50.](#) *I-clede*, y-clad, clad. Ch. has *clede*.

[54.](#) “No one within thought he could be seen by any wight outside.”

P. 3, [1. 56.](#) *clos it*, enclose it; the MS. has *closit*.

[57.](#) *alphest*. This reading of the MS. is an error for *alcest*. See Chaucer, Prologue to Legend of good women, l. 511:

“The grete goodnesse of the quene Alceste,
That turned was into a dayesye,”

Alceste being the contracted form of Alcestis.

[59.](#) *Wnclosing gane*, did uncloze.

[60.](#) “The bright sun had illumined the spray, and had updrawn (upwarped) into the lusty air the night’s soft (sober) and moist showers; and had made the morning soft, pleasant, and fair.” With this difficult passage we should compare [1. 2477](#).

[66.](#) *Quhill*, until.

[67.](#) *till ony vicht*, to any wight.

[69.](#) *Bot gladness til the thochtful, euer mo*, etc., “But, as for gladness to the melancholy man, evermore the more he seeth of it, the more wo he hath.”

[73.](#) *represent*, represented (accented on the second syllable).

[74.](#) *Al day gan be sor*, etc., “All the day, my spirit began to dwell in torment, through sorrow of thought;” *be sor*, by sorrow (A.S. *sorh*).

[77.](#) *Ore slep, or how I wot*, “Or sleep, ere I knew how.”

[83.](#) *A-licht*, alighted.

[84.](#) *levis in to were*, livest in doubt.

P. 4, [1. 91.](#) *be morow*, by morrow; at early morn.

[99.](#) *set*, although.

[103.](#) *weil accordinge*, very fitting.

[105.](#) *long ore he be sonde*, (It is) long ere he be sound.

[108.](#) *seith, for to consel*, saith, that as for concealing or shewing, etc.

[109.](#) *althir-best*, lit. best of all; see Chaucer’s use of *alderfirst*, *alderlast*.

P. 5, [1. 127.](#) *lat be thi nyss dispare*, let be thy nice (foolish) despair.

[128.](#) *erith*, earth.

[134.](#) *schall hyme hating*, shall hate him. The termination *-ing* is here the sign of the infinitive mood after the verb *shall*.

[140.](#) *Set*, although.

[146.](#) *tak one hand and mak*, undertake and compose; *trety*, treatise; *vnkouth*, unknown, new.

[151.](#) *belevis*, believe will please thy lady.

[160.](#) *yis*, this.

P. 6, [l. 161.](#) *troucht*, truth.

[163.](#) *discharge*, release.

[170.](#) *spir*, sphere.

[171.](#) “At command of a wise (god from) whose vision,” etc. We sometimes find in old English the adjective “a wise” used absolutely for “a wise man.” See “Le Morte Arthur,” ed. F. J. Furnivall, l. 3318.

[175.](#) *tynt*, lost.

[177.](#) *be this worldis fame*. Here again, as in many other passages, “be” expresses with relation to, as regards.

[185.](#) *yaim*, them.

[191.](#) *demande*, demur.

P. 7, [l. 198.](#) *Quhill*, until.

[200.](#) *conten*, treat; lit. contain.

[202.](#) Lancelot is here called the son of Ban, king of Albanak; so again in [l. 1447.](#)

[204.](#) *redis*, read.

[214.](#) “I will not waste my efforts thereupon.”

[219.](#) *wnwyst*, unwist, unknown.

[225.](#) *nome*, name.

[226.](#) *Iwondit to the stak*, very deeply wounded; but there is no doubt about the origin of the phrase. See Glossary.

[228.](#) *astart*, get rid of it, escape it.

P. 8, [l. 240.](#) *dedenynt to aras*, deigned to pluck out.

[244.](#) *hurtare*, hurter.

[245.](#) *Iwond*, wounded.

[248.](#) *ful wicht*, full nimble.

[251.](#) *of quhome*, by whom.

[253.](#) *send*, sent.

[257.](#) *pasing vassolag*, surpassing prowess.

[260.](#) “Passed down into the fell caves.”

[264.](#) *tane*, taken.

[266.](#) *cwre*, care.

P. 9, [l. 267.](#) *gart be maid*, caused to be made.

[271.](#) *awoue*, vow.

[275.](#) *in to that gret Revare*, in that great river.

[284.](#) *o gret confusione of pupil and knychtis*, al enarmyt, a great medley of people and knights, all fully armed. Stevenson actually reads *unarmyt*!

[294.](#) *I wil report*; both here and in [l. 320](#) we should almost expect to find “*I nil report*,” i.e. I will not tell. It must mean, “I will tell you why I omit to mention these things.” Compare lines [266](#), [320](#).

[297.](#) *thing*, think.

P. 10, [l. 305.](#) *veris*, wars.

[306.](#) *be the wais*, by the ways.

[307.](#) *Tuex*, betwixt; *accorde*, agreement.

[314.](#) *mot*, must.

[316.](#) *stek*, concluded.

[319.](#) *most conpilour*, very great composer.

[320.](#) “As to whose name I will only say, that it is unfit,” etc.

[326.](#) *stant*, standeth.

[328.](#) *yroung*, rung.

[330.](#) *beith*, shall be; observe the *future* sense of *beith* in this place.

[331.](#) *suet*, sweet.

[332.](#) “His soul in bliss preserved be on that account.”

[334.](#) *and this endit*. Whether *endit* here refers to *inditing* or *ending* is perhaps doubtful.

NOTES TO BOOK I.

P. 11, [l. 336](#). If by *aryeit* is here meant the *sign*, not the *constellation* of Aries, the day referred to is April 1 or 2, according to Chaucer's "Astrolabie."

[338](#). *bewis*, boughs.

[340](#). *makyne gone*, did make.

[341](#). *in ther chere*, after their fashion. (For *chere*, see Glossary.)

[345](#). *auerding to*, belonging to.

[351](#). *Anoit*, annoyed.

[352](#). *For why*, wherefore; so also *for-thi*, therefore.

[354](#). *can*, began.

[355](#). *sende*, sent.

[358](#). *heryng*, hear (infin. mood). In the next line it occurs as a present participle.

[362](#). *to pas hyme*, to go, depart.

[364](#). *meit*, to dream of; *aperans*, an appearance, apparition.

P. 12, [l. 365](#). *hore*, hair.

[375](#). *vombe*, womb; hence bowels.

[377](#). *stert*, started.

[384](#). *gert*, caused.

[390](#). *traist*, trust.

[397](#). *demande*, demur, delay.

[398](#). *at*, that.

P. 13, [l. 407](#). *whill*, until.

[408](#). *the*, they.

[410](#). *to viting*, to know.

[412](#). *shauyth al hall*, sheweth all whole.

[414](#). *chesith*, chooseth.

[422](#). *shire*, sir.

[424](#). *fore to awysing*, in order to take counsel. 432. All this about astronomy (i.e. astrology) should be compared with Gower; Conf.

Amantis, lib. vii; ed. Pauli, vol. 3, pp. 133, 134. Arachell, Nembrote, Moises, Hermes are there mentioned as astrologers.

[433](#). The MS. has “set” (*not* with a long s). Mr Stevenson has “fet,” which would seem right.

P. 14, [l. 435](#). *nembrot*, Nimrod; see *Genesis and Exodus* (E.E.T.S.), l. 659.

[436](#). *herynes*, miswritten for *herymes*, i.e. Hermes.

[439](#). “The which they found were wondrously evil set.”

[440](#). *his sweuen met*, dreamed his dream.

[443](#). *waryng in to were*, were in doubt.

[444](#). *danger*, power to punish; compare Shakspeare’s use of the word.

[457](#). *but delay*, without delay.

[459](#). *stondith heuy cherith*, stood heavy-cheered, was sad in his demeanour.

[465](#). *fundyng*, found.

[466](#). *depend to*, depend upon.

P. 15, [l. 475](#). *tone*, taken.

[478](#). *assey*, test.

[481](#). *record*, to tell out, speak.

[487](#). *preseruith It allan*, is preserved alone.

[499](#). *affy in-tyll*, rely upon.

[500](#). *failye*, fail.

[504](#). *there clergy*, their science.

P. 16, [l. 519](#). “Through the watery lion, who is also faithful, and through the leech and eke the water also, and through the counsel of the flower.” It is very possible this passage is partly corrupt; [l. 520](#) should certainly be (as may be seen from lines [2010](#), [2056](#)),

“And through the leich withouten medysyne.”

The meanings of lion, leech, and flower are fully explained, however, in lines [2013-2120](#).

[524](#). *weyne*, vain.

[527](#). *passid nat his thoght*, left not his thoughts.

[531](#). *rachis*, braches, dogs.

[533.](#) *grewhundis*, grayhounds.

[536.](#) This purely conjectural line is merely inserted to carry on the sense.
It is imitated from line 3293. In the next line we should read
“*grewhundis*,” rather than “*grewhund*.”

[538.](#) *Befor ther hedis*, before their heads.

P. 17, [l. 545](#). “All armed, as was then the fashion.”

[546.](#) *salust*, saluted.

[548.](#) *kend*, known.

[549.](#) *leuyth*, liveth.

[552.](#) The rime requires “land,” as in [l. 638](#).

[553.](#) *yald hyme our*, yield him over.

[554.](#) *if tribut*, give tribute.

[566.](#) *recist*, resist; *mone bee*, must be.

[568.](#) *be*, by.

[569.](#) *day moneth day*, ere this day month; comp. [l. 1162](#).

P. 18, [l. 577](#). *fairhed*, fair-hood, beauty.

[587.](#) *magre myne entent*, in spite of my intention.

[591.](#) *nome*, took.

[593.](#) *Inquere at*, inquire of.

[596.](#) *wes*, was.

[599.](#) *rased*, rose.

[605.](#) *accordith*, agree thereto.

[606.](#) *recordith*, belongith.

[607.](#) *visare*, wiser.

P. 19, [l. 621](#). *This spek I lest*, this I list to speak.

[622.](#) *varnit*, warned.

[626.](#) “Though the season of the year was contrary.”

[627.](#) *atte*, at the.

[629.](#) *the ilk*, that (Scotch *thilk*).

[632.](#) *Melyhalt*, the name both of a hill, and of the town built upon it.

[636.](#) *affray*, terror.

[642.](#) *wnconquest*, unconquered.

[643.](#) *cwre*, care.

P. 20, [l. 649.](#) *nemmyt*, named.

[652.](#) *were*, war.

[654.](#) *or than to morn*, earlier than to-morrow.

[660.](#) *our few*, over few.

[677.](#) *northest*, north-east.

P. 21, [l. 686.](#) *fechteris*, fighters.

[688.](#) *holde*, held.

[691.](#) *presone*, prison.

[697.](#) *peite*, pity.

[699.](#) The metre of Lancelot's lament is that of Chaucer's "Cuckoo and Nightingale," and was very possibly copied from it. *Qwhat haue y gilt*, what crime have I committed.

[702.](#) *ago*, gone.

[703.](#) *nat*, naught; *me glaid*, gladden me.

[706.](#) *til haue*, to have.

[709.](#) *Sen thelke tyme*, since that time.

P. 22, [l. 718.](#) *of remed*, for a remedy.

[719.](#) *sesith*, ceaseth.

[723.](#) *with this lady*, by this lady.

[728.](#) *laisere*, leisure.

[731.](#) *diuerss wais sere*, divers several ways.

[733.](#) *bur*, bore.

[735.](#) *cher*, car.

[740.](#) *dout*, to fear.

[745.](#) *but were*, without doubt. This expression often occurs.

P. 23, [l. 751.](#) *few menye*, small company; an oddly sounding expression to modern ears.

[753.](#) *cold*, called.

[754.](#) *hot*, hight, was named.

[755.](#) *but in his cumpany*, unless he had with him.

[757.](#) *He saith*; the speaker is the captain of the hundred knights, called in [l. 806](#) *Maleginis*.

[768.](#) *als fell*, just as many.

[777.](#) *hard*, heard.

[781.](#) *clepit*, called.

P. 24, [l. 793](#), *as he wel couth*, as he well knew how.

[796.](#) *sen*, seen.

[800.](#) *sen*, since.

[806.](#) *was hot*, was hight, was named.

[809.](#) *In myde the borde and festinit in the stell*, In the midst they encounter, and fastened in the steel. See [l. 850](#).

[812.](#) *Rout*, company.

[815.](#) *ferde*, fourth.

[817.](#) *sauch thar latter batell steir*, saw their last division stir.

P. 25, [l. 820](#). *gane his mortall fell*. A word seems here omitted; if after *mortall* we insert *strokis*, the sense will be, “His enemies began his mortall strokes to feel.”

[825.](#) *worth*, worthy. It would improve the metre to read *worthy* ([l. 875](#)).

[828.](#) *In to were*, in war, in the strife.

[829.](#) *hyme bure*, bore himself.

[839.](#) *to-for*, heretofore.

[841.](#) *Atour*, i.e. *at over*, across.

[842.](#) *assall*, assault. The rime shews we should read *assaill*, as in [l. 855](#).

[849.](#) *socht atour*, made their way across. The use of *seke* in Early English is curious.

P. 26, [l. 861](#). *setith his payn vpone*, devotes his endeavours to.

[868.](#) *al to-kerwith*, wholly cutteth in pieces.

[880.](#) *dirk*, dark.

[883.](#) *tan and slan*, taken and slain.

P. 27, [l. 895](#). It frequently occurs in the MS. that a space is left at the beginning of a line, and the first letter of the line is omitted. It is evident that the intention was that the first letter should be illuminated, and that this,

after all, was not done. Here, for instance, the T is omitted, as indicated by the square brackets. So also in [l. 1083](#), etc.

[897.](#) *pasing home*, go home.

[899.](#) *was vent*, had gone.

[905.](#) *dulay*, delay. So also *duclar* for *declare*.

[907.](#) *comyne*, came.

[908.](#) *ill paid*, displeased.

[909.](#) *homly*, humbly. Stevenson reads *hourly*, but this is wrong; see [l. 914](#).

[911.](#) *carful*, full of care, unhappy.

[912.](#) *withouten were*, without doubt.

[914.](#) *lawly*, lowly.

[918.](#) *wight*, with (unusual, and perhaps wrong).

P. 28, [l. 924](#). *leife*, live.

[929.](#) *eft*, after.

[933.](#) *thar longith*, there belongeth.

[943.](#) *I was for til excuss*, I had some excuse.

[944.](#) “Because I did behove (to do it), out of very need.”

[946.](#) *lefe it but*, leave it without.

[953.](#) *ma*, make.

[954.](#) *ga*, go.

[955.](#) *of new*, anew.

[958.](#) *But if that deth or other lat certan*, “Except it be owing to death or other sure hindrance.”

P. 29, [l. 960](#). *be hold*, be held. MS. *behold*. Stevenson suggested the alteration, which is certainly correct.

[961.](#) *withthy*, on the condition that.

[965.](#) *promyt*, promise; *als fast as*, as soon as.

[973.](#) *ferd*, fourth.

[982.](#) “Where we shall decide the end of this war.”

P. 30, [l. 997](#). *cag*, cage, prison.

[999.](#) *amen*, pleasant.

[1000.](#) *vodis*, woods.

[1004.](#) *lust*, pleasure (Ch.). But the line is obscure; unless we read “*diuersitee*.”

[1009.](#) “His spirit started (owing to the) love (which) anon hath caught him,” etc.

[1012.](#) *at*, that.

[1014.](#) “(As to) whom they know not at all.”

[1019.](#) *sen at*, since that.

[1022.](#) *the dewod*, devoid thee.

[1024.](#) *and*, if.

[1026.](#) *be ony mayne*, by any mean.

P. 31, [l. 1027.](#) *y red*, I advise.

[1035.](#) *To warnnyng*, to warn.

[1040.](#) *our the furdis*, over the fords.

[1044.](#) *oyer*. So in MS.; the *y* representing the old *th* (*b*); other.

[1046.](#) *hufyng*, halting.

[1050.](#) *worschip*, honour. “It were more expedient to maintain your honour.”

[1058.](#) *wonk*, winked.

[1062.](#) *vare*, aware.

P. 32, [l. 1064.](#) The meaning of “ferst-conquest” is “first-conquered” (*conquest* being Old Fr. for conquered). It is explained in [l. 1547](#) as having been a title given to the king whom Galiot first subdued.

[1067.](#) *ferss*, fierce.

[1070.](#) *suppos*, although.

[1073.](#) *he*; viz. the shrew.

[1077.](#) The MS. has “fched.”

[1080.](#) *y men*, I mean.

[1095.](#) *tais*, takes.

P. 33, [l. 1109.](#) *Galyot* put for *Galiotes*, the genitive case-ending being often omitted, after a proper name especially.

[1110.](#) *prewit*, proved, tried.

[1129.](#) *traist*, trust.

[1131.](#) *that euery thing hath cure*, that (of) everything hath care.

P. 34, [l. 1135.](#) “Aye from the time that the sun began to light the world’s face, until he was gone.”

[1137.](#) *o forss*, perforce.

[1141.](#) *taiis*, takes.

[1142.](#) *hecht*, promised.

[1151.](#) *failzeis*, fail.

[1154.](#) *fet*, fetched.

[1156.](#) *stant*, standeth.

[1162.](#) *resput*, respite.

[1166.](#) *very knyghtis passing*, weary knights go.

P. 35, [l. 1170.](#) *till spere*, to inquire.

[1177.](#) *ne wor his worschip*, had it not been for his valour.

[1187.](#) *qwheyar*, whether.

[1191-4.](#) “And fond,” etc. These four lines are now for the first time printed. They were omitted by Stevenson, evidently by accident.

[1196.](#) *Per dee*. Fr. *par Dieu*: an oath common in old ballads, generally in the form *pardy*.

[1197.](#) *vsyt*, used.

[1198.](#) “I advise that we go unto his arms” (armour).

[1203.](#) *haill*, whole.

P. 36, [l. 1207.](#) *abwsyt*, abused, i.e. made an ill use of.

[1208.](#) *vsyt*, used.

[1209.](#) *suppos the best that lewis*, even though (it were) the best that lives.

[1217.](#) *on slep*, asleep. The prefix *a-* in English is due to the Saxon *on*.

[1221.](#) *al to-hurt*, etc. See note in Glossary on the word *To-kerwith*.

[1225.](#) *sauch*, saw; *rewit*, rued, pitied.

[1233.](#) *one syd a lyt*, a little on one side.

[1236.](#) *our mekill*, over much.

P. 37, [l. 1240.](#) *yarof*, thereof.

[1241.](#) *ruput*, repute, think.

[1242.](#) *ablare*, abler, readier.

[1253.](#) Insert a comma after *thret*, and destroy that after *lowe*. The meaning perhaps is, “But what if he be appealed to and threatened, and (meanwhile) his heart be elsewhere set to love.” Observe that *and* is often the third or fourth word in the sentence it should begin. See [l. 2833](#).

[1258.](#) *3he tyne yowr low*, you lose your love.

[1260.](#) *conclisit*, ended.

[1265.](#) *mokil*, much.

[1268.](#) *of new*, anew, again.

[1273.](#) *pan*, pain.

NOTES TO BOOK II.

P. 38, [l. 1279.](#) *thocht*, anxiety.

[1284.](#) *apperans*, i.e. vision, as in [l. 364](#).

[1295.](#) *aqwynt*, acquainted; Burns uses *acquent*.

[1297.](#) *com*, coming.

P. 39, [l. 1316.](#) “So far out of the way you go in your course.” Compare [l. 1797](#).

[1317.](#) “Thy ship, that goeth upon the stormy surge, nigh of thy revels (i.e. because of thy revels) in the gulf it falls, where it is almost drowned in the peril.”

[1321.](#) “In the wretched dance of wickedness.” See the curious uses of the word “daunce” in Chaucer.

[1323.](#) *the son*, thee soon.

[1330.](#) *powert*, poverty; *as the-selwyne wat*, as thyself knows.

[1334.](#) *in to spousag*, in wedlock.

P. 40, [l. 1343.](#) The word *diuerss* is required to complete the line; cf. [l. 731](#).

[1352.](#) *suppriss*, oppression.

[1354.](#) *wedwis*, widows.

[1367.](#) *that ilke*, that same.

[1369](#). *sufferith*, makest to suffer.

P. 41, [l. 1379](#). Eccles. iv. 9, 10.

[1387](#). *yow mone*, thou must.

[1392](#). *her-eftir leif*, hereafter live.

[1401](#). A comma is scarcely needed after “*sapiens*.” It means “The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom.” Prov. ix. 10.

P. 42, [l. 1409](#). *to ryng wnder his pess*, to reign under His peace, by His permission. Roquefort gives *pais*, licence, permission.

[1420](#). *arour*, error.

[1427](#). *leful*, lawful.

P. 43, [l. 1447](#). Ban, king of Albanak, was Lancelot’s father. See [l. 202](#), [1450](#).

[1474](#). The MS. has “affit.”

P. 44, [l. 1491](#). *tak the bak apone themself*, turn their backs.

[1500](#). *yewyne*, given.

[1504](#). *till*, to; redundant.

[1506](#). *stand aw*, stand in awe. So also in [l. 2684](#). The same expression occurs in *The Bruce*, iii. 62, ed. Pinkerton, p. 42, ed. Jamieson; and also in *Havelok*, l. 277, where the word *in*, supplied from conjecture, should be struck out.

P. 45, [l. 1537](#). *throw his peple*, by his people.

[1541](#). *Thus falith not*, etc., “Except wise conduct falleth to a king.”

[1546](#). It may be right to retain the spelling of the MS.—“kinghe;” for, though strange and unusual, it occurs again in [l. 2527](#).

P. 46, [l. 1556](#). *wende*, weened.

[1560](#). *in to his contrare*, against him.

[1568](#). *trewis*, truce.

[1575](#). *his powar*, his chief army.

[1576](#). *by the yhere*, by the ear, privately.

[1579](#). *cold*, called; as in [l. 753](#).

P. 47, [l. 1597](#). *home fair*, go home.

[1608](#). *And*; redundant in modern English. For many of the precepts given by Amytans the author must have been indebted to Gower, or, at any rate, to the author of the *Secreta Secretorum*. See Gower; Conf. Amantis; ed. Pauli, lib. vii; vol. 3, pp. 152-159. And cf. Tyrwhitt's note to the Canterbury Tales, l. 16915; and Warton's Hist. Eng. Poetry.

P. 48, [l. 1628](#). *lest*, least; *low*, law. It requires care to distinguish the two meanings of *low*, viz. *love* and *law*.

[1633](#). *Iug*, judge.

P. 49, [l. 1660](#). *sar*, sorely.

[1666](#). A line omitted. The inserted line is purely conjectural.

P. 50, [l. 1704](#). *pupelle*, people.

[1708](#). *Inwyus*, envious.

[1716](#). *longith*, belongeth.

[1717](#). *the lykith*, it likes thee, thou art pleased.

P. 51, [l. 1724](#). *betak til hyme*, confer upon him.

[1730](#). *essy*, easy.

[1736](#). *for the nonis*, for the occasion. See White's Ormulum.

[1739](#). *vn to the vorthi pur yow if*, unto the worthy poor thou give.

[1742](#). *set nocht of gret substans*, though not of great value.

[1754](#). *alowit*, approved of.

P. 52, [l. 1761](#). *tynith*, loseth.

[1763](#). *atonis*, at once.

[1771](#). *resawe*, receive.

[1773](#). *with two*, also.

P. 53, [l. 1791](#). *well less*, *al-out*, much less, altogether. The punctuation hereabouts in Stevenson's edition is very wild.

[1795](#). *wys*, vice; *the wrechitness*, thy miserliness.

[1797](#). *pass the courss*, go thy way.

[1808](#). *vrech*, wretch; but here used instead of *miser*.

[1812](#). *viss*, vice.

[1814](#). *ben y-knawith*, are known (to be) (?).

[1815](#). *dant*, daunt.

[1822](#). *the ton*, the one.

P. 54, [l. 1832](#). *beis var*, beware.

[1834](#). *colde*, cool.

[1852](#). *onys*, once.

[1855](#). *whar-throw*, through which, whereby.

P. 55, [l. 1864](#), *awn*, own. The metre requires the more usual form *awin*.

[1879](#). *dispolzeith*, despoileth.

[1881](#). *For-quhi*, wherefore. In this line the MS. has “srikth.”

P. 56, [l. 1899](#). *most nedis*, must needs. *Ye* = *the*; i.e. The one, He.

[1909](#). *Mot*, might.

[1917](#). *in* should be *into*, as elsewhere.

P. 57, [l. 1940](#). *havith*, hath.

[1950](#). *hot*, hight, is called.

P. 58, [l. 1966](#). *wnepwnist*, unpunished.

[1990](#). *omend*, amend; *spill*, destroy.

P. 59, [l. 2011](#). *ayre*, are.

[2012](#). *duclar*, declare; so also *dulay* for delay.

[2017](#). *the god werray*, the Very God.

P. 60, [l. 2036](#). *For-quhi*, wherefore.

[2040](#). *mad*, made.

[2041](#). *clergy*, science.

[2062](#). *be the mycht dewyne*, by the might divine.

P. 61, [l. 2069](#). *far*, fare.

[2079](#). *helyth frome the ground*, heals from the bottom; i.e. effectually.

[2100](#). *not sessith*, who ceaseth not.

P. 62, [l. 2107](#). *Ne war*, were it not for; *hartly*, hearty; it occurs again four lines below.

[2135](#). *yneuch*, enough. He means he will ask but one question more.

P. 63, [l. 2148](#). *To passing home*, to go home.

[2162](#). *the xxiiij day*. The first *i* in the MS. is like a “v” smudged over; we should read “xxiiij,” as in [l. 2155](#). The contraction is to be read *four and twentieth*, not *twenty-fourth*; so also in [l. 610](#).

P. 64, [l. 2190](#). *hal dure*, hall door.

[2192](#). *o iorne most for to comend*, a journey most to be commended.

[2194](#). *lowith*, love.

P. 65, [l. 2212](#). *the fewar eschef thay*, the less they achieve.

[2229](#). “For no adventure will prove so great, that ye shall not achieve it.”

[2241](#). *whill*, until.

P. 66, [l. 2247](#). *galot*; so in MS.

[2265](#). *grant mercy*, great thanks; Fr. *grand merci*.

[2267](#). *quhy*, because.

P. 67, [l. 2279](#). *thithingis*, tidings; probably an error of the scribe for *tithingis*. Stevenson has *chichingis*!

[2284](#). *al-out*, altogether.

[2304](#). *oft syss*, oft-times. See Glossary (Syss).

[2306](#). *dante*, dainty.

[2310](#). *tithandis*, tidings; compare [l. 2279](#).

P. 68, [l. 2323](#). *aw*, owe.

[2328](#). *fantessy*, fancy, notion.

[2334](#). *for no why*, for no reason.

[2337](#). *mon I fair*, must I go.

[2338](#). *our son It waire*, over soon it were.

[2342](#). *For-quhy*, because.

P. 69, [l. 2352](#). *nor* has the force of *but*.

[2366](#). *be ony men*, by any means.

[2368](#). *on of tho*, one of them.

[2375](#). *chen of low*, chain of love.

[2376](#). *and if 3he may deren*, an if you may declare.

P. 70, [l. 2409](#). *hartly raquer*, heartily require.

[2416](#). *gar ordan*, cause to be provided.

- P. 71, [l. 2428](#). *prewaly disspone*, privily dispose.
[2436](#). *ellis-quhat*; I suppose this means, “he was on fire *elsewhere*.”
[2448](#). *hamlynes*, homeliness.
[2452](#). *fest throw al the 3her eliche*, feast through all the year alike.
- P. 72, [l. 2469](#). *commend*, commended.
[2470](#). *he drywith*, he driveth, pursueth. The reading is not *drawith*, as in Stevenson.

NOTES TO BOOK III.

- P. 73, [l. 2471](#). This line is too long, and the sense imperfect; but there is no doubt about the reading of the MS.
[2474](#). *Awodith*, expels.
[2475](#). *doune valis*, falls down; for it is evident that *valis* is an error for *falis*, the mistake having arisen from confusion with the succeeding line.
[2480](#). *cled*, clad.
[2487](#). *bygown*, begun. In the next line Stevenson has *sown*; but the true reading is *Rown*, run; as in [l. 2820](#).
[2492](#). *barnag*, baronage, nobility.
- P. 74, [l. 2522](#). *but dulay*, without delay; *the*, they.
[2524](#). *thar com*, their coming.
[2530](#). *in the dogre*, in its (due) degree.
- P. 75, [l. 2545](#). *Or that*, ere that.
[2552](#). *he and hate*, high and hot.
[2558](#). *the can*, they began.
- P. 76, [l. 2574](#). *hyme mak*, prepare himself; or perhaps simply, make (for the field), go.
[2582](#). *helmys last*; *last* clearly means *laced*; see [l. 2250](#).
[2594](#). *3hit*, although.
[2599](#). *dout*, fear.

[2600.](#) *is assemblit*, made an attack. The peculiar use of *assemble* must always be borne in mind.

[2601.](#) *erd*, earth.

P. 77, [l. 2612.](#) *found till gwyans*, go to Gwyans.

[2614.](#) *til esquyris thei sewyt*, after Esquyris they followed.

[2619.](#) *one to the melle socht*, made their way to the mêlée.

[2627.](#) *don bore*, borne down.

[2630.](#) Fifty thousand. It would appear that Galiot had 40,000, of whom 10,000 were held *in reserve*; so that in [l. 2632](#) only 30,000 are mentioned. See [l. 2569](#), [2647](#).

P. 78, [l. 2646.](#) *ten*, sorrow, vexation.

[2656.](#) *resauf*, receive.

[2663.](#) *at thar come*, at their coming; *led*, put down.

[2670.](#) *biding one the bent*, abide on the grassy plain.

P. 79, [l. 2679.](#) “That, despite their efforts, they must needs retire.”

[2684.](#) *stud aw*, stood in awe; see note to [l. 1506](#).

[2693, 4.](#) These lines do not rime. But we should certainly read *felde*, *erde* having slipped in from confusion with [l. 2691](#). The knight of Galloway goes *to the field*, i.e. joins battle.

P. 80, [l. 2712.](#) *On ayar half*, on either side. The MS. omits *to*.

[2713.](#) *of*, off.

[2714.](#) *noiss*, nose.

[2731.](#) *Bot nocht forthi*, But not on that account.

P. 81, [l. 2754.](#) *harmys*, loss.

[2761.](#) *aucht to ses*, ought to cease.

[2765.](#) *at*, that.

[2768.](#) *my lef*, my leave, permission.

[2770.](#) *in to cage*, in prison.

P. 82, [l. 2802.](#) *commandit*, commended.

P. 83, [l. 2819.](#) *one athir half*, on either side.

[2820.](#) *rown*, run.

[2821.](#) *howyns*; an ungrammatical form; perhaps *howyng* is meant.

[2827.](#) *one hycht*, on height; i.e. aloud.

[2829.](#) *sterith*, stirreth.

[2833.](#) “The lady of Melyhalt made (her way) to him, and immediately caused his couch to be placed before a window.” Mr Stevenson reads,

“Of Melyhalt the lady to hyme maid

Incontinent his couche, and gart he [1](#) had,” etc.

i.e. “The lady immediately made his bed for him,” etc.

[2841.](#) *wencust*, vanquished. After this word we should perhaps insert “at,” as in [l. 3336](#).

P. 84, [ll. 2877-2880](#). These lines were printed by me for the first time, four lines having been here again omitted by Mr Stevenson.

[2880.](#) *but weyne*, without doubt.

[2884.](#) *to led and stere*, to lead and direct.

P. 85, [l. 2893](#). *Endlong*, along.

[2894.](#) *weryne*, were.

[2913.](#) *let*, hinder.

P. 86, [l. 2925](#). *dulay*, delay; as in several other places.

[2938.](#) *fek*, effect.

[2944.](#) *zude*, went.

[2947.](#) *fair*, welfare.

P. 87, [l. 2964](#). *Whill*, until.

[2970.](#) *ho*, stop, pause.

[2971.](#) *veryng In affray*, were in terror.

[2972.](#) *rovm*, room.

[2978.](#) *socht*, made his way.

[2984.](#) *disponit*, intends; but we must insert “not,” to complete the sense and the metre.

P. 88, [l. 2998](#). *eschevit* (used passively), is achieved.

[3003.](#) *o knyght*, a single knight.

[3005.](#) *tais*, takes.

[3006.](#) *fays*, foes.

[3013](#). *onys or the nycht*, once ere the night.

[3015](#). *that zhe have gilt to mend*, to amend that in which ye have trespassed.

P. 89, [l. 3052](#). *Do at I may*, Do that which I can.

P. 90, [l. 3065](#). This line is printed by Mr Stevenson,

“Curag can [] encresing in [2](#) his hart”;

but it is not clear that a word is wanting, for the metre is as complete as in many other lines; whilst, as regards the sense, “the knycht” is probably a nominative without a verb, and [l. 3065](#) means, “Courage did increase in his heart.” Or the reader may, if he pleases, insert “fele.” Compare [l. 3058](#).

[3066](#). *lap*, leaped.

[3079](#). Observe the omission of the word “neither” in this line.

[3080](#). *persit*, pierced.

[3086](#). *onan*, anon. A.S. *on-án*.

P. 91, [l. 3093](#). *In samyne will*, with like intent.

[3100](#). *bet axampil*, better example.

[3104](#). *bot*, unless; *me fall*, befall me.

[3108](#). *one vthir*, another.

[3120](#). *send*, sent.

[3121](#). *lewit one*, left one.

[3122](#). *but mercy*, without mercy.

P. 92, [l. 3134](#). *deliuer besynes*, clever readiness.

[3136](#). *aray*, livery.

[3140](#). *Ee*, eye.

[3146](#). *the morow new*, the early morning.

[3160](#). *deith*, dead.

[3162](#). *Suppos*, although.

P. 93, [l. 3178](#). *Nor*; we now use *but*.

[3184](#). *ward*; see Glossary. *tho*, then.

P. 94, [l. 3200](#). *relewit*, relieved.

[3201.](#) *diuerss placis sere*; as *sere* = *diuerss*, one of these words is redundant. So in [l. 3266](#).

[3207.](#) *ewil awysit*, ill advised.

[3217.](#) “And if it so happen, that they be discomfited.”

P. 95, [l. 3240.](#) *leuch*, laughed; *sarues*, service.

[3246.](#) *al haill*, all whole.

[3248.](#) *x thousand mo*, ten thousand, and more.

[3259.](#) *abaid*, delay.

[3263.](#) *aucht*, eight.

[3265.](#) *petws for til her*, piteous to hear.

P. 96, [l. 3297.](#) *dreuch*, drew.

[3299.](#) *fellit*, fallen.

[3304.](#) *levyng*, leave.

P. 97, [l. 3307.](#) *sest*, ceased.

[3321.](#) *askit at*, asked of.

[3331.](#) *Wencussith*, vanquisheth.

[3340.](#) *in to one*, continually; which is sometimes the sense of A.S. *on-án*.

P. 98, [l. 3353.](#) *to fillyng*, to fulfil.

[3357.](#) *soght*, came on; see Glossary.

[3359.](#) *Ne war*, etc., “Had it not been that they were, individually, the better men.”

[3364.](#) *ralef*, relieve.

[3368.](#) *fellith*, feeleth.

P. 99, [l. 3384.](#) *virslýng*, wrestling, *i.e.* entangled with; a strong expression!

[3385.](#) *assalzeing*, assail.

[3390.](#) *rowmyth*, roometh, emptieth.

[3403.](#) *departit*, parted.

[3404.](#) *dout*, fear.

P. 100, [l. 3412.](#) *left*, failed.

[3423.](#) *The lord*, *i.e.* Galiot, as I suppose; Mr Stevenson has, “The Lord.”

[3430.](#) *stere*, to stir, move, come.

P. 101, [l. 3450](#). *pretendit*, endeavour.

[3457](#). *occupye*, employ.

[3461](#). *For one hour*, etc., “On account of suffering distress for one hour.”

[3470](#). *the well less*, much less; see [l. 1791](#).

[3471](#). *berd*, beard.

[3473](#). *o woyss*, one voice.

[3475](#). *eschef frome yhow*, not, *win* from you; but, *withdraw* himself from you. See Glossary.

P. 102, [l. 3481](#). *wend thai var no mo*, thought they were no more.

[3487](#). *And sich enconter*, and such encounter. These three words are written at the bottom of the page as a catchword. The rest of the MS. is wanting.

¹ But the MS. has “be;” also “melyhat” instead of “Melyhalt.”

² MS. has “to.”

GLOSSARIAL INDEX.

[As many of the words occurring in “Lancelot” are well explained either in Jamieson’s Scottish Dictionary or in Roquefort’s “Glossaire de la langue Romane,” I have frequently referred to these works by means of the letters J. and R. Other abbreviations, as O.N. for Old Norse; Goth. for Mæso-Gothic; Su.-G. for Suio-Gothic, etc., will be readily understood. Ch. has also been used as an abbreviation for Chaucer. The various French, Danish, German, and other words referred to in the Glossary are merely added by way of illustration, to indicate in what direction a word may be most easily traced up. To ensure accuracy as far as possible, I have verified every foreign word by the aid of dictionaries, referring for Gothic words to my own Glossary, edited for the Philological Society; for Suio-Gothic words, to Ihre’s Glossarium; for Icelandic words, to Egilsson; and for Old French words, to Roquefort and Burguy. Whatever errors occur below may thus, I hope, be readily traced.]

[A](#) [B](#) [C](#) [D](#) [E](#) [F](#) [G](#) [H](#) [I](#) [K](#) [L](#) [M](#) [N](#)
[O](#) [P](#) [Q](#) [R](#) [S](#) [T](#) [U](#) [V](#) [W](#) [Y](#) [ȝ](#)

Abaid, } delay, tarrying, [1882](#), [2147](#), [3069](#), [3308](#).
Abyde, } A.S. *abídan*, J.

Abasit, } abashed, humbled, dispirited, cast down, [378](#), [1452](#), [2664](#).
Abasyt, } Abasit of, dispirited by, [3301](#).
Abaysit, } R. *abaiser*.

Abasit of (used passively), were dispirited by, [2243](#).

Abraid, awoke, [1231](#);
(Ch.) A.S. *on-bredan*.

Abwsyt (abused), made an ill use of, [1207](#).

Access, a fever; or better, a fit of the ague; Lat. *accessus febris*, (Wright's Glossary), [31](#).

Accorde, to agree with, [1526](#).

Fr. *s'accorder*.

Accordith, is suitable for, becomes, [1679](#), [1951](#);

agree therewith, [605](#);

is useful for, is fit for, [1204](#).

According for, suitable for, [1512](#).

R. *accordant*.

Adred, terrified, [378](#), [2664](#).

A.S. *on-drádan*, to dread.

Affek, effect, [382](#).

Cf. *Fek*.

Afferd, afraid, [3472](#).

A.S. *afered*, *aféran*.

Affere, warlike preparation, [985](#);

aspect, bearing, [3043](#), [3334](#), [3394](#).

See J., who makes it of Teutonic origin; but it may be no more than the O.Fr. *afeire*, *affaire* = state, condition; as explained by Burguy.

Afferith, belongs to, suits, [1550](#).

Afferis, is suitable, [1690](#), [1961](#).

R. *aferer*.

Affrait, terrified, from the verb *Affray* (Ch.), [2462](#), [3469](#).

R. *effraer*.

Affray, terror, fright, [636](#), [3454](#).

Fr. *effroi*.

Affy in till, trust to, rely upon, [499](#), [1394](#).

R. *affier*.

Afyre, on fire, [30](#), [251](#);

hence, used allegorically, in love, [2436](#).

Agrewit, } aggrieved, vexed, [1308](#), [1538](#);
Aggrewit, } angry, enraged, [2618](#).

R. *agrever*.

Ago, gone, [159](#).

A.S. *of-gán*.

Aire, are, [1732](#).

Algait, Algat, always, [1996](#), [1792](#).

Gothic *gatwô*, a street, way.

Al magre thine, in spite of thee, [115](#).

An expression compounded of A.S. *al*, wholly; *maugre* (Fr. *mal grè*), ill-will, and *thine* (A.S. *thín*, the gen. case of *thú*, thou).

Al-out, altogether, [1676](#), [1791](#), etc.

Alowit, approved, [1754](#).

Fr. *allouer*.

Als, (1) as; (2) also.

Amen, } pleasant, [64](#), [999](#).

Ameyne, } Lat. *amænus*.

Anarmyt, fully armed, [545](#), [620](#), [2219](#), [2771](#).

See [Enarmyt](#).

And, if, [1024](#), [1591](#);

and if (= an if), if, [2376](#).

Anerly, only, [1476](#), [1696](#).

A.S. *æn-líc*.

Anoit, } annoyed, vexed, [351](#), [2244](#).

Anoyt, }

Anoyt, annoyeth, [1407](#).

Anterous, (for Aunterous, the shortened form of Aventurous), adventurous, [2618](#).

Fr. *aventure*.

Aparalit, apparelled, [338](#).

Aperans, an appearance, a vision, [364](#).

So also Apperans, [1284](#).

Apone, upon, [765](#), etc.

Appetit, desire, [2722](#).

Ch. has *appetite* as a verb, to desire.

Aqwynt, acquainted, [1295](#).

Burns uses *acquaint*.

Aras, to pluck out, [240](#).

Fr. *arracher*.

Araid, disordered, afflicted, [3270](#).

See *Araye* in Halliwell. The examples there given shew that to *araye* sometimes actually signifies to *disorder*.

Arest, stop, delay, [678](#), [3072](#), [3308](#).

Fr. *arrêt*.

Arly, early, [4](#), [384](#), [975](#).

A.S. *árlíce*.

Artillery, implements of warfare, [2538](#).

See R. *artillerie*. Compare 1 Samuel, xx. 40.

Assay, (1) assault, trial, [11](#), [35](#), [112](#), [712](#);
attack, [537](#), [2662](#).

As a verb, to assault, attack, assail, [570](#), [1044](#).

Fr. *assaillir*.

(2) to essay, attempt, [2936](#);
to test, [478](#), [982](#).

Fr. *essaier*.

Assaid, } assaulted, [1224](#), [2641](#).
Assayt, }

Assall, assault, attack, [842](#).

We should perhaps read “assaill,” as in [1. 855](#).

Assal3eing, assail (3 pers. plural), [3385](#).

Assemblay, an assembling of knights for a combat, a tournament, [267](#).

Assemble, a hostile meeting, combat, battle, [978](#), [3336](#).

See J.

Assemblyng, encountering, [2588](#).

Assemblyng on, attacking, [2956](#).

Assey, to test, [478](#).

See Assay.

Astart, to start away from; hence to escape from, avoid, [228](#), [3296](#).

Ch. has *asterte*.

At, that, [1019](#), etc.

Compare Dan. *at*; O.N. *at*.

Atour, at over, i.e. across, [841](#), [849](#), [873](#);
in excess, in addition, besides, [1775](#).

Ather, either, [2629](#), [2819](#), [3264](#).

A.S. *ægther*.

Atte, at the, [627](#), [1055](#).

Aucht, eight, [3263](#).

Compare Ger. *acht*.

Auentur, adventure, [601](#).

Auer, ever, [273](#), etc.

Auerding to, belonging to (?), [345](#).

The sense seems to point to the A.S. *and-weardian*, to be present, Goth.
and-wairths, present.

Auentur, Auentoure, adventure, [80](#), [222](#).

Aw, owe, deserve; the present tense of the verb of which *ought* is the past
tense; [3447](#).

A.S. *áh*, *áhte*.

Awalk, awake, [1049](#).

Goth. *wakan*. The form *awalk* occurs in Dunbar,

“Awalk, luvaris, out of your slomereng.”
(The Thistle and the Rose.)

Awant, boast, [2136](#).

As a verb, [1588](#);
and as a reflexive verb, [2196](#), [2386](#).

Fr. *se vanter*. Ch. has *avante*.

Awin, own, [89](#).

A.S. *ágen*.

Awodith, maketh to depart, [2474](#).

See *Avoid* in Nares' Glossary, edited by Halliwell and Wright.

Awow, } vow, [234](#), [242](#), [246](#).
Awoue, } Ch. has *avowe*.

Awys, consideration, advisement, [558](#).

Awyß the, advise thee, consider, [1913](#).

Awyß, } to consider, [424](#), [429](#).
Awyfing, } Fr. *s'aviser*.

Awysment, advisement, consideration, [360](#), [680](#).

Ay, ever, continually, [1135](#), [1486](#).

A.S. *á*.

Ayar (*written instead of Athar*), either, [2712](#).

Ayre, are, [2011](#).

Ayanis, [744](#), } against.
A3anis, [1164](#), [2283](#), } A.S. *ongean*.

A3ane, A3eine, again, [3253](#), [380](#).

[Bachleris](#), bachelors; a name given to novices in arms or arts, [1689](#).

See *bachelor* in R.

Banaris, banners, [770](#).

Bartes, [2897](#) } See [Bertes](#).
Bartiis, [3041](#) }

Barnag, baronage, nobility, [2492](#).

See *barniez* in R.

Batell, a battalion, division of an army, [784](#), [808](#), etc.

Be, by.

A.S. *be*.

Behest, promise, [2766](#).

A.S. *behæs*.

Behufis, behoves, [579](#).

A.S. *behófan*, often used impersonally.

Behuß, } it behoves, it is necessary (to do), [944](#), [2342](#);

Behwß, } apparently contracted from *behufis*.

Beleif, *in phr.* ore belief = beyond belief, [112](#).

Bent, a grassy plain (properly a coarse grass; in German, *binse*), [2670](#). J.

Bertes, a parapet, a tower, [1007](#), [1118](#), [2815](#).

R. *bretesche*, from Low Latin *brestachia*.

Betak til, to confer upon, [1724](#).

A.S. *be-técan*, in the sense, to assign.

Betakyne, betoken, [2014](#).

A.S. *be-técan*, in the sense, to shew.

Bewis, boughs, [338](#).

A.S. *boh*.

Billis, letters, [142](#).

Fr. *billet*.

Blindis, blindness (?), [1903](#).

Borde, to meet in a hostile manner, encounter, [809](#).

We find in R. *border*, to joust, fight with lances.

Compare Fr. *aborder*, and Spenser's use of *bord*. See *horde* in Burguy.

Bot, (1) but; (2) without. In general, *without* is expressed by *but*, and the conjunction by *bot*; but this distinction is occasionally violated.

Bown, ready, prepared, [1036](#).

O.N. *búinn*, past part. of *búa*, to prepare. Su.-G. *boa*, to prepare. J.

Bretis, fortifications, forts, [874](#);

“properly wooden towers or castles: *Bretachiæ*, castella lignea, quibus castra et oppida muniebantur, Gallis *Bretesque*. Du Cange.” Jamieson. See [Bertes](#).

Bukis, books, [434](#), [1862](#).

Burdis, boards, i.e. tables, [2198](#).

A.S. *bórd*, which means—1. a plank; 2. a table, etc.

Bur, bore, [733](#), [778](#).

But, without; common in the phrase *but were*, without doubt.

But if, unless, except, [958](#).

Byhecht, } promised, [1485](#), [2791](#).

Byhicht, } A.S. *be-hætan*.

Byknow, notorious for, known to be guilty of, [1627](#).

Compare “I know nothing *by* myself” (1 Cor. iv. 4). Compare also Dan. *bekiende*, to make known.

By, near at hand, [1535](#), [2916](#).

[Cag](#), } cage, prison, [997](#), [2770](#).
Cage, }

Can, an auxiliary verb, used nearly as we now use *did*.

Careldis, plural of Careld, a merry-making, revel (?), [1318](#).

“*Caraude*, réjouissance;” and “*Caroler*, danser, se divertir, mener une vie joyeuse.” Roquefort.

Catifis, wretches, [2102](#).

R. *caitif*, *captif*. Compare Ital. *cattivo*.

Chalmer, chamber, [2281](#), [2308](#), [2427](#), [2808](#). J.

Chare, } chariot, [4](#), [735](#).

Cher, } R. *cher*.

Charge, load, [693](#).

Fr. *charge*; see *discharge* in the line following ([694](#)), meaning to shake off a load.

Chargit, gave attention to, [710](#), [2454](#).

Fr. *se charger de*.

Chen, chain, [2375](#).

Cher, car, chariot, [735](#). See *Chare*.

Chere, cheer, demeanour, [83](#), [341](#), [695](#);
sad demeanour, outward grief, [2718](#).

Fr. *chère*; compare Ital. *ciera*, the face, look.

“Wepinge was hyr mosté chere.”

(Le Morte Arthur, l. 726.)

Cheß, choose, [1611](#), [1636](#), [2368](#).

A.S. *ceósan*; Ger. *kiesen*; Dutch *kiezen*.

Clariouns, clarions, [771](#), [789](#).

Clepe, to call, [90](#), [99](#).

A.S. *clepan*.

Clepit, callest, [93](#);

called, [781](#).

Clepith, is called, [1919](#).

Clergy, science, knowledge, [504](#), [511](#), [2041](#).

R. *clergie*.

Closine, closed, concluded, [316](#).

Closith, enclosed, shut up, [427](#).

Cold, called, [753](#), [1579](#).

Commandit, commended, [2802](#).

Comprochit, approached, [2472](#), [2509](#).

Conpilour, compiler, poet, [319](#).

Conquest, conquered, [574](#);

Fyrst-conquest, first conquered, [1545](#), etc.

Conseruyt, preserved, [332](#).

Conten (used as a reflective verb), to demean oneself valorously, to
maintain one's ground, [823](#), [1107](#), [1130](#).

See R. “*contenement*, contenance, conduite, maintien, posture.”

Contentit hym, behaved himself, [3219](#);

Contentit them, [2634](#).

Contenyt, endured, [3190](#).

Contretioun, contrition, [1415](#), [1426](#).

Contynans, demeanour, [1693](#), [1747](#).

Counter, encounter, attack, charge, [3239](#).

Couth, could, [793](#).

A.S. *cunnan*; past tense, *ic cúðe*.

Cowardy, cowardice, [1023](#), [3287](#).

Cownterit, encountered, [2609](#), [2621](#). J.

Crownel, coronal, corolla of a flower, [59](#). J.

Cummyne, } came, [807](#), [907](#).

Comyne, }

Cumyne, [650](#), [1136](#), } come (past part.).

Cumyng, [447](#), }

Cummyng, [2498](#), }

Cunyng, knowledge, [1455](#).

Cusynace, [1270](#), kinswoman.

Cusynece, [2802](#), }

Cusynes, [2287](#), }

Cwsynes, [1185](#),

Cwre, care, [98](#), [266](#), [643](#).

Lat. *cura*. (N.B. Though *Cwre* = *cura*, yet *cura* should be distinguished from A.S. *cearu*.)

[Danger](#), power to punish; “the power of a feudal lord over his vassals,” (Wright), [444](#).

Also, power to injure, [3006](#).

See R. *dangier*.

Dans, (dance), in the phrase “wrechit dans,” evil mode of life, [1321](#).

See Chaucer's use of *daunce*; and compare—

“I sai 3ow lely how thai lye
Dongen doun alle in a *daunce*.”

Lawrence Minot; quoted in *Specimens of Early English*, by R. Morris;
p. [194](#).

Dede, [90](#), } death.

Ded, [3304](#), } Dan. *död*. A.S. *deáð*. O.N. *dauði*.

Deden, deign, [949](#). J.

Dedenyt, deigned, [240](#).

Deid, died, [215](#).

Deith, dead (past part.), [3160](#).

Delitable, delightful, [1738](#).

R. *delitable*.

Deliuer, nimble, clever, [3134](#).

Deliuerly, (cleverly), nimbly, lightly, [3089](#), [3131](#).

R. *delivre*.

Demande, demur, [191](#), [397](#), [3052](#), [3354](#).

See R. “*demander*, contremander, changer, revoquer l’ordre donné.”

Depart, to part, [3421](#).

R. *departir*.

Departit, parted, [3403](#).

Depaynt, painted, [46](#), [1703](#).

Fr. *dépeint*. Ch. *depeint*.

Depend me, waste or consume (my powers), [214](#); possibly miswritten for
despend.

Cf. *Dispendit*.

Depend to, to concern, appertain to, [466](#).

Deren, to speak out, tell, [2376](#).

R. *derainier*.

Dereyne, a plea, [2313](#);

“haith o dereyne ydoo,” hath appealed to trial by combat.

R. *derainier*.

Des, daïs, high table, [2762](#).

R. *deis*; Lat. *discus*.

Deuit, availed, [18](#). See note.

Devith, } deafen, [92](#), [94](#).

Dewith, } “Su.-G. *deofwa*; Icel. *deyfa*,” J.

Compare Dan. *döve*. Burns has *deave*.

Dewod the, devoid thyself, [1022](#).

Deuoydit was = departed, [1031](#).

Compare *Awodith*.

Dewyß, to tell, narrate, [373](#).

Discharg, to put aside one’s liability, [163](#), [1665](#).

Diseß, lack of ease, misery, [707](#).

Disiont (Disioint?), disjointed, out of joint; hence uncertain, hazardous, [2907](#).

“Disjoint, A difficult situation.” Halliwell.

Dispendit, spent, [1808](#).

R. *despendre*.

Dispens, expenditure, [1746](#).

Fr. *dépense*.

Dispolzeith, despoileth, [1879](#).

Dispone, to dispose, provide; or, as a reflexive verb, to be disposed to do, to intend, [54](#), [446](#), [980](#), [1590](#), [2428](#), [2462](#).

Disponit, declines (?); but much more probably, intends; and we must read “disponit not,” [2984](#).

Dout, fear, [2599](#), [3404](#), [3438](#);

(as a verb), to fear, [740](#), [1827](#).

Ch. *doute*. R. *doubtance*.

Drent, drowned, [1319](#).

A.S. *drencan*.

Dreß (as a reflexive verb), to direct oneself, proceed, go, [1975](#), [2288](#), [2486](#).

Lat. *dirigere*.

Drywith, drives; “he drywith to the end,” i.e. concludes, [2470](#).

Duclar, declare, [3022](#).

Dulay, delay, [681](#), [788](#), [2925](#).

[Effere](#), shew, pomp, [2360](#).

Compare *Affere*.

Efter, after, [217](#).

A.S. *efter*.

Eld, old age, [3225](#), [3242](#).

A.S. *ylde*. Gothic *alds*.

Elyk, Eliche, alike, [182](#), [2452](#).

Eme, uncle, [2572](#).

A.S. *eám*.

Empit, emptied, empty, [180](#).

A.S. *æmtian*.

Empleß, to please, [2455](#). J.

Empriß, worth, honour, [129](#), [269](#), [3458](#);

cf. Romans of Partenay, l. 2013.

Anxiety, oppression, [393](#).

R. *emprindre*.

Enarmyt, fully armed, [285](#), [751](#), [2499](#). J.

Endit, indited, [138](#);

indite, [206](#);

inditing, poem (?), [334](#).

If the meaning were, “this ends,” the form “endis” would be required;
besides which, the rime shews that the *i* is long; cf. [ll. 138](#), [206](#).

Endlong, along, [2893](#).

A.S. *andlang*; Ger. *entlang*.

Entent, intention, will, meaning, thoughts, [448](#), [1451](#), [1499](#), [2938](#).

R. *entente*. Used by Chaucer.

Entermet, to intermeddle with, to have do with, [2914](#).

R. *entremetre*.

Enweronyt, environed, [53](#).

Erde, earth, [1072](#), [1540](#), [2601](#).

Compare Ger. *erde*.

Erdly, earthly, [498](#).

Erith, earth, [128](#).

A.S. *eorð*.

Eschef (1. eschew), to shun, withdraw himself, [3475](#).

R. *eschever*;

(2. achieve), to accomplish, [2212](#), [2513](#).

R. *eschavir*.

Eschef deith, to die, [2732](#).

Escheuit, achieved, [258](#).

Eschevit, is achieved, [2998](#).

Eß, [174](#), } ease.

Eeß, [706](#), }

Essenzeis (ensigns), warcries, [3349](#), J.

See also R. *enseigne*.

Euerilkon, every one, [1039](#), etc.

Exasy, extasy, [76](#). (Possibly miswritten.)

Exortith, beseecheth, [3026](#).

Extend, attain, [3281](#).

[Fail3eis](#), fail, (3 pers. plu. indicative), [1151](#).

Fairhed (fairhood), beauty, [577](#).

In A.S. *fægernes*, but in Dan. *förhed*.

Fall, to happen, befall, [493](#), [2139](#).

A.S. *feallan*; Dan. *falde*.

Fallyng, fallen, [1217](#), [1322](#).

Falowschip, used as we now use company, [1105](#), [2687](#), etc.

Falzeing, failing, [1499](#).

Falzet, Falzheit, failed, [1460](#), [1469](#), [1498](#), [1503](#).

Farhed, beauty, [2440](#).

See [Fairhed](#).

Fayndit (feigned), dissembled, [2397](#).

Fays, foes, [3006](#).

A.S. *fáh*.

Fechtand, fighting, [2691](#), [3127](#), [3407](#).

Ger. *fechten*.

Fechteris, fighters, [686](#).

Feill, knowledge, skill, [2854](#). J.

A.S. *félian*.

Fek (effect), sum, amount, result, drift, [2938](#).

Fr. *effet*.

Fell, to feel, [820](#), [2131](#).

Fellith, feeleth, [3368](#).

Fell, many; als fell, as many, [768](#).

A.S. *féala*; Gothic *filu*.

Fell, horrible, [260](#).

A.S. *fell*, cruel, fierce.

Ferde, fourth, [815](#), [973](#), [2285](#).

Compare Dan. *fierde*.

Ferleit, wondered, [3117](#).

A.S. *fær-líc*, sudden, fearful. Burns has *ferlie*.

Fet, fetched, [433](#), [1154](#).

A.S. *feccan*, past tense, *ic feahte*.

Fongith, catcheth, seizeth, [1922](#).

A.S. *fangan*; Goth. *fahan*.

Forfare, to fare amiss, to perish, [1348](#).

A.S. *for-faran*.

Forlorn, lost, [3305](#).

A.S. *forloren*; cf. Goth. *fra-liusan*.

For-quhy; see *For-why*.

For-thi, } (there-fore), on that account, [332](#), [2261](#), [2731](#).

For-thy, } A.S. *forthý*; where *thý* (Gothic *thê*) is the instrumental case of *se*,
that.

For-wrocht (for-wrought), over-worked, wearied out, [888](#).

A.S. *forwyrca*.

For-why, [798](#), [925](#), [2209](#), } for the reason that, because that.

For-quhy, [2171](#), [2342](#), [2290](#), }

Found, to advance, go, [2612](#). J.

A.S. *fundian*, to try to find, go forward.

Franchis, generosity, [230](#).

R. *franchise*.

Fremmytneß, strangeness, alienation, [1508](#).

A.S. *fremdnes*.

Froit, enjoyment, [1644](#);

fruit, [2088](#), [2109](#).

R. *fruit*.

Frome, from the time that, [17](#), [1432](#).

Goth. *frums*, a beginning.

Fruschit, broken, dashed in pieces, [1201](#).

R. *frois*, broken; from the verb *froier*.

Fundyne, [497](#), } found (past part.).

Fundyng, [465](#), }

Fyne, faithful, true, [519](#).

See R. “*fine*, *fidéle*;” and “*fine*, *foi*.”

Fyne, end, [1388](#), [2081](#).

Fr. *fin*.

[Ganith](#), is suitable for, [991](#).

Icel. *gegna*. J. Compare Dan. *gavne*.

Ganyth, it; it profits; *used impersonally*, [121](#).

R. *gaagner*.

Gare, to cause, [910](#), [2416](#).

Dan. *giöre*; Icel. *göra*.

Gart, caused, [267](#), [2777](#).

Gentilleß, [917](#), [1847](#).

See *Gentrice*.

Gentrice, [130](#), [2757](#), } courtesy, nobleness.

Gentriß, [2790](#). } R. *gentillesse*.

Gere, gear, equipment, armour, [2777](#).

A.S. *gearwa*.

Gert, [384](#).

See [Gart](#).

Giffis, give thou, (lit. give ye, the plural being used in addressing the king),
[463](#).

A.S. *gifan*.

Gifyne, given, [1752](#).

Gilt, offended, done wrong, [699](#), [3015](#).

A.S. *gyltan*.

Grewhundis, greyhounds, [533](#), [537](#).

“O.N. *grey*, *grey-hundr*, a bitch.” Wedgwood.

Gowerne the, conduct thyself, [1598](#).

Grawis, groves, [2481](#).

Ch. *greves*.

Gyrð, grass, [10](#).

A.S. *gærs*.

Gyð, guise, fashion, custom, [545](#).

Ch. *gise*.

[Haade](#), had, [2150](#).

Habariowne, habergeon, [2889](#).

From *haubergeon*, the French form of Ger. *halsberge*.

See [Hawbrek](#).

Habirioune, habergeon, [3380](#).

[Haill](#), whole, [3246](#).

A.S. *hæl*.

Haknay, an ambling horse for a lady, [1730](#).

R. *hacquenée*.

Half; in the phrase on arthuris *half*, i.e. on Arthur's side, [883](#).

Compare use of Germ. *halb*.

Halk, a hawk, [1736](#), [2482](#).

A.S. *hafoc*.

Hall, various spellings of Haill, whole.

Hoil, }
Holl, }
Hail,

Hals, neck, [1054](#).

A.S. *hals*. Goth. *hals*.

Hant, to exercise, practise, [2191](#).

Fr. *hanter*, lit. to frequent.

Hardement, [801](#), [2669](#), } hardihood, boldness.

Hardyment, [900](#), [3362](#), } R. *hardement*.

Harrold, herald, [1047](#).

Hate, hot, [2552](#).

Havith, hath, [1940](#);
have, [3404](#).

Hawbrek, [1070](#), [1200](#), } hauberk, neck-defence;
Hawbryk, [3112](#), } Ger. *hals-berge*, armour for the neck.

Hawnt, to use, [3418](#).
See [Hant](#).

Hawntis, exercise, [2772](#).

He, high, [1969](#), [2552](#).
A.S. *háh*.

Hecht, hight, is called, [2140](#);
was called, [2290](#).

Hecht, to promise, [3101](#);
promised (*past part.*), [1142](#).
A.S. *hátan*.

Hedis, heads, [538](#), [869](#).

Hewy, [442](#), } heavy.
Heuy, [459](#), } A.S. *hefig*.

Hie, [550](#), } high.
Hye, [297](#), } See [He](#).

Hienes, highness, [126](#).

Ho, pause, stop, cessation, [2970](#).

According to J. radically the same with the verb *Houe*, or *How* (see [Houit](#)). The Dutch, however, use *hou*, hold! from *houden*, to hold.

Holl, whole, [106](#), [745](#).

Hore, hair, [365](#).

“Holȝe were his yȝen and vnder campe hores.”
(Early English Alliterative Poems; ed. Morris. See Poem B. l. 1695.)

The meaning of the line quoted is, “Hollow were his eyes, and under bent hairs.”

Hot, hight, was called, [754](#), [806](#);
is called, [1950](#).

A.S. *hátan* (neuter).

Houit, delayed, tarried, halted, [996](#).

“W. *hofian*, *hofio*, to fluctuate, hover, suspend,” Morris.

Hovith, stays, halts, [2829](#).

Howit, halted, [2814](#), [2842](#).

Howyns, halts, tarries, [2821](#).

Probably miswritten for “howyng.”

Hufyng, halting, delaying, [1046](#).

Hundyre, a hundred, [756](#), [1554](#).

I, in, [332](#).

Dan. *i*; Icel. *í*.

Iclosit, y-closed; i.e. enclosed, shut in, [53](#).

If, to give, [554](#).

In lines [1718-1910](#) the word occurs repeatedly in several forms; as *iffis*, *iffith*, giveth; *iffis*, give ye (put for give thou); *ifyne*, given, etc.

Ifyne, to give, [3454](#).

Iftis, gifts, [1741](#).

In the line preceding we have *giftis*.

Ilk; the ilk (= thilk) that, [629](#), [1601](#).

Literally, the ilk = the same.

A.S. *ylc*. See [1367](#).

Ilk, each, [2211](#), etc.

A.S. *ælc*.

Illumynare, luminary, [3](#).

Incontinent, } immediately, [253](#), [1215](#), [2647](#), [2834](#).

Incontynent, } Still used in French.

In-to-contynent (= Incontinent), [3020](#).

In to, used for “in;” *passim*.

Iornaye, journey, [680](#).

Irk, to become slothful, grow weary, tire, [2709](#).

A.S. *eargian*.

Iuperty, combat, [2547](#).

Fr. *jeu parti*, a thing left undecided;

hence the meanings, 1. strife, conflict; 2. jeopardy, as in Ch.

See J.; and Tyrwhitt’s note to C. T. 16211.

Iwond, [245](#), } wounded.

Iwondit, [226](#), } We find in A.S. both *wúnd* and *wúnded*.

I-wyß, certainly, of a surety, [1709](#), [1925](#), [1938](#).

A.S. *gewís*; Ger. *gewiss*. Often *wrongly* interpreted to mean, *I know*.

See [Wit](#).

[Kend](#), known, [548](#), [906](#).

[Laif](#), the remainder (lit. what is *left*), [1802](#), [3472](#).

A.S. *láf*. Burns has “the *lave*.”

Lametable, lamentable, [3265](#).

The omission of the *n* occurs again in [l. 2718](#), where we have *lemytable*.

Larges, liberality, [608](#), [1681](#), [1750](#).

Fr. *largesse*.

Larg, prodigal, profuse, [2434](#).

Lat, impediment, [958](#).

A.S. *létan*, means (1) to suffer, (2) to hinder.

Lat, to let, permit (used as an auxiliary verb), [803](#).

Latith, preventeth, [1927](#).

Lawrare, a laurel, [82](#).

Ch. *laurer*.

Learis, liars, [493](#).

Led, put down, beat down, depressed, overpowered, [2663](#).

It is the past tense of A.S. *lecgan*, to lay, to cause to submit, to kill.

Lef, to live, [564](#), [3230](#).

Leful, lawful, [1427](#).

Legis, lieges, subjects, [1957](#).

R. *lige*; Lat. *ligatus*.

Leich, leech, physician, [106](#).

A.S. *læce*; Dan. *læge*.

See [520](#), [2056](#).

Leif, to live, [952](#), [1392](#).

A.S. *lybban*; Goth. *liban*.

Leir, to learn, [1993](#).

Comp. D. *leeren*.

Lest, to list, to please, [555](#), [621](#).

A.S. *lystan*.

Lest, to last out against, sustain, [811](#).

A.S. *læstan*.

Lest, least, [1628](#).

Let, hindrance, [2495](#).

Leuch, laughed, [3240](#).

A.S. *hlihan*, past tense *ic hloh*.

Lewis, liveth, [1209](#).

Lewith, left, deserted, [1854](#).

Liging, [376](#).

The sense requires *lay*, i.e. the 3rd p. s. pt. t. *indic.*, but properly the word is the present participle, *lying*.

Longith, belongeth, [738](#), [1921](#), [2429](#), [2778](#).

Compare Dan. *lange*, to reach.

Longith, belonged, [3242](#).

Longyne, belonging, [433](#).

Lorn, lost, [2092](#);
destroyed, [2740](#).

See *For-lorn*.

Loß, praise, [1777](#).

Lat. *laus*. Ch. has *losed*, praised.

Low, } (1) law, [1602](#), [1628](#), [1636](#), etc.

Lowe, } (2) love, [29](#), [1620](#).

It is sometimes hard to say which is meant.

Compare Dan. *lov*, law; A.S. *luf*, love.

Luges, tents, [874](#), [881](#), [2500](#), [2680](#).

Fr. *loge*, *logis*; Ger. *laube*, a bower, from *laub*, foliage; Gothic *laúf*, a leaf.

Lugyne, a lodging, tent, [891](#).

Lyt, a little, [1233](#).

At lyte, in little, used as an expletive, [143](#).

Ma, short form of Make, [953](#).

Maad, made, [697](#).

Magre of, in spite of, [500](#), [960](#), [2679](#), [2702](#), [2711](#).

Sometimes “magre” is found without “of.”

Fr. *mal gré*.

Matalent, } displeasure, anger, [2169](#), [2660](#).

Matelent, } In both cases Mr Stevenson wrongly has *maltalement*.

R. *maltalement*, *mautalent*.

Mayne, [1026](#).

See Men.

Medyre, mediator (?), [1624](#).

I am not at all sure of this word, but we find in R. many strange forms of “mediator,” such as *méener*, *méeisneres*, etc. In the Supplement to the “Dictionnaire de l’Academie” we find *mediaire*, qui occupe le milieu, from Low Lat. *mediarius*.

N.B. In the MS. the “d” is indistinct.

See *mediare* in Ducange.

Meit, to dream, [363](#).

A.S. *mætan*.

Mekill, much, [876](#), [1236](#).

Mokil, [1265](#).

Melle, contest, battle, [2619](#).

Fr. *melée*, J.

Memoratyve, mindful, bearing in remembrance, [1430](#).

Fr. *mémoratif*.

Men, mean, way; “be ony men” = by any means, [2366](#);

so, too, “be ony mayne,” [1026](#).

Fr. *moyen*.

Men, to tell, declare, [510](#).

A.S. *mænan*.

Menye, a company, multitude (without special reference to number);
whence “a few menye,” a small company, [751](#).

Apparently from A.S. *menigu*; Ger. *menge*; but it may have nothing to do
with the modern word *many*, and is more probably from the O.F.
maisnée, a household.

Met, dreamt, [440](#).

See [Meit](#).

Meyne, [41](#).

See [Men](#).

Misgyit, misguided, [1663](#).

R. *guier*.

Mo, more, [3187](#), etc.

A.S. *má*.

Mon, man, [96](#).

Moneth, month, [569](#).

A.S. *mónáð*; Goth. *menoth*.

Morow, morning, [1](#), [30](#), [64](#), [341](#).

Goth. *maúrgins*.

Mot, must, [195](#).

A.S. *ic mót*.

Mys, a fault, [1888](#), [1937](#), [3230](#).

A.S. *mis*. Do o myß, to commit a fault, [1926](#).

Mysour, measure, [1830](#).

Myster, need, [1877](#), [2322](#).

Ch. *mistere*; R. *mester*; Lat. *ministerium*. Cf. Ital. *mestiere*.

[Nat](#), naught, [703](#).

Shortened from A.S. *ná wuht*, i.e. *no whit*.

Nece, nephew, [2200](#), [2245](#), [2720](#).

R. *niez*.

Nedlyngis, of necessity, [2337](#), J.

A.S. *neádinga*.

Nemmyt, considered, estimated, [649](#), [2852](#).

A.S. *nemnan*, to name, call.

Ner, near, [441](#).

Neulyngis, newly, again, [36](#), J.

A.S. *níwe-líce* (?).

Newis, for Nevis, nieves, fists, [1222](#).

Icel. *hnefi*. Dan. *næve*. Burns has *nieve*; Shakspeare *neif*.

Noght, not, [1182](#).

Noiß, nose, [2714](#).

R. *néis*.

Nome, name, [226](#), [320](#), [1546](#), [3341](#).

Fr. *nomme*.

Nome, took, [591](#), [1048](#).

A.S. *niman*, past tense, *ic nám*.

Northeast, north-east, [677](#).

Not (shortened from Ne wot), know not, [522](#), [3144](#).

A.S. *nát*, from *nitan* = *ne witan*.

Not, naught, [720](#).

See [Nat](#).

Noyith, annoyeth, [904](#).

Fr. *nuire*. Lat. *nocere*.

Noyt, annoyed, offended, [471](#).

Nys, } (nice), foolish, [127](#), [1946](#).

Nyce, } Fr. *niais*.

[O](#), a, an, *passim*; one, a single, [2998](#), [3003](#), [3393](#), etc.

Obeisand, obedient, [641](#).

Obeß, obey, [2134](#).

Oblist, obliged, [969](#).

Occupyte, to use, employ, [3457](#);

to dwell, [75](#).

Lat. *occupare*.

Of, with, [66](#).

Oft-syß, oft-times, [2304](#), [2594](#), [2789](#), [2885](#), [2929](#).

See [Syß](#).

On, and, [519](#).

Possibly a mistake.

One, on, often used for In; One to = unto.

Onan, } anon, [158](#), [1466](#), [2602](#), etc.

Onone, } The form “onan,” [1.3086](#), suggests the derivation of *anon*; viz.

Onon, } from A.S. *on-án*, in one; hence, forthwith, immediately.

Onys, once, at some time or other, [3013](#);

at onys, at once, [3187](#).

open.

Opin, [1286](#), }
Opine, [13](#), }

Or, ere, before, [77](#), [1887](#), [2545](#).
A.S. *ær*.

Ordand, to set in array, [784](#);
to prepare, procure, [1713](#).
R. *ordener*; Lat. *ordinare*.

Ordan, to provide, [2416](#), [2777](#).

Ordynat, ordained, [490](#).
See [l. 507](#).

Orest (= Arest), to arrest, stop, [3186](#).

Orient, east, [5](#).

Oucht, it; it is the duty of (= Lat. *debet*), [2995](#).
Strictly, we should here have had “it owes” (*debet*), not “it ought” (*debuit*).
See [Aw](#).

Ourfret, over-adorned, decked out, [71](#), [2480](#).
A.S. *frætwian*, to trim, adorn.

Out-throng (= Lat. *expressit*), expressed, uttered, [65](#).
A.S. *út*, out, and *þringan*, to press.

Owtrag, outrage, [3454](#).
R. *outrage*; Ital. *oltraggio*, from Lat. *ultra*.
The MS. has *outray*, probably owing to confusion with *affray* in the same line.
We find “owtrag” in [l. 2578](#).

Oyß, to use, [1701](#), J.

[Paid](#), pleased; ill paid, displeased, [908](#).
Low Lat. *pagare*, to pay, satisfy.

Palʒonis, pavilions, tents, [734](#);
plural of

Palzoune, a pavilion, a tent, [1305](#).

R. gives *pavillon*, a tent; cf. Low Lat. *papilio*, a tent.

Pan, pain, [1273](#).

Pas hyme, to pace, go, [362](#).

Paß, to go, [1213](#).

Pasing, pacing, departing, [371](#);
surpassing, [303](#), [346](#), [689](#), etc.

Pens, to think of, [1431](#).

Fr. *penser*.

Planly, at once, [3319](#).

J. gives “Playn, out of hand, like Fr. *de plain*.” In the same line “of” = off.

Plant, plaint, complaint, [137](#).

Fr. *plainte*.

Plesance, Plesans, pleasure, [941](#), [1939](#).

Plessith, pleases, [68](#).

Possede, to possess, [578](#).

Fr. *posseder*.

Poware, a power, a strong band of men, [2647](#). We now say *force*.

Powert, poverty, [1330](#), [1744](#).

Pref, to prove, [2229](#), [3476](#).

Prekand, pricking, spurring, [3089](#).

See the very first l. of Spenser’s *Faerie Queene*.

Prekyne, [2890](#), showy(?), gaudy(?).

J. gives “Preek, to be spruce; to crest; as ‘A bit *preekin* bodie,’ one attached to dress; *to prick*, to dress oneself.”

Compare D. *prijcken*.

Pretend, to attempt, aspire to, [3282](#), [3465](#).

Fr. *prétendre*. So, too, in lines [559](#), [583](#).

Pretendit, endeavour, attempt, [3442](#).

Process, narration, [316](#).

Wright gives “Proces, a story or relation, a process.” The writer is referring to his prologue or introduction.

Promyt, to promise, [965](#).

Proponit, proposed, [361](#), [445](#).

Pupil, people, [285](#).

Puple, people, [1367](#), [1498](#), [1520](#).

Pur, [1648](#),

Pure, [1697](#),

Pwre, [1655](#),

} poor.

[Quh-](#). Words beginning thus begin in modern English with Wh. Thus, Quhen = when, etc.

Quhilk (whilk), which, [184](#).

A.S. *hwylc* = Lat. *qualis* rather than *qui*.

Quhill, while, *used as a noun*, [1229](#), [1293](#).

A.S. *hwīl*, a period of time.

Quhill, until, [24](#), [198](#).

See [Whill](#).

Quhy; the quhy = the why, the reason, [123](#), [1497](#).

Qwhelis, wheels, [736](#).

A.S. *hweol*.

Qwheyar, whether, [1187](#).

Quhois, } whose, [171](#), [1297](#).

Qwhois, }

[Rachis](#), hounds, [531](#).

Su-G. *racka*, a bitch, which from the v. *racka*, to race, course. Perhaps connected with *brach*.

Radur, fear, [1489](#), J.

From Su-G. *rædd*, fearful; Dan. *ræd*.

fear.

Raddour, [2133](#),
Radour, [1835](#), [3465](#), }

Raid, rode, [3070](#), [3260](#), etc.

Ralef, relieve, [3364](#).

Ramed, remedy, [117](#).

See [Remed](#).

Randoune, in, [2542](#).

The corresponding line ([1. 739](#)) suggests that *in Randoune* = *al about*, i.e. in a circuit. But if we translate it by “in haste,” or “in great force,” we keep nearer to the true etymology. In Ogilvie’s Imperial Dictionary, s.v. Random, we find the Nor. Fr. *randonnée* explained to mean the “sweeping circuit made by a wounded and frightened animal;” but the true meaning of *randonnée* is certainly *force, impetuosity*; see R., Cotgrave, etc. In Danish, *rand* is a surrounding edge or margin; while in Dutch we find *rondom* round about.

Raquer, require, [2409](#).

Raß, race, swift course, [3088](#).

A.S. *ræs*. Compare Eng. *mill-race*, and D. *ras*.

Recidens, delay, [2359](#).

R. *residier*, to defer.

Recist, resist, [566](#), [660](#), [2578](#).

Recounterit, met (in a hostile manner), encountered, [2958](#).

Fr. *rencontrer*.

Record, witness, testimony; hence value, [388](#).

R. *record*.

Recorde, to speak of, mention;

hard recorde, heard say, [121](#), [595](#).

Recorde, speak out, [454](#), [481](#).

See R. *recorder*.

Recordith, is suitable, belongs, [606](#).

Recourse, to return, [1798](#).

Lat. *recurrere*.

Red, to advise, [1027](#), [1198](#).

A.S. *rædan*; Goth. *rêdan*.

Relewit (relieved), lifted up again, rescued, [2617](#).

Fr. *relever*. J.

Remede, [89](#), } remedy.

Remed, [718](#), }

Remuf, remove, [655](#).

Report, to narrate, [266](#);

to explain, [294](#);

to state, [320](#).

Reprefe, reproof, defeat, [764](#).

Reput, he reputed, i.e. thought, considered, [743](#).

Resaut, received, [2796](#).

Resawit, received, kept, [2106](#).

We should have expected to find “reseruit.”

Resonite, resounded, [66](#).

Resydens, delay, [670](#).

See [Recidens](#).

Revare, [275](#), } river.

Rewar, [2893](#), }

Rewere, [2812](#), }

Reweyll, proud, haughty, [2853](#).

R. *revelé*, fier, hautain, orgueilleux. Compare Lat. *rebellare*.

Richwysneß, righteousness, [1406](#).

A.S. *rihtwísnes*.

Rigne, [94](#), [1527](#), } a kingdom.

Ring, [1468](#), }

Ringe, [1325](#), }

Fr. *régne*. Ch. *regne*.

Rignis, kingdoms, [1858](#).

Rignis, Rignith, reigneth, [1825](#), [782](#).

Ringne, a kingdom, [1952](#).

Rout, a company, a band, [812](#), [2956](#), [3403](#).

Rowt, [2600](#).

Rowmyth, roometh, i.e. makes void, empties, [3390](#).

A.S. *rúmian*.

Rown, run; *past part.* [2488](#), [2820](#).

Rwn, run, [2545](#).

Rygnis, kingdoms, [1904](#).

Ryne, to run, [113](#). See [2952](#).

Ryng, to reign, [1409](#), [2130](#).

[Sa](#), so, [3322](#), [3406](#).

Dan. *saa*.

Saade, said, [698](#).

Salust, saluted, [546](#), [919](#), [1553](#), [2749](#).

Ch. *salewe*.

Salosing, salutation, [1309](#).

Sar, sorely, [1660](#).

Sauch, saw, [817](#), [1219](#), [1225](#).

A.S. *ic seáh*, from *seón*.

Schawin, shewn, [2387](#).

Schent, disgraced, ruined, [1880](#).

A.S. *scendan*; Dan. *skiænde*.

Schrewit, accursed, [1945](#).

Scilla, the name of a bird, also called Ciris, [2483](#).

——“plumis in avem mutata vocatur

Ciris, et a tonso est hoc nomen adepta capillo.”

(Ovid, Met. viii. [150](#).)

Screwis, shrews, ill-natured persons, [1053](#).

More often used of males than females in old authors.

Sedulis, letters, [142](#).

R. *cedule*.

Sege, a seat, [2258](#).

Fr. *siège*.

Semble, a warlike assembly, hostile gathering, [988](#), [2206](#).

Semblit, assembled, [845](#).

G. *sammeln*; from Goth. *sama*, *samana*.

Semblyng, encountering, [2951](#).

See [Assemble](#).

Sen, since, [709](#), [800](#), etc.

Sen at, since that. In Piers Plowman we find *syn*.

Septure, sceptre, [666](#).

Sere, several, various, [594](#), [731](#), [746](#).

“Su-G. *sær*, adv. denoting separation.” J. Cf. Lat. *se*-.

Sess, to cease, [14](#), etc.

Fr. *cesser*.

Set, although.

Sew, to follow up, seek, [2326](#).

R. *suir*; Fr. *suivre*.

Sew, to follow up, go, proceed, [3145](#).

Sewyt, [2614](#).

Shauyth, shewith, [412](#).

Sice, such, [2115](#).

Scotch, *sic*.

Snybbyth, snubs, checks, [3387](#).

Comp. D. *sneb*, a beak; *snebbig*, snappish.

Sobing, sobbing, moaning, [2658](#).

Socht, } sought to go; and hence, made his (or their) way, proceeded, went,
Soght, } [2619](#), [3179](#), [3357](#), [3428](#).

Sought one, advanced upon, attacked, [3149](#), [3311](#).

Sought to, made his way to, [3130](#).

A.S. *sécan*, past tense *ic sóhte*, to seek, approach, go towards.

Sor, sorrow, anxiety, [74](#).

A.S. *sorh*; Goth. *saúrga*.

Sort, lot, fate, [26](#).

Fr. *sort*.

Sound, to be consonant with, [149](#).

See Gloss. to Tyrwhitt's Chaucer.

Lat. *sonare*.

Soundith, [1811](#). "So the puple soundith," so the opinion of the people tends.

"As fer as *souneth* into honestee."

(Chaucer: *Monkes Prologue*.)

Soundith, tend, [1943](#);

tends, [149](#).

Sown, sound, [1035](#).

Fr. *son*.

Sownis, sounds, [772](#), [3436](#).

Spent, fastened, clasped, [2809](#).

A.S. *spannan*, to clasp, join. Comp. Dan. *spænde*, to stretch, span, buckle together.

Spere, } sphere, [6](#), [170](#);

Spir, } speris, spheres, circuits, [24](#).

Spere, to inquire, [1170](#).

A.S. *spirian*, to track. Cf. G. *spur*.

Sperithis, spear's, [810](#).

Spill, to destroy, ruin, [1990](#).

A.S. *spillan*.

Spreit, spirit, [81](#), [364](#).

Stak, [226](#). J. gives "to the steeks, *completely*;" and this is the sense here.

See Jamieson: s.v. “Steik.” Halliwell gives *stake*, to block up; also *steck*, a stopping place (cf. Shakespeare’s *sticking-place*, Macb. i. vii. l. 60). In the N. of France it is said of one killed or severely wounded, *il a eu son estoque*, he has had his belly-ful; from *estoquer*, to cram, satiate, “stodge.”

Compare Ital. *stucco*, cloyed. It has also been suggested that *to the stak* may mean to the *stock*, i.e. up to the hilt, very deeply.

Start, started up, leapt, [994](#), [1094](#).

Stede, stead, place, [218](#), [1124](#).

A.S. *stede*.

Steir, to stir, [817](#).

A.S. *stirian*.

Stekith, shuts, [1651](#).

Ger. *stecken*. Burns has *steek*.

Stek, shut, concluded, [316](#).

Stell, steel, [809](#).

Stell commonly means a stall, or fixed place; but the form *stell* for *steel* occurs; e.g. “Brounstelle was heuy and also kene.” *Arthur*, l. 97.

Sterapis, [3056](#), } stirrups.

Steropis, [3132](#), } A.S. *stí-rap* or *stíge-ráp*, from *stígan*, to mount, and *ráp*, rope.

Stere, ruler, arbiter, [1020](#);
control, guidance, [1974](#).

Stere, to rule, control, [1344](#), [2884](#),
A.S. *stýran*.

Stere, to stir, move, go, [3430](#).

See [Steir](#).

Sterith, stirreth, [2829](#).

Sterf, to die, [1028](#).

A.S. *steorfan*.

Sterit, governed, [612](#).

A.S. *stýran*.

Stert, started, [377](#).

Stok, the stake to which a baited bear is chained, [3386](#).

Stour, conflict, [1108](#), [2607](#), [3124](#).

R. *estour*.

Straucht, stretched out, [3090](#).

A.S. *streccan*, past part. *gestreht*.

Strekith, stretcheth, i.e. exciteth to his full stride, [3082](#).

Subiet, [1799](#), } subject; subjects.

Subeitis, [1828](#), }

Subiettis, [1878](#), }

Sudandly, Sodandly, suddenly, [1009](#), [1876](#).

Suet, sweet, [331](#).

Suppris, (surprise), overwhelming power, [691](#), [860](#), [2651](#);
oppression, [1352](#).

Fr. *surprendre*, to catch unawares.

Supprisit, overwhelmed, [1237](#), [1282](#);
overpowered, [2705](#), [3208](#).

Supprisit ded, suddenly killed, [3125](#).

Surry3enis, surgeons, [2726](#).

Suth, sooth, true, [110](#).

A.S. *sóð*.

Suthfastnes, truth, [1183](#).

A.S. *sóðfæstnes*.

Sutly, soothly, truly, [963](#).

Swelf, a gulf such as is in the centre of a whirlpool, a vortex, [1318](#), J.

A.S. *swelgan*, to swallow up.

Sweuen, a dream, [440](#).

A.S. *swefn*.

Swth, sooth, true, [2753](#).

See [Suth](#).

Syne, [2026](#),
Synne, [2029](#), } sin.

Syne, afterwards, next. J. [45](#), [794](#), etc.

Syß, times, [3054](#).

A.S. *sið*.

[Tais](#), [1095](#), [3005](#), } takes. Abbreviated, as “ma” is from “make.”
[Taiis](#), [1141](#). } See [Ma](#).

Tane, taken, [264](#).

Ten, grief, vexation, [2646](#), [3237](#).

A.S. *teonan*, to vex.

Tennandis, tennants, vassals holding fiefs, [1729](#).

R. *tenancier*.

Than, then, [3111](#).

The, (1) they, (2) thee, (3) thy.

Thelke, that, [709](#).

See [l. 629](#), where *the ilk* occurs; and see [Ilk](#).

Thir, these, those, [2734](#), [2745](#), [2911](#), [3110](#), etc.

Thithingis, tidings, [2279](#).

A.S. *tidan*, to happen.

Tho, then, [545](#), [2221](#);

them, [2368](#).

Thoore, there, [628](#). Thore, [1102](#).

Thrid, third, [370](#), [2347](#), [2401](#).

A.S. *pridda*.

Throng, closely pressed, crowded, [3366](#).

A.S. *pringan*.

Til, to; til have, to have, [706](#).

Tint, lost, [1384](#).

See [Tyne](#).

Tithandis, tidings, [2310](#).

Tithingis, tidings, [902](#), [2336](#).

To, too, besides, [3045](#).

Togidder, together, [254](#).

To-kerwith, carves or cuts to pieces; al to-kerwith, cuts all to pieces, [868](#).

A.S. *to-ceorfian*. The prefix *to-* is intensive, and forms a part of the verb.

See Judges ix. [53](#): “All to-brake his skull;” i.e. utterly brake;
sometimes misprinted “all to break” (!).

Ton, taken, [1054](#), [1071](#).

Ton, one; the ton, the one, [1822](#).

The tone = A.S. *þæt áne*.

To-schent, disfigured, [1221](#).

The intensive form of the A.S. verb *scendan*, to shame, destroy. In the same line we have *to-hurt*, and in the next line *to-rent*, words modelled on the same form. We find, e.g., in Spenser, the forms *all to-rent*, *all to-brus’d*. (See the note on the prefix *To-* in the Glossary to William of Palerne.)

Tothir, the other, [2536](#).

The tothir = A.S. *þæt opere*, where *þæt* is the neuter gender of the definite article. Burns has *the tither*.

Toyer (= tother), the other;

y being written for the A.S. *þ* (*th*), [2571](#), [2584](#).

Traist, to trust, to be confident, [390](#), [1129](#), [1149](#), J.

Trast, [1659](#).

Traisting of (trusting), reliance upon, or expectation of, [25](#), J.

Translat, [508](#), } to transfer, remove.

Transulat, [2204](#), }

Tratroy, treachery, [3224](#).

See R. *traïtor*.

Trety, treatise, [145](#).

Fr. *traité*.

Trewis, truce, [1568](#), [2488](#), [2545](#).

Tronsione, [239](#),
Trunscyoune, [2962](#),
Trownsclown, [2890](#), } a truncheon, a stump of a spear.
Fr. *tronçon*; from Lat. *truncus*.
In the last passage it means a sceptre, *bâton*.

“One hytte hym vpon the oldé wounde
Wyth A tronchon of an ore;” (oar.)
(Le Morte Arthur, l. 3071.)

Troucht, truth, [161](#).

Tueching, [403](#), } touching.
Tweching, [386](#), }

Tyne, to lose, [1258](#), [1387](#).

Icel. *týna*.

Tynith, loseth, [1761](#).

Tynt, lost, [175](#), [1384](#), [1521](#).

[Unwist](#), unknown, [1140](#).

[Valis](#), falls; we should read “falís,” [2475](#).

Valkyne, to waken, [8](#).

See [Awalk](#).

Vall, billow, wave, [1317](#).

Ger. *welle*, a wave; *quelle*, a spring;

Icel. *vella*, to *well* up, boil. Cf. also A.S. *wæl*; Du. *wiel*; Lancashire *weele*,
an eddy, whirlpool. So, too, in Burns:—

“Whyles owre a linn the burnie plays,
As thro’ the glen it wimpl’t;
Whyles round a rocky scaur it stays,
Whyles in a *wiel* it dimpl’t.”

Varand, to warrant, protect, [3411](#).

R. *warandir*.

Varnit, warned, [622](#).

Vassolag, a deed of prowess.

Pasing vassolag, surpassing valour, [257](#).

R. has *vasselage*, courage, valour, valourous deeds, as indicative of the fulfilment of the duties of a *vassal*. We now speak of rendering *good service*.

Vassolage, valour, [2724](#).

Veir, were, [818](#).

Veris, wars, [305](#).

See [Were](#).

Veryng, were, [2971](#).

A.S. *wáron*.

Vicht, a wight, a person, [10](#), [55](#), [67](#).

A.S. *wiht*.

Virslyng, wrestling, struggling, [3384](#).

J. gives the forms *warsell*, *wersill*.

Visare, wiser, [607](#).

Viting, to know, [410](#).

A.S. *witan*.

Vncouth, lit. *unknown*; hence little known, rare, valuable, [1734](#).

A.S. *uncúð*.

Vodis, woods, [1000](#).

Vombe, womb, bowels, [375](#).

Goth. *wamba*.

Vondit, wounded, [700](#).

Vpwarpath, warped up, i.e. drawn up, [63](#).

See Note to this line. It occurs in Gawain Douglas's prologue to his translation of the [12](#)th Book of the *Æneid*.

Du. *opwerpen*, from Goth. *waírpan*, to cast.

Vsyt, used, [1197](#), [1208](#).

Vyre, a cross-bow bolt, [1092](#).

R. *vire*; cf. Lat. *vertere*.

[Wald](#), would, [419](#), [470](#), etc.

Walkin, to waken, wake, [1239](#).

See [Awalk](#).

Wapnis, weapons, [241](#).

A.S. *wápen*, or *wápn*.

Ward, world, [3184](#).

Grose's Provincial Dictionary gives *Ward* = world; and the omission of the *l* is not uncommon; see *Genesis and Exodus* (E.E.T.S.), ll. 32, 1315.

Wassolage, valour, [2708](#).

See [Vassolag](#).

Wat, know, [512](#).

Wawasouris, vavasours, [1729](#).

A *Vavasour* was a sub-vassal, holding a small fief dependent on a larger fief; a sort of esquire.

R. *vavaseur*.

Weil, very. Weil long, a very long time, [79](#).

Comp. Ger. *viel*, J.

Wencussith, vanquisheth, [3331](#);

vanquished, [3337](#).

Wencust, vanquished, [2841](#).

Wend, (1) to go, [2191](#);

(2) weened, thought, [3481](#).

Wentail, ventaile, a part of the helmet which opened to admit air, [1056](#).

R. *ventaile*; from Lat. *ventus*.

Were, (1) war. Fr. *guerre*. R. *werre*, [308](#), etc.

(2) doubt, [84](#), etc. "But were," without doubt. A.S. *wár*, cautious, *wary*.

(3) worse, [1930](#). Burns has *waur*.

Wering, weary, [58](#).

A.S. *wérig*.

Werray, very, true, [1262](#), [2017](#).

Werroure, warrior, [248](#).

Weriour, warrior, [663](#).

Wers, worse, [515](#).

Weryng, were, [2493](#).

Wex, to be grieved, be vexed, [156](#).

Weyn, vain, [382](#), [524](#).

Weyne, *in phr.* but weyne, without doubt, [2880](#).

A.S. *wénan*, to ween, to suppose.

Whill, until, [1136](#), J. Formed from A.S. *hwíl*, a period of time.

Wice, advice, counsel, [1909](#).

Shortened from Awys.

Wichsaif, vouchsafe, [355](#), [1391](#).

Wichsauf, *id.* [2364](#).

Wicht, wight, person, [131](#).

Wicht, strong, nimble, [248](#).

“Su-G. *wig*” J. Sw. *vig*.

Wight, with, [918](#). Possibly miswritten.

Wist, knew, [225](#), [1047](#). See [Wit](#).

Wit, to know, [268](#).

A.S. *witan*; pres. *ic wát*, past tense, *ic wiste*.

Wit, knowledge, [2504](#).

With, by, [723](#).

Withschaif, vouchsafe, [1458](#).

With-thy, on this condition, [961](#).

See *For-thy*.

Wnkouth, little known, [146](#). See [Vncouth](#).

Wnwemmyt, undefined, [2097](#).

A.S. *wam*, *wem*, a spot.

Wnwyst, unknown, secretly, [219](#), [269](#).

Wod (wood), mad, [3334](#), [3440](#).

A.S. *wód*. Goth. *wôds*.

Woid, mad, [2695](#). Perhaps we should read *woud*.

Wonde, wand, rod, or sceptre of justice, [1601](#), [1891](#). J.

Wonk, winked, [1058](#).

Wonne, to dwell, [2046](#). A.S. *wunian*.

Worschip, honour, [1158](#), [1164](#).

A.S. *weorð-scipe*.

Wot, know, [192](#), etc. See [Wit](#).

Wox, voice, [13](#).

Lat. *vox*.

Woyß, voice, [3473](#).

Wrechitnes, misery, [2102](#);
miserliness, niggardliness, [1795](#), [1859](#).

Wy, reason; “to euery wy,” for every reason, on all accounts, [2356](#).

Compare *Quhy*.

Wycht, strong, nimble, [2592](#).

See [Wicht](#).

Wynyth, getteth, acquireth, [1832](#).

Wyre, a cross-bow bolt, [3290](#).

See [Vyre](#).

Wys, vice, [1795](#).

Wysis, [1540](#).

[Y](#), written for “th.” Thus we find “oyer” for “other,” etc. The error arose with scribes who did not understand either the true form or force of the old symbol þ.

Yaf, gave, [387](#).

Yald, yield, [553](#);
yielded, [558](#).

A.S. *gildan*.

Yclepit, called, [414](#).

Yef, give, [563](#).

Yeif, give, [923](#).

Yer, year, [610](#).

Used instead of the plural “yeris,” as in [l. 3243](#).

Yewyne, given, [1500](#).

Ygrave, buried, [1800](#).

Comp. Ger. *begraben*.

Yhere, ear, [1576](#).

Yher, year, [2064](#).

Used instead of “yheris,” [3243](#).

Yhis, yes, [1397](#).

Yis, yes, [514](#);
this, [160](#).

Ylys, isles, [2858](#), [2882](#).

Ymong, among, [821](#).

Yneuch, enough, [2135](#).

A.S. *genog*.

Yolde, yielded (to be), [951](#), [1088](#).

Ystatut, appointed, [2529](#).

Fr. *statuer*.

Ywyß, certainly, [1798](#), [1942](#).

See [Iwyß](#).

[3eme](#), to take of, regard, have respect to, [665](#).

A.S. *géman*.

3ere, year, [342](#).

Ȝerys, years, [23](#), [1432](#).

Ȝewith, giveth, [1772](#).

Ȝha, yes, [2843](#).

Ger. *ja*.

Ȝhe, ye, [921](#).

Observe that, as in this line, *ye* (A.S. *ge*) is the *nominative*, and *you* (A.S. *eów*) the *objective* case.

Ȝhed, went, [1486](#)

Ch. has *yede*.

A.S. *ic eóde*, past tense of *gán*, to go.

Goth. *ik ıddja*, past tense of *gaggan*, to go.

Ȝher, year, [2064](#), [2274](#).

Ȝhing, young, [2868](#).

Ȝhis, yes, [1397](#).

Ȝhouth-hed, youth-hood, youth, [2772](#).

Ȝhud, went, [2696](#).

See [Ȝhed](#).

Ȝis, yes, [3406](#).

Ȝolde, yielded, [291](#), [380](#), [951](#).

A.S. *ic geald*, past tense of *gyldan*, to pay, to yield.

Ȝude, went, [2944](#).

See [Ȝhed](#).

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